

EDITING COPY for Basic track. Change text here, then send the file back. Keep TABLE / DIAGRAM / NOTE blocks if you still want those layouts in the academy. Quiz answers are marked in red for editors — hide them before any student-facing export. Education only. Not a buy signal.

Crypto Foundations

BASIC TRACK | slug: crypto-foundations | level: beginner | FREE

The first course in Crystal Stones Academy Basic. You start with zero Web3 background. By the end you can explain how modern money actually moves, why Bitcoin exists, how a blockchain records transfers, how keys control assets, and how a token like Crystal Stones sits on BNB Smart Chain. Every term is defined in full. Education only — not a buy order.

Module 1: Why crypto exists

Modern money is a ledger. Bitcoin was a public alternative to that design. Learn the problems, the history, and the words people abuse — before any wallet.

Lesson 1: How money works today (26 min)

How money works today

This academy does not start with Bitcoin. It starts with the money you already use, because crypto is a response to that design — not a separate planet.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to say, in your own words, what money is for, what a ledger is, what actually happens in a bank transfer, and why inflation and institutional trust matter. Those four ideas are the floor of everything later.

Money is a tool with three jobs

A thing is treated as money when a group of people use it for three jobs. Economists give each job a name. We will use the names, then unpack them until they are usable.

Medium of exchange

This means: the thing people actually hand over when they trade. You do not have to find someone who both wants your bicycle and has the exact groceries you need. That failed matching problem is **barter**. Money exists so trade does not depend on a double coincidence of wants.

If a café will not accept concert tickets for coffee, those tickets are not a medium of exchange in that café. The medium of exchange is whatever the group already agrees to take.

Store of value

This means: you can keep the thing and still spend it later. A salary paid today is meant to still buy rent in two weeks. Food spoils. A service cannot sit in a drawer. Money is supposed to wait.

When it waits badly — when the same 100 units buy much less next year — that is a **store-of-value failure**. We will name that failure **inflation** later in this lesson. Hold the idea: storing is one of money's jobs, and some forms of money do it worse than others.

Unit of account

This means: prices are written in it. A laptop costs 900 units, not “three favours and a used printer.” A shared measuring stick lets you compare one good with another, keep books, sign contracts, and tax income.

If something cannot do these three jobs well, people quietly stop treating it as money. That is why we do not price houses in birthday cakes.

Job	Official name	What it means in practice
A way to trade	Medium of exchange	People accept it for goods and services
A way to keep	Store of value	It still works later
A way to measure	Unit of account	Prices, salaries, and debts are written in it

Fiat money, cash, and bank money are not the same object

Fiat money is money that is money because a government and a legal system say it is, and because people actually use it — not because each note is a claim on a fixed weight of gold. The US dollar, the euro, the yen, the pound, and most national currencies you will meet are fiat.

That does not make them “fake.” It makes their value a social and political fact: laws, taxes, banks, and habit. Crypto later offers a different design (rules in public software). You cannot understand that offer if you think “real money” only means metal in a vault.

Your everyday “money” is also not one layer. It is a stack:

- **Cash** — notes and coins. Physical. Limited in practice. Easy to lose. Slow to move across a border.
- **Bank money** — numbers in an account. This is most of the money in a modern economy. It is a **promise** from a bank that they will honour withdrawals and payments under their rules.
- **Central-bank money** — the base layer. Commercial banks settle with each other through the central bank of that currency. You rarely touch this layer directly. It is still the foundation the other layers sit on.

When you tap a card or send a bank transfer, you are almost never mailing paper. You are asking two **ledgers** to change.

A ledger is the book of who is owed what

A **ledger** is the official list of balances and transfers. A village savings group's notebook is a ledger. A bank's database is a ledger. A blockchain, later in this course, is also a ledger — with different rules about who may write, who may read, and how pages are sealed.

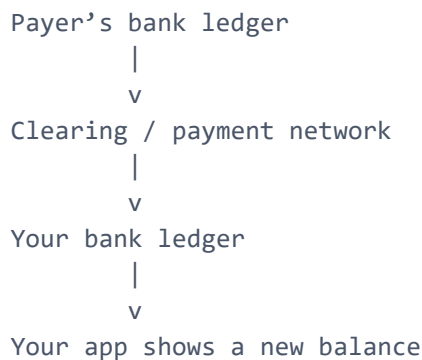
Your app “balance” is not a stack of notes with your name in a drawer. A few notes exist. Most money is an entry: the bank’s book says they owe you that amount, subject to law and their contract with you.

Worked scenario. You invoice a client for 2,000 units of your local currency. They pay by bank transfer.

1. Their bank checks: is the account open, is there enough, is the payment allowed.
2. If yes, their bank reduces the number on their page.
3. A clearing system — the plumbing between banks — carries the instruction.
4. Your bank increases the number on your page.
5. Your app shows a credit. You still cannot spend *cash* until you withdraw. What you have is a claim on your bank.

If any bookkeeper in that chain says no — fraud alert, frozen account, name mismatch, holiday window, sanctions list — the payment fails even though both of you “meant” it.

DIAGRAM



If any ledger says NO, you are not paid.

Layer	What you see	What it really is	Who can stop it
Cash	Notes in your hand	Physical fiat	Theft, loss, seizure
Bank deposit	App balance	A promise in the bank's ledger	Bank, court, fraud team
Card / fintech wallet	Card or app	A company ledger, often sitting on banks underneath	The company, plus the banks behind it

Inflation is a purchasing-power problem

Inflation means the general level of prices is rising, so each unit of money buys less. It is not a rumour and it is not only a Twitter argument.

Two honest drivers, without a conspiracy:

- Goods become scarcer (supply shock).
- More money chases the same goods (too much currency relative to output).

Families feel it as: “this salary does not finish the month.” That is a store-of-value complaint. People respond by converting idle cash into inventory, foreign currency, land, or financial assets. They are not all “traders.” They are trying to store value in something that shrinks more slowly.

Crypto culture talks about this constantly. Some overclaim. The useful beginner fact is calmer: **if a committee can create more of a money, that money has a political layer.** Whether that is good or bad is a debate. That it is true of major fiat currencies is not a debate.

Bitcoin’s designers later wanted a money whose **supply rules sat in public software** instead of a committee. You do not need Bitcoin yet. You need to see why anyone would want a different kind of ledger.

Trust is the product banks actually sell

When you keep a salary in a bank, you are buying a bundle:

- a number you hope is real
- the hope the app works on Monday
- the hope a transfer does not vanish
- some chance that if a card is stolen, a bank or a scheme might reverse the payment

That bundle is **trust**. It is expensive to build. It is why banks ask who you are.

KYC means **Know Your Customer**: the institution records your identity because the law and their risk team require it. It is why some transfers have cut-off times. It is why sending money to another country can feel like paperwork — **correspondent banks**, compliance checks, and **SWIFT** messages (the messaging network banks use to instruct international payments, not a pile of cash flying across the ocean).

Crypto’s later bet is different: publish the rule-book and the ledger so you are not depending on one company’s database to know whether a transfer is valid. That bet has a cost. If you lose the secret that controls your coins, there is no “dear bank, reset my password.” This course will be honest about both sides.

ACADEMY NOTE Academy rule: we will never tell you “fiat is fake” or “crypto replaces your bank tomorrow.” Adults use both. The skill is knowing what each layer can and cannot do. If a sentence uses a heavy word, the next paragraph must define it. If it does not, the course has failed — not you.

What this lesson is for

You are not here to become an economist. You are here so that words like ledger, settlement, inflation, and KYC are tools, not fog. Module 2 will reuse them without apology. Module 3 will place tokens like Crystal Stones on top of them.

Say this out loud

- Money is a tool with three jobs: trade, keep, measure.
- Most of the “money” in an app is not notes. It is a row in an institution’s book. That book is a ledger.
- A transfer is two ledgers changing. If a bookkeeper says no, you are not paid.
- Inflation is when the same units buy less.
- Banks sell trust: uptime, records, and sometimes reversal. That trust has rules — identity checks, delays, freezes.

Next lesson we name the exact design problems that made people want a public ledger. Still no shopping for coins.

Lesson 2: The problems crypto was built to fix (26 min)

The problems crypto was built to fix

Bitcoin did not appear because people were bored on the internet. It appeared after decades of trying to make **digital cash** — value that moves like a file, but cannot be photocopied — and it launched in 2009 after a global banking crisis.

This lesson names the **design problems**. It does not claim crypto solved all of them for everyone, everywhere. An academy that skips the problems will later sell you slogans.

Problem 1 — a computer file can be copied

A photo can be copied. An MP3 can be copied. If digital cash worked like a photo, you could spend the same 50 units twice: once with a merchant, once with a second merchant.

That is the **double-spend problem**. In one sentence: **how do you stop someone copying electronic money and using it twice?**

Banks already have an answer. They are the referee. Only one database is allowed to be right. When you pay by card, your bank subtracts the amount. You cannot also spend those same units at a second shop unless the bank is wrong or offline.

Crypto's bet was different: let thousands of computers share one public history, and make cheating more expensive than honesty. You do not need the engineering yet. You need the question: **if there is no bank to be the referee, who stops the photocopy?**

Worked scenario. You email a PDF invoice. The client can print it ten times. That is fine for a document. It is fatal for money. Digital value needs a single official history of "this unit already moved."

Problem 2 — you need permission to move value

To send money far away you usually need:

- an account that is open
- identity documents
- a corridor that is not blocked
- a weekday when the office is working
- fees that make a small payment look silly

When institutions work, this is a feature: fraud controls, consumer protection, a place to call. When they do not — capital controls, a frozen account, a weekend, a freelancer paid from another continent, a migrant sending a small remittance — the same design feels like a locked gate.

Permissionless, at the protocol level, means: if you can pay the network's fee and broadcast a valid instruction, the software does not ask your surname.

Two honest warnings, immediately:

- Apps on top of crypto (an exchange, a random website, a “support agent”) often **do** ask your name. Do not confuse the **base network** with a company’s signup form.
- Permissionless is not a moral halo. It also means the network will not parent you if you send to a thief.

Problem 3 — some payments reverse, some do not

Card networks often allow a **chargeback**: a customer disputes a payment and the scheme may reverse it. That protects buyers. It also means a merchant can lose both the goods and the money.

A completed international wire is closer to the opposite: recovery is a bank-and-legal story, not a button.

Finality means: after a payment has settled under the system’s rules, it is not a customer-care undo.

Bitcoin-style transfers are closer to **digital cash**: after the network has accepted them and later pages have buried them, there is no “dear support, reverse this.” That is power for settlement. It is danger if you send to the wrong place.

Academy rule from today, and we will repeat it until it is a reflex: **practice on tiny amounts**.

System	Can someone reverse it?	Everyday use	How it fails
Card networks	Often a bank or scheme can	Shopping	Chargeback, freeze, “do not honour”
Bank transfer	Sometimes a bank or court	Local and some international payments	Delay, wrong account, compliance hold
Cash	Almost nobody	Face to face	Theft, bulk, distance
Public blockchain	Network rules, not a help desk	Open settlement	Lost secret, wrong address, scam

Problem 4 — one company owns the history

If one office holds the only copy of the book:

- a hack can rewrite balances
- an insider can mint extra units
- an outage can freeze a country-sized pile of apps
- a legal order can freeze you, which may be legitimate law enforcement and may also be abuse — the design itself does not know the difference

A bank is a professional, regulated version of that single book. Public blockchains publish the history. Anyone can, in principle, check how many coins exist. That does **not** make the **price** honest. It makes the **rule-set inspectable**. Those are different skills. This course trains the second one first.

DIAGRAM

Private ledger

One institution’s database

Public ledger

Many independent copies

You must ask “please update me”
If that office is down, you wait

Anyone can read the history
One company is not the referee

Problem 5 — knowing your name is not the same as knowing the money is good

Traditional finance mixes three questions:

- **Who are you?** (KYC, passport, national ID)
- **Is this money good?** (clearing and settlement)
- **Are you allowed?** (compliance, sanctions, fraud checks)

A public blockchain mostly answers one question: **is this digital signature allowed to move these coins under the published rules?**

It does not know if you are a saint. It does not replace courts. Laws still apply to people and businesses. This academy will not teach you to hide from the law. Crypto is not a cloak of invisibility.

What crypto does not automatically fix

Say these so they stick:

- It does not fix poverty by existing.
- It does not fix bad budgeting.
- It can make scams faster, because a completed send is hard to reverse.
- An unbacked token can still collapse in price.
- Clicking a random “airdrop” is not a job.

Worked scenario. A designer in one country is owed payment from a client in another. The bank corridor is closed until Monday, the fee eats a chunk of a small invoice, and a compliance hold asks for documents. That pain is real. Crypto networks were built to let value move with a fee to the network rather than a stack of offices. That does **not** mean the designer should skip identity law, tax law, or fraud caution. It means you can now see the design tradeoff: **open settlement versus institutional parenting.**

ACADEMY NOTE If someone says “crypto fixes everything,” they are selling. If someone says “crypto is only crime,” they are not looking at the actual tradeoff: public rules, user-held secrets, hard-to-reverse settlement. Hold both thoughts.

How this maps to Crystal Stones Academy

We teach the rails first so you can later look at a wallet screen, a BNB Smart Chain token, or a project website without drowning. Crystal Stones is one project on one network. It is not the definition of crypto. You will learn the map, then where that token sits, without being told to buy it.

Say this out loud

- Digital money can be copied unless a referee — a bank, or a public network — agrees on one history. That is the double-spend problem.

- Moving value today often needs permission from offices. Base crypto networks do not ask your surname. Apps on top often still do.
- Hard-to-reverse settlement is both a feature and a way to get hurt.
- One private notebook is convenient and fragile. A public notebook is inspectable and unforgiving.
- Crypto does not parent you.

Next: Bitcoin's origin, as history, not as worship.

Lesson 3: Bitcoin's origin, without hype (26 min)

Bitcoin's origin, without hype

On 31 October 2008, a person or group using the name **Satoshi Nakamoto** circulated a nine-page paper:

Bitcoin: A Peer-to-Peer Electronic Cash System. The network started in January 2009.

You do not need to worship Satoshi. Nobody even knows who they were. You need to know what was new, what was borrowed, and what people still get wrong.

Why 2008 is context, not a meme

Banks in several countries were failing or being rescued. Ordinary depositors watched institutions that held their salaries get special treatment they would never get. You do not need to become a historian. You need the feeling: **the bookkeepers were saved; many customers were not.**

The first page of Bitcoin's chain even contained a newspaper headline about bank bailouts. Treat that as a timestamp and a political hint, not as a prophecy.

People wanted electronic cash that:

- did not bounce like an informal IOU
- did not require a card network's permission
- had a public issuance schedule

The one-sentence idea, then the slow version

One sentence: **Bitcoin is a network that lets people transfer a scarce digital token without a company in the middle, by agreeing on a shared history of transfers.**

That sentence contains three older tools glued together, not one miracle.

1. Digital signatures

A **digital signature** is mathematics that proves "the holder of this secret authorised this message," without revealing the secret. It is older than Bitcoin. It is the difference between "anyone can type a payment" and "only the key-holder can authorise it." Module 2 will go deeper. Today: it is proof of authorisation without a government name on the form.

2. A peer-to-peer network

Peer-to-peer means computers talk to each other without a required headquarters. Email and file-sharing used versions of this idea. Bitcoin uses it so there is no single “Bitcoin Inc” server that must approve a payment.

3. A way to agree on order

If two signed payments try to spend the same coins, the network must pick one history. Bitcoin combined **proof-of-work** (computers spending real electricity to propose the next page of the book) with a rule: honest computers build on the longest valid chain of pages.

The miracle people sell you is “magic internet money.” The actual invention is glue: old tools, stuck together, so there is a public notebook nobody privately owns.

Why a cap of 21 million is a recipe, not a slogan

Bitcoin’s software is written so that only **21 million** coins will ever be created, released on a known timetable. About every four years the reward for producing a new page is cut in half. That event is called the **halving**. You do not need to trade around it. You need this: the issuance is a public recipe.

Whether 21 million is “good money” is a debate. Whether the cap is **auditable in software** is a fact. Fiat currencies do not come with a public recipe that says “this is the last unit that will ever exist.” That is not an insult to fiat. It is a difference in design.

Claim you will hear	What is actually true
“Satoshi was a god”	Unknown author. The design is what matters.
“Bitcoin is anonymous”	Addresses are public. It is closer to a nickname than a mask. Investigators exist.
“Bitcoin is free to send”	You pay a fee to the computers that add the next page. Fees rise when the network is busy.
“One confirmation means done forever”	Wait for more pages on top. Exchanges often wait several.
“Bitcoin has a CEO”	No. Changes are social plus software. Messy, not corporate.

How a Bitcoin transfer works, stripped of apps

Forget the logos. The skeleton is:

- You hold a secret (we will call it a **private key** in the next module) that controls some coins recorded in the public book.
- You write an instruction: “these coins, to this address, with this fee.”
- You **sign** it. That signature is the proof it was you, without writing your government name.
- The instruction sits in a waiting room. The waiting room is called the **mempool**. Ugly word. It only means “pile of valid-looking proposals not yet written into a page.”
- A **miner** — a computer spending electricity to win the right to propose the next page — includes your instruction in a **block** (a page of the book).
- Later pages are stacked on top. Changing your payment would mean rebuilding all those pages faster than the honest network. That gets expensive.

You will later do a cousin of this on BNB Smart Chain with a phone wallet. Same family of ideas, different engine.

DIAGRAM



What Bitcoin is not

- Not a company stock.
- Not a bank account with “forgot password.”
- Not a perfect tool for buying a bottle of water every time. Space on the pages is limited. Think of it more like a **settlement rail** than a coffee-app database.
- Not guaranteed profit. Price is a market. This course will not forecast it.

Energy, said in class, not in comments

Bitcoin uses real electricity for proof-of-work. Critics say that is waste. Supporters say a global notebook that is hard to bully should cost something real, the way a vault costs steel.

You are allowed both thoughts: **security has a cost**, and **cost deserves scrutiny**. An academy that hides the argument is a fan club.

Altcoins, in one paragraph so you are not lost

After Bitcoin, thousands of other coins and tokens appeared. Some copy the idea. Some add extra programs (**Ethereum** is the landmark for that). Some are jokes. Some are frauds. **Being “on a blockchain” is not a quality stamp**. The rest of Basic trains you to tell rails apart.

ACADEMY NOTE Never send money to “Satoshi,” recovery agents, or people who say they can unlock a wallet for a fee. Bitcoin has no admin. Crystal Stones Academy staff will never ask you for the secret words that control a wallet.

Say this out loud

- Bitcoin launched after a crisis, as a public notebook with no company in the middle.
- The new part was the glue: signatures, a network, and a costly way to agree on order.
- 21 million is a software recipe, not a slogan.

- A send is: sign, wait, get written into a page, then buried under more pages.
- No CEO, no password reset, no guaranteed price.

Next: the most abused word in crypto — decentralised.

Lesson 4: What “decentralized” actually means (26 min)

What “decentralized” actually means

Decentralized is the most abused word in crypto. Projects stamp it on websites the way restaurants stamp “organic” on menus.

In this academy it has a testable meaning: **no single office can unilaterally rewrite the ledger, freeze every user, or change the rules without the network noticing.**

A system can be open in one layer and closed in another. If you do not separate the layers, a slogan will fool you.

Five places power can sit

1. Who keeps a copy of the book?

If only one server in one company has the truth, that is a private ledger. If thousands of independent computers keep the same history, that is closer to a public one. Those computers are **nodes**. A node is simply a machine running the network’s software and (if it is a full node) checking the rules.

2. Who is allowed to add the next page?

If one operator always writes the next page, they are a central bank with extra steps. If many **miners** or **validators** compete or rotate, power is more spread. “More spread” is not “perfect.” Concentration can still exist — a few mining pools, a small validator set.

3. Who can change the software people actually run?

A CEO can ship an app update tonight. A public network changes only if enough people choose to run new software. Messy. Also harder to sneak a silent rewrite.

4. Who holds most of the coins?

If ten wallets own almost everything, those ten people **are** the economy, even if the software looks open. This is **holder concentration**. It is a different question from “how many nodes exist.”

5. How do humans actually enter?

If the only way to use the thing is one company’s app store, that company is still the gate, even if the chain underneath is public.

Bitcoin can be relatively open at the protocol and still be used mainly through an exchange. Crystal Stones can be a token on a public chain and still have a team, a website, and a marketing wallet. Both facts can be true at once.

Layer	More centralised picture	More open picture
The book	One bank database	Many independent copies
Login	Email and password at a company	A secret you hold
Upgrades	CEO ships an update	Users choose which software to run
On-ramp	Only one broker	Many exchanges and peer trades
Token supply	An admin can mint forever	Fixed or public mint rules

Why people want it

The hopes, stated as tests, not poetry:

- A manager cannot quietly delete you from the ledger because you argued.
- Supply is not only a press release. People can inspect the book.
- The network does not close at 5pm like a local branch.
- The base rules do not know your politics.

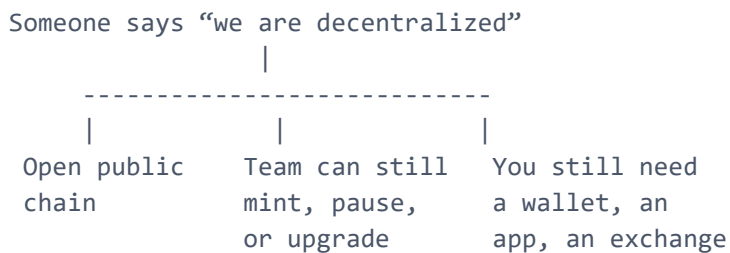
Those are hopes. Hopes are not guarantees.

Why fake versions hurt people

- An **admin key** that can create new tokens out of nothing is a private money printer. “Admin key” means a privileged secret the deployer kept so they can mint, pause, or upgrade.
- A contract the team can silently **upgrade** is a company product. That can be legitimate — just do not call it unchangeable.
- If 90% of tokens sit in three wallets, “community governance” is a group chat.
- If the only place to trade is one website, that website *is* the product.

Worked scenario. A website says “fully decentralized token.” You ask five questions and get: the team can pause transfers, they can mint, liquidity sits in a pool they can empty, and the only market is their own site. The chain underneath may still be public. The **product** is not decentralised. You have just used the layer test. Keep it.

DIAGRAM



A practical test you will reuse all course

When a site says decentralised, ask, slowly:

- Can I verify the contract address from more than the project’s banner?
- Can the team pause transfers?
- Can they pull the trading pool (a **rug** — they yank the money and leave you holding a name)?

- Who can change fees or taxes?
- If the website dies, does the token still exist on the chain?

For Crystal Stones, the public BEP-20 contract on BNB Smart Chain, as the project publishes it, is:

0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00

Treat that as a **reference to verify**, not as a request to buy. Always check the address on a block explorer yourself. Scammers clone sites and change one character.

We have not yet taught you the explorer. That comes in Module 2. Today you only need the habit: **a slogan is not a test**.

Spectrum, not a switch

Think of a slider:

- Left: cash in a box. You are the bank. Theft is on you.
- Middle: a fintech app. Convenient. Freezeable.
- Right-open: a public chain plus secrets you hold. Powerful. Unforgiving.

Professionals choose positions on that slider for different jobs. Sending rent is not the same job as settling a token between two programs.

ACADEMY NOTE Holding the secret that controls coins is power and liability. A “decentralised” token sitting inside a centralised exchange account is, for practical purposes, an IOU from that exchange. Self-custody is a later course. Do not rush it with money you cannot lose.

Say this out loud

- Decentralised is a test of power, not a vibe.
- Ask who keeps the book, who writes the next page, who can mint, and who you must log into.
- Apps can be central while chains are open.
- Crystal Stones’ contract address is something to verify, not a buy order.
- Self-custody is later. Do not skip the queue.

Next: what crypto is not — immune-system training before any more vocabulary.

Lesson 5: What crypto is not (24 min)

What crypto is not

This is the most important lesson in Module 1. Everything else is vocabulary. This one is how you avoid becoming the story people tell after a loss.

The blockchain will happily settle a theft. The network is not your parent.

It is not a job that pays you for existing

If a stranger offers any of these, it is theft wearing a suit:

- a “listing bonus” if you send USDT first
- a romance that needs you to help move coins
- a fake Crystal Stones, exchange, or academy-checkout support agent
- a chat admin who will “double your money in 45 minutes”
- someone who wants the **seed phrase** (the secret word list that controls a wallet) to “validate” you

There is no validation that requires those words. Anyone who has them can empty the wallet. We will unpack seed phrases slowly in Module 2. Today’s rule is simpler: **no human, including academy staff, should ever receive those words.**

Pitch	Translation
“Guaranteed 20% a week”	They need new deposits to pay old ones, or they are lying.
“Send your seed phrase to validate”	They will empty the wallet.
“We are the official recovery team”	There is no recovery team.
“Pay gas in advance to this address”	Fake fee. Real networks take fees inside the transaction.
“The CEO privately told me the price”	Gossip is not a process.

It is not automatically anonymous, legal, or tax-free

Pseudonymous means: the chain sees addresses, not necessarily passport names. That is not the same as **anonymous** (nobody can link you). Explorers show transfers. Exchanges in many countries share identity data with regulators. Local law still applies to fraud, securities, and tax.

This academy does not give legal advice. It tells you not to confuse “it happened on a chain” with “it happened outside the law.”

It is not one coin

People say “crypto” the way they say “food.” Food includes rice, poison, and chewing gum. Crypto includes:

- Bitcoin
- Ether and other **native coins** (the home money of a network)
- **Tokens** on those networks (including Crystal Stones on BNB Smart Chain)
- **Stablecoins** like USDT — tokens designed to track a currency such as the dollar
- Experiments, games, scams

You will learn to name three things together, every time:

12. the **asset** (what are you sending — USDT? Bitcoin?)
13. the **network** (which road — BNB Smart Chain? Ethereum? Tron?)
14. the **address** (the destination, checked twice)

Mixing them is how people send USDT on the wrong road and never see it again. Same nickname on the bottle. Different planet.

Worked scenario. A checkout says “send USDT on BNB Smart Chain (BEP-20).” You hold USDT on Tron (TRC-20) because an exchange used the same ticker. You send. The letters still say USDT. The receiving contract

on BSC never sees it. “Successful” on the sending side does not mean the receiver was paid. Same nickname. Wrong network. This is one of the most expensive beginner mistakes in the industry. The complete sentence is never “I sent USDT.” It is “I sent this asset, on this network, to this address.”

DIAGRAM

Wrong sentence: “I will send crypto.”

Right sentence:

Asset: USDT

Network: BNB Smart Chain (BEP-20)

App: a wallet you chose on purpose

Address: 0x.... checked twice

It is not a substitute for reading

A whitepaper can be poetry. A Telegram with 50,000 members can be bots. A screenshot of “liquidity” can be borrowed for an hour.

Your process in this academy, every time:

15. Name the chain.
16. Name the contract (if it is a token).
17. Name who can change the contract.
18. Name how you would exit (who would buy it from you).
19. Only then talk about the story.

Crystal Stones’ public story is an **RWA** token. That acronym means **real-world asset**: a digital token whose story is tied to physical things. The project describes a BEP-20 asset on BNB Smart Chain, deflationary design, and backing claims around solid minerals, with additional talk of real estate and petroleum.

That is **their claim to verify**, not a certificate from this classroom that minerals sit in a vault under your name. Later courses teach how to read those claims. This lesson only plants the habit: **claim is not proof**.

“Too late” and “too early” are both sales

“Too late, you missed it” is a sales tactic. “Too early, just buy now” is also a sales tactic. The adult position: **learn the rails before you size a bet**. Many people skip this and become the exit — the person who buys so that earlier people can cash out.

ACADEMY NOTE Crystal Stones Academy will never ask for your seed phrase, private key, or a “verification deposit.” Payments for paid tracks, when live, go through the checkout we build — not a random wallet pasted in chat.

Module 1 wrap

You now have:

- a model of money as ledgers
- the problems public ledgers attacked

- Bitcoin as a historical design, not a religion
- a working test for “decentralised”
- a scam filter

The quiz is not trivia for its own sake. If you cannot pass it, you will misread Module 2, where we open the engine.

Say this out loud

- Three scam patterns: fake love, fake support, fake guaranteed yield. The chain will not save you.
- “Crypto” is a supermarket aisle, not one product.
- Always name asset, network, and address together.
- An RWA story is a claim. Claims need evidence.
- This academy refuses investment guarantees.

Take the quiz. Then we will walk, slowly, through what a blockchain actually is.

Module quiz (answers included for editors)

Q1. Most of the money in a bank app is best described as?

- A. Paper notes stored in your phone
- B. A ledger entry — a promise recorded by the bank
- C. Gold bars in the SIM card
- D. Bitcoin wrapped as local currency

Correct answer: B

Q2. The three jobs of money are?

- A. Mining, staking, and listing
- B. Medium of exchange, store of value, and unit of account
- C. Email, password, and PIN
- D. Asset, logo, and ticker

Correct answer: B

Q3. The double-spend problem is?

- A. Paying a card fee twice
- B. Copying the same digital cash so it can be spent more than once
- C. Inflation over two years
- D. A bank opening two branches

Correct answer: B

Q4. A public blockchain is designed mainly to?

- A. Guarantee token prices go up

- B. Hide all payments from every observer
- C. Let many computers share one inspectable history of transfers
- D. Replace all courts

Correct answer: C

Q5. “Permissionless” at the protocol level means?

- A. Apps never ask for your name
- B. If you broadcast a valid instruction and pay the network fee, the software does not ask your surname
- C. Crime is legal
- D. You no longer need keys

Correct answer: B

Q6. Someone in chat asks for your seed phrase to “validate” an account. You should?

- A. Send it quickly before it expires
- B. Treat it as a theft attempt and refuse — those words control the wallet
- C. Send half the phrase
- D. Post it in the project group for help

Correct answer: B

Q7. A permissionless protocol with a company mobile app means?

- A. The whole stack is equally decentralised
- B. The chain may be open while the app can still freeze your login
- C. The app is illegal
- D. You no longer need keys ever

Correct answer: B

Q8. When sending value you must name at least?

- A. Only the ticker, like USDT
- B. The influencer who recommended it
- C. Asset, network, and destination address
- D. Only the amount in USD

Correct answer: C

Module 2: How a blockchain works

Transactions, blocks, hashes, keys, and consensus — defined in full, then stitched into one send.

Lesson 1: Transactions, blocks, and the chain (26 min)

Transactions, blocks, and the chain

A **blockchain** is a shared ledger with strict rules for adding pages. The ledger is copied to many computers. Each **page** is a **block**. Each **line** on the page is usually a **transaction**.

IBM, banks, and every serious explainer use the same skeleton: record → agree → seal with a hash → link to the previous seal. We will walk that skeleton until it is boring. Boring is the goal. Magic is how scams talk.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to separate a proposed payment from a confirmed one, explain why pages are batched, and explain why linking fingerprints makes old history expensive to edit.

A transaction is a proposed edit, not a finished payment

A **transaction** is a signed instruction the network has not necessarily accepted yet. Simplified:

“Address A sends 10 units to address B, and pays a fee to whoever includes this in a block.”

It is not complete when you tap Send in a wallet. It is complete when the network **accepts it into the official history**.

Until then it is a rumour in the **mempool** — a waiting room of valid-looking proposals. Ugly word. Picture an out-tray on a desk: signed forms waiting for the next official page.

If the network is busy, the form can wait. If the fee is too small on some networks, it can wait a long time. On BNB Smart Chain, waiting is usually short. Still, **Send is not settled**.

Worked scenario. You tap Send on a token transfer. Your wallet shows “pending.” A recipient who ships goods at that moment is taking the same risk as a merchant who hands over a laptop because a card terminal said “processing.” Settlement is a later state.

A block is a batch with a seal

Networks do not write one line at a time to everyone on earth. They batch.

A block typically contains:

- a list of transactions
- a timestamp
- a reference to the **previous block’s hash**
- other header fields (nonce, height, Merkle root — names you can learn later; you do not need them to pass this module)

A **hash** is a fingerprint of the block’s contents. Change a comma, the fingerprint changes. Lesson 4 of this module will unpack hashes as tamper alarms. Today: the seal notices edits.

Idea	Everyday picture	Chain picture
Transaction	A signed instruction, like a cheque	“Move these coins, signed by the key”
Mempool	Out-tray on a desk	Waiting to be picked

Block	A numbered page of cheques	Batch sealed with a hash
Chain	Pages glued in order	Each page names the previous fingerprint

Why linking hashes makes history sticky

Block 100's header includes the hash of block 99. Block 101 includes the hash of 100.

If you try to secretly edit a transaction in block 90, block 90's hash changes. Then 91 no longer points at a real parent. You must rebuild 91, 92, ... up to now, faster than the honest network. On a large proof-of-work or well-distributed proof-of-stake chain, that is the expensive part.

This is **immutability in practice**: not “cannot theoretically change,” but “economically stupid to rewrite deep history.”

DIAGRAM

```

Block 89  hash: a91f
    |
    v
Block 90  txs.... prev: a91f  hash: b22c
    |
    v
Block 91  txs.... prev: b22c  hash: c80e

Edit a tx in 90 => b22c becomes garbage => 91 breaks

```

Confirmations are extra pages on top

When your transfer is in the latest block, it has **1 confirmation**. Each new block on top adds one.

Exchanges wait for more confirmations on Bitcoin than on faster chains because a deeper burial is harder to undo. BNB Smart Chain is faster than Bitcoin. It is still not a joke to wait for an explorer to show success before you ship goods.

Confirmation does not mean “a human approved you.” It means “this many official pages now sit on top of the page that contains your payment.”

Nodes and light clients

A **full node** stores and checks the rules — a complete copy of the book, or enough of it to verify.

Your phone wallet is often a **light client**: it does not keep the whole chain. It asks another computer for data. That helper is often called an **RPC node** (Remote Procedure Call — simply “a node you call for answers”). Convenient. It also means you are trusting that RPC a little. Advanced users run or choose RPCs carefully. You do not need to run a node this week.

What people mix up, on purpose, so it stops

Three confusions wreck beginners the first week they open a wallet:

Pending versus confirmed. Pending means the proposal is in the mempool, or the wallet has broadcast it. Confirmed means a block producer included it. Deeply confirmed means more blocks sit on top. A merchant who ships at “pending” is taking credit-card-processing risk with fewer consumer protections.

The wallet screen versus the chain. Your app can lag, lie if it is malware, or cache an old state. The chain is the book. An explorer reads the book. When those two disagree, the book wins.

“The blockchain” as one computer. There is no single Bitcoin computer in one building. There are many nodes sharing one history. That is why a screenshot from one app is not the network, and why “the blockchain is down” usually means *your app, your RPC, or one chain among many* — not every ledger on earth.

Worked scenario. A freelancer sends a payment and immediately messages “check your wallet.” The recipient’s app still shows zero. Two honest explanations exist: the transaction is still in the mempool, or the recipient’s light wallet has not refreshed from its RPC. A third, dishonest explanation is a fake “sent” screenshot. The adult move is not an argument. It is: open the explorer, paste the transaction ID or the destination address, and read the official history. If the row is not there, it is not paid. Module 2’s later lessons will make that reflex mechanical.

This is the skill the rest of Basic is for: **you stop taking apps at their word, and you start taking public ledgers at theirs.**

ACADEMY NOTE If this lesson still feels like a pile of new words, keep only four: line (transaction), page (block), glue (hash of the previous page), waiting room (mempool). Everything else in this module hangs on those four.

Say this out loud

- A transaction is a proposal. It is settled when it is written into the official book.
- A block is a page of proposals with a seal.
- Pages name the previous seal so quiet edits break the glue.
- Confirmations are extra pages on top.
- Your phone wallet is often asking a helper computer, not storing the whole chain.

Next: the object that actually controls coins — keys.

Lesson 2: Keys, addresses, and “your keys, your coins” (26 min)

Keys, addresses, and “your keys, your coins”

If Module 1 was money, this lesson is **property law for the internet of value**.

On typical public chains, coins are not stored “in the app.” The chain stores balances (or UTXOs — unspent outputs, Bitcoin’s accounting style). Your **private key** is the power of attorney to move them.

People mix three objects. Mixing them is how funds disappear.

The three pieces, defined

Private key

A huge secret number. Anyone who has it can sign “yes, move these coins.” This is the vault combination. If someone copies it, they can empty the account. There is no bank manager to call.

Public key

Mathematics derives this from the private key. You can show it. Other computers use it to check that a signature is real. Think of it as the lock on a door: people can see the lock. They cannot open it without the key.

Address

A shorter form you paste when someone should pay you. Like an account number, except there is no bank to call if you paste it wrong. On Ethereum-style chains (including BNB Smart Chain) addresses look like `0x` followed by 40 hexadecimal characters.

A **seed phrase** (12 or 24 ordinary words, also called a **recovery phrase** or **mnemonic**) is a human backup that can regenerate those keys. If you photograph it, you photographed your vault. If you type it into a “giveaway website,” you handed over the vault.

Object	Share it?	If stolen
Private key / seed phrase	NEVER	Funds can be drained now
Address	Yes, when receiving	People can see you got paid; they cannot spend unless they have the key
Wallet app password	No	May lock the key on that one device — not a chain-level reset
Exchange email login	No	They can empty the exchange account; that is not the same as chain keys

Worked scenario — email versus a house. Your email address is public enough to receive a message. Your email password must not be public. A wallet **address** is the email address of value. The **private key / seed** is the password — except there is no “reset password” link, because there is no company in the middle. A wallet **app PIN** is only the lock on that one phone’s drawer. Resetting the PIN does not reset the chain.

Two ways to “have” crypto

Self-custody

You hold the keys. A carefully used software wallet. Later, a hardware device. The chain agrees you can spend because you can sign.

Custodial

An exchange or app holds the keys and shows you a balance. You have an account, like a bank. Useful for changing local currency into crypto. Also: exchange risk, freezes, phishing of the login.

Neither is morally superior. **Mixing them up is how people lose everything.** “I have Bitcoin on an exchange” means you have an **IOU** from that exchange until you withdraw to an address you control. An IOU is a promise in **their** ledger, not coins sitting in a key you hold.

DIAGRAM



The slogan **“your keys, your coins”** means: whoever can sign with the private key can spend the assets. If you do not hold the keys, you hold a promise.

How a seed phrase actually works (without the priesthood)

A seed phrase is not a password you invented. It is a human encoding of a large random number. Wallet software runs a standard (you will hear **BIP-39** — a Bitcoin Improvement Proposal that most ecosystems reused) to turn those words into keys.

Consequences that matter on day one:

- The words are the backup. The app is disposable. Uninstalling the app does not move coins. Losing the words without a copy does.
- Word order matters. The same 12 words in a different order are a different vault.
- A 13th “passphrase” some wallets offer is an extra secret on top of the 12. If you do not understand it, do not turn it on. People have locked themselves out with a forgotten extra word.
- Anyone who sees the words, even for two seconds on a camera, can copy the vault. There is no “they didn’t spend it yet, so it is still safe.” Assume spent.

Worked scenario. You buy a new phone. The old phone is dead. If the 12 words are on paper, you install a reputable wallet from the official store, type the words **into that wallet, once, offline as much as possible**, and the same addresses reappear. If the words were only in a photo album or a chat backup, assume they leaked. Create a new wallet, move whatever remains with a tiny test first, and retire the old one. That migration is a later course in slow motion. Today you only need the law: **the words are the vault.**

Why an exchange login is not a key

An exchange email and password protect an account on a company’s servers. Two-factor codes protect that same account. None of that is a private key for coins on the chain — unless you withdraw.

While funds sit on the exchange:

- the company can freeze withdrawals
- a phishing site can steal the login
- the company’s own failure becomes your failure

That is not an argument against using exchanges. It is an argument against saying “I hold Bitcoin” when you hold a balance in an app. Precise language is a safety tool.

Why mistakes are brutal

There is no “forgot private key” email. That is the point of removing the company, and it is the cost.

Common disasters, in the order we will keep repeating:

- Typing an address by hand and missing one character. Coins go to someone else’s door, or to a door nobody can open. **Copy, then check the first and last 6 characters.**
- Sending an asset on the wrong network (USDT on Ethereum to an address that was meant for BNB Smart Chain). Same nickname, different planet. Often unrecoverable.
- “Support” in chat asking for 12 words. The wallet empties in seconds.
- Malware that swaps the address you copied. You paste a thief’s address without seeing it.

ACADEMY NOTE In a later Basic course (Wallets, Keys & Self-Custody) you will practise this slowly. Do not generate a seed phrase on a random website. Do not type a seed into cloud docs or chat. Do not use a seed to “unlock a bonus.” There is no bonus. Crystal Stones Academy will never ask for a seed.

Smart-contract accounts (preview only)

On Ethereum-style chains (including BNB Smart Chain), some “wallets” are programs with extra rules. You still need a key to control them. Extra rules can help (**multisig**: 2-of-3 people must sign) or hurt (a hidden owner key). Park this. You do not need it to pass this module.

Say this out loud

- The chain does not know your name. It knows keys and addresses.
- Address is how people pay you. Private key is how you spend. Seed phrase recreates the private key. App password is only the lock on that device.
- “I have coins on an exchange” means the company owes you, until you withdraw.
- Crystal Stones Academy will never ask for a seed.

Next: who is allowed to add the next page of the book — miners and validators.

Lesson 3: Who keeps the ledger: miners and validators (26 min)

Who keeps the ledger: miners and validators

Someone must propose the next block. If everyone writes at once, the notebook forks into arguments. **Consensus** is the rule for picking one valid next page.

You do not need to become an engineer. You need this sentence: **block producers are paid to follow the rules, and they compete or rotate so one office is not the central bank.**

Two famous engines

Proof of Work (Bitcoin)

Miners spend energy guessing hashes. The winner publishes a block. Others check it is valid and build on it. Energy is the cost of attacking. To rewrite history you must out-spend the honest set of miners.

Proof of Stake (Ethereum today)

Validators lock capital as a bond. If they cheat, they can be punished (**slashing** — a protocol penalty that destroys some of the locked capital). If they are honest, they earn fees and rewards.

BNB Smart Chain is not Bitcoin mining. It uses a staked / authority-style design: a smaller set of validators, faster pages, cheaper fees.

	Proof of Work	Proof of Stake / validator nets
Who produces blocks	Miners with hardware	Validators with stake (and rules)
Attack cost	Energy + machines	Capital at risk + social control of validators
Energy use	High by design	Much lower
Familiar example	Bitcoin	Ethereum (after 2022)

BNB Smart Chain, in honest beginner terms

Remember three names, slowly:

- **BNB Smart Chain** (people say **BSC**) is a **network** — a road.
- **BNB** is the **native coin** of that road. It pays the fee.
- **BEP-20** is the style of token on that road, the cousin of Ethereum's **ERC-20**.

Crystal Stones' token lives here as BEP-20. That does not make Crystal Stones into BNB. It makes it a token riding the BSC road.

BSC is more centralised than Bitcoin at the validator layer. That is a tradeoff: speed and low fees versus “as hard as Bitcoin to lean on politically.” Adults pick rails on purpose. We will not pretend every chain is equally neutral.

EVM-compatible means: it speaks the same contract language as Ethereum. Tools, wallets, and token standards look familiar. Compatibility is not identity. BSC is still a different book, with different validators and different fees.

What “consensus” is actually deciding

Consensus is not a group chat vote about whether you are a good person. It is a rule for this question: **which page is the next official page?**

If two valid-looking pages appear at once, the network must pick. Different engines pick differently:

- Proof of work: the page that came with enough computational work, then the chain that honest miners extend.
- Proof of stake: the page that a scheduled (or elected) validator proposed, then the chain that honest validators attest to.

A **fork** is what happens when two histories exist for a while. Short forks happen. Deep, successful attacks are what large networks make expensive. You do not need to trade around forks. You need this: **your payment is not “the universe agreed.” It is “this network’s rule picked a history that includes your transaction.”**

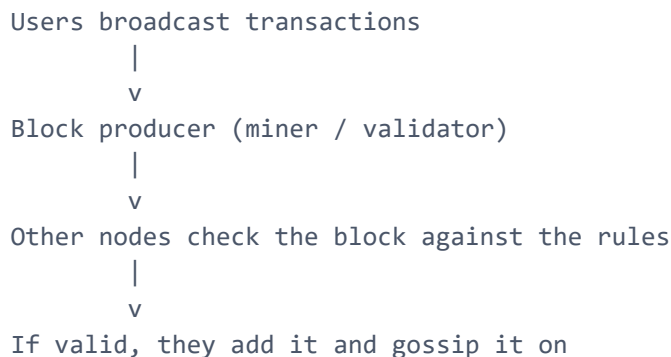
That is why “it is on the blockchain” is an incomplete sentence. *Which* blockchain? *How many* confirmations? *Which* token contract?

Why validator concentration is a real sentence, not an insult

When people say BSC is “more centralised than Bitcoin,” they are not calling it fake. They are saying: fewer independent block producers, more ability for that set to pause or reorganise under pressure, in exchange for speed and low fees.

Bitcoin’s cost is energy and slowness. Ethereum’s cost is gas that can spike. BSC’s cost is a smaller validator set. **There is no free rail.** This academy uses BSC because Crystal Stones lives there and because cheap, fast blocks are how beginners survive their first practice sends. We will not pretend that choice is ideologically pure. We will teach you to name it.

DIAGRAM



Fees are bids for block space

You are not paying “Crystal Stones” when you move a token on BSC. You typically pay **BNB** as **gas**.

Gas is the network fee for computation and inclusion. The courier does not take the token as payment. The courier takes the road’s home money.

People lose funds because they hold a token but have zero BNB. The wallet refuses the send — or they follow a scammer who says “send gas to this address first.” Real gas is taken **inside** the transaction, not as a separate gift to a stranger.

Write this until it is a reflex:

Token ≠ gas. Gas is the native coin of the chain.

On Bitcoin, fees are in bitcoin. On Ethereum, fees are in ether. On BSC, fees are in BNB.

Worked scenario. A wallet holds 500 units of a BEP-20 token and 0 BNB. The owner tries to send the token. The wallet cannot pay the validator. Nothing moves. A stranger in chat offers “I will unlock your gas if you

send 0.05 BNB to this address.” That is theft. The fix is to obtain a small amount of BNB through a venue you chose on purpose — never by paying a stranger’s “unlock” invoice.

Finality is a spectrum

Some chains treat a block as done quickly. Bitcoin wants more burial. If a shop releases a phone at 0 confirmations, they are taking risk. Wait until an explorer shows success before you hand over something you cannot claw back.

ACADEMY NOTE You do not need to become a miner or a validator. You need one habit: before you send, ask “what is the gas coin on this network, and do I have a little of it?” If the answer is no, stop. Do not send that gas coin to a stranger who offered to unlock you.

Say this out loud

- Someone must propose the next page or the book becomes an argument.
- Miners spend energy. Validators lock capital. Both are paid to follow rules.
- BSC is a faster, cheaper, more validator-concentrated road than Bitcoin.
- To move a token on BSC you still need BNB for gas.
- Fast and cheap is a tradeoff, not a free lunch.

Next: why forging a transaction is hard — without a maths degree.

Lesson 4: Why a transaction is hard to fake (26 min)

Why a transaction is hard to fake

Scammers fake *you*. They almost never fake the chain’s arithmetic. This lesson is why.

A thief cannot easily walk into a bank and write “pay me two million” on your page. They need your login, or a court, or a staff insider. On a public chain, they need your **private key**, or they need to trick you into signing.

Digital signatures

Your wallet signs a message: “move X from my address.” Nodes check the signature against the address’s public key. Without the private key, you cannot produce a valid signature. That is not a password guess like “1234.” The space is enormous.

So the attack that works is **trick the human into signing** (phishing, malware, fake sites), not “hack SHA-256 with a laptop in a café.”

Phishing means: a fake site or message that looks official so you type a secret or click a signature you should not. The chain then executes honestly. Honesty of the chain is not protection if you authorised the theft.

Hashes as tamper alarms

A **cryptographic hash** takes any input and produces a fixed-size fingerprint (Bitcoin uses **SHA-256** — a specific hash function. You do not need to compute it). Good hashes are:

- **one-way** — you cannot reverse the fingerprint back to the original
- **collision-resistant** — hard to find two inputs with the same fingerprint
- **chaotic** — one flipped bit wrecks the output

Blocks commit to their transactions with hashes (often in a **Merkle tree** — a way to fingerprint many transactions efficiently so you can prove one payment was in a block without sending the whole block). Change one payment, the fingerprint moves, peers reject the block.

Attack	Why it usually fails on a healthy public chain
Invent a signature	Need the private key
Edit an old block secretly	Child blocks still point at the old hash
Print extra Bitcoin	Nodes reject blocks that break issuance rules
Replay someone else's tx as new	Nonces / UTXOs make copies invalid
Lie in a screenshot	Screenshots are not consensus — check an explorer

Explorers are your eyes

A **block explorer** is a website that reads the same public data nodes see.

- BNB Smart Chain: BscScan
- Bitcoin: sites such as mempool.space
- Ethereum: Etherscan

When checkout tells you to send USDT BEP-20, you should later see:

- the **from** address (yours)
- the **to** address (the one on screen, character for character)
- the **token contract** (USDT on BSC, not a random “USDT” scam token)
- a success status

Anyone can deploy a token named USDT or CRYSTAL STONES. The name is a sticker. The **contract address** is the identity. We will repeat this until it is a reflex.

A **token contract** is a program on the chain that stores balances and transfer rules. The human-readable name is decoration. The address of that program is the ID.

Why “I already signed” is the moment that matters

On a website, you type a password and the company checks it. You can later call support. On a chain, you sign a payload and thousands of computers will execute it if it is valid.

That payload might be:

- a simple send

- an approval (permission for a contract to move tokens later)
- a swap
- a “permit” or typed-data signature some sites use so you do not even see a send

If you cannot explain what you just signed, you do not sign. That one rule prevents more losses than any antivirus slogan.

Worked scenario. A site says “verify wallet — sign this message, it is free.” Sometimes a signature is actually a harmless login. Sometimes it is a typed-data permit that lets a contract drain tokens. You cannot tell from the marketing sentence. You can tell from the wallet’s decode screen, from the URL you typed yourself, and from whether you needed to be there at all. Foundations does not ask you to verify anything with a signature. Later courses will show a real wallet UI slowly. Today: **unexpected signature requests are a stop sign.**

Replay and why you cannot photocopy an old payment

On Bitcoin, coins are tracked as unspent outputs. Once an output is spent, a copy of the old transaction is not a new payment. On Ethereum-style chains, each address has a **nonce** — a counter of how many transactions it has sent. Replaying the same signed payload fails because that nonce is already used (on that chain). This is why “copy the transaction bytes” is not a money printer. It is also why sending on the **wrong** chain is a different universe: the nonce and the contracts do not carry over.

DIAGRAM

Phishing attack (common):

Fake site -> you sign -> real chain executes honestly -> funds gone

Protocol attack (rare on large nets):

You try to rewrite history -> honest majority ignores you

“Code is law” is incomplete

People say **code is law** to mean: the chain will execute a valid signature even if you were fooled. That is true of settlement. It is not true of society. Courts still exist for humans. Bridges still get hacked at the application layer. Smart contracts can have bugs.

So: **the base ledger is hard to fake; the apps around it are not automatically safe.** That is why we separate rails, tokens, and websites in this academy.

Worked scenario. A merchant is shown a screenshot: “payment sent.” A screenshot is a picture. Pictures are easy. The merchant opens the explorer, searches the destination address, and looks for a successful transfer of the **correct token contract**, in the **correct amount**, after the invoice was created. If that row is missing, they have not been paid. Explorers are the court clerk. Screenshots are not.

ACADEMY NOTE Anyone can deploy a token named USDT or CRYSTAL STONES. The name is a sticker. The contract address on a specific network is the identity. If those two disagree, trust the mismatch — not the logo.

Say this out loud

- Signing with a key is not the same as typing a password into a random website.
- A hash is a tamper alarm: change a comma, the fingerprint moves.
- Explorers beat screenshots.
- A token's identity is its contract address on a specific network, not its logo.
- Scammers fake people. They rarely fake the arithmetic of a large chain.

Next: one full send, start to finish.

Lesson 5: What actually happens when you send crypto (26 min)

What actually happens when you send crypto

We now stitch Module 2 into one sequence. Keep a real example: sending a BEP-20 token on BNB Smart Chain. It could be USDT. It could be Crystal Stones. The movie is the same.

Sit with each step. This is the lesson people wish they had before their first painful mistake.

Step 1 — unlock

You open a wallet app. You type a PIN or biometrics. That PIN is **not** the chain key. It is the lock on the drawer where the key lives. A well-built wallet keeps the private key from leaving the device. If the device is compromised, that protection can fail. Unlocking is local.

Step 2 — name four things, not one

You must set:

20. **Asset** — what is being sent
21. **Network** — which road (here, BNB Smart Chain)
22. **Amount**
23. **Destination address** — pasted, then checked

If 1 or 2 is wrong, you are already in danger. "I sent USDT" is not a complete sentence. "I sent USDT on BNB Smart Chain to this exact address" is.

Step 3 — the network fee

The wallet estimates **gas in BNB**. Even if you are sending a token, the courier is paid in the road's home coin.

If you have the token but zero BNB, the film stops. Nothing moves. Scammers will now try a second film: "send BNB to this address to unlock gas." That is theft. Real gas is charged inside the send, to the network, not to a stranger.

For tokens, you are not mailing a physical chip. You are telling the **token contract** — a program on the chain that stores balances — "reduce mine, increase theirs."

Step 4 — the irreversible human moment

You read the screen. You sign.

This is the moment. After this, “I didn’t mean to” is a feeling, not a button.

Steps 5 to 8 — broadcast, wait, page, proof

24. An RPC helper hears the signed instruction and gossips it.

25. It sits in the mempool. Validators see it.

26. A block includes it.

27. The wallet shows success. The recipient must still verify on an explorer, not on your screenshot.

If this goes wrong	You will see
No BNB for gas	Wallet error; nothing moves
Wrong network	Funds may be unrecoverable on the other rail
Wrong token contract	You sent a fake asset that only looks like the name
Wrong address	Likely gone
Too-low fee on busy nets	Stuck pending (more common on Ethereum than BSC)

DIAGRAM

```

You --sign--> Token contract on BSC --update--> Recipient balance
                \
                --> Gas paid in BNB to validators

```

Native coins versus tokens in this flow

- Sending **BNB** is a native transfer on BSC — moving the road’s own money.
- Sending **BEP-20 Crystal Stones** is a call to the token program. The project’s published contract is ``0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00``. Always re-check on the official site and explorer. Do not trust a chat PDF.

If you send Crystal Stones as if it were BNB, or send it on Ethereum, you are performing a different, often fatal, action.

The wallet UI may show both as “Send.” The chain does not treat them as the same action. If a recipient’s memo said “send BNB” and you send a token, they did not receive BNB. If they needed a specific token and you sent BNB, they received BNB — which may not be what they sell, and which may not be recoverable as the token.

Worked scenario. A checkout pins “USDT on BNB Smart Chain (BEP-20)” and shows one address. You:

28. Confirm the wallet network is BNB Smart Chain, not Ethereum.

29. Confirm the token is the official USDT contract on that chain, not a copycat.

30. Send a tiny test first.

31. Open BscScan, paste the destination, confirm success, amount, and token.

32. Only then send the rest.

Skipping the test to save ten minutes is how people lose the whole amount.

What this academy's checkout will do later

A serious checkout:

- names the **only** network (we will say BNB Smart Chain BEP-20 for USDT payments)
- shows a fresh address or a hosted invoice
- confirms on-chain on the server
- then unlocks the course in our own database

Never skip the warning: **wrong network can mean loss.**

ACADEMY NOTE Module 2 quiz comes next. If gas versus token still blurs, re-read the miners lesson. This mix-up is the number one beginner burn on BSC. Tiny test send before a large one. Always.

Say this out loud

- Unlock, name asset + network + amount + address, pay gas in BNB, sign, wait for a block, check an explorer.
- Token is not gas.
- Screenshots are not proof.
- The academy will pin one network on purpose when paid tracks open.
- Practice with tiny amounts.

You now have the engine. Module 3 is the map: coins, tokens, three networks, wallets, exchanges, and where Crystal Stones sits — still not a buy order.

Module quiz (answers included for editors)

Q1. A transaction is considered settled on-chain when?

- A. You tapped Send in the wallet
- B. It is included in a block (and buried by more blocks as policy requires)
- C. You screenshot the wallet
- D. Customer support replies

Correct answer: B

Q2. Blocks are linked primarily by?

- A. Telephone cables between CEOs
- B. Each block storing the previous block's hash
- C. PDF whitepapers
- D. Social media timestamps

Correct answer: B

Q3. A seed phrase is?

- A. A username
- B. A backup that can recreate your private keys
- C. The token contract
- D. A public address you should post everywhere

Correct answer: B

Q4. On BNB Smart Chain, gas for a token transfer is typically paid in?

- A. The token you are sending
- B. Local currency on-chain
- C. BNB
- D. Bitcoin

Correct answer: C

Q5. “Your keys, your coins” means?

- A. The exchange must always refund you
- B. Whoever can sign with the private key can spend the assets
- C. Passwords are stored on the blockchain
- D. Customer care can reset a seed

Correct answer: B

Q6. The identity of a token is?

- A. Its ticker or display name
- B. Its logo colour
- C. Its contract address on a specific network
- D. The number of chat members

Correct answer: C

Q7. A custodial exchange balance is closest to?

- A. A private key in your hardware wallet
- B. An IOU in the company’s ledger until you withdraw
- C. A mined Bitcoin block
- D. A seed phrase

Correct answer: B

Q8. The most common successful attack on users is?

- A. Hand-computing SHA-256 collisions at home
- B. Tricking the user into signing or leaking a seed
- C. Rewriting Bitcoin’s entire chain with a phone
- D. Guessing a 24-word phrase in one try

Correct answer: B

Module 3: The map of crypto

Coins, tokens, major networks, wallets versus exchanges, Crystal Stones as a BEP-20 token to study, and a ritual for staying safe.

Lesson 1: Coins vs tokens vs networks (26 min)

Coins vs tokens vs networks

Beginners say “I bought a crypto.” Professionals ask three questions:

33. Which **network**?
34. Is this the **native coin** or a **token** on that network?
35. What is the **contract** (if it is a token)?

Those three questions are how you stop mixing planets that share a nickname.

A network is a separate ledger with separate rules

A **network** (also called a **chain**) is a community of computers following one rule-set. Bitcoin, Ethereum, and BNB Smart Chain are not three brands of the same bottle. They are different books, different fees, different histories.

Think of mobile networks: airtime on one carrier does not magically sit on another. Value on Bitcoin does not magically sit on BNB Smart Chain because a ticker looked similar.

Native coins

A **native coin** is the home asset of a chain. It usually pays for security and fees.

- Bitcoin the network uses **BTC**
- Ethereum uses **ETH** (ether)
- BNB Smart Chain uses **BNB**

You cannot “deploy Bitcoin as a BEP-20” and have it still be Bitcoin. You can have **wrapped** versions, which are IOUs on another chain: someone locks the original and issues a representation. Wrapping is advanced. Do not start there. If you cannot explain custody of the lock, do not wrap.

Tokens

A **token** is a contract on someone else’s chain. **ERC-20** on Ethereum. **BEP-20** on BSC. The contract stores balances and transfer rules.

Crystal Stones is a **token** (BEP-20), not its own layer-1 coin. That is not an insult. USDT on BSC is also a token. Tokens are how most project assets exist.

A **layer-1** is a base chain with its own consensus (Bitcoin, Ethereum, BSC). A token does not have its own miners. It rents the host chain's security and pays that chain's gas coin.

	Native coin	Token
Lives	The base chain	A contract on a chain
Examples	BTC, ETH, BNB	USDT (BEP-20), Crystal Stones (BEP-20)
Pays gas?	Yes, usually	No. You still need the native coin for gas
Created by	The protocol	A deployer publishing a contract

DIAGRAM

```
BNB Smart Chain
  native coin: BNB (gas + validator economics)
  tokens:      USDT, Crystal Stones, thousands more
                |
                +-- each has a unique contract address
```

Why this saves you money

If a checkout says “USDT on BNB Smart Chain (BEP-20)” and you send USDT on Tron (TRC-20) or Ethereum (ERC-20), you may never see it again. Same ticker. Different planets.

Ticker means the short nickname (USDT, ETH, BNB, CST). Tickers are not unique. Contracts on a given network are.

Worked scenario. An exchange withdrawal screen has a dropdown: network. You are tired. You pick the first USDT you see. The recipient gave a BNB Smart Chain address. You picked Tron. Two days later the recipient has nothing, the exchange says successful, and a stranger offers to “recover” it for a fee. There is usually no recovery. The asset was real. The road was wrong.

Crystal Stones in this picture, still not a buy order

- Network: BNB Smart Chain
- Type: token, BEP-20
- Home coin for fees: BNB
- Identity: the published contract address, not the logo

If a wallet has Crystal Stones and zero BNB, the token cannot move. That is not a Crystal Stones failure. That is the road's gas rule.

Standards are formats, not quality stamps

ERC-20 is a shared interface: a contract on Ethereum that implements functions like transfer and balanceOf in a way wallets expect. **BEP-20** is the same idea on BSC. **TRC-20** is Tron's cousin.

A standard answers: “can a wallet display this and send it without a custom app?” It does **not** answer: “is this token honest, backed, or worth anything?” Anyone can deploy an ERC-20 named USD Tether lookalike. The standard made the sticker printable. The contract address is still the ID.

Stablecoin, restated: a token *designed* to track a currency such as the US dollar. Design is not a law of physics. Some are backed by reserves you can audit. Some are algorithmic experiments. Some are fakes using the name. In this academy, USDT on a named network is a *payment rail we may pin later* — not a lecture that every token called USDT is the same object.

Worked scenario, slower. You will hear “just send USDT.” Ask:

36. Which network? (BEP-20, ERC-20, TRC-20, something else)
37. Which contract on that network is the official one this recipient means?
38. Do I have the gas coin of *that* network?
39. Did I copy the address from the screen in front of me, then check first and last characters?

If you cannot answer those four, you are not ready to send. That is not cowardice. That is Foundations doing its job.

ACADEMY NOTE Nicknames are not identities. USDT, CST, BNB, BTC are labels humans like. The network plus, for a token, the contract address, is the identity. If a checkout or a contact will not name the network, do not send.

Say this out loud

- Network is the road. Coin is the road’s home money. Token is a program on that road.
- Tickers are nicknames, not IDs.
- Crystal Stones needs BNB in the wallet to move.
- Wrong network is a common way to lose funds.

Next: three roads you will actually meet — Bitcoin, Ethereum, BNB Smart Chain.

Lesson 2: Bitcoin, Ethereum, and BNB Smart Chain (26 min)

Bitcoin, Ethereum, and BNB Smart Chain

You do not need fifty chains. You need three landmarks.

We will give each road a job, a home coin, and an honest weakness. The point is not to pick a favourite. The point is to stop treating “crypto” as one rail.

Bitcoin — settlement and scarce coin

- **Job:** move BTC and store a conservative, high-cost ledger.
- **Home coin:** BTC. Fees are paid in BTC.
- **Programs:** limited compared with Ethereum. Culture prefers simplicity: “don’t change it.”
- **Beginner use:** understand it as digital cash / settlement, not as an app store.
- **Weakness you should respect:** when blocks are full, fees can spike. It is not always the tool for a tiny payment.

Ethereum — programmable contracts

- **Job:** run applications (tokens, on-chain exchanges, experiments) with a global computer model.

- **Home coin:** ETH (gas). Fees can be expensive when the road is busy.
- **Tokens:** ERC-20, ERC-721, and more.
- **Engine today:** proof of stake. Validators, not Bitcoin miners. You do not need the politics; you need “different engine.”
- **Beginner use:** many serious apps live here. Watch gas.

A **smart contract** is a program stored on the chain that runs when you send it a valid transaction. Ethereum made that model mainstream. Tokens are the simplest familiar example: a contract that keeps a balance sheet.

BNB Smart Chain — EVM, speed, low fees

- **Job:** Ethereum-like apps with cheaper, faster blocks.
- **Home coin:** BNB.
- **Tokens:** BEP-20.
- **Why this academy names it often:** Crystal Stones lives here, and planned USDT checkout for paid tracks will pin this road on purpose so beginners do not guess.
- **Honest tradeoff:** more validator concentration than Bitcoin. You gain UX; you give up some “maximum neutrality.”

Pick the rail for the job:

- Hold and move BTC as a conservative settlement asset → Bitcoin.
- Use a complex Ethereum application → Ethereum, and hold ETH for gas.
- Interact with Crystal Stones or with this academy’s later USDT checkout → BNB Smart Chain, and hold BNB for gas.

Mixing those three jobs into one “send crypto” sentence is how people lose funds.

How to choose a rail without becoming a tribal fan

You will meet people who say only Bitcoin is real, or only Ethereum is serious, or only BSC is usable. That is identity, not analysis.

A practical beginner rule:

- If the job is **hold a scarce native coin with the longest security story**, Bitcoin is the landmark.
- If the job is **use an application that lives as a contract**, you need an EVM-style chain. Ethereum is the original. BSC is the cheaper cousin this academy standardises on for practice and for Crystal Stones.
- If the job is **pay a specific invoice**, you use the rail the invoice named. You do not improvise a “cheaper” rail because a video said so.

Gas, restated per chain: BTC on Bitcoin, ETH on Ethereum, BNB on BSC. Holding a token on Ethereum without ETH is the same trap as holding a token on BSC without BNB.

Explorer, restated per chain: mempool.space (or equivalents) for Bitcoin, Etherscan for Ethereum, BscScan for BSC. Bookmark them. Do not Google “BscScan” and click the first ad. Phishing copies sit on ads.

	Bitcoin	Ethereum	BNB Smart Chain
Native asset	BTC	ETH	BNB
Token standard	Rare / different	ERC-20	BEP-20
Typical beginner use	Hold / transfer BTC	Apps, tokens, DeFi	Cheap tokens, BNB ecosystem
Crystal Stones?	No	No	Yes — BEP-20 contract on BSC
Explorer (examples)	mempool.space	etherscan.io	bscscan.com

DIAGRAM

Choose the rail for the job

```

Store BTC long-term      -> Bitcoin
Complex DeFi on ETH     -> Ethereum (watch gas)
BEP-20 token / low fee  -> BNB Smart Chain

```

Bridges — a warning, not a tutorial

A **bridge** moves value between chains by locking on one side and minting a representation on the other. Bridges are a major hack target. Beginners should avoid them until they can explain custody and contract risk. This academy will not rush you across a bridge to look clever.

If a video says “just bridge it,” close the video. A bridge is a later, dangerous tool, not a beginner shortcut.

ACADEMY NOTE Official Crystal Stones contract on BSC, as published:

0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00. Verify on crystalstones.org and [BscScan](https://bscscan.com). We do not teach “send to any address in a pinned chat message.”

Say this out loud

- Three roads, three home coins: BTC, ETH, BNB.
- Crystal Stones is not Bitcoin and not BNB. It is a BEP-20 token on BSC.
- This academy standardises on BSC for its token and planned USDT payments so you are not guessing roads.
- A bridge is not a next button.

Next: the shops on those roads — wallets, exchanges, and DeFi.

Lesson 3: Wallets, exchanges, and DeFi on one map (26 min)

Wallets, exchanges, and DeFi on one map

You now have rails. Here are the **venues** on those rails.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to say who holds the keys at a wallet, at a centralised exchange, and at a decentralised exchange — and why a deposit screen has a network dropdown.

Wallets

A **wallet** is software (or hardware) that holds keys or talks to keys. Examples you will hear: MetaMask, Trust Wallet, hardware devices (Ledger-style).

A wallet does not “contain coins” like a leather purse contains notes. The chain contains the balances. The wallet contains **credentials** to move them.

If you lose the phone but have the seed phrase on paper in a safe place, you can recreate the keys. If you lose the phone and the paper, the coins are still on the chain — and nobody can move them, including you.

A **hardware wallet** is a dedicated device that keeps keys offline and only signs when you confirm on its screen. It is a later skill. Do not buy one from a random reseller who “sets it up for you.” If someone else saw the seed, it is not your vault.

Centralised exchanges (CEX)

A **centralised exchange** is a company: they custody assets, match buyers and sellers, and usually ask KYC. Easy on-ramps from local currency. You meet order books, deposit networks, withdrawal fees.

This is often how beginners first touch crypto. That is fine. The trap is the deposit screen: it asks **which network**. If you deposit BSC funds to a Bitcoin deposit address, you are back in the wrong-road story.

Crystal Stones’ site describes a Crystal Stones CEX as part of its ecosystem. Treat that as **project infrastructure to study later**, not as “withdraw blindly.” Confirm networks on the screen in front of you, not on social media.

Decentralised exchanges (DEX) and DeFi

DeFi means decentralised finance: programs that lend, swap, or pool assets without a traditional teller.

A **DEX** is a swap shop made of programs. On BSC, PancakeSwap is the name you will hear. You keep your keys. The program holds **liquidity pools** — pots of tokens other people provided so swaps can happen.

Risks, stated plainly:

- fake tokens with similar names
- rewards that cannot last
- bugs in the program
- you signing a bad **approval** (permission for the program to spend your token, sometimes “unlimited”)

An **approval** is a signed permission: “this contract may move this token from my address, up to this amount.” Unlimited approvals are common and dangerous. If the site is evil, it can drain later.

Venue	Who holds keys	Good for	Beginner trap
Self-custody wallet	You	Using chains, receiving	Seed theft, wrong network
CEX	They	Buying with fiat, liquidity	Wrong deposit network, phishing logins
DEX	You + contracts	Swapping tokens	Scam tokens, bad approvals

DIAGRAM



Worked scenario — a safe first month, not a trading plan.

40. Create a wallet yourself. Write the 12 or 24 words on paper. Store the paper offline. Never photograph it.
41. Buy a little BNB on an exchange you chose on purpose (the Exchanges course will go step by step — do not improvise this tonight).
42. Withdraw a tiny test of BNB to your wallet address on BNB Smart Chain. Check BscScan.
43. Only then withdraw a token, still tiny, still the same network.
44. Do not visit a DEX in week one. Swapping is a later skill.

If you skip to step 5 because a group chat said “APY,” you are no longer studying. You are a customer of someone else’s urgency. **APY** means annual percentage yield — a rate. Unsustainable rates are a marketing device.

Order books versus pools, in one page

A CEX usually uses an **order book**: buyers post bids, sellers post asks, the company matches them. You are trading against other customers, through the company’s ledger, until you withdraw.

A DEX usually uses a **liquidity pool**: someone deposited two tokens into a contract; a formula prices the swap. You are trading against the pool. If the pool is thin, the price you get can be terrible (**slippage** — the difference between the quoted price and what you actually receive). If the token is fake, the pool is a fake-token shop.

Neither venue is “the real crypto.” They are different machines. Foundations only asks you to know which machine you are in, and who can freeze you.

On-ramp means converting local currency or dollars into crypto. **Off-ramp** is the reverse. Most on-ramps are companies. They will ask who you are. That is not the chain “becoming KYC.” That is the door you used.

ACADEMY NOTE Connect is a signature-shaped permission. A pretty website can still be a trap. Type the URL. Bookmark it. If a stranger sends a “wallet connect” link, that is the same family as “send your seed to validate.”

Say this out loud

- Wallet = keys. Exchange balance = IOU until withdrawal.

- Deposit screens have a network dropdown for a reason.
- DeFi is not free money on a map.
- Do not connect a wallet to a link from chat.

Next: where Crystal Stones sits on this map — education, not a buy order.

Lesson 4: Where Crystal Stones sits (education, not a buy order) (26 min)

Where Crystal Stones sits (education, not a buy order)

This academy exists because Crystal Stones funds education as a utility. That does not turn the classroom into a sales floor. We describe **what the project publishes**. We do not predict price. We do not tell you to buy.

If you came here only for a signal, this lesson will disappoint you on purpose.

Placement on the map you already have

Walk it with the three questions from the coins-versus-tokens lesson:

- **Network:** BNB Smart Chain
- **Type:** BEP-20 token (not a layer-1 coin, not Bitcoin, not BNB)
- **Official contract, as published:** 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00
- **Category they claim:** Real World Asset (RWA) token

Open the official site. Copy the contract. Later, paste it into BscScan and ask: “does this page and that explorer agree?” If a chat message pasted a different address, trust the mismatch, not the chat. That is the academic use of this lesson.

What RWA means, carefully

RWA means **real-world asset**: projects try to connect an on-chain token to off-chain things — invoices, property, commodities, minerals.

The easy part is creating a token. The hard part is **legal title, audits, who holds the physical thing, and who you sue if the story breaks**.

crystalstones.org describes backing primarily in solid minerals (they mention gold, lithium and more), with additional exposure to real estate and petroleum. It describes a deflationary design, a circulating supply figure in the 104 million range, a total supply of 135,000,000, buy/sell taxes, and an auto-burn on buys.

Those are **website / whitepaper parameters**. Your job in later modules is to ask how they are enforced on-chain: can taxes change? is minting closed? is liquidity actually locked?

This classroom does not certify mines. A classroom paragraph is not a receipt. A receipt would be legal title, custody, and audit you can follow.

Question	Beginner answer after this lesson
Is Crystal Stones Bitcoin?	No
Is it BNB?	No. BNB is gas. Crystal Stones is a token on BSC.

Where does it live?	BSC, BEP-20 contract above
Does this academy prove the mines?	No. We teach you to demand evidence.
May staff DM a payment address?	No. Use in-app checkout only when paid tracks open.

DIAGRAM

```

Physical claims (minerals, etc.)    <-- legal / audit world
      |
      | (must be evidenced, not believed)
      v
BEP-20 token on BSC  <-- you can verify transfers on BscScan
      |
      v
Utilities the project describes: CEX, Academy, on-chain transfers

```

Tokenomics is not a personality test

Tokenomics means the economic rules of the token: supply, taxes, burns, who gets fees.

- A **burn** destroys tokens, reducing supply if the rule actually executes.
- **Buy/sell tax** takes a percentage of a transfer for the project's programmed destinations.
- **Locked liquidity** means the pool used for trading is restricted from being pulled for a stated period — if the lock is real.
- A **renounced** contract means the team gave up the admin keys. That can be safer against silent minting and also **unable to fix a bug**.

"Renounced" is not a halo. "Audit" is not a halo. Audits have **scope** — they check what they were paid to check. They are not insurance.

The project site mentions a smart-contract audit, locked liquidity, and a renounced contract. You should still open the explorer yourself in later practical lessons.

What this classroom is for, relative to the token

Crystal Stones Academy is a **utility**: education funded as part of the project's public story. The course sequence (Basic free, Intermediate paid as a bundle, Advanced later) is how we force real learning — quizzes gate modules, ranks track completion, Crystal Mentor answers study questions and must refuse investment instructions.

None of that is a reason to skip the three questions:

45. Network?
46. Native coin or token?
47. Contract?

You should be able to place Crystal Stones on the map you built in this course:

- It is not Bitcoin.
- It is not BNB.

- It is not “crypto” as a single object.
- It is a BEP-20 token on BNB Smart Chain, with an RWA claim that lives in the legal/audit world, and with transfers you can watch on BscScan.

That sentence is the whole academic goal of this lesson. If you can say it without a buy or a sneer, you are done.

ACADEMY NOTE The public site has also used large market-cap targets. We will not repeat targets as facts. Marketing is not consensus. Crystal Mentor, when you use it, must refuse investment instructions. So must this page.

Say this out loud

- Crystal Stones is a BEP-20 token on BNB Smart Chain with an RWA story.
- Website claim and explorer fact are different species.
- This classroom stays non-advisory on purpose.
- BNB is still the gas coin.

Last lesson of the course: how to keep learning without becoming prey.

Lesson 5: How to keep learning safely (24 min)

How to keep learning safely

You now have a beginner’s operating system. This lesson is how not to throw it away on the first chat group.

By the end of Basic, the aim is not that you can recite slogans. The aim is that you can open a project page, name the network, name the asset, refuse a seed-phrase request, and know what you do not yet know. Intermediate skill is the whole Basic track plus practice — wallets, exchanges, BSC, and safety — not this course alone.

A 10-minute page-reading ritual

When you open any project site:

48. Write the **chain** in your notes.
49. Copy the **contract** from the official site, then search it on the explorer. Confirm the site and explorer match.
50. Check whether you need a **native gas coin**.
51. Find **who can mint or pause** (later course: read the contract tab).
52. Ignore price predictions in the first pass.
53. Look for how you **exit** (pairs, exchanges, lock status) without believing screenshots.
54. Only then read the story.

If a page will not give a contract, there is no on-chain asset. There is a story.

What “intermediate” means in this academy

People use “intermediate” as a compliment. Here it is a checklist. After the full Basic track you should be able to:

- create and back up a wallet without photographing a seed
- explain self-custody versus an exchange IOU
- withdraw a tiny test on a named network and confirm it on an explorer
- refuse seed, gas-unlock, and guaranteed-yield pitches
- name Crystal Stones as a BEP-20 token on BSC with a contract you verify
- know that DeFi, bridges, and leverage are later, optional, and dangerous

This course — Crypto Foundations — is the vocabulary and the map. It is necessary and it is not sufficient. If you skip Wallets, Exchanges, BSC, and Safety, you are still a beginner with good notes.

Green flags (still not advice)	Red flags
Contract + explorer match	Contract only in a PDF from a stranger
Clear network labels	“Send USDT” with no chain
Docs that admit risks	Guaranteed returns, countdown bombs
You can explain coin vs token	“Trust me I am in the team chat”

What Basic unlocks next

Stay on rails:

- Wallets, Keys & Self-Custody
- Exchanges & Your First Buy (process, not a pump)
- Blockchain & BNB Smart Chain for Beginners (deeper BSC)
- Crypto Safety & Common Scams

Then Intermediate (paid track when priced): Ethereum, DeFi, tokenomics, markets, NFTs, DAOs — still with quizzes gating modules.

DIAGRAM

```

Crypto Foundations (you are here)
  |
  v
Wallets -> Exchanges -> BSC deeper -> Safety
  |
  v
Intermediate track (unlock as a whole when payment is live)
```

Rules that survive every cycle

- Tiny test transfers before large ones.
- No seed to any human.
- Bookmark official URLs; do not click sponsored ads for wallets.
- Crystal Mentor can help you think; it is not a financial adviser and must refuse investment instructions.

- If you are breathless, you are not studying. Close the app.

Worked scenario. You finish this course and a friend sends a link: “new Crystal Stones wallet connect, listing in two hours.” You do not connect. You open the official site you bookmarked. You compare the contract. You remember: urgency is a sales tool, staff will not DM a payment address, and this academy’s paid tracks — when live — go through in-app checkout. That is intermediate behaviour from a beginner who finished Foundations. That is the point.

ACADEMY NOTE You passed from “crypto is a vibe” to “crypto is ledgers, keys, networks, and contracts.” That is the whole point of an academy versus a highlight reel.

Say this out loud

- A ritual for opening a project page: chain, contract, gas, admin powers, exit, then story.
- This course sits at the start of Basic, not at the end of becoming intermediate.
- Speed is the enemy of self-custody.
- Asset + network + address. Token is not gas. Screenshots are not proof. Seeds go to no one.

Take the quiz. If you miss network versus token questions, retake Module 3 lessons — those mistakes cost real money.

Module quiz (answers included for editors)

Q1. Crystal Stones is best classified as?

- A. A native layer-1 coin like Bitcoin
- B. A BEP-20 token on BNB Smart Chain
- C. A banknote series
- D. An Ethereum validator

Correct answer: B

Q2. Gas on BNB Smart Chain is paid in?

- A. Crystal Stones
- B. USDT only
- C. BNB
- D. Local currency on-chain

Correct answer: C

Q3. A native coin and a token differ because?

- A. Tokens are always safer
- B. A native coin is the chain’s home asset and usually pays gas; a token is a contract on that chain
- C. Tokens have CEOs and coins never do
- D. There is no difference

Correct answer: B

Q4. USDT on BEP-20 and USDT on TRC-20 are?

- A. The same asset on the same network
- B. The same ticker on different networks — sending one to the other can mean loss
- C. Both Bitcoin
- D. Both BNB

Correct answer: B

Q5. A centralised exchange balance is?

- A. The same as holding your own keys
- B. An IOU in the company's ledger until you withdraw
- C. A mined block
- D. A seed phrase

Correct answer: B

Q6. An RWA claim in this academy is treated as?

- A. Proof that minerals sit in a vault under your name
- B. A project story that must be evidenced — this classroom does not certify mines
- C. A guaranteed return
- D. A reason to skip the contract address

Correct answer: B

Q7. When you open a project page, the first facts to write down are?

- A. Price targets and chat member count
- B. Network, contract address, and whether you need a gas coin
- C. The CEO's favourite colour
- D. Yesterday's candle

Correct answer: B

Q8. This academy's rule on seeds and staff payments is?

- A. Staff may DM a wallet for "verification"
- B. Never give a seed to anyone; paid tracks go through in-app checkout, not a chat address
- C. Share the seed with the mentor bot
- D. Post it in the group for backup

Correct answer: B

Wallets, Keys & Self-Custody

BASIC TRACK | slug: wallets-keys-self-custody | level: beginner | FREE

The second Basic course. You already know that a private key is power of attorney over coins. This course is the operating manual: what a wallet actually is, custodial versus self-custody, how a seed phrase works, how to receive and send on BNB Smart Chain without mixing networks, how approvals drain wallets, and how to store a backup like an adult. Education only — practice with amounts you can lose. Crystal Stones Academy will never ask for a seed phrase.

Module 1: What a wallet actually is

A wallet is a key manager, not a bank drawer. Separate the app, the PIN, the keys, and the chain.

Lesson 1: A wallet does not hold coins (26 min)

A wallet does not hold coins

The word **wallet** is a bad metaphor, and it is the first one this course has to kill. A leather wallet holds cash. A crypto wallet does **not** hold coins. If you keep that picture, every later lesson will fight you.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to point at a phone screen and say, in your own words, where the coins actually live, what the app is doing, and what you lose if the phone dies. You already met **keys** in Crypto Foundations: a private key is power of attorney over coins. This course is the operating manual for that fact.

Coins live on the chain, not in the icon

A **blockchain** is a public book of balances and transfers. **BNB Smart Chain** is one such book. Its chain id is **56**. Its common explorer is **BscScan**. The native coin that pays fees on that book is **BNB**.

When a wallet app shows “0.12 BNB,” it is not showing you notes stuffed inside the app. It is showing you what the book currently lists for an **address** that the app can sign for. Uninstall the app and the book does not empty. Smash the phone and the book does not empty. The book changes only when a valid signed instruction is accepted.

That is the whole mental model, and beginners fight it for months. They say “my Trust Wallet has the coins.” Trust Wallet is an **example of a wallet app**, not a vault in Cupertino. MetaMask is another example of a wallet app, usually living as a browser extension. Neither company is a bank drawer. Neither is this academy’s product.

If the only copy of the keys lived inside that dead phone, and you have no backup, you did not “lose the coins from the app.” You lost the **power of attorney**. The coins are still on the book, sitting at an address nobody you know can move. That is a worse outcome than a stolen leather wallet, because there is no branch manager who can reprint the notes.

Three jobs a wallet actually does

A wallet, used honestly, is a **key manager**. It does three jobs:

- 55. It stores or uses your **keys** (or asks a hardware device to use them).
- 56. It builds **transactions** — signed instructions the network can check.
- 57. It shows you a human picture of what the book says.

Job 3 is a **report**. Reports can lag. Reports can be drawn by a fake app. Reports can show a token that is a clone. The book is still the book. Later in this module you will treat explorers as the adult copy of the report. Today you only need this: the screen is not the money.

Transaction means a message that says, roughly: “the holder of this key authorises this movement under these rules.” It is not a chat receipt. It is not a WhatsApp screenshot. It is not “I meant to pay you.” After the network accepts it and later pages bury it, there is no academy help desk that can reverse it.

Everyday sentence	What is actually true	What you risk if you believe the sentence
“The coins are in my wallet app”	The coins are rows on the chain; the app is a window and a pen	You think uninstalling the app deletes the money, or that reinstalling magically restores keys you never backed up
“I lost my wallet when the phone drowned”	You lost the device, maybe the only copy of the keys	You wait for Apple or Google to “recover crypto”
“The app balance is the official truth”	The chain is the official truth; the app asked a helper and drew a number	You argue from a screenshot instead of an explorer row
“Crystal Stones lives inside Crystal Stones Academy”	Crystal Stones is a BEP-20 token on BNB Smart Chain	You send tokens to a random academy “portal”

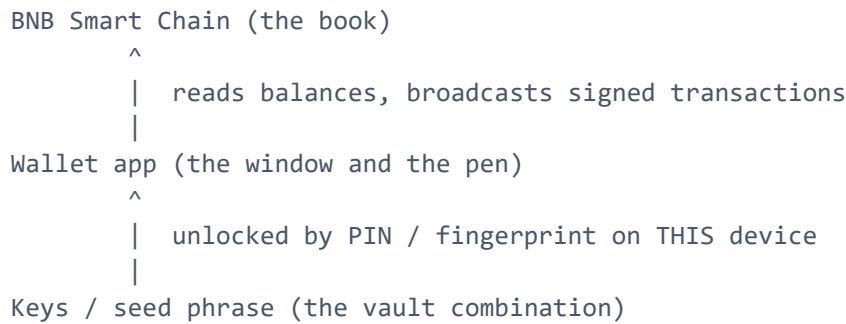
What happens when the phone dies

Worked scenario. Amaka’s phone falls in a basin of water. The Trust Wallet icon is gone. She still has twelve words on a paper in a drawer.

- 58. She buys a new phone from a shop she chose, not from a stranger who “already installed the wallet for her.”
- 59. She installs the **official** app from the official store — the same publisher she used before, not a clone with a similar name.
- 60. She chooses Restore / Import, and types the twelve words **into that app once**, privately, not into a website, not into a Telegram bot.
- 61. The app derives the same keys, asks BNB Smart Chain what those addresses hold, and draws the same balances.
- 62. The coins did not “come back from the cloud.” The app asked the book again. The book still listed those addresses.

If the words existed only on the dead phone, the vault combination is gone. No academy mentor, no “recovery agent,” no remote-desktop helper can honestly fetch them. Anyone who says they can is selling a second theft.

DIAGRAM



Phone dies: window is gone.

Paper backup exists: combination still works in a new window.

No backup: combination is gone. The book still lists the coins. Nobody you know can move them.

Why the metaphor still exists, and how this academy will use the word

Early Bitcoin used “wallet” because people needed a word that felt like money. The industry kept it. You will keep hearing it in shops, in WhatsApp groups, and on YouTube. Inside this academy, when we say **wallet** we mean **key manager**, unless we explicitly say **custodial account** (an exchange login, which is an IOU in a company’s ledger).

Crystal Stones’ token, as a **BEP-20** asset on BNB Smart Chain, is a row in **that** book. A wallet that can speak BNB Smart Chain can show it **if** you are looking at the right contract and the right network. A Bitcoin-only wallet will not magically display a BEP-20 token. Wrong book. The public Crystal Stones contract, as the project publishes it, is:

```
`0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00`
```

Treat that as a **reference to verify**, not a request to buy, and not something to type into a random “add token” website a stranger sent you. This academy will not tell you to buy Crystal Stones to finish this course. You can complete every lab with a practice amount of BNB you can afford to lose, or even with an empty wallet and a paper drill.

ACADEMY NOTE Academy staff will never ask you to “import your wallet into our portal.” Importing a seed into a website is how wallets empty. There is no academy portal that needs those words, your private key, your 2FA codes, or remote desktop control of your phone. If a message uses our name and asks for any of those, it is theft wearing a logo.

What this lesson is for

You are not here to worship an app brand. You are here so that “wallet,” “keys,” “chain,” and “balance” stop being one mashed object. The rest of Basic — exchanges, BNB Smart Chain, safety — assumes you can point at the right object. If you still think coins live in the icon, stop and reread. The metaphor is the trap.

Say this out loud

- Coins live on the chain. The wallet is a window and a pen, not a drawer of notes.

- Uninstalling an app is not the same as losing keys — unless the keys had no backup.
- A drowned phone with a paper seed is an inconvenience. A drowned phone with no backup is a closed vault.
- A BEP-20 token is invisible to a wallet pointed at the wrong network.
- Crystal Stones Academy will never ask for a seed phrase, a private key, a 2FA code, or remote screen control.

Next: four objects people smash into the single word “wallet” — the app, the device lock, the keys, and the chain.

Lesson 2: Four objects people smash into one word (26 min)

Four objects people smash into one word

People say “wallet” and mean four different objects. Then they treat a fingerprint as a seed, treat an app PIN as chain insurance, and treat a network dropdown as decoration. This lesson separates the four objects until you can name which one you are touching.

By the end you should be able to look at a phone and say: that icon is the app, that Face ID is the device lock, those twelve words are the keys, and that BNB number is a row on a chain. Mixing them is how ordinary adults lose money without a “hacker genius” in the story.

Object 1 — the wallet app

The **wallet app** is a program. Trust Wallet on a phone is an example of a wallet app. MetaMask in a browser is an example of a wallet app. A hardware device’s companion app on a laptop is also an app. Programs have bugs, updates, phishing clones, and app-store fakes.

An app can be deleted and reinstalled. That is not a chain event. If you still hold the keys, a clean official install is a new window on the same book. If you install a clone with a similar icon from a random APK site, the clone’s job is to harvest the words you type. The clone will still draw a pretty balance. Pretty is not proof.

Apps also choose which **networks** they speak. A Bitcoin-only app will not show Crystal Stones. An app that can add **EVM** networks — Ethereum-style chains that use 0x addresses — can speak BNB Smart Chain if you set it to do so. The app is a translator. It is not the book.

Object 2 — the device lock

The **device lock** is the PIN, pattern, fingerprint, or face that opens **this phone or this browser profile**. It is local security. It stops a thief who picks up an unlocked handset for thirty seconds. It does **not** live on BNB Smart Chain.

Resetting a PIN does not reset the book. Factory-resetting a phone does not notify validators. Apple or Google unlocking a new handset for you does not reprint a seed you never wrote down. The device lock and the vault combination are different secrets with different jobs.

Beginners mash them because both feel like “my password.” Say it the long way until it sticks: the PIN is the lock on this furniture. The seed is the combination of the vault the furniture was looking at.

Object 3 — the keys

The **keys** are the secret that can **sign**. In practice you meet them as a **seed phrase** (12 or 24 words) and as **private keys** derived from that seed. Module 2 of this course is entirely about this object. Today you only need the job description: whoever can use the keys can spend the coins. There is no “dear blockchain, that was not me.”

A **signature** is mathematics that proves the holder of the secret authorised this message, without putting the secret in the message. The network checks the signature. It does not check your national ID. It does not check whether you were tired, phished, or helping an auntie.

Object 4 — the chain

The **chain** is the book. BNB Smart Chain, Bitcoin, Ethereum, and the rest are separate books. Your wallet app can speak to several books. That does not make the books the same. Balances do not spill across them because the address **looks** similar.

On BNB Smart Chain, **BNB** is the native coin that pays **gas** (the network fee). **BEP-20** tokens — Crystal Stones, USDT on BSC, and others — are entries in token contracts on that same book. Moving a token still spends BNB. The chain does not care that your naira account is empty. It cares that the sending address can pay the fee.

Object	Everyday picture	What it can do	If you lose it
Wallet app	The banking-app icon	Draw balances, propose transactions	Reinstall from the official store; keys can restore the view
Device lock	The lock on this phone	Stop a grab-and-run on this device	Annoying. Not a chain reset. Not a seed
Seed / private key	The vault combination	Sign. Spend. Empty the address	Coins can be spent by whoever has it. No help desk
Chain record	The official book	Decide what is paid	Still there even if your phone dies

Worked scenario. Chinedu’s cousin picks up his unlocked phone and opens the wallet app. There is no PIN on the app itself — only the phone’s lock, which was already off.

63. The cousin can see addresses and balances. That is object 4, reported by object 1.

64. If the app still has the keys unlocked (object 3 sitting ready), the cousin can send.

65. Changing the phone PIN afterwards does not reverse the send. Object 2 is furniture. The book already moved.

66. If Chinedu had used a hardware device, the cousin would still need that device and its own PIN. Different object, different grab.

67. If Chinedu now factory-resets the phone “to be safe” without a seed backup, he has punished himself, not the cousin. The cousin already signed. The reset only destroys the remaining copy of the keys.

DIAGRAM

```
You say "wallet"
|
+--> App (program, clone risk, network list)
+--> Device lock (PIN / face — this furniture only)
+--> Keys / seed (the only thing that can sign)
+--> Chain (BNB Smart Chain, chain id 56, BscScan)
```

Touch the wrong object, tell the wrong story, take the wrong recovery step.

How the four objects show up on one screen

Open a typical phone wallet and you will see all four at once, mashed:

- An icon and a brand name (app).
- A prompt for fingerprint when you open it (device lock, or the app's own PIN — still local).
- A "Backup" nag about twelve words (keys).
- A number labelled BNB or a token name (chain report).

The **network selector** is part of the app, but it chooses which chain you are reading. If it says Ethereum, you are looking at Ethereum's book. If it says BNB Smart Chain, you are looking at BSC. The same seed can produce an address that **looks** the same on both, because both are EVM-style. The **balances are not shared**. USDT on Ethereum is not USDT on BSC. Crystal Stones on BSC is not "whatever token a clone deployed on another chain."

ACADEMY NOTE When this academy says "protect your wallet," we will try to say which object. Protect the app by installing it from the official store. Protect the device with a lock. Protect the keys with a paper or steel backup you never photograph. Protect your reading of the chain by checking BscScan, not a screenshot. A sentence that does not name the object is a slogan.

What this lesson is for

You now have names for the four objects. The rest of this module uses them without apology. Custodial versus self-custody is about **who holds object 3**. Hot versus cold is about **where object 3 sits**. The screen versus the book is about **object 1 lying about object 4**. If you cannot name the object, stop moving value.

Say this out loud

- "Wallet" is four objects: app, device lock, keys, and chain.
- A PIN or fingerprint locks this device. It does not reset the book and it is not the seed.
- Keys sign. Whoever can sign can spend. The chain does not parent you.
- The network dropdown chooses which book you are reading. Same 0x shape is not a shared piggy bank.
- Reinstalling an official app restores a view only if you still have the keys.

Next: three honest ways to "have" crypto — custodial, software self-custody, and hardware — and why mixing the stories is how funds disappear.

Lesson 3: Custodial, self-custody, and hardware (27 min)

Custodial, self-custody, and hardware

There are three honest ways to “have” crypto. None is morally superior. **Mixing them up** is how people lose everything and then write “the blockchain stole my money.”

By the end of this lesson you should be able to name which of the three you are using, every time you look at a balance. If you cannot name it, you do not know who can freeze you, who can spend, and who you call when something breaks.

1. Custodial — you have an account

Custodial means a company holds the keys. An **exchange** or a fintech app holds them. You log in with email, password, maybe SMS or an authenticator app. What you see is a **balance in their ledger**.

Binance is **an example of a centralised exchange**, not “the only real one.” A local P2P desk that credits you inside their own app is also custodial. Your naira fintech wallet is custodial too: a company book, not BNB Smart Chain.

This is useful:

- changing local currency into USDT or BNB
- when you do not yet want to hold a seed
- when a court or a company **should** be able to freeze an account (that is a feature of this design, not a bug you discovered late)

This is the cost:

- they can freeze withdrawals
- a phishing site can steal the login
- if the company fails, you are in a queue of creditors, not holding keys

“**I have USDT on Binance**” means: Binance’s book says they owe you. Until you **withdraw** to an address you control, you hold an **IOU**. An IOU can be honest and still not be self-custody. Both facts can be true. This academy will not order you off every exchange on day one. It will order you to stop calling an IOU a key.

2. Self-custody (software) — you hold the keys on a phone or browser

Self-custody means you can sign. The seed lives (encrypted) on the device. Trust Wallet, MetaMask, and similar apps are **examples of wallet apps** that can do this. They are not endorsements. They are not academy products.

This is useful:

- you can leave an exchange
- you can talk to **dApps** — decentralized apps, meaning websites that ask the wallet to sign
- Crystal Stones, as a BEP-20 token, can show up when the network is BNB Smart Chain and you have added the right contract

This is the cost:

- malware
- fake apps in the store
- a photo of the seed in Google Photos
- signing a malicious contract because a website asked nicely

Hot wallet means: the keys sit on a machine that also goes online. Convenient. Attackable. A phone that has Telegram, WhatsApp, Chrome, and a wallet is a hot environment even if you are a careful person. Care is not architecture.

3. Hardware — the keys sit in a dedicated device

Ledger and Trezor are **examples of hardware wallets**, not ads, not a homework purchase for this week. The seed is generated and stored inside a small computer that does not browse the web. The computer signs; the laptop only proposes.

This is useful:

- amounts you would actually miss
- a backup that is not “a screenshot”

This is the cost:

- you can still be phished (you sign the wrong thing on the device screen)
- you can lose the device **and** the paper backup
- cheap clones exist; buy from the maker, not a random marketplace listing with a seed already in the box

Cold means: the keys are not on an internet-connected general-purpose computer. Hardware is the common beginner form of cold. A paper backup of a seed is also cold — and also easy to photograph, flood, or fight over in a family. Module 5 returns to hardware without worship. Today you only need to place it on the map.

Style	What you actually have	Who can freeze it	Typical fail
Custodial exchange	A login and an IOU	The company, a court, a fraud team	Freeze, hack of the company, phishing the email
Software self-custody	Keys on a phone or browser	Nobody at a help desk — only you, or whoever stole the seed	Fake app, clipboard malware, seed photo
Hardware self-custody	Keys in a dedicated box	Still nobody at a help desk	Tampered device, signing a malicious tx, lost backup

Worked scenario. Ada, a freelancer in Lagos, buys a little USDT on an exchange, leaves it there, and tells friends “I am in self-custody now.” She is not.

68. She has an account. The exchange can still freeze withdrawals if a compliance flag fires.

69. Self-custody starts at **withdraw to an address whose seed she holds**.

70. She later withdraws 10 USDT as a test on **BNB Smart Chain (BEP-20)** to a wallet she created herself.
71. She checks BscScan for the incoming transfer to **her** address, not a screenshot from the exchange chat support.
72. Only then does she have a small self-custodied balance. The rest still sitting on the exchange is still an IOU. Leaving it there is a legitimate choice. It is not self-custody.

DIAGRAM



Mixing the three stories is the actual disaster

The disaster is rarely “I chose custody.” The disaster is thinking an exchange password is a seed, thinking a hardware box makes a phishing site safe, depositing to an exchange using the wrong network then arguing with “the blockchain,” asking exchange support to restore a self-custody seed, or asking a wallet app’s Twitter to reverse an exchange freeze. Name the bucket before you name the blame.

This academy’s paid-track checkout, when you meet it later, is **USDT on BNB Smart Chain (BEP-20) through academy checkout**. That is a payment rail, not Crystal Stones token, and not an instruction to hold anything. You will still need to know whether you are paying from an exchange withdrawal or from a wallet you control. Different objects, same sentence: asset, network, standard, from which kind of account.

Hardware does not cancel custody. If you buy a Ledger or a Trezor and then leave every coin on an exchange, you bought a signer you are not using. If you create a software wallet and then type the seed into an exchange “support form,” you converted self-custody into a gift. The object that matters is still: who can sign, right now.

ACADEMY NOTE This course will not order you to buy a hardware wallet this week, and it will not order you to empty every exchange. It will order you to **name which of the three you are using**, every time you move value. If you cannot name it, stop. Moving value while confused is how post-mortems start.

What this lesson is for

You now have three honest buckets. Hot versus cold, in the next lesson, is a refinement of buckets 2 and 3. It is not a fourth religion. Practice saying the long sentence: “This is an IOU at a company” or “This is a key on my phone” or “This is a key in a dedicated device.” Short slogans hide the object.

Say this out loud

- Custodial means an IOU from a company. Self-custody means you can sign. Hardware means the keys are not on the laptop.
- Withdrawal is the moment self-custody can begin. A balance on an exchange is not that moment.
- Hot means the keys can sign from an online daily driver. Cold means they cannot.
- Mixing the three stories is how people blame “the blockchain” for a company freeze or a seed photo.
- Ledger and Trezor are examples of hardware, not homework, not ads, and not magic.

Next: hot versus cold in more detail, and why “I wrote it in my Notes app” is still hot.

Lesson 4: Hot, cold, and the Notes-app trap (26 min)

Hot, cold, and the Notes-app trap

Hot and **cold** are about whether the secret sits on a machine that also talks to the internet. They are not a personality type. They are not a moral grade. A hardware wallet used to sign a phishing site is hot *in effect*: the attacker did not need to steal the chip. They needed your finger on the button.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to sort every copy of your seed into hot or cold, including the copies you pretend do not count — the photo “just for today,” the WhatsApp message to yourself, the email draft.

Hot is convenient and noisy

Anything that can sign from a daily driver is hot: a browser extension; a phone wallet; a seed typed into a laptop that also has Telegram, Chrome, and random PDFs; a seed sitting in a cloud notes app that syncs to that laptop.

Hot wallets are how you **use** crypto: pay a fee, talk to a site, move a practice amount. They are not how you should store a year of savings on day two of this course. That is not a scare banner. It is a matching of tool to job. You do not leave a month of rent in the same pocket as your bus fare because both are “money.”

A **hot wallet** is still self-custody if you hold the keys. Self-custody and cold are not synonyms. You can hold keys on a noisy phone. That is self-custody and hot. An exchange is neither. Trust Wallet and MetaMask, as **examples of wallet apps**, are typically hot when they sit on a daily driver. That is not an insult. It is the job they are good at.

Hot also includes copies you did not mean to make. Android backups, iCloud Photos, WhatsApp media, Google Drive “scan document,” a printer job at a business centre. If a company computer can see the words, the words are hot. If a cousin can open the chat, the words are hot.

Cold is quiet and easy to do badly

Cold examples: a hardware device bought from the maker and initialized by you; a seed written on paper or steel, never photographed, never typed into a computer except the device itself.

Fake cold — the Notes-app trap and its cousins: seed in iCloud Notes or Google Keep; seed in a WhatsApp “message to myself”; seed in an email draft; seed in a screenshot folder; seed in a password manager **shared with a teammate**; seed in a photo of the paper, because “my handwriting is ugly.”

Those copies live on company servers, or on a camera roll that backups to company servers. That is a hot backup wearing a paper costume. The paper in the drawer is not the copy that matters to an attacker. The synced copy is.

A paper backup can still fail as cold without a cloud: it sits in the same bag as the phone, so one theft takes both; it sits under a mattress in a house that burns; it is so cleverly hidden that you cannot find it either. Cold is a location and a process, not a vibe.

Backup	Actually cold?	Why	Beginner verdict
Paper in a drawer, never photographed	Yes, if the house risk is acceptable	No server has a copy	Fine for practice amounts
Steel plate, two locations	Yes	Fire and flood resistant	For amounts you would miss, later
Notes app / Google Doc	No	Synced, searchable, account-takeover	Treat as leaked
Photo of the paper	No	Camera-roll backups	Treat as leaked
Password manager on your personal vault, no sharing	Debatable	Convenient, still an account to phish	Not this course’s default
Hardware device, seed never exported	Yes, for the keys in the chip	You still need a paper/steel backup of the seed	Optional later layer
WhatsApp “message to myself”	No	Chat backups, other devices, screenshot risk	Treat as leaked

Worked scenario. Yusuf “backs up” twelve words by emailing them to himself with the subject “crypto.” He also has them on paper.

73. Two years later his email is phished. The thief does not need the phone.

74. The thief restores the wallet in an hour on a fresh install of an official-looking app.

75. BscScan will show outgoing transfers signed by Yusuf’s key. The chain did nothing wrong.

76. The paper in the drawer is still there. It did not protect him, because a hotter copy existed.

77. The correct move, which Module 2 will drill, is **rotation**: new wallet, tiny test, move, retire the old words. Hoping “nobody looked” is not a control.

DIAGRAM

Real cold

Device / paper that never
talks to random websites

|
v

Attacker must touch the

Fake cold

Cloud note, screenshot,
chat backup, email draft

|
v

Attacker needs one

physical object

password reset or one
malware scan of photos

Signing the wrong thing makes even hardware hot in effect

Cold storage is about **where the secret sits**. It is not a spell that blesses every click. If a website proposes a transaction that sends your tokens to a thief, and you confirm it on a hardware screen you did not read, the architecture did its job and you still paid the thief.

That is why this academy will keep repeating **read the sheet**. The wallet sheet — the popup that asks you to confirm — is the last place the true destination and the true permission show up. A pretty website is not that place. A Telegram admin is not that place.

If you already put a seed in the cloud, treat it as **leaked**. Not “maybe later.” Not “it was only a practice wallet.” Practice wallets become funded wallets because humans are lazy. Later in this course we cover rotation in full. Today’s rule is simpler: do not add a digital copy, and if one already exists, assume it is the copy that counts.

A related trap: writing the words in a phone note “until I get paper,” then forgetting to delete the note. Deleting a note that already synced is not time travel. The backup of the backup may still exist. Rotation is cleaner than archaeology.

People also confuse **encrypted** with **cold**. A notes app that claims encryption still lives behind an account you can phish, a device you already unlock to read WhatsApp, and a recovery email. Encryption of a hot copy is not the same architecture as a paper that never left the house.

ACADEMY NOTE If you already put a seed in the cloud, treat it as leaked. Create a new wallet later in this course, prove the new backup, move a tiny test, then the rest, then retire the old words. Do not “hope nobody looked.” Hope is not a backup. Crystal Stones Academy will never offer to “store your seed for you” in a student portal, and will never ask you to screenshot words “so we can verify the backup.”

What this lesson is for

You can now sort copies. The next lesson is about another lie: the screen versus the book. Hot and cold are about keys. Screens and books are about reports. Different objects. Do not mash them.

Say this out loud

- Hot means keys can sign from an online daily driver. Cold means they are not sitting on that daily driver.
- A cloud copy of a seed is hot, even if a paper copy also exists. Attackers use the hotter copy.
- Signing the wrong thing makes even hardware hot in effect.
- A seed in Notes, WhatsApp, email, or photos is a leak wearing a backup costume.
- Self-custody and cold are not synonyms. You can hold keys and still be hot.

Next: the screen versus the book — why your app can lie, what a watch-only view is, and why a delayed RPC is not a theft.

Lesson 5: The screen versus the book (27 min)

The screen versus the book

A wallet screen is a **report**. The chain is the **book**. When they disagree, the book wins.

This lesson exists because scammers send screenshots, because honest apps lag, and because a **watch-only** address can look like a wallet that can spend. By the end you should be able to use an explorer as the adult copy of the report, and you should know what an RPC is without becoming an engineer.

What the app is doing when it draws a number

Most phone wallets are **light clients**. They do not store the whole BNB Smart Chain. They ask a helper computer — an **RPC** — “what does this address hold?” Then they draw a number.

RPC means **Remote Procedure Call**: a way for your app to ask a node for chain data and to broadcast a signed transaction. You will see “RPC” in network settings. For BNB Smart Chain you want a helper that is actually talking to chain id **56**, not a lookalike chain with a similar name.

If the RPC is slow, your balance looks wrong. If the RPC is malicious, your balance can look right while a send goes somewhere else. If the app is a clone from a random APK site, it can draw whatever it wants while it steals the seed you just typed in. Three different failures. One screen. Name which failure you are in before you “fix” it by sending more.

Delayed RPC is the honest lag: you received BNB two minutes ago, the explorer shows it, the phone still shows 0.00. Pull to refresh. Switch off Wi-Fi and on again. Wait a block or two. Do not panic-send a second payment. Do not give a stranger remote access “to refresh the node.”

A light client is a design trade. You get a small app that runs on a phone. You pay for it by trusting a helper to tell you the truth and to broadcast your signed transaction. A **full node** would check the rules itself. You do not need to run one to finish Basic. You need to know that your pretty number came from a helper, not from a vault inside the icon.

You see	What might be true	Adult move
“0.00” after a send to you	Tx still pending, RPC not refreshed, or wrong network in the app	Check BscScan on your address; wait; do not send twice
“Success” in a chat screenshot	Photoshop, or a send on a different chain	Paste the tx hash into the real explorer yourself
A token named Crystal Stones	Could be a clone contract with a similar name	Compare the contract to 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00
Green “connected”	Connected to a website. Not the same as “this website is honest”	Connecting is not paying and not approving
Watch-only / imported address	The app can see; it cannot sign unless keys are present	If it cannot send, you are looking, not holding

The explorer is the adult move

A **block explorer** is a search engine for one chain's book. For BNB Smart Chain, **BscScan** is the common one. Bookmark the real domain the way you bookmark a bank. Fake explorers exist. Never follow an explorer link from a random DM.

You will practise this until it is a reflex:

78. Copy the **transaction hash** (a long id the wallet shows after a send) or the **address**.

79. Paste it into the explorer **for that chain**.

80. Read the official row: asset, from, to, status, network, timestamp.

If the row is not there, it is not paid. An argument in Telegram is not a row. A JPEG is not a row. A customer who swears they paid is not a row.

Explorers can also lag, and fake explorers can lie. Two controls: you typed the domain from a bookmark, and you are looking at the address you actually control, not an address the sender chose for you. If two honest sources disagree, wait a minute. If a stranger's screenshot disagrees with your bookmark, the stranger is not a source.

Watch-only is a window without a pen

Watch-only (sometimes "address import" or "observation") means the app knows an address and can draw its balances, but it does **not** have the keys. This is useful: a shopkeeper can watch a receiving address on a tablet that never held a seed. It is also how people fool themselves.

If you paste an address into a wallet and it shows Crystal Stones, you have not "imported the wallet." You have imported a view. Pressing Send will fail or will ask for keys you do not have. Do not then type a seed into a second app "to make send work" on a device you do not trust.

Worked scenario. A buyer says they paid Amaka in Crystal Stones. They send a screenshot of a wallet with a green tick.

81. Amaka does not argue about JPEG quality.

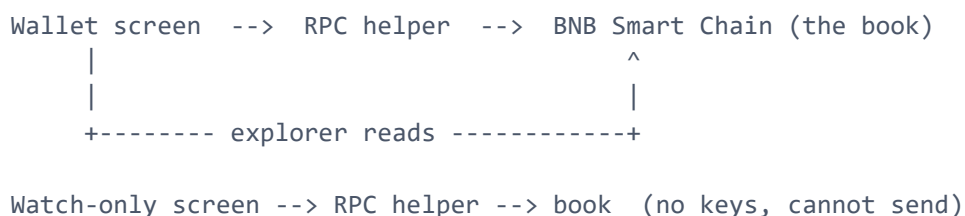
82. She opens BscScan — the real site from her bookmark — and pastes **her** receiving address.

83. She filters the token to the Crystal Stones **contract** 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00.

84. If there is no incoming transfer, she was not paid. If there is a transfer of a **different** token named Crystal Stones, she was paid a clone. If the transfer is on another chain, she was paid on the wrong book.

85. Only if the explorer row matches asset, network, and her address does she ship the goods.

DIAGRAM



If screen and explorer disagree, believe the explorer.
If a screenshot and explorer disagree, believe the explorer.
If a delayed RPC and explorer disagree, wait; do not double-pay.

Network selector is part of the screen, not a sticker on the coins

MetaMask and similar apps have a network dropdown. If it says Ethereum, you are looking at Ethereum's book. If it says BNB Smart Chain, you are looking at BSC. Add the wrong RPC and you may be looking at a **test network** or a fake chain that mimics names.

The same seed can have an address that **looks** the same on both (EVM chains share the 0x address format). The **balances are not shared**. A watch-only view of the Ethereum copy of your 0x will not show your BEP-20 Crystal Stones. That is not theft. That is the wrong book.

A delayed report on the right book is annoying. A perfect report on the wrong book is how people donate to a void. Check the dropdown every time you open the app to send or to declare yourself paid.

ACADEMY NOTE Always check you are on the real explorer domain. Fake explorers exist. Bookmark BscScan the way you bookmark your bank. Never follow an explorer link from a random DM, and never install an "explorer app" from a sponsored message. Academy staff will not send you a special explorer "to verify your wallet," and will not ask for remote desktop to "fix your RPC."

What this lesson is for

You now have a rule for disagreement: the book wins. You know that light wallets ask an RPC, that watch-only cannot spend, and that delayed reports are not frozen funds. Take the quiz. Then we open the vault combination — the seed phrase — slowly, as an operating manual, not as a dare.

Say this out loud

- The app is a report. The chain is the book. When they disagree, the book wins.
- Light wallets ask an RPC. That is convenient and a trust trade. A delayed RPC is lag, not theft.
- Explorers read the book. Screenshots do not. Watch-only is a window without a pen.
- The network dropdown is which book you are reading. Same 0x shape is not a shared balance.
- Crystal Stones on BscScan means the published contract, not a clone with the same nickname.

Take the quiz. Then we open the vault combination — the seed phrase — slowly.

Module quiz (answers included for editors)

Q1. Amaka's phone drowns. The Trust Wallet icon is gone. Where are the coins?

- A. Inside the drowned icon; they evaporate with the app
- B. On the chain's ledger; if she still has the seed she can open a new window on the same book
- C. In the App Store, waiting for a reinstall credit
- D. In Crystal Stones' office, which can reprint them

Correct answer: B

Q2. Chinedu resets his phone PIN after a cousin sent funds from his unlocked wallet. What did the PIN reset do?

- A. It reversed the send on BNB Smart Chain
- B. It only changed the lock on this device; the chain already accepted a signature
- C. It issued a new seed automatically
- D. It notified BscScan to freeze the address

Correct answer: B

Q3. Ada has USDT sitting in her Binance account and tells friends she is in self-custody. What does she actually have?

- A. Self-custody of on-chain keys
- B. An IOU in the company's ledger until she withdraws to an address whose seed she holds
- C. A hardware wallet by default
- D. A seed phrase stored by the exchange in her name

Correct answer: B

Q4. Yusuf stored his twelve words in iCloud Notes "just until he buys paper." How should this academy describe that copy?

- A. Proper cold storage because he intended to buy paper
- B. A hot, synced copy — treat it as exposed if the account can be phished
- C. Required by BNB Smart Chain for BEP-20 tokens
- D. Safer than paper because Apple cannot be phished

Correct answer: B

Q5. A buyer sends Amaka a screenshot of a green tick. BscScan shows no incoming Crystal Stones to her address on the published contract. What is true?

- A. The prettier screenshot is the official receipt
- B. She was not paid on that book for that contract; believe the explorer row
- C. She should delete BNB Smart Chain and try Ethereum
- D. She should send her seed to support so they can locate the missing tick

Correct answer: B

Q6. The same 0x address appears in a wallet on Ethereum and on BNB Smart Chain. What does that mean?

- A. Balances are automatically shared across both books
- B. The address format matches; the books and tokens are still separate
- C. Crystal Stones exists equally on both chains because the letters match
- D. Gas is free when the address looks the same

Correct answer: B

Q7. A shopkeeper imports a receiving address as watch-only on a tablet. What can that tablet do?

- A. Sign spends because seeing a balance means the keys are present
- B. Show balances by asking an RPC; it cannot spend unless keys are also on that tablet
- C. Reset the seed if the shopkeeper forgets it
- D. Convert BEP-20 tokens into naira without an exchange

Correct answer: B

Q8. A Telegram account named Crystal Stones Support asks you to import your seed into a “verification portal” and share your 2FA. What is the academy rule?

- A. Do it if they also ask for remote desktop — that proves they are staff
- B. Never. Academy staff will never ask for a seed, private key, 2FA, or remote screen control
- C. Send the first four words only, as a compromise
- D. Do it after you finish this course, because graduates are verified

Correct answer: B

Module 2: Seed phrases and recovery

The 12 or 24 words are the vault combination. How they are made, why order matters, how to write them, and what to do if they leak.

Lesson 1: How a seed phrase is born (26 min)

How a seed phrase is born

A **seed phrase** (also **recovery phrase** or **mnemonic**) is 12 or 24 ordinary words in a fixed order. It is not a slogan you invent. It is a human-readable encoding of a large random number.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to say how those words are supposed to be born, why a website that “generates your seed” is a trap, and why you prove a restore with zero funds before you deposit anything you would miss.

Wallet software uses a standard most of the industry copied: **BIP-39**. BIP-39 is a recipe that turns random bits into words from a published list, then later turns those words back into keys. You do not need to implement it. You need the consequences: create the words in a place you trust, copy them exactly, treat any extra digital copy as a leak.

Randomness is the whole product

When you tap “Create wallet,” the device is supposed to generate **entropy** — true-enough randomness — then map it onto a word list.

If the randomness is bad (a website generating your seed in a browser tab, a fake app, a “paper wallet generator” from 2017), an attacker may be able to regenerate the same words. The words will still look

official. They will still restore in a real app. That is the point of the trap: the vault combination was born in the thief's building.

Rule: create a seed **inside** a reputable wallet you installed from the official store, or on a hardware device's own screen. Not inside Telegram. Not inside a Google Doc. Not on a website that says "generate seed." Not on a laptop a cousin "already prepared for crypto."

Entropy is the product because everything after it is mechanical. BIP-39 is public. The word list is public. Derivation is public. The only secret is the random number. If someone else chose that number, or if a weak generator chose it from a small set, the public recipe works for them too.

Word order is the secret, not the poetry of the words

The same 12 words in a different order are a **different vault**. There is no "close enough." There is no "I remember most of them." There is no academy staff who can fill in the blanks.

The words come from a published list (2048 English words in the common list). That does **not** mean they are weak. The power is in the **combination and order**, like a long PIN made of dictionary words. A later lesson in this module unpacks the wordlist. Today: do not invent a memorable sentence. Invented phrases are guessable and not standard.

24 words is more entropy than 12. 12 is common and valid in BIP-39. Either must stay secret. Longer is not safer if you then photograph it. Shorter is not "beginner mode that the chain will forgive."

Myth	Fact	What people do after believing it
"I can pick words I will remember"	No. Invented phrases are guessable and not standard.	They write a proverb, get drained by a guesser, blame crypto
"24 words is always required"	12 is common and valid in BIP-39. 24 is more entropy. Either must stay secret.	They refuse a good 12-word wallet and then screenshot a 24-word one
"I can skip three words I forgot"	No. Partial phrases are not a login hint.	They pay a "recovery agent" who wants the remaining words plus leftover funds
"The wallet company has a copy"	A real self-custody wallet must not. If they do, it is not self-custody.	They message support for a reset, then type the seed into a fake support site
"The academy can regenerate it from my student login"	Never. Your course account is not a vault.	They wait, then panic-send

Worked scenario. Tunde sits in a cybercafé because his phone storage is full. A bookmark says "generate BIP-39 seed — free."

86. The site shows 12 words. It also shows them to whoever runs the site.

87. Tunde writes the words on a receipt, installs an official wallet at home, and restores. The balances will be visible to him — and to the generator.

88. He funds it with a practice amount "to see if it works." It works. That is not a blessing.

89. Hours or weeks later the address empties. BscScan shows a signed send. The chain did its job.

90. The adult create path: official app or hardware screen, airplane mode if you like, pen ready, no café generator, no Telegram bot.

DIAGRAM

```
Entropy on the device you trust
  |
  v
BIP-39 words (12 or 24, ordered)
  |
  v
Master key --> many child keys --> addresses on each chain
```

If entropy is born on a stranger's website, the stranger has the master key too.

Prove the birth before you fund the vault

Write the words **before** you put money in. Confirm the wallet can restore on a second view (the app usually asks you to tap the words in order). If you cannot restore with zero funds, do not fund it.

A create flow that skips the confirmation quiz is not “faster.” It is an untested backup. An untested backup is a rumour. Module 6 will make you do this as a lab. Today you need the rule: birth, write, confirm, then — maybe — a tiny receive.

Do not create a second wallet “for backup” by generating a second seed and mixing papers. One seed, one paper (or two copies of the same paper in two places), one restore proof. Extra unused seeds become extra ways to confuse yourself.

ACADEMY NOTE Crystal Stones Academy will never generate a seed for you, never display your words in a student portal, and never ask you to paste them “so we can confirm BIP-39.” If a page uses our logo and a generate-or-paste box, it is theft. Close it. Report it. Do not type.

What this lesson is for

You now know a seed is born as randomness on a device, not as a slogan in your head and not as a gift from a website. The next lesson is the tree those words grow: keys and addresses. You do not need a maths degree. You need to know why a restore can show zero without the coins being gone.

Say this out loud

- A seed is generated randomness, not a password you chose and not a proverb you will remember.
- Create it in a real wallet or hardware screen, never on a website, never in a café generator, never in a chat bot.
- Order matters. Partial memory is not recovery. The academy cannot fill in blanks.
- Prove restore with zero funds before you deposit.
- 12 words can be valid. 24 words can be valid. A photographed phrase of either length is a leak.

Next: what those words turn into — keys and addresses — without a maths degree.

Lesson 2: From words to keys to addresses (27 min)

From words to keys to addresses

The seed is the root. Wallets grow a tree of keys from it so you can have many addresses without many pieces of paper.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to walk the stack — words, master key, child keys, public keys, address — and you should know why restoring the same words in a different app can show a zero balance without the coins having vanished.

You will hear **derivation path**. It is just a recipe: “from this seed, walk this folder structure, produce this key.” Different apps may use slightly different recipes. That is why restoring a seed in a **different brand** of wallet sometimes shows a **zero balance** even though the funds exist — the app is looking at a different branch of the tree.

The stack, slowly

91. **Seed words** — human backup. 12 or 24 ordered words. This is what you write on paper.
92. **Master key** — the big secret derived from the words (and, if you used one, a passphrase — later lesson).
93. **Child private keys** — one per account or address the app creates. A **private key** is the number that can sign for one address.
94. **Public keys** — can be shown; used to check signatures. A public key is not an address, but an address is derived from it.
95. **Address** — the 0x... thing you publish to receive funds.

On BNB Smart Chain (an **EVM** chain — it speaks Ethereum’s style), addresses look like 0x plus 40 hex characters.

One seed can produce an Ethereum-style address, the **same looking** address on BSC, and different addresses if the derivation path or account index differs. Balances still live **per chain**. The format matching is convenience, not a shared piggy bank.

A **hex private key** is another way to export one child secret. If a site asks you to paste a hex key, that is the same family of disaster as pasting the seed. Sharing one child key can empty that address. Sharing the seed can empty the tree.

You hold	You can share	You must not share	Typical mix-up
Seed words	Never	Never	“Support asked for 12 words to verify”
Private key (hex)	Never	Never	“Export key to connect faster”
Address	Yes, to receive	Sharing it does not let them spend	Thinking an address is a password
QR of the address	Yes, to receive	Check it is an address QR, not a seed QR	Scanning a “wallet QR” from a DM
Public key	Usually yes, still pointless for beginners	Not a seed, but do not scatter it into random forms	Thinking it is the vault

Worked scenario. Ngozi restores a MetaMask seed into Trust Wallet — both are examples of wallet apps, not a required pair. She expected Crystal Stones to appear. The app shows 0.

96. She does not panic-send, and she does not paste the seed into a third “checker” site.
97. She checks the network dropdown: is she on BNB Smart Chain (chain id 56), not Ethereum, not a testnet.
98. She checks whether she added the Crystal Stones contract
0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00. Adding is viewing. It is not a buy.
99. She opens BscScan on the address she **actually used** when she received funds — the address from the first app’s receive screen, not the address she assumes.
100. Possible honest reasons for a zero: wrong network, token not added, derivation account index is not account 0. Not a reason: “BSC deleted it.” Not a reason: “Trust Wallet ate MetaMask coins.”

DIAGRAM

```
12/24 words
  |
  v
master secret
  |
  +--> account 0 --> key --> 0xaaa...    (what most apps show first)
  +--> account 1 --> key --> 0xbbb...    (a different door, same seed)
  +--> other paths / other brands        (can look empty if you are on the wrong
branch)
```

Same words, wrong folder of the tree, empty screen, funds still on the book.

Why “one seed, many addresses” is power and a foot-gun

Apps show “Account 2,” “Add address,” “New wallet” inside the same seed. Those are often still the same tree. If you leak the seed, every account in that tree is in the race. Creating Account 2 is not a new backup. It is a new door with the same combination.

If you truly need a separate vault — household money versus a practice hot wallet — you need a **new seed**, a new paper, a new restore proof. Do not invent a “separate account” story that still sits on the leaked phrase.

Never type a seed into two random apps “to compare.” Each extra typing is an extra chance of malware. If you must restore, do it on a clean install from the official store, once. Module 6 will give you a lab version of that discipline.

ACADEMY NOTE Never type a seed into two random apps “to compare.” Each extra typing is an extra chance of malware. If you must restore, do it on a clean install from the official store, once. Crystal Stones Academy will never ask you to paste a hex private key into a lesson, a mentor chat, or a “derivation checker.”

What this lesson is for

You can now see the tree. Words are the root. Addresses are doors. Derivation is the hallway. The next lesson is the wordlist itself — why order matters mathematically enough for you to treat a shuffled paper as a different vault.

Say this out loud

- Words become a master key, then child keys, then addresses. The paper is the root, not one door.
- Derivation path is which folder of that tree you are in. Wrong folder can look like a hack.
- Same 0x shape on BSC and Ethereum does not share balances.
- Explorer the address you used, not the address you assumed.
- A second account on the same seed is not a second backup. A leak of the words is a leak of the tree.

Next: BIP-39 wordlists and why order matters — the 2048-word list is public, the combination is not.

Lesson 3: BIP-39 wordlists and why order matters (26 min)

BIP-39 wordlists and why order matters

The BIP-39 English list is 2048 ordinary words. You can look it up. Looking it up does not open anyone's vault. The secret is **which words, in which order, for this wallet**.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to explain why a shuffled paper is a different combination, why "I remember they were nature words" is not recovery, and why writing the numbers 1–12 next to the words is not optional decoration.

The list is public on purpose

A recovery phrase has to be writable by a tired human with a pen. The designers picked a list of short, distinct words so that "apple" and "able" are less likely to collapse into the same scribble, and so that software can check that a word is even on the list.

Checksum means the last word is not fully free: it is partly determined by the earlier randomness, so a typo is more likely to be rejected. That is a kindness. It is not a backup of three forgotten words. If you are off by one word, the wallet should refuse. If you shuffle the first eleven and keep the twelfth, you do not have "almost the vault." You have a failed checksum or a different vault.

People see the public list and think the system is weak. A PIN made of four digits is weak because there are 10,000 guesses. A BIP-39 12-word phrase is a combination from a 2048-word list, in order, with a checksum. Guessing it is not a hobby. Stealing a photo of it is.

Order is the combination

Write the words numbered. Read them back in order, privately. If you copy them as a paragraph without numbers, a smudge or a line break will invent a new vault later.

The same twelve words, reversed, are not “your wallet backwards.” They derive a different master key. Software will often still accept them if they pass a checksum, and then show empty addresses. That empty screen is how people decide they were hacked when they only shuffled a page.

What you did	What the software does	What you should do
Wrote 1–12, restored in order	Opens the original tree	Fund only after this works with zero
Shuffled the paper “to make it harder for a thief”	Opens a different tree, or fails checksum	Do not shuffle. Hide the paper. Do not encrypt it with a scheme you will forget
Skipped a word you thought was duplicate	Fails, or a different vault	Copy exactly. Duplicates can happen. Order still matters
Translated words into another language by hand	Not the same list	Use the list the wallet used. Do not translate
Picked twelve words from the public list because they were memorable	Guessable, non-standard entropy	Never invent. Let the device generate

Worked scenario. A shopkeeper, Ife, copies twelve words onto a card, then rewrites them alphabetically in a second notebook “so a thief cannot use the first card.”

101. The first card is the real combination, if it was copied in order.
102. The alphabetical notebook is a different order. Restoring from it will not show the funds.
103. A thief who finds the alphabetical notebook may still try orders, but Ife has mainly attacked herself: two papers, one of which will “fail” during a panic restore, at which point she may type both into a helper.
104. The adult move is two copies of the **same ordered list**, in two boring places, not two encodings.
105. If she already rewrote alphabetically and funded the wallet, she must still keep the ordered original. The sorted copy is not a backup. It is a puzzle.

DIAGRAM

Word 1 -> Word 2 -> ... -> Word 12 = vault A

Word 12 -> Word 11 -> ... -> Word 1 = vault B (different)

Alphabetical sort = vault C or a checksum fail

Public wordlist (2048 words)

|
v

Does NOT open vaults. Only the ordered pick does.

Languages, lookalikes, and “I will just remember”

Some wallets offer other BIP-39 language lists. Do not mix. If the device showed English, write English. Do not “translate for my auntie.” The auntie needs the exact words or she needs not to be the backup.

Lookalike handwriting is a practical enemy: l and i, r and n, words that differ by one letter on the list. Print in block letters. Leave space. Do not write on both sides of flimsy paper that will bleed.

Remembering twelve words in your head is a party trick until a hospital, a panic, or a year of disuse. This academy's default is paper or steel, not memory. Memory is a single point of failure with no checksum.

ACADEMY NOTE Do not invent a “coded” order as a security layer unless you can explain it to your future tired self at 3 a.m. Most people who shuffle, rotate, or translate their own backup lock themselves out more reliably than they lock out a thief. Hide the ordered paper. Do not encrypt it with folklore.

Do not “improve” the list

People add extra words from their language, or replace a word that feels unlucky. That is a new vault the app will not confirm. People also write the words in two columns without numbers, then cannot remember whether they read down or across. Numbers exist so that panic has a sequence. Use them.

What this lesson is for

You now treat order as the combination and the public list as a writing aid, not a weakness. Next is the physical job: writing and storing the words so you do not become a cautionary tale about photos, printers, and cloud folders.

Say this out loud

- The BIP-39 list is public. The ordered pick is the secret.
- The same words in a new order are a different vault, or a checksum fail — not a clever lock.
- Number the lines 1–12 or 1–24. Copy exactly. Do not translate. Do not alphabetise.
- A checksum can catch a typo. It cannot reconstruct three forgotten words.
- Memory is not a backup. Paper with numbers is.

Next: writing and storing the words — paper, metal, never photos, never cloud.

Lesson 4: Writing and storing the words (27 min)

Writing and storing the words

This is the practical heart of self-custody. Cryptography does not save sloppy storage.

By the end of this lesson you should have a boring, adult plan: pen, numbered lines, a read-back, two locations if the amount would hurt, and zero photos. You should also know which “clever” hiding places are just delays before a disaster.

How to write them

Use a pen, paper, or a purpose-made steel plate. Number the lines 1–12 or 1–24. Copy **exactly**. Then read them back once, out loud, privately. Do not correct “ugly handwriting” by taking a photo “to be sure.”

Do not type them into chat to “have a copy.” Do not email them. Do not put them in a tweet draft. Do not use a printer at an office — printers keep jobs. Do not type them into a notes app “until I buy a metal plate.” The temporary copy becomes the real copy.

Write in block letters. Do not write in pencil that will fade. Do not write on a sticky note that will travel on someone's shoe. Do not write on the back of an identity photocopy. Theft of that envelope is identity plus vault.

If the wallet shows the words on screen, cover the screen from cameras, windows, and video calls. Finish writing. Confirm the in-app quiz. Then — and only then — consider a tiny receive. Crystal Stones Academy will never run a “backup verification” that requires you to type words into our site. If a site says that, it is theft.

Where to put the paper

Good enough for practice amounts: a drawer that is not a postcard; not the same bag as the phone; not taped to the device.

Better for amounts you would miss: two copies in two places (flood in one house should not take both); steel if fire is a real risk; someone you trust **only** if you have thought about inheritance and theft by that person — this is a relationship decision, not a crypto trick. Module 5 returns to household and death. Today: do not put a seed in a family WhatsApp group “so everyone can help.”

A bank safe-deposit box can be a serious option for some adults. It has hours, paperwork, and a process. It is still more adult than Google Photos. It is not required for this course's practice amounts.

Place	Risk	When it is used anyway
Same phone case as the device	Stolen together	People want “convenience.” Convenience is the thief's friend
Family WhatsApp group	Social and screenshot risk	“Backup by community.” Community is not a vault
Bank safe deposit	Process and access hours; sometimes a good option	Amounts you would miss, with a legal mind
Under a mattress only	Fire, theft, relatives	Folklore. Add a second location
Two boring locations	Usually the adult amateur setup	Practice this before you scale amounts
Photo “just for tonight”	Camera-roll backup, then forever	The most common self-own in this course

Worked scenario. A learner, Kemi, writes the words, funds a wallet with a test amount, then “improves” the backup by typing it into Notes.

106. She now has two backups: paper (good) and cloud (fatal).
107. The cloud one is the one that matters to an attacker. Account takeover, a stolen laptop, a curious roommate with her unlocked phone — any of these beats the locked drawer.
108. Deleting the note after it synced is not a time machine. Treat the seed as leaked if the copy existed long enough to leave the device.
109. Rotation, later in this module: new wallet, new paper, tiny test, move, retire.
110. If the note existed for thirty seconds on a phone that never backed up, she may still choose to rotate. Dignity is cheaper than a drained address.

DIAGRAM

```
Create wallet
|
v
Write words on numbered paper --> confirm restore with 0 funds
|
v
Tiny test receive on the right network
|
v
Only then: larger amount, if ever
|
v
Never: photo, cloud, printer, group chat
```

Steel, fire, and the urge to get fancy

Steel plates exist so that a house fire does not eat the combination. They are examples of a tool, not a shopping list for week one of Basic. If your practice amount is smaller than the plate, paper in two dry places is enough. If you later hold an amount a fire would ruin you for, steel becomes a conversation, not a personality.

Do not stamp a seed into a decorative object you will photograph for Instagram. Do not engrave it on jewellery you wear to a market. Physical backup means **boring and unadvertised**.

ACADEMY NOTE Crystal Stones Academy will never run a “backup verification” that requires you to type words into our site. If a site says that, it is theft. We will also never ask you to upload a photo of the paper “for your student record.” Official stores, official apps, your paper, your drawer.

Ink, time, and the urge to type

If your hand is shaking, slow down. A wrong word written neatly is a wrong vault. A right word written so badly you will read “sword” as “word” is also a wrong vault. Block letters. Numbered lines. One private read-back. The five minutes you save by photographing the screen are the five minutes a camera-roll backup uses to leave the house.

What this lesson is for

You have a write-and-store ritual. Next is an optional extra secret — the passphrase, the so-called 25th word — and why most beginners should leave it off until they can teach it.

Say this out loud

- Ink and steel beat cloud. Numbered paper beats a paragraph. A read-back beats a photo.
- Two locations beat one clever hiding place. The same bag as the phone is one location.
- Confirm restore before funding. An untested paper is a rumour.
- A digital copy poisons the setup. If it synced, rotate.
- Do not print, do not chat, do not decorate, do not file the seed with your passport photocopy.

Next: the optional extra word — passphrase — and why most beginners should leave it off.

Lesson 5: The optional passphrase (25th word) — power and how people lock themselves out (26 min)

The optional passphrase (25th word) — power and how people lock themselves out

Some wallets let you add a **passphrase** on top of the 12/24 words. People call it a 25th word. It is not on the sticker. You invent it.

Technically it derives a **different** vault from the same words. Same paper, different extra secret → different addresses. That is power. It is also how careful people lock themselves out more thoroughly than a thief ever could.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to say what a passphrase does, why this academy's default for Basic is **off**, and what a zero balance after a restore might mean if you ever turned it on.

Why it exists

If someone finds the paper, they still need the passphrase. It is a second factor **you must remember** (or store as carefully as the seed, which means you now have two secrets).

It is used by people who want a **decoy**: the twelve words alone open an empty or small wallet; the twelve words plus passphrase open the real one. That is an advanced household and duress design. It fails if you forget which is which, if you tell the wrong story under stress, or if you never wrote the passphrase because you thought the device PIN was the passphrase.

Why beginners lock themselves out

They turn it on without writing it. They think the PIN is the passphrase. They type a space or a capital letter once and never again. They enable it on one app and restore in another app without it, see a zero balance, and panic-send. They use “Family2024” or a birthday, which is a second factor a cousin can guess.

A passphrase is **case-sensitive** and space-sensitive. “Family 2024” and “Family2024” and “family2024” are three different vaults. There is no “forgot passphrase” email. There is no academy reset. The paper seed will still “work.” It will open the un-passphrased tree. That tree can be empty. The funds are in the hidden tree you cannot open.

If you	Result	Academy default
Do not understand this lesson	Leave passphrase OFF	Yes
Use it	Treat it as seriously as the seed; two secrets now	Only after you can teach this lesson
Forget it	The paper seed opens an empty decoy wallet. Funds are in the hidden one you cannot open	Avoid
Confuse it with the device PIN	PIN still only locks furniture. Passphrase changes the vault	Name the object
Use a birthday	Guessable second factor	Do not

Worked scenario. A user, Sola, enables a passphrase “Family2024” then restores on a new phone without it.

111. The familiar 12 words work. Balance is 0.
112. Sola assumes a hack. She is looking at the **un-passphrased** tree.
113. The funds are still in the passphrased tree — which she also might have forgotten, including whether it was “Family2024” or “family2024”.
114. If she now creates a brand new seed and moves nothing, she has not healed anything. If she types the old words plus guesses into a “recovery helper,” she has donated the vault.
115. If she still remembers the exact passphrase, she restores with words **plus** that exact string, then checks BscScan on the address that actually held funds.

DIAGRAM

12/24 words alone	-->	vault A (often empty if you used a passphrase)
12/24 words + "X"	-->	vault B
12/24 words + "x"	-->	vault C (different)
PIN / fingerprint	-->	still just this device

Leave it off until you can teach it

This academy’s default advice for Basic: **leave the passphrase off** until you can explain it to someone else without notes. Complexity is not safety if you are the one who fails the puzzle.

Hardware wallets make passphrases easy to enable and easy to forget. Software wallets hide the setting under “advanced.” If you did not intend to create a hidden wallet, do not poke advanced settings while tired. If you already did, write the exact passphrase as carefully as the seed — then admit you now have two objects to inherit, lose, or leak.

A passphrase is not a substitute for a steel plate. It is not a substitute for avoiding screenshots. It is an extra derivation input. Treat it that way, or leave it off.

ACADEMY NOTE This academy’s default advice for Basic: leave the passphrase off until you can explain it to someone else without notes. We will never ask you for a 25th word, a PIN, or a “hidden wallet check.” If a helper wants those, they want the vault.

Hidden wallets and fake support

Some thieves ask you to “open the hidden wallet” and will coach you through enabling a passphrase on a seed they already stole, or on words they want you to type. You do not need a hidden wallet to finish Basic. You need a paper you can restore.

If a helper says the 25th word is your date of birth “for inheritance,” they are guessing a vault they hope you already made. Do not confirm or deny secrets on a call. Hang up. Open the official app from the icon you installed. Not from their link.

What this lesson is for

You can now refuse a feature that would make you safer on paper and poorer in practice. Next is the leak: what to do when you think the words got out, including the race you do not win by hoping.

Say this out loud

- A passphrase makes a different wallet from the same words. It is optional. Off is valid.
- Forgetting it is as final as losing the seed. The paper will still open an empty decoy.
- PIN is not the passphrase. Birthday is not a passphrase. A space and a capital letter matter.
- A zero after restore might mean wrong network, wrong derivation — or a passphrase you forgot to type.
- Do not turn it on to feel advanced. Turn it on when you can teach it and store it.

Next: the leak. What to do when you think the words got out.

Lesson 6: If you think the seed leaked (27 min)

If you think the seed leaked

Assume spent. Not “maybe later.” Spent.

A leak is: photo, cloud sync, screen share, typing into a website, a stranger who “helps you restore,” a repair-shop backup, a Discord “support” form, a remote-desktop session that watched the words, a 2FA code you handed to someone who then opened your email and your cloud photos.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to run **rotation** without a helper, and you should be able to name which secret leaked — seed, exchange password, or device PIN — because those are three different playbooks.

Rotation, not hope

116. On a device you trust, create a **new** wallet (new words). Write those words properly, numbered, no photo.
117. Confirm restore of the **new** wallet with zero funds.
118. From the **old** wallet, send a **tiny test** to the new address on the **correct network** (BNB Smart Chain for BEP-20 assets in this academy).
119. Confirm on BscScan.
120. Move the rest. Leave a little BNB in the old address only if you still need to move tokens; then move those; then stop.
121. Stop using the old wallet. Treat old words as radioactive. Do not “keep it for small stuff.”

Do not wait “to see if they take it.” Bots watch. Humans delay. A balance still showing is not safety. It is a countdown you cannot see.

Do not send everything in one first try to a mistyped address. That is how people donate a leak to a void. Test, explorer, remainder.

Do not ask a helper to “check the seed.” They check it into their wallet.

Bad move	Why	Do this instead
Leaving funds in the old wallet	The leak is a race you will lose	New wallet, test, move, retire
Sending everything in one first try to a mistyped address	You can donate to a void	Tiny test, BscScan, then remainder

Asking a helper to “check the seed”	They check it into their wallet	You restore on an official app you installed
Changing only the PIN	PIN is furniture	Rotation of the seed
Posting “I was hacked, here is my address, send gas”	Predators will answer	Get BNB from a venue you chose, not a stranger

Worked scenario. You pasted 12 words into a “wallet connect” site. You still see the balance.

122. That does not mean you are safe. The site may already have the combination and be waiting, or a bot may be watching the address.
123. Create the new wallet now, on the official app, paper ready.
124. Prove restore of the new words with zero funds.
125. Move a tiny BNB test on BNB Smart Chain. Confirm on BscScan that it landed on **your** new address.
126. Move remaining BNB and tokens (Crystal Stones only if you already held them — this is not a buy order). Then retire the old words. Speed matters more than dignity.

DIAGRAM

```

Old wallet (compromised)
|
| tiny test --> explorer confirms new door
| then remainder (tokens need BNB gas)
v
New wallet (fresh words, clean backup)
|
v
Old words = radioactive. Do not reuse. Do not “check” with support.

```

Name which secret leaked

If the leak was an **exchange password**, that is a different playbook: change password, revoke sessions, 2FA, contact the exchange. That is **not** a seed rotation. If the leak was a **device PIN**, lock the furniture; it does not move the book by itself. If the leak was a **seed**, rotate. If you are not sure which leaked, assume the seed if the words were ever typed, photographed, or shown on a call.

“Support asked for 12 words” is always a leak if you complied — whether they used the academy’s name, Binance’s name, Trust Wallet’s name, or MetaMask’s name. Those companies, and this academy, do not need the words. A human who asks is not confused. They are collecting.

Never send leftover funds to a stranger who promises to “reverse the hack” or “trace the mixer.” That is a second theft. This academy will not give recovery-agent advice that requires sending leftover funds to a stranger.

ACADEMY NOTE If the leak was an exchange password, that is a different playbook: change password, revoke sessions, 2FA, contact the exchange. That is not a seed rotation. Name which secret leaked. Academy staff will never ask you to paste old words “so we can freeze the chain.” The chain does not freeze for our course login.

What “leaked” includes, said plainly

A screen share while the words were visible. A repair shop that backed up the phone. A photo you deleted after iCloud already had it. A “wallet connect” form. A cousin who helped you type. A printer. A password-manager share with a teammate. A 2FA code you handed over that opened the email that opened the photos.

If you are arguing with yourself about whether it counts, it counts. Rotation is cheaper than a paragraph of hope.

Do not pay a recovery agent

Someone will offer to “trace” the thief if you send remaining coins to their address, or if you share the old words so they can “front-run.” That is a second thief. This academy will not give recovery-agent advice that requires sending leftover funds to a stranger. Rotate to a vault they do not have. That is the whole honest move.

What this lesson is for

You have a leak playbook. Take the quiz. Then we practise addresses, networks, and receiving without theatre — the public door, not the combination.

Say this out loud

- Leaked seed means new wallet, test, move, retire. Balance still showing is not safety.
- Never “verify” a seed with a helper, a website, or a remote-desktop technician.
- Exchange password leaks are not seed leaks. PIN leaks are not seed leaks. Name the object.
- Tiny test on the correct network, then explorer, then remainder. Do not donate to a mistype.
- Support that asks for 12 words is theft, even when it uses a logo you trust.

Take the quiz. Then we practise addresses, networks, and receiving without theatre.

Module quiz (answers included for editors)

Q1. Tunde generates twelve words on a “free BIP-39” website in a cybercafé, then restores them in an official app. What is true?

- A. Official restore washes the words; the café site no longer matters
- B. The words were born in a stranger’s building — treat the vault as already known to someone else
- C. BIP-39 websites are required by BNB Smart Chain
- D. The academy can re-issue him a clean phrase from his student login

Correct answer: B

Q2. Ngozi restores the same seed in a second wallet app and sees 0 Crystal Stones. A possible honest reason is?

- A. The chain deleted her account because she switched brands

- B. Wrong network, wrong derivation account, or she is looking at a different address than the one that received funds
- C. Crypto is fake and balances are only screenshots
- D. She must pay a listing fee to make tokens visible

Correct answer: B

Q3. Ife alphabetises her twelve words in a second notebook so a thief cannot use the first card. What did she create?

- A. A stronger lock on the same vault
- B. A different order — a different vault or a checksum fail — and a way to confuse herself during a panic restore
- C. A BIP-39 checksum that reconstructs the original order
- D. A valid 25th-word passphrase

Correct answer: B

Q4. Kemi typed her seed into the Notes app after writing it on paper. Which copy should she treat as the one that matters to an attacker?

- A. Only the paper, because paper is always colder
- B. The digital copy — a hot, synced leak. If it existed long enough to leave the device, rotate
- C. Neither, because Crystal Stones staff can freeze both
- D. The paper, but only if the handwriting is ugly

Correct answer: B

Q5. Sola enabled a passphrase “Family2024”, then restored on a new phone with the twelve words only. The balance is 0. What may be true?

- A. The PIN reset the book
- B. She is looking at the un-passphrased tree; the funds may sit in the passphrased tree she did not open
- C. BscScan deletes passphrased wallets
- D. She must message academy support with the 25th word

Correct answer: B

Q6. This academy’s default for the optional passphrase in Basic is?

- A. Turn it on with a birthday so family can guess if you die
- B. Leave it off until you can explain it and back it up as a second secret
- C. Use the word “password” on every wallet
- D. Share it with Telegram admins as a second backup

Correct answer: B

Q7. You pasted a seed into a “wallet connect” site and the balance is still there. What should you do?

- A. Wait a week to see if anyone takes it
- B. Create a new wallet, prove the backup, tiny test, move the rest, retire the old words
- C. Send the seed to support so they can freeze it
- D. Change the phone PIN only

Correct answer: B

Q8. A site branded like Crystal Stones Academy asks you to paste twelve words to “verify your backup” before a certificate. What is true?

- A. It is part of graduation for paid tracks
- B. It does not exist as an academy feature — any site asking for words is theft
- C. You should send only the first four words
- D. It is safe if they also ask for remote desktop

Correct answer: B

Module 3: Addresses, networks, and receiving

An address is not a bank account number you can guess. Asset + network + standard must be said together or funds vanish.

Lesson 1: What an address is (and is not) (26 min)

What an address is (and is not)

An **address** is the public door. On BNB Smart Chain it looks like 0x followed by 40 hexadecimal characters (0–9 and a–f, sometimes mixed with A–F).

By the end of this lesson you should be able to say what an address is, what it is not, why you copy-paste instead of dictating, and why a token contract is a different door from a person’s wallet.

It is not a bank account with a name on file at a branch. It is not something you can “reset” if you paste it wrong. It is not proof of who a person is. It is not a Crystal Stones account number issued by the academy. Anyone can generate an address. Anyone can send to it. Only the matching key can send **from** it.

A door, not an identity, not a customer record

When you give someone an address, you are giving them a public identifier the chain can credit. You are not giving them permission to know your legal name. You are not opening a file at Crystal Stones Academy. You are not creating a reversible bank transfer.

If you send to the wrong door, the network does not call you. If you send to the right door on the wrong chain, the network you used is happy and the network you meant never hears about it. The next lesson forces the full sentence: asset, network, standard, address. Today, own the door.

Reuse of addresses is common on EVM chains. Privacy is imperfect. Treat an address as public the moment you share it: it can be watched on BscScan by anyone. That is not a reason to hide your receiving address from a client who must pay you. It is a reason not to also paste your seed beside it.

Checksum: the mixed-case hint

Many EVM wallets show addresses with **mixed capital letters**. That is a **checksum** — extra information so a typo is more likely to look invalid. If you lower-case everything, some checks go away. Prefer copy-paste over retyping. Then check the **first 6 and last 6** characters on the screen you will send from.

Dictating an address on a phone call is how two characters get swapped. The send can still look “valid enough.” Funds go to a door nobody you know can open — or to a stranger. Copy-paste exists. Use it. Then still check the ends. Clipboard malware, later in this module, is why the last check is not paranoia.

Safe habit	Unsafe habit	Why the unsafe one survives
Copy from the wallet receive screen	Retype from memory	Pride. Memory is not 40 hex characters
Check first 6 and last 6	Glance at “0x” and send	Speed. Thieves also like speed
Use the explorer to confirm a past receive	Trust a screenshot someone DMed	Politeness. Politeness is not a row on BscScan
Give one address you control	Give an address a stranger generated “for you”	Helpfulness. Helpfulness can be a redirection
Treat contract and wallet as different doors	Send BNB to the token contract as if it were a friend	The 0x prefix looks the same

Worked scenario. Chinedu dictates his BSC address to a client on a noisy call. Two characters get swapped.

127. The client sends USDT as BEP-20 to the swapped door. The wallet may even show the address as valid.
128. BscScan shows a successful send — to someone else, or to an empty key.
129. Chinedu’s receive screen never changes. He argues. The book already moved.
130. The adult path: he copies from the receive screen, pastes into the chat, then reads first 6 and last 6 aloud while looking at his own screen. The client does the same before confirming.
131. If the amount would hurt, they do a tiny test first. That ritual belongs to the whole module. It starts with not dictating.

DIAGRAM

```

Person's wallet address  -->  they can spend what they receive
Token contract address  -->  the program that defines the token
You receive tokens at the person's address, recorded by the program.

```

```

Academy printing a contract  =  verify / add token
Academy printing a contract  !=  “send funds here”

```

Contracts are addresses too

A **token contract** is also an 0x address, but it is a **program**, not a person's door. Crystal Stones' token contract is a program that keeps a list of who holds how many tokens. The published contract is 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00.

Sending BNB to the **token contract** by mistake is not the same as sending Crystal Stones to **your friend's wallet**. Different doors, different results. Beginners mix "the token's contract" with "the person's address" because both start with 0x and both appear on BscScan.

When we print Crystal Stones' contract, that is so you can **add/verify the token** in a wallet or explorer. It is not a deposit address for the academy. It is not a buy order. It is not a tuition wallet. Paid tracks, when live, use a checkout rail — USDT on BNB Smart Chain (BEP-20) through academy checkout — not this contract as a piggy bank.

A contract can also be a **spender** you approve later in this course. Seeing 0x should make you ask: whose door, or which program? If you cannot answer, do not send.

ACADEMY NOTE When we print Crystal Stones' contract 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00, that is so you can add or verify the token in a wallet or explorer. It is not a deposit address for the academy, not a salary wallet, and not a place to send BNB "to activate Crystal Stones."

What this lesson is for

You now have a public door you can share and a contract you must not confuse with that door. Next you will glue three more words onto every send: asset, network, standard. Nicknames without roads are how USDT disappears.

Say this out loud

- Address means public door. Key means who can leave. Sharing the door does not share the key.
- Copy, then check first and last 6. Do not dictate forty hex characters on a call.
- Token contract is not a friend's wallet. Both can look like 0x.
- Academy contract printouts are not payment addresses and not a buy order.
- A successful send on BscScan to the wrong door is still the wrong door.

Next: networks — the most expensive beginner mix-up. Asset, network, standard — say all three.

Lesson 2: Asset, network, standard — say all three (27 min)

Asset, network, standard — say all three

You already met this in Crypto Foundations. This course makes it muscle memory, because wallets will let you sign a disaster in two taps.

Always speak a send as a full sentence: **I am sending [asset] on [network] as [standard] to [address].**

By the end of this lesson that sentence should feel as automatic as saying a bank name plus an account number. “I’ll just send USDT” is how funds vanish while both people are honest.

Nicknames are not roads

Examples of full sentences:

- I am sending **USDT** on **BNB Smart Chain** as **BEP-20** to 0xabc...
- I am sending **BNB** (native coin) on **BNB Smart Chain** to 0xabc...
- I am sending **USDT** on **Tron** as **TRC-20** to a T-address
- I am sending **USDT** on **Ethereum** as **ERC-20** to 0xabc...

USDT is a **nickname**. The nickname appears on several roads. The roads do not share the money. **ERC-20** is a token standard on Ethereum. **BEP-20** is a token standard on BNB Smart Chain. **TRC-20** is a token standard on Tron. Same ticker letters. Different books. Different address shapes (0x versus T...).

A wallet that can hold all three will still let you pick the wrong one. The app is a translator. It will not parent you. The receive screen on an exchange will usually name the network in small text. Read the small text. If it says BEP-20, do not send TRC-20 because “USDT is USDT.”

Nickname	Common roads	Address look	What happens if you mix them
USDT	Ethereum (ERC-20), BSC (BEP-20), Tron (TRC-20), others	0x on EVM; T... on Tron	Often irrecoverable for a beginner
BNB	BNB Smart Chain (native), also wrapped forms	0x on BSC	Wrapped BNB is not the native gas coin
Crystal Stones	BNB Smart Chain BEP-20 (the official story)	0x contract + 0x wallets	A clone on another chain is a different token
Bitcoin	Bitcoin	bc1... / 1... / 3... (not 0x)	Sending BTC to 0x is the wrong planet

Worked scenario — the academy checkout warning. Paid tracks, when live, ask for **USDT on BNB Smart Chain (BEP-20)** and warn: sending on another network may mean loss.

132. Ada has USDT on Tron (TRC-20) in an exchange account. She sees “USDT” and sends to a BEP-20 checkout address.
133. The letters still say USDT. The receiver’s BSC book never credits them.
134. Support may or may not be able to help; this academy will not promise a rescue. The warning exists because this mistake is common and ugly.
135. The adult path: she withdraws or converts so that the asset, network, and standard match the invoice sentence, then sends a tiny test if the rail allows, then the rest.
136. She never “tries another network” with the same amount hoping one of them will land.

DIAGRAM

Wrong: “I’ll just send USDT”

Right:

Asset: USDT
Network: BNB Smart Chain
Standard: BEP-20
To: 0x... (checked, first 6 and last 6)
Gas: small BNB on that same wallet
Chain id: 56

Native coin versus token

On BSC:

- **BNB** is the native coin. It pays **gas**. It is not a BEP-20 contract you add.
- **Crystal Stones** is a BEP-20 **token**. The contract keeps balances. Moving it still costs **BNB** gas.

If you have tokens and 0 BNB, you can be “rich” on screen and unable to move. Scammers will offer to “unlock gas” if you pay them first. That is theft. Get a little BNB from a venue you chose — never a stranger’s invoice.

This academy does not tell you to buy Crystal Stones to complete Basic. Adding a token contract to a wallet is **viewing**, not investing. The public contract to verify is 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00. Verify, do not treat as a deposit address.

A full sentence also names **from which kind of account**: exchange IOU versus self-custody address. Withdrawing from an exchange to “BEP-20” when you meant “ERC-20” is the same class of error as a wallet-to-wallet mix-up. The dropdown on the exchange is a network selector too.

ACADEMY NOTE This academy does not tell you to buy Crystal Stones to complete Basic. Adding a token contract to a wallet is viewing, not investing. Checkout warnings about BEP-20 exist because sending the same ticker on another network can result in loss — not because we need you to hold a project token.

Why the wallet will not save you

The send button does not know your intent. If USDT BEP-20 and a Tron USDT are both on the phone, the wrong tap is a valid instruction on the wrong book. Valid is not correct. Explorers will show success. Success is not “arrived where I meant.”

Say the sentence out loud before you tap, even if you feel silly. Silly is cheaper than a support ticket that cannot reprint the coins. If the other person cannot say the sentence, stop. Two confused adults do not make a network.

What this lesson is for

You now have the sentence that prevents the ugliest beginner loss. Next is receiving without getting hunted: new address habits, memos on centralised exchanges, QR codes that are not magic truth.

Say this out loud

- Nickname is not the road. USDT on the wrong chain is a different object.
- Always say asset, network, and standard together, then the address, then who pays gas.
- BNB pays BSC gas. Tokens do not pay the courier. A zero-BNB wallet full of tokens is stuck.

- Checkout warnings about BEP-20 exist because this mistake is common and ugly.
- Crystal Stones, as taught here, is a BEP-20 token on BNB Smart Chain — verify the contract, do not send to it as if it were a person.

Next: how to receive without getting hunted — new address, memo/tag on a CEX, QR.

Lesson 3: How to receive without getting hunted (27 min)

How to receive without getting hunted

Receiving looks easy. That is why people get sloppy.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to run a clean receive on BNB Smart Chain, know when an exchange needs a **memo** or **tag**, and treat QR codes as data that can lie.

The clean receive

137. Open **your** wallet, official app — Trust Wallet or MetaMask as examples of wallet apps, not as required brands.
138. Select the **network** (BNB Smart Chain for Crystal Stones / BEP-20 USDT). Confirm chain id 56 if the app shows it.
139. Tap Receive. Copy the address or show the QR **from that screen**.
140. Send a **tiny test** from the other side first if the amount matters.
141. Confirm on BscScan, then send the rest.

Never reuse a “receive address” someone else generated “for you” in a DM. Generate from your app. A helpful stranger who builds the invoice PDF with a QR can swap the door. Your receive screen is the source. Their PDF is a copy that can be poisoned.

If you are receiving onto a **centralised exchange** (a custodial account), read their deposit page until you can say asset, network, standard, address, and whether a **memo/tag/payment ID** is required. A memo is an extra number some exchanges use to credit the right customer, because many customers deposit to one shared chain address. Missing memo on those rails can mean a delay or a painful support ticket. BNB Smart Chain personal wallets usually do **not** use memos. Do not invent a memo for a self-custody 0x.

QR codes are not magic truth

A QR can encode your address (good), a whole payment request (amount + address), a malicious URL, or in nightmare cases, something you should not scan with a seed-aware camera app.

Scan wallet QRs with the wallet, not with a random “crypto scanner” from an ad. After scan, read the address on the confirm sheet — first 6 and last 6 — as if you had pasted. The QR did not bless the digits.

A printed QR on a shop counter should match the watch-only tablet or the receive screen behind the counter. If they disagree, stop. The counter is a report. The receive screen or explorer is closer to the book.

Clipboard malware

Some malware waits until you copy an 0x address, then **replaces** it with the thief's address. You paste without looking. You send.

Habit: after paste, check first 6 and last 6 **on the sending screen** before you hit confirm. Every time. Especially on a computer. A phone is not immune. Speed is the malware's friend.

Step	Why	Skip it and you get
Tiny test	Proves door + network before the amount that hurts	A beautiful, irreversible mistake
Explorer confirm	Book, not screenshot	A JPEG argument
Check ends after paste	Beats clipboard malware	A send to a hunter who watches busy addresses
Official app receive screen	Beats a PDF invoice with a swapped QR	Paying a stranger who designed the invoice
Read memo rules on a CEX deposit	Shared addresses need a tag	A deposit the exchange cannot auto-credit

Worked scenario. You copy your address from Trust Wallet to tell a client. On the laptop, malware swaps it.

142. The client pastes and pays without checking ends.
143. Explorer shows a send to an address that is not yours.
144. The client "did everything right" except the check of the ends. Both of you now have a problem the chain will not reverse.
145. Prevention is dull: you paste into the chat, then read first 6 and last 6 from your receive screen while the client reads the same digits from their send screen.
146. For a large invoice, the tiny test is cheaper than a lawyer.

DIAGRAM

```

Your receive screen --> copy/QR
    |
    v
Sender pastes --> checks first/last 6 --> tiny tx
    |
    v
Explorer shows it on the right book
    |
    v
Remainder
  
```

If a CEX is the receiver: address + memo/tag as the deposit page states.

New address, old address, hunter's address

On Bitcoin, people often generate a fresh address per receive. On BSC, reuse is common. Hunters still watch busy addresses and sometimes send **dust** — tiny token amounts — to bait you into a draining site.

You do not have to rotate addresses every invoice. You do have to ignore mystery tokens and not click “claim.”

A hunter’s address can also land in your **address book** after one paste. The next lesson on poisoned books goes deeper. Today: after every paste, check ends. Do not trust last-used.

ACADEMY NOTE Never reuse a receive address someone else generated “for you” in a DM. Generate from your app. Academy staff will not send you a special QR to “activate receiving,” and will not ask for remote desktop to “fix a memo.”

Reuse versus rotation, as a shop habit

You may reuse one BSC address for a stall. Hunters can watch it. That does not force a new seed every morning. It does force: ignore dust, ignore claim links, check ends every send, and do not put the seed on the stall tablet. A busy public address is a visible door. Keep the combination off the street.

What this lesson is for

You can receive like an adult: your screen, the right network, a test, an explorer row, a memo when a CEX actually requires one. Next: adding a token is not buying it — Crystal Stones’ contract as a verify-only drill.

Say this out loud

- Receive from your app’s network-correct screen. Do not let a DM generate your door.
- Test, explorer, then remainder. Check ends after every paste.
- Random QRs are not addresses until proven. Scan with the wallet, then still read the digits.
- Some exchange deposits need a memo or tag. Personal BSC wallets usually do not. Do not invent one. Do not skip one when the deposit page requires it.
- Mystery dust is bait. Receiving it is not a request to tap Claim.

Next: adding Crystal Stones as a token view — contract verification, not a purchase.

Lesson 4: Adding a token is not buying it (26 min)

Adding a token is not buying it

Wallets show native coins automatically. They do **not** magically know every BEP-20 token. You **add** a token by pointing at its **contract**. That only **displays** a balance. It does not purchase anything.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to add Crystal Stones as a view on BNB Smart Chain using the published contract, and you should treat a mystery airdrop as bait rather than a gift.

This academy shows the official contract so you can recognise fakes. It is not an order to buy, hold, or add liquidity. You can finish this course with an empty wallet. Empty and competent beats funded and confused.

How to add without a trap

147. Get the contract from a source you already trust **and** from a second source (project site + explorer search — not a Telegram screenshot alone).

148. For Crystal Stones, the published BEP-20 contract is
0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00.
149. In the wallet, on **BNB Smart Chain** (chain id 56), choose Add token / custom token and paste.
150. Confirm the **name/symbol** the contract reports. Clones often mimic the name.
151. If a stranger sends you a “token” you never added, **do not tap it to “claim.”** That is a common scam path (a dust airdrop that opens a draining site).

Adding a token does not move coins. It does not require Approve. If the add-token sheet suddenly asks you to sign Approve, you are no longer adding a view. You are in Module 4’s danger zone. Reject.

If after adding you still see 0, you may simply hold 0. That is allowed. It may also mean you are on the wrong network, or you pasted a clone. Check BscScan for **your address** plus **that contract**. The book wins.

Healthy	Unhealthy	What the unhealthy one is selling
Add contract you verified on BscScan	Add whatever a pop-up said you received	A draining site behind a familiar name
View zero balance after adding	Panic-buy because the logo appeared	A buy order dressed as a tutorial
Ignore unknown airdrops	Connect wallet to “activate” a mystery token	Your Approve signature
Paste 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00 on BSC	Paste a lookalike contract from a sponsored Google result	A clone

Worked scenario. A wallet shows “Crystal Stones” after a random airdrop. The contract is **not** 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00.

152. It is a clone. Tapping it opens a site that asks you to approve unlimited spending.
153. You approve. The clone did not make you rich. It rented your signature.
154. Later, real tokens you actually held can leave. BscScan will show you authorised a spender.
155. The adult path: hide or ignore the mystery token. Do not swap it. Do not “claim.” If you want the real Crystal Stones **view**, add the published contract yourself, on BSC, as a display.
156. Still not a buy order. Viewing zero is a successful lab.

DIAGRAM

```
Verified contract --> add to wallet on BSC --> view only
Unknown airdrop   --> ignore                --> do not approve
```

```
Name match is not contract match.
Logo match is not contract match.
Telegram screenshot is not a second source.
```

What BscScan shows when you did it right

Open the published contract on BscScan. You should see a token page, holders, and transfers. Your address, if you hold any, appears in that list. If you hold none, you will not appear. That is not a bug.

Read the contract address character by character against what you pasted — at least first 6 and last 6, preferably more. Lookalike contracts change the middle. Hunters count on fatigue.

This academy will not invent yield, listing dates, or mineral-vault proof. Crystal Stones' RWA story is **their claim to verify**. Adding the contract does not verify a mine. It verifies which program your wallet is counting.

ACADEMY NOTE This academy shows the official contract so you can recognise fakes. It is not an order to buy, hold, or add liquidity. Paid-track checkout, when you meet it, is USDT on BNB Smart Chain (BEP-20) through academy checkout — not Crystal Stones token, and not this contract as a tuition address.

Decimals, symbols, and other costume jewellery

A clone can copy the name, the logo, and even the **decimals** (how many fraction digits the token uses). None of that is the contract. The contract is the 0x. If BscScan's token page for your pasted address is not 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00, you added a different program.

Some wallets search by name. Searching "Crystal Stones" can return a list of lookalikes. Do not pick the first logo. Paste the string. If the search result's contract differs in the middle, it is not a checksum variant. It is a different door.

A zero view after a correct add means you hold zero. That is a complete lab. It is not a prompt to visit a DEX. It is not a prompt to message an admin for an airdrop.

What this lesson is for

You can add a token as a view and you can refuse a clone. Next: QR codes, lookalike characters, and poisoned address books — the last receiving traps before we send.

Say this out loud

- Adding a token means viewing a contract's balances. It is not a purchase and not an approval.
- Verify the contract twice. For Crystal Stones, match 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00 on BNB Smart Chain.
- Mystery airdrops are bait. Name match is not contract match.
- A zero after adding can be honest. Check the book before you chase a claim site.
- Never send BNB to a contract "to activate" a token. That story is theft.

Next: QR codes, lookalike characters, and poisoned address books.

Lesson 5: QR codes, lookalike characters, and poisoned address books (27 min)

QR codes, lookalike characters, and poisoned address books

Hunters do not always need your seed. Sometimes they only need you to send to a door that **looks like** a door you already trust.

By the end of this lesson you should treat address books, recent-send lists, and QR stickers as reports that can be poisoned, and you should check first 6 and last 6 even when the name in the book says "Ada."

Poisoned address books

You send to a client once. The wallet saves the address under a name. Later, malware or a clipboard swap inserts a **lookalike** into the book, or you yourself paste a hunter's address once and the book keeps it as "Ada."

Lookalike characters in hex are limited, but hunters still pick addresses that share the same first 4–6 and last 4–6 as a busy victim or a famous wallet. Your eyes love the ends. They skip the middle. Check more than a glance. For a large send, compare the full string to a source you already trust — a previous BscScan receive, not a Telegram "updated wallet."

Some scams **poison** public labels: they send a tiny amount from an address they control to your address, hoping your wallet's "recent" list will make their address look familiar. Familiar is not verified. Recent is not a checksum.

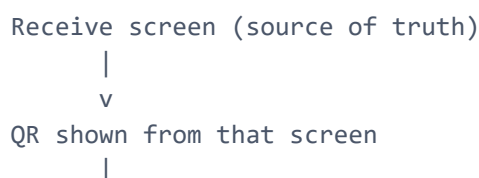
What you trusted	How it lies	Adult check
Address book name "Ada"	The name is local; the 0x can change	First 6 and last 6 against Ada's last known good, or a tiny test
QR sticker on a counter	Sticker can be swapped overnight	Match the shop's receive screen or watch-only tablet
Recent send list	A dust sender wants to look like a friend	Do not send back to mystery dust
Looks like first and last 6	Hunters grind for vanity ends	Read more of the middle, or compare full string
A PDF invoice QR	Designer or a forwarder can swap it	Generate from your own receive screen if you are the payee; if you are the payer, confirm with the payee out of band

Worked scenario. A shop, Mallam Yusuf's stall in Suleja, prints a QR for BEP-20 USDT. A visitor swaps the paper QR when the stall is busy.

157. Customers pay. BscScan shows success. Yusuf's wallet does not move.
158. He was paid to the hunter's door. The chain is not confused. The sticker was.
159. The fix is operational: the QR lives on a screen he controls, or he checks the stall QR against his receive screen every morning — first 6 and last 6.
160. He does not then type his seed into a "QR recovery" app a customer recommends.
161. If a day's takings matter, a watch-only tablet showing incoming BscScan rows is more honest than a paper square that can walk.

DIAGRAM

Good payee flow




```
      v
Payer scans --> reads ends on confirm sheet --> tiny test if it hurts
      |
      v
Explorer row on payee's address
```

Poisoned flow

```
Old QR / saved "Ada" / dust "recent"
      |
      v
Payer trusts the label
      |
      v
Book credits a hunter
```

Homoglyphs, handwriting, and “I’ll type it”

You will not usually type a 0x by hand. If you do, you will lose. If someone sends an address as an image, retype nothing — ask for a copy-paste and still check ends, or better, confirm a tiny test.

On EVM, mixed-case checksums exist to catch typos. A QR can still encode a perfectly checksummed wrong door. Checksum is not “this is my friend.” Checksum is “this string is internally consistent.”

If you maintain an address book, treat edits as a security event. A cousin with your unlocked phone can change Ada to a hunter. A shared family phone is a shared address book. Module 5 talks about household sharing without sharing a seed. Today: do not let the book be the only copy of a destination.

ACADEMY NOTE Confirm destinations the way you confirm a bank account: out of band, on a channel you already trust, plus a tiny test when the amount would hurt. Academy staff will not send you a “new official address” in a DM. We will not ask you to update your address book from a WhatsApp broadcast.

Out-of-band means a second channel you already trust

If Ada’s address arrives in Telegram, confirm a first-6 last-6 on a phone call you know is Ada, or on a channel you have used for a year. Do not confirm on a second Telegram account that popped up. Hunters occupy both seats.

For a shop, the second channel can be the receive screen behind the counter, not a second sticker. For an exchange withdrawal, the second channel is the exchange’s own deposit page, not a DM that “updated the wallet.”

Write one trusted destination on paper if you send to it often — Ada’s full 0x in your own handwriting, stored with household papers, not with the seed. Then the address book is a convenience you still check, not the only copy.

What this lesson is for

You now treat labels, stickers, and recents as untrusted until checked. Take the quiz. Then we send: gas, approvals, and the loaded gun called Approve.

Say this out loud

- An address-book name is a sticker you wrote. It can be wrong. Check the 0x.
- Hunters grind for lookalike ends. Read more than first 4 and last 4 when it matters.
- A QR is data. Stickers get swapped. Scan, then read the confirm sheet.
- Dust in “recent” is not a friend. Do not send back to it.
- Checksum means internally consistent, not “this is Ada.”

Take the quiz. Then we send — gas, failed transactions, and the Approve button.

Module quiz (answers included for editors)

Q1. Chinedu dictates his 0x address on a noisy call and two characters get swapped. The send shows success on BscScan. What is true?

- A. Success means the chain will bounce it back to him after 24 hours
- B. The public door was wrong; a successful send to the wrong door is still the wrong door
- C. Checksum always blocks swapped characters, so this cannot happen
- D. Academy staff can reset the address like a bank account

Correct answer: B

Q2. Ada sends USDT on Tron (TRC-20) to a checkout that asked for USDT on BNB Smart Chain (BEP-20). What did she send?

- A. The same coins in the same book, because USDT is USDT on every chain
- B. The same nickname on a different network — the BSC book may never credit the receiver
- C. Bitcoin, automatically wrapped
- D. A guaranteed academy refund

Correct answer: B

Q3. To move a BEP-20 token on BSC you typically need?

- A. Only the token, never BNB
- B. A little BNB in the same wallet for gas
- C. A Crystal Stones employee PIN
- D. To post your seed in the receiving chat

Correct answer: B

Q4. Clipboard malware swapped an address after copy. What habit beats it?

- A. Sending faster so the malware cannot catch up
- B. Checking the first and last 6 characters on the confirm screen after paste
- C. Using all caps in the chat
- D. Asking Telegram which address is real

Correct answer: B

Q5. An exchange deposit page shows one 0x plus a memo/tag field. What is the memo for?

- A. A seed backup the exchange stores for you
- B. Crediting the right customer on a shared deposit address — skip it only if that page says none is needed
- C. Paying extra gas to validators in naira
- D. Proving you own Crystal Stones

Correct answer: B

Q6. Crystal Stones' published contract address is for?

- A. The academy tuition wallet — send BNB there to enrol
- B. Verifying or adding the official BEP-20 token — not a deposit address and not a buy order
- C. Google login
- D. Academy checkout automatically, on any network

Correct answer: B

Q7. A wallet shows an unexpected "Crystal Stones" airdrop whose contract is not 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00. What should you do?

- A. Tap and approve immediately so you do not miss the listing
- B. Ignore it; do not "activate" via a random site; add the published contract only if you want a verified view
- C. Forward the token plus your seed to support
- D. Sell it in the same minute on any DEX pop-up

Correct answer: B

Q8. Mallam Yusuf's stall QR was swapped. Customers' BscScan rows show success, his wallet does not move. What failed?

- A. BNB Smart Chain reversed the payments because the sticker was unofficial
- B. Payers trusted a sticker instead of confirming the shop's receive-screen digits — the book credited a hunter
- C. He needed a memo on a personal wallet
- D. He should have photographed his seed as a backup QR

Correct answer: B

Module 4: Sending, gas, and approvals

A send is a signed instruction. Gas is paid in BNB. Approve is a loaded gun.

Lesson 1: A send, step by step on BSC (27 min)

A send, step by step on BSC

You will do this slowly, even when you are “sure.” A send is not a chat message. It is a signed instruction the book will keep.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to walk a native BNB send and a BEP-20 token send on BNB Smart Chain without mixing the dropdown, the asset, or the gas reserve.

Native BNB send

162. Network = BNB Smart Chain. Chain id 56 if the app shows it. Not Ethereum. Not a testnet. Not “BNB Smart Chain (test).”
163. Paste address. Check first 6 and last 6 against the source you trust — the recipient’s receive screen, not a week-old chat.
164. Amount. Leave a little BNB for **this** fee and **future** fees if you still need to move tokens later.
165. Confirm. Wallet shows estimated gas in BNB. Read the destination on the sheet again.
166. Wait. Open BscScan. See success. Copy the **tx hash** — the long identifier of this instruction.
167. Only then tell the human on the other side “it is paid,” and give them the tx hash. Chat is not a receipt.

If the amount would annoy you to lose, insert a tiny test between steps 2 and 3. Test, explorer, remainder. You already know this ritual. Sending is where people skip it because they are “just paying a friend.” Friends still cannot reverse a wrong door.

Token send (BEP-20)

Same as above, plus: you are calling the **token contract** to update balances. You still pay gas in **BNB**.

If gas is missing, the wallet will fail. If you are looking at Ethereum in the network dropdown, you may send a different asset or fail. Look at the dropdown every time. Crystal Stones, if you hold any, moves as a BEP-20 token on this book. This is not a buy order. It is a description of a send you might one day do with a practice amount.

USDT on BSC is also BEP-20. USDT on another chain is not this send. Say the full sentence before you tap.

Field	What you verify	Failure if you skip
Network	BNB Smart Chain for this academy’s token path	Right letters, wrong book
Asset	BNB vs USDT vs Crystal Stones — pick on purpose	You paid in the thing you meant to keep
To	First/last 6 match the intended door	A hunter or a void
Amount	Test first if it hurts to be wrong	A beautiful mistake
Gas	BNB left over after the send	Tokens stranded
Tx hash	You can paste it into BscScan	A screenshot argument

Worked scenario. Ada sends “all” BNB including what would have paid the next token transfer.

168. The BNB send succeeds. BscScan is green.
169. Crystal Stones (or USDT BEP-20) still sits on the address and cannot move until more BNB arrives.
170. A stranger in a group chat offers to “unlock gas” if she pays a fee to their 0x. That is theft.
171. She obtains a little BNB from a venue she chose — an exchange she already uses, or a friend she can actually find — then moves the tokens.
172. She keeps a **gas reserve** after that. There is no honour in a zero-BNB wallet full of tokens. “Max” buttons are how people strand themselves.

DIAGRAM

```
Pick network (BSC, chain id 56)
--> pick asset (BNB or a BEP-20 token)
--> paste + check ends
--> tiny test (if needed)
--> explorer
--> remainder
--> keep BNB for next gas
```

Never: tell the recipient “paid” from a pending spinner.
Never: Max BNB if tokens still need a courier.

What you are actually signing

The wallet builds a transaction: to, value, data, gas parameters. You sign with the key. The RPC broadcasts. Validators include it in a block. BscScan reports the book. Your chat does not.

If you sign on the wrong network, you signed a different book’s instruction. If you sign to the wrong to, you signed a gift. If you sign an Approve thinking it is a send, you signed a loaded gun — two lessons from now.

Read the sheet. The sheet is the last honest place. A website can draw a smiley. The sheet shows the 0x.

ACADEMY NOTE Never send your entire BNB balance if you still need to move tokens later. Leave a reserve. “Max” buttons are how people strand themselves. Nobody honest will ask you to Max-send BNB to “activate” Crystal Stones, and this academy will not ask you to send us a test as a graduation fee.

Talking to the recipient like an adult

Do not say “I sent it” from a spinner. Say “here is the tx hash, check BscScan on BSC.” If they cannot use an explorer, walk them to the row, or wait until your own bookmark shows success to their door. If they insist on a screenshot of your wallet, that screenshot is still a report. Offer the hash.

If they gave you an address in a group chat and then a “corrected” address in a DM, stop. Confirm out of band. Poisoned corrections are a job. The send ritual includes knowing whose mouth the 0x came from.

The Max button, again, because it will still be there

Max on a token send is less dangerous than Max on BNB, but it still deserves a look: are you emptying a token you needed to split, are you paying a hunter, are you on the right book? Max is not evil. Unread Max is. Leave BNB. Read the sheet. Then Max is just a number.

What this lesson is for

You have a send ritual. Next: what gas actually pays for — gwei, why a failed transaction still costs, and why cheap-fee panic is how people get stuck.

Say this out loud

- Dropdown first. Asset second. Ends third. Then amount. Then gas reserve. Then explorer. Then you may say “paid.”
- Token sends still spend BNB. A max BNB send can strand tokens.
- Tx hash is the receipt. Chat is not. A spinner is not.
- Practice amounts you can lose. A send is hard to reverse.
- The confirm sheet is the last honest place. Read the 0x.

Next: what gas actually pays for — gwei, failed tx still costs.

Lesson 2: What gas actually pays for (27 min)

What gas actually pays for

Gas is the fee the network charges to run your instruction. On BNB Smart Chain you pay it in **BNB**, the native coin. Tokens do not pay the courier. A pretty Crystal Stones balance does not move itself.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to say why a failed transaction can still cost BNB, what **gwei** is doing on the sheet, and why “gas is high” is not a reason to type a seed into a discount site.

The courier is a computer, not a bank clerk

A public chain has no branch manager who includes your payment out of kindness. People running software — **validators** on BSC’s current design — include transactions. Gas is how you pay for that inclusion and for the work of running the instruction.

Gas limit is the maximum work you allow the transaction to do. **Gas price** (often shown in **gwei**) is how much you pay per unit of that work. **Gwei** is a tiny unit of the native coin. You do not need to convert it in your head. You need to read the wallet’s estimate in BNB, and you need to keep extra BNB so the estimate is not your entire balance.

Simple BNB sends are cheap most days. Token transfers cost a bit more work. Approves cost work. Complicated contract calls cost more. You will not learn to hand-tune gas in Basic. You will learn not to panic-press settings you do not understand.

You see	What it means	What to do
Estimated fee 0.0003 BNB	The app’s guess for this instruction	Keep more BNB than the guess
Failed, but BNB went down	The network ran the attempt; it still spent work	Read the error on BscScan; do not retry blindly into the same wall
Pending for a long time	May be underpriced, congested, or RPC lag	Wait; check explorer; do not double-send a second full amount
A site says “pay 0.5 BNB to unlock gas”	Theft	Get BNB from a venue you chose
Gas 0 because “we sponsor fees”	Maybe a genuine feature, often a	You still must not Approve a

	lure	stranger
--	------	----------

Worked scenario. Emeka tries to send USDT BEP-20 with almost no BNB.

173. The wallet estimates a fee he cannot cover. The send never starts — or it starts and fails.
174. He retries five times, each fail nibbling BNB he did not know he still had, or each pending stacking in the app.
175. A pop-up says his wallet is “frozen pending gas” and offers a wallet-connect unlock. That is a drainer.
176. The adult path: he stops clicking. He checks BscScan. He acquires a little BNB from an exchange he already uses. He sends once.
177. He leaves a reserve so the next token send is boring.

DIAGRAM

```

Your signed tx
  |
  v
RPC broadcasts
  |
  v
Validators include it if gas is enough
  |
  +--> success: state changes, you paid gas
  +--> fail: state may not change the token, you often still paid gas
  +--> pending: not in a block yet – wait, do not double-pay

```

Failed tx still costs — say it until it sticks

On EVM chains including BSC, a transaction that **runs out of gas** or **reverts** (the contract says no) can still charge you for the work done. The book did not credit your friend. The courier still worked. That feels unfair if you grew up with “failed transfer, no fee.” It is how this machine is built.

Read the explorer status: success, fail, pending. A red fail is not “nothing happened to my BNB.” Check the fee line. Then fix the actual cause — wrong token, missing BNB, contract error — before you retry.

Do not raise gas to “priority” because a stranger said you are stuck, then also send a second copy of the full amount. That is how people pay twice. The next lesson but one is about stuck transactions. Today: gas is BNB, failed can cost, strangers do not unlock it.

ACADEMY NOTE Nobody honest needs your seed to “top up gas.” Nobody honest needs remote desktop to “set gwei.” If fees confuse you, wait, read BscScan, and move a practice amount. This academy will not sell you a gas-saver dApp.

Why BNB must sit in the same address

Gas is paid by the **sending address**. A second wallet full of BNB does not pay for the first. Tokens on address A plus BNB on address B means A is still stuck. Move a little BNB to A, then move the tokens. Do not send the tokens to a stranger who “will add gas.”

This is also why a brand-new receive of only Crystal Stones, with 0 BNB, cannot leave. If someone airdrops you tokens and you have no BNB, you are not late to a listing. You are looking at bait you cannot even move without first fetching a courier from a venue you chose.

Estimates lie a little, thieves lie a lot

An estimate of 0.0004 BNB that becomes 0.0005 is normal. An estimate of 0.0004 that a website rewrites into “send 0.4 BNB to this unlocker” is not an estimate. It is an invoice from a stranger. Gas is paid **inside** your transaction to the network, not as a separate pre-payment to a helper address.

If the wallet estimate is far above what BscScan shows for recent similar sends, you may be on the wrong network or a fake RPC. Stop. Bookmark. Recheck chain id 56.

What this lesson is for

You know what the courier charges and that failure is not always free. Next: Approve — the permission that is not a send and still empties wallets.

Say this out loud

- Gas on BNB Smart Chain is paid in BNB. Tokens do not pay the courier.
- Gwei is a small unit of price per work. Read the estimate in BNB. Keep a reserve.
- A failed transaction can still cost. Check the explorer fee line before you retry.
- “Pay gas to this address to unlock” is theft. Get BNB from a venue you chose.
- Do not double-send because a spinner is slow. Pending is not a dare.

Next: what Approve actually grants — the quiet way wallets get emptied.

Lesson 3: What Approve actually grants (27 min)

What Approve actually grants

On Ethereum-style chains (including BSC), many sites do not take your tokens immediately. They ask the wallet to **approve** a spender.

Approve means: you sign a permission for a **contract** to pull up to N tokens later, without asking you each time.

This is how swaps work. It is also how drainers work. By the end of this lesson you should read an Approve sheet as a loaded gun, not as a “continue” button.

Permission, not payment, not a connection tick

Connecting a site usually shows your address to that site. Annoying, sometimes enough for targeted dust, not the same as spending. **Signing** a message can prove you hold a key. Sometimes harmless, sometimes a login, sometimes a trick. **Sending** moves coins now. **Approve** lets a program move tokens later.

If you do not know why a site needs an approval, **reject**. Prefer the amount you actually intend to swap, when the UI allows. Mystery “claim,” “airdrop,” “drainer reverse,” “support unlock” approvals are theft.

The spender is a contract address. It is not the friendly logo. If the sheet says unlimited, that is the next lesson. If the sheet says a token you did not mean to touch, reject. If the sheet appeared after you tapped a mystery Crystal Stones clone, reject.

Prompt	Translation	Beginner move
Approve 50 USDT for a swap you started on a site you chose	Often legitimate if you chose the site	Read token, amount, spender; still not a command from this academy
Approve unlimited Crystal Stones for a site you just met	A loaded gun	Walk away
“Sign to verify wallet” that is actually Approve	A costume	Walk away
Permit / Increase Allowance	Same family as Approve — read it	Same rules
Set token allowance	Approve in other words	Same rules

Worked scenario. A Google ad says “Crystal Stones airdrop.” You connect.

178. It asks to Approve unlimited tokens. You sign because the logo looks right.
179. Nothing appears in your balance, or a fake balance appears.
180. Later the tokens leave. The chain shows you authorised a spender. Support cannot reverse an authorisation you signed.
181. The published Crystal Stones contract 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00 was not a reason to Approve a stranger. Adding a token is viewing. Approving is permission to pull.
182. You rotate only if the seed itself leaked. If only an Approve leaked, the intermediate skill is **revoke** — later tracks. Until then: do not grant them to strangers. You cannot “un-sign” with a feeling.

DIAGRAM

```

Connect (they see your address — usually not a spend)
|
v
Sign message (proof of key — read it; still not always a spend)
|
v
Approve (they may take tokens later — danger)
|
v
Swap / transfer (the actual move, plus gas in BNB)

```

Why this exists at all

Decentralized exchanges cannot take tokens from you without a permission, unless you send to them. The Approve design lets a contract pull the input of a swap. That is a real use. Drainers copy the same popup. The popup is not a halo. The site you typed from a bookmark is the context. A sponsored ad is not a bookmark.

This academy will not walk you through a swap as homework. Swaps are how people skip the rest of Basic and meet drainers early. If you already know you need a swap, you still read the sheet: which token, how much, which spender, is it unlimited.

ACADEMY NOTE Revoking approvals is an intermediate skill (a later track). Until then: do not grant them to strangers. You cannot “un-sign” with a feeling. Academy staff will never ask you to Approve a “verification spender,” and will never send a dApp link in a DM.

How to read the sheet without becoming an engineer

The wallet sheet usually shows a token icon, a number, and a spender. The number may look like a send amount. It is often an **allowance** — a ceiling, not a purchase. If you hold 20 USDT and approve 20, the spender may pull 20 later, maybe not now. If you hold 20 and approve unlimited, the spender may pull 20 now and whatever arrives tomorrow.

If the token on the sheet is not the token you meant, reject. Drainers ask for a valuable token while the website talks about a worthless airdrop. If the spender address is not a venue you can name, reject. You do not need to decode the contract. You need to refuse unknown spenders.

A hardware device will still show Approve. Read that screen too. The box does not translate “unlimited” into “safe.” It translates your confirmation into a signature.

Practice amounts still need this lesson

People think a 2 USDT wallet cannot teach Approve. It can. Drainers take what is there and wait if they have unlimited. A practice wallet that you later reuse as a funded wallet carries old allowances. That is why this academy prefers: do not Approve strangers even with dust, and treat a practice wallet you Approved on as dirtier than it looks.

If you already Approved a mystery site, stop using that wallet for new deposits until you learn revoke on a later track — or rotate if you also leaked a seed. Name which object was compromised: allowance versus combination. They are different playbooks.

What this lesson is for

You can name Approve as permission to pull later. Next: why unlimited approvals exist, and why convenience is not an argument for a site you met today.

Say this out loud

- Approve means permission for a contract to pull tokens later. It is not a simple send and not a connection tick.

- Unlimited plus unknown site means no. Claim sites that need approvals are usually drainers.
- Adding Crystal Stones by contract is viewing. Approving a clone is how real tokens leave.
- Connect is not approve. Approve is not send. Read the wallet sheet.
- You cannot reverse an authorisation with a support ticket. The book shows you signed.

Next: unlimited approvals and why they exist.

Lesson 4: Unlimited approvals and why they exist (26 min)

Unlimited approvals and why they exist

An **unlimited approval** is an allowance so large it might as well be “all you ever hold of this token, including what you receive tomorrow.”

Sites ask for it so you do not have to sign a new Approve every time you swap. That is convenience. If that contract is malicious, or later hacked, or later sold, it can pull until you are empty without a new popup.

By the end of this lesson you should treat unlimited as a deliberate trust decision, not as a default tick, and you should know that “everyone signs unlimited” is not a safety argument.

Convenience versus blast radius

A capped approve — 50 USDT for a 50 USDT swap — means the spender can take at most that much unless you approve again. Slightly more clicks. Much smaller blast radius if the site is wrong.

An unlimited approve means you are saying: I trust this program with this token for the life of this permission, including future deposits. That can be reasonable for a venue you have researched like an adult. It is not reasonable for an airdrop, a Google ad, a “Crystal Stones staking” page you met in WhatsApp, or a site that opened itself.

Phishing pages copy the same “unlimited” checkbox because it pays. One signature, many later withdrawals. Bots watch allowances. Speed is their product.

Situation	Unlimited?	Why
A swap you started, UI lets you set 50 USDT	Prefer 50	Matches the job
A DEX you already use, you understand the trade	Maybe, as a later choice	Still a trust decision, not a law
A site you met today with a logo you like	No	Logos are cheap
“Approve to revoke a hack”	No	Drainers love this costume
“Approve to receive airdrop”	No	Receiving does not need your allowance
Hardware wallet in the mix	Still no to strangers	Hardware does not fix a bad Approve

Worked scenario. Ife uses a swap site she chose. The sheet asks for unlimited USDT.

183. She looks for an amount field. Some UIs hide it behind “custom.” She sets the swap amount, not unlimited.
184. If the UI refuses to work without unlimited, she decides whether this venue is worth that trust. “It refused” is information, not a command.
185. A second tab pops up from an ad, also asking unlimited Crystal Stones. She closes it. She did not start that job.
186. Weeks later the first site is fine and the ad site would have emptied her. BscScan would have shown her signature on the allowance, not a mysterious hacker.
187. She still keeps a gas reserve in BNB, because none of this is free to unwind later.

DIAGRAM

Capped approve

```
50 USDT allowance --> spender can pull <= 50  
later deposit of 200 USDT --> spender still capped at remaining allowance
```

Unlimited approve

```
2^256 style number --> spender can pull until you are empty  
later deposit --> still pullable without a new sheet
```

Why wallets default to easy

Apps compete on fewer clicks. Fewer clicks include dangerous defaults. You are the adult in the loop. This academy will nag you about the sheet more than about yield, because yield is not our subject and the sheet is how beginners get wrecked.

Revoke tools exist. They are a later skill, they cost gas, and fake revoke sites are drainers wearing a mop. Until you can name a revoke tool from a source you already trust, the control you have is **not granting**.

ACADEMY NOTE “Everyone signs unlimited” is how whole group chats get emptied in one afternoon. This academy will not tell you that unlimited is always evil. It will tell you it is a loaded gun, and that a site you did not choose does not get to hold it.

The huge number is not a compliment

You will see a figure with dozens of zeros. That is not “the site is rich.” That is the ceiling they want. Some UIs write “Max” or “Infinite.” Same gun. Some write a token’s whole supply. Same gun. Read past the logo.

If you are practising, you do not need a DEX this week. You can finish Basic without a swap. The people who “just try a swap” on a sponsored site are how unlimited gets its reputation. Curiosity is not a venue.

When a later course shows a swap, you will still bring this sentence: **how much, of which token, to which spender, for how long**. Unlimited is “how long = until I revoke or I am empty.” Capped is “how long = until this amount is used.”

A token you added as a view — Crystal Stones on the published contract — can still be the asset an unlimited Approve targets. Viewing did not invite that. Do not Approve Crystal Stones to a site you met in a blast, even if the blast used our name.

Tomorrow's deposit is in the blast radius

Unlimited is not only about what you hold tonight. If you get paid next month into the same address, the old spender may still be allowed to pull. That is the convenience: you do not re-Approve. That is the danger: you forget who you trusted in March. Capped amounts forget for you.

If you use one hot wallet for experiments, keep the pile you would miss on a different seed. Experiments collect allowances. Allowances collect endings.

What this lesson is for

You now know why the huge number exists and why you should not feed it to strangers. Next: failed, pending, and stuck transactions — the spinner that makes people double-pay.

Say this out loud

- Unlimited means this spender can pull this token until you revoke or you are empty, including future deposits.
- Convenience is why it exists. Drainers are why it is famous.
- Prefer a capped amount when the UI allows. If it does not allow, that is a trust decision, not an order.
- Hardware does not make unlimited safe. You still signed the gun.
- Fake revoke sites are drainers. Not granting is the Basic control.

Next: failed, pending, and stuck transactions.

Lesson 5: Failed, pending, and stuck transactions (26 min)

Failed, pending, and stuck transactions

A spinner is not a verdict. BscScan is.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to tell **pending**, **failed**, and **success** apart, and you should know the two beginner sins: paying twice, and handing a stranger remote desktop “to unstick it.”

Three statuses, three jobs

Pending means the network has not put the instruction in a block yet — or your RPC has not seen that block. Wait. Check the explorer with the tx hash. Do not assume it is lost after forty seconds. Do not assume it succeeded because the app played a happy sound.

Failed (reverted, out of gas, status 0 on the explorer) means the instruction was included but did not do the thing you wanted. You may still have paid gas. Fix the cause. Do not immediately resend the full amount to a slightly different address a helper invented.

Success means the book changed as that instruction specified. Confirm it is the instruction you meant: asset, to, amount. Then you may tell the human.

Stuck is a pending that sits. Causes include: gas too low for the moment, RPC lag, a nonce gap (a previous pending from the same address is blocking later ones), or you are watching the wrong network. You do not

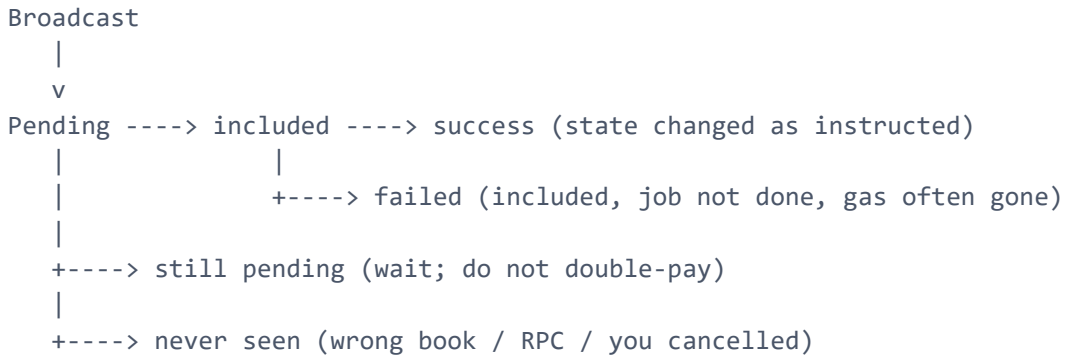
need to master **nonce** — it is a sequence number so your address’s transactions stay in order — but you need to know that a second send while one is pending can queue or collide in ways that scare you.

Status on BscScan	What you do	What you do not do
Pending	Wait, refresh explorer, keep the tx hash	Send the full amount again because WhatsApp is impatient
Success	Tell the recipient, with hash	Also send a “just in case” copy
Failed	Read the error, fix cause, then one retry	Approve a “stuck transaction fixer” dApp
Not found	Wrong explorer, wrong network, or never broadcast	Paste the seed into a broadcast helper

Worked scenario. Amaka sends USDT BEP-20. The app says pending. The recipient says they have not been paid.

188. She copies the tx hash. She opens BscScan from a bookmark, on BSC, not a DM link.
189. If pending, she waits. She does not send a second 100 USDT. She may message the hash so the recipient can watch the same row.
190. If the explorer cannot find the hash, she checks the network and the RPC. She still does not type her seed into a “push transaction” site.
191. If it failed, she checks whether she has BNB, whether the token is the right contract, whether the to address is right. Then one corrected send.
192. A helper offers AnyDesk to “speed up gas.” She refuses. Remote desktop plus a wallet is how the helper sends for her.

DIAGRAM



Stranger with remote desktop sits outside this diagram, holding your pen.

Speed-up and cancel are advanced

Some wallets offer **speed up** (same job, higher fee) or **cancel** (a dummy transaction with the same nonce). Those are useful and easy to botch. In Basic, prefer waiting on a practice amount. If you must act, stay inside the official wallet’s own speed-up, and still watch the explorer. Do not import the seed into a second “stuck tx” app.

A replacement transaction is not a time machine for a success. If the first one landed, speeding up does not unsay it.

ACADEMY NOTE Remote desktop, AnyDesk, TeamViewer, “share screen so I can set gwei” — academy staff will never ask. A pending transaction is a wait, not an invitation. Practice amounts exist so that waiting is tolerable.

Nonce, without a maths class

Nonce is a counter: your address’s next transaction number. If tx 7 is pending, tx 8 may wait. If you then fire tx 8 with a full second payment, you may have two live jobs. If 7 lands and 8 also lands, you paid twice. If you replace 7 with a speed-up, you need the wallet to keep the numbers straight. That is why Basic says wait.

You do not set nonce by hand in this course. You do notice: several pendings from one address is a reason to stop tapping, not a reason to import the seed into a “nonce fixer.”

The recipient’s clock is not the network’s clock

WhatsApp impatience is not a status. A recipient who says “I have not received” may be on the wrong network, watching a watch-only of the wrong address, or looking at a delayed RPC. Send them the tx hash. If BscScan shows success to their door on the right book, you are paid. If it shows pending, you are both waiting. If it shows a different to, you have a different problem — and a second send will not unsay the first.

Practice amounts make waiting cheap. That is why they exist.

Two explorers, same hash

If a stranger’s explorer link and your bookmark disagree, your bookmark wins. If your wallet and your bookmark disagree, wait and refresh the bookmark. If two honest statuses remain pending, you wait. The only thing that turns pending into two successes is your second send. That is the one move this lesson exists to stop.

What this lesson is for

You can sit with a spinner without donating a second copy. Next: connect versus sign versus send, so the last sheet you see in a dApp is a named object.

Say this out loud

- Pending, failed, and success are explorer words. A spinner is not.
- Failed can still cost gas. Success is not “whatever I intended.” It is what the instruction said.
- Do not double-send a pending payment. Share the tx hash instead.
- Remote desktop to unstick a wallet is how the wallet leaves.
- Speed-up and cancel are advanced; wait on practice amounts.

Next: connect versus sign versus send — three different permissions on one screen.

Lesson 6: Connect versus sign versus send (27 min)

Connect versus sign versus send

Three different popups wear similar colours. Beginners mash them into “I clicked yes.” Drainers depend on that mash.

By the end of this lesson you should name which permission you are giving before your finger moves, and you should reject anything you cannot name.

Connect

Connect (WalletConnect or an injected-wallet connect) usually means: this site can see my address and may ask me for more signatures later. It is not a send. It is not an Approve. It is still a tracking door. Connect to sites you chose. Disconnect when you are done if the wallet makes that easy. Connecting to a random “Crystal Stones portal” gives the portal a target.

WalletConnect is a protocol for linking a phone wallet to a website. The honest version shows a pairing you started. The dishonest version is a QR from a DM. If you did not start the pairing, do not scan it.

Sign

Sign a message means: prove I hold the key that controls this address, or agree to some text. Some logins use it. Some scams use it to trick you into a **permit** — a gasless-style allowance. If the sign sheet looks like a novel, or mentions spending, or mentions unlimited, treat it as Approve’s cousin. If you cannot explain the message, reject.

Signing is not “free so it must be safe.” Free of BNB is not free of consequence.

Send (and Approve, which is a kind of send)

Send is a transaction that costs gas and, if successful, changes the book: BNB moved, tokens moved, or an allowance set. **Approve** is a send to a token contract that writes permission. Both show a fee in BNB. Both deserve the full read: network, asset, to, amount.

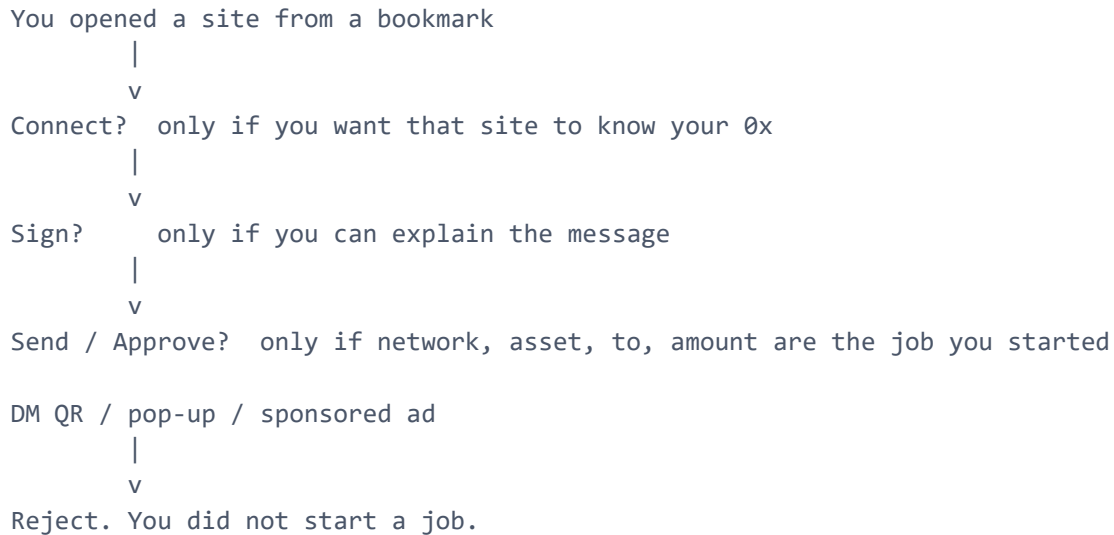
If a site says “sign to continue” and the wallet sheet shows a network fee, you are in send-land, not in a free login. Believe the sheet, not the website caption.

Sheet	Typical cost	What they get	Beginner test
Connect	Usually none	Your address, a chance to ask for more	Did I open this site on purpose?
Sign message	Usually none	Proof of key, sometimes a permit	Can I explain this sentence?
Send BNB / token	BNB gas	Coins moved now	First 6 last 6, asset, network
Approve / permit	BNB gas or a signature	Right to pull later	Do I want this spender to take this token?

Worked scenario. A “support agent” sends a WalletConnect QR so they can “raise your BNB Smart Chain limit.”

193. Amaka did not start a pairing. She does not scan it.
194. If she had scanned, the next sheet might be Connect (already too much), then Sign, then Approve unlimited.
195. She names each sheet out loud. If she cannot, she rejects.
196. Real academy support, real wallet brands, real exchanges do not raise limits by QR from a chat. They do not need her seed, her 2FA, or her desktop.
197. She reports the account and goes back to her bookmark.

DIAGRAM



Say the name out loud before you tap

This is the whole skill. “This is Connect.” “This is a message signature.” “This is Approve unlimited USDT.” “This is a BNB send to 0xabc...def.” If the sentence will not come, the tap should not happen.

Practice on a site you do not need, with an empty wallet, if you like — still not a dare to import a funded seed. Module 6’s lab stays on official apps and practice amounts. DApp tourism is not the lab.

ACADEMY NOTE Crystal Stones Academy will never ask you to Connect, Sign, or Approve to collect a certificate, to unlock a lesson, or to “sync progress.” Progress lives on our course account, not on your keys. A wallet sheet in our name is a costume.

Disconnect is a habit, not a cleansing ritual

Disconnecting a site does not revoke an Approve you already signed. It only stops that browser session from nagging you as easily. If you Approved, you still have an allowance until you revoke or the tokens leave. Name the object: session versus allowance versus seed.

After this lab, disconnect sites you do not use. It is hygiene. It is not a time machine. The checklist in Module 5 includes this on purpose.

A worked rejection script

When a sheet appears, say: “This is Connect to a site I opened / did not open.” If you did not open it, reject. If you did, continue. Next sheet: “This is a message. I can / cannot explain it.” If you cannot, reject. Next sheet: “This is Send of X on BSC to 0x...ends, or this is Approve of token Y unlimited to a spender I cannot name.” If that sentence includes unlimited and an unnamed spender, reject.

Practise the script on an empty wallet if you wish. Do not practise it by importing rent. The script is the skill. The tap is optional.

What this lesson is for

You can name the three permissions. Take the quiz. Then hardware, household, and inheritance — the signer as a tool, the backup as a family object.

Say this out loud

- Connect shows your address. Sign proves a key or may hide a permit. Send and Approve change the book or the allowance.
- Believe the wallet sheet, not the website caption. A fee means you are in send-land.
- WalletConnect QRs from DMs are not support. If you did not start the pairing, do not scan.
- Name the permission out loud. If you cannot name it, reject it.
- Academy certificates do not need a wallet signature.

Take the quiz. Then hardware, household, and inheritance — without worship and without folklore.

Module quiz (answers included for editors)

Q1. Ada hits Max on BNB, then tries to send a BEP-20 token. What is the likely result?

- A. Validators will gift her gas because the token is valuable
- B. She can spend the BNB she needed as gas, leaving tokens stranded until more BNB arrives
- C. The token pays the courier automatically
- D. BscScan will reverse the Max send

Correct answer: B

Q2. Emeka’s token send fails on BscScan, but his BNB went down. What should he believe?

- A. Failed means the network refunds all fees always
- B. A failed transaction can still cost gas for the work done; read the explorer before retrying
- C. Someone stole his seed through the gas line
- D. He must Approve unlimited to reclaim the fee

Correct answer: B

Q3. A Google ad asks Ife to Approve unlimited Crystal Stones to “claim” a balance. What did Approve grant if she signs?

- A. A free listing on every exchange

- B. Permission for that spender contract to pull tokens later — treat as a drainer unless she truly trusts it
- C. A backup of her seed on-chain
- D. A gas sponsorship from the academy

Correct answer: B

Q4. Why do swap sites ask for unlimited allowances?

- A. BNB Smart Chain law requires unlimited
- B. Convenience so you do not sign a new Approve every swap — the blast radius is that the spender may pull later deposits too
- C. Unlimited is the only way a BEP-20 transfer can work
- D. It stores your seed in the token contract

Correct answer: B

Q5. Amaka's send is pending. The recipient is impatient. What should she do first?

- A. Immediately send the same amount again
- B. Paste the tx hash into BscScan and wait; do not double-pay a pending instruction
- C. Give a helper AnyDesk so they can set gwei
- D. Approve a stuck-transaction dApp from a sponsored result

Correct answer: B

Q6. A website caption says "Sign to continue" but the wallet sheet shows a BNB fee and an Approve. What should you believe?

- A. The caption, because websites cannot lie
- B. The wallet sheet — a fee and an Approve mean send-land, not a free login
- C. Neither; type the seed into a checker
- D. The academy progress bar, which needs this signature

Correct answer: B

Q7. A Telegram "support" account sends a WalletConnect QR to raise her BSC limit. What is Connect in that moment?

- A. A required academy step
- B. A pairing she did not start — reject; Connect is not harmless when a stranger opens the door
- C. The same as a BNB send, so at least she can see the amount
- D. A way to revoke unlimited approvals for free

Correct answer: B

Q8. Connect, Approve, and Send are?

- A. The same signature wearing three labels
- B. Different permissions; read the wallet sheet and name which one you are giving

C. Required for viewing BscScan

D. How Crystal Stones certificates are issued

Correct answer: B

Module 5: Hardware, household, and inheritance

Hardware is a signer, not magic. Backups must survive a fire, a theft, and a funeral without putting words in a group chat.

Lesson 1: Hardware wallets, without worship (27 min)

Hardware wallets, without worship

A hardware wallet keeps the seed in a small computer. The laptop proposes a transaction. The device signs if you confirm on **its** screen.

Ledger and Trezor are **examples of hardware wallets**, not ads, not a required purchase for Basic, not a halo. By the end of this lesson you should know what the box fixes, what it does not fix, and how people still empty a hardware wallet with their own finger.

What it fixes

Malware that tries to export keys from Chrome does not find the seed on the laptop if the seed never lived there. A stolen laptop that does not also have the device and PIN is a brick, not a vault. A phishing site that asks you to type 12 words into a browser is easier to refuse when the words never appear on that browser.

That is the job: **the secret is not on the daily driver**. The daily driver still proposes. You still decide.

What it does not fix

You confirm a swapped address because you did not read the device screen. You bought a used device that already had a seed. You typed the seed into a computer “to check.” You signed an unlimited approve. You stored the paper backup in Google Photos. You left every coin on an exchange and called the unopened box “self-custody.”

Hardware is a signer. It is not a babysitter. It is not an insurance policy. It is not colder than a paper you photographed.

Buy from the manufacturer. A marketplace “new Ledger, 40% off, seed already in the box” is a loaded vault. Initialize the device yourself. If a seed card came pre-written, the device is a gift for the seller.

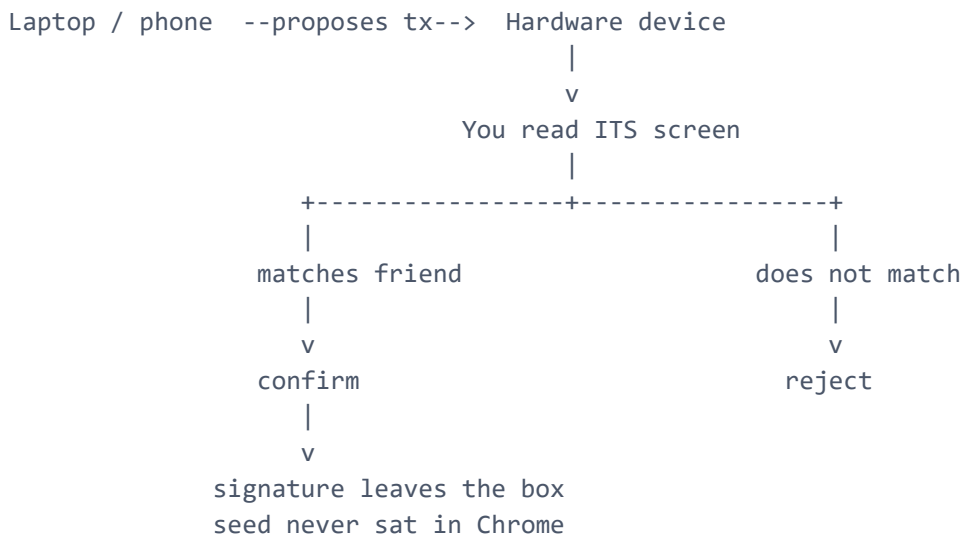
Do	Don't	Why
Initialize the device yourself	Use a pre-written seed from the box	The seller kept a copy
Confirm address on the device screen	Trust only the laptop monitor	Malware swaps the monitor
Keep a paper or steel backup	Photograph the seed “so I don’t lose the device”	The photo is the hotter copy
Buy from the maker	Buy a “discount sealed” unit from a random listing	Tamper and pre-load risk

Use it for amounts you would miss	Think it makes Approve unlimited safe	You still signed the gun
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Worked scenario. The laptop shows your friend’s address. The hardware screen shows a different 0x.

198. That is the malware fight the device is for. If you click OK without reading the device, you brought a vault to a phishing site and opened it.
199. You reject on the device. You do not type the seed into the laptop “to see which address is real.”
200. You confirm the friend’s address from their receive screen, out of band, then try again.
201. If you had bought a pre-initialized device, both screens could be theatre: the seller already had the combination.
202. You can finish Basic without buying hardware. If you cannot keep a paper seed safe, hardware will not magically create discipline.

DIAGRAM



Pre-filled seed in the box = seller already has a copy of this diagram.

Companion apps are still apps

The phone or desktop app that talks to the device can be cloned. Install from the official source. A clone companion will ask you to “enter seed to pair.” Real pairing does not need you to type the vault combination into a new pretty window.

Firmware updates come from the maker’s instructions, not from a Telegram file. A random firmware is a way to replace the small computer with a traitor.

You still need a paper or steel backup of the seed the device generated. The box can break, drown, or get lost. The backup is the combination. The box is a signer. Two objects. Module 1’s four objects still apply: the companion is the app, the device PIN is furniture, the seed is the vault, the chain is the book.

ACADEMY NOTE You can finish Basic without buying hardware. If you cannot keep a paper seed safe, hardware will not magically create discipline. This academy will not sell you a device, will not ask you to “pair hardware for graduation,” and will not send a firmware file in a chat.

When Basic is enough without a box

If your practice amount is smaller than the cost of the device, paper plus official app is the lab. Buy hardware later because the pile grew, not because a video said you are not a real holder. Worship is how people skip the paper backup and then lose the box.

What this lesson is for

You can place hardware on the map without worship. Next: a backup drill for real life — prove the paper, then put it where fire, theft, and panic cannot all win at once.

Say this out loud

- Hardware signs offline; you must still read its screen. The laptop can lie. The device screen is the destination.
- Never accept a pre-filled seed. Buy from the maker. Initialize yourself.
- Hardware does not fix bad approvals, photographed backups, or coins left on an exchange.
- Companion apps can be cloned. Pairing does not require typing 12 words into a website.
- Official shop, self-init, paper backup, read the device. Optional for this course.

Next: a backup drill for real life.

Lesson 2: A backup drill for real life (27 min)

A backup drill for real life

Keys outlive phones. They also outlive people. This is uncomfortable and it is part of self-custody.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to run a drill with zero or tiny funds: write, restore, receive a test, put the paper where you decided, and tell yourself one human plan.

The drill (do with zero or tiny funds)

203. Create a wallet on an official app or on a hardware device you initialized. Write the words, numbered, no photo.
204. Confirm the in-app quiz of the word order.
205. Receive a tiny amount on the right network — BNB on BNB Smart Chain is enough to prove the door. Practice amount you can lose.
206. Restore on a second view **or** (carefully) on a spare profile or spare device you trust — not on a café PC, not on a cousin’s phone.
207. See the tiny amount. You have proved the backup. If you cannot restore, you do not have a backup. You have a rumour.
208. Put the paper where you decided. Tell **one** plan to yourself: who should be able to find this if you are in hospital.

If you cannot complete that drill, you are not ready to store an amount you would miss. That is not an insult. It is a measurement. Exchanges exist. IOUs exist. Self-custody is optional. Pretend self-custody is not.

A second profile on a phone can work as a restore test if the app supports it and you understand you are typing the seed on the same daily driver. A spare old phone that is offline is cleaner. A café PC is not a test. It is a leak.

Drill step	Pass	Fail
Write numbered words	Paper matches the screen, read back once	Photo “to be sure,” chat copy
In-app confirmation	You tap the order from paper	You skip because it was slow
Tiny receive	Explorer shows it on your address	You funded rent first
Restore	Second view shows the same address and the tiny amount	You never tried, or you tried on a stranger’s laptop
Storage	Two boring places, not the phone bag	WhatsApp group, email, mattress only
Human plan	One sentence you could tell a lawyer or a trusted person	“They will figure it out”

Worked scenario. Chinedu writes twelve words, skips restore, deposits a month of freelance pay, then drops the paper in a moving box that goes to another city.

- 209. The phone dies. He has a PIN. He has an email. He has no combination in reach.
- 210. A helper offers to recover from IMEI. That is nonsense for a seed. A second helper wants leftover funds to “trace.” That is theft.
- 211. The drill would have caught this at step 4 with a tiny amount, or at step 6 when he noticed the only copy was travelling with the furniture.
- 212. He can still be fine if the box arrives. Hope is not a control. Two locations exist so that one moving box is not the vault.
- 213. After this course he runs the drill on a new wallet before any amount that would annoy him. He does not “upgrade” the old rumour with a photo.

DIAGRAM

```
Practice amount
--> drill restore
--> paper in two boring places
--> written plan for a human you trust
--> only then: amount you would miss
```

Skip any arrow, and you have folklore, not a backup.

Two locations, one combination

Two copies of the same ordered list, not two different encodings. Fire in one house should not take both. Theft of one bag should not take both. A spouse who can open a drawer you both know about is a relationship decision — next lessons. A group chat is not a location. It is a broadcast.

Steel is for when fire is a real risk and the amount justifies it. Paper is enough for the drill. Do the drill before you shop for plates.

ACADEMY NOTE Never put a seed in the same envelope as a full identity dump “for convenience.” Theft of that envelope is identity plus vault. Never run the restore half of the drill on a café PC or on a remote-desktop session. Academy staff will not watch you restore “to grade the lab.”

What “second view” is allowed to be

A second user account on your phone. A spare phone that is yours, updated, official app. A hardware device restoring from the paper you wrote — only if that device was initialized by you and is not a pre-seeded marketplace unit.

What it is not: a cybercafé, a phone repair counter, a friend’s phone, a Zoom share, an academy “restore portal.” If the only way to restore is one of those, you do not restore. You paper-drill and you wait for a clean spare. The coins can wait. The leak cannot be un-done.

Label the paper without decorating it

A small note “practice / BSC / 2026” on the same sheet is useful so a future you does not mix two vaults. A doodle, a gold sticker, or a photo of the sheet for “the aesthetic” is how backups become content. Boring paper in a boring place is the drill. If you cannot stand boring, you are not drilling — you are performing.

If the tiny receive never arrives, you still have a restore proof of the address. Funding can wait. The restore is the product of this lesson, not the balance.

What this lesson is for

You have a pass/fail drill. Next: sharing a household without sharing a seed — spouses, shops, and the difference between a watcher and a signer.

Say this out loud

- A backup that was never restored is a rumour. Drill with tiny funds.
- Write, confirm, tiny receive, restore, store, one human plan.
- Two copies of the same ordered list beat one clever hiding place and beat two different encodings.
- Café restore is a leak. Photo restore is a leak. Group-chat restore is a leak.
- If you cannot pass the drill, do not store rent in that vault.

Next: sharing a household without sharing a seed.

Lesson 3: Sharing a household without sharing a seed (27 min)

Sharing a household without sharing a seed

A household is not one brain. Self-custody that assumes one brain will fail at the first hospital, the first shop shift, or the first argument.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to name ways two adults can receive, watch, and (if they truly want) spend, without pasting twelve words into a family WhatsApp.

Watch versus spend versus custody of the paper

Watch-only on a shop tablet: the tablet shows incoming BNB or USDT. It cannot spend. The seed is not on the stall. This is how a shop shares a view without sharing a vault.

Two wallets: each adult has their own seed, their own paper, their own practice. They send to each other as they would send to a client — full sentence, tiny test. This is the default this academy likes. Boring. Clear. When one phone dies, the other person is not holding a hostage combination.

One vault, two signers (more than one key required) is an advanced design. It is real. It is easy to botch. It is not Basic homework. If a YouTube video says “just use a multisig,” you are allowed to say “later.”

One vault, shared seed is the common disaster: both phones have the words, or one notes app is shared, or the paper sits in a drawer every cousin knows. You have doubled the leak surface. You have also doubled the chance of a quiet send during a fight. If you choose this, you are choosing a joint account without a bank referee. Name it that way.

Setup	Who can see	Who can spend	Typical fail
Watch-only tablet	Shop / spouse	Nobody on that tablet	Seed later imported “so we can refund”
Two wallets, two seeds	Each their own	Each their own	Paying the wrong of the two doors
One seed on two phones	Both	Both, from either phone	One leak empties both views
Paper in a known drawer	Anyone who opens it	Anyone who restores	Relatives, theft, a teenager
Custodial joint exchange	Both logins if you set it so	Company can freeze	IOU, not keys — sometimes simpler

Worked scenario. Ada and her husband run a stall. They want to take BEP-20 USDT.

214. They create **one** receiving wallet on Ada’s official app. They write the seed properly. They do not put it in the couple chat.

215. They set a cheap tablet to **watch-only** on that address. Customers can see a tick when BscScan moves. The tablet cannot send.

216. Refunds, if any, wait until Ada is on her own phone, reading ends, with a gas reserve. They do not import the seed onto the tablet “just this once.”

217. The husband’s personal funds live on a **different** seed. Stall money and rent money are different objects if they want them to be.

218. If they later want him to spend stall funds without her phone, they are choosing either a second stall wallet they fund on purpose, or a shared-seed risk they can name. They do not pretend WhatsApp is a signer policy.

DIAGRAM

Stall receive address
|

```
+--> Ada's phone (keys)  --> can spend
+--> tablet watch-only   --> can see, cannot spend
+--> BscScan bookmark    --> book
```

Household personal

```
|
+--> Ada's second seed (optional)
+--> husband's seed
+--> no group-chat backup
```

Children, cousins, and “help me restore”

Do not let a helpful teenager finish the restore quiz. Do not dictate words to a cousin on a call. Do not share a screen on video while the words are visible. Household help is how seeds travel. If someone must help with a phone problem, they help with the app install — official store — not with the paper.

A shared Android backup of a wallet app can copy keys to a cloud. Check what the phone backs up before you call a setup “hers only.” If you do not know, assume hot.

ACADEMY NOTE A family WhatsApp group is not a vault, not an inheritance plan, and not a shop policy. If you need both adults to spend, say so and pick a design. If you need both adults to see, use watch-only. Do not paste twelve words into the chat because it feels like teamwork.

Money fights are not a dApp setting

If a couple cannot agree who may spend stall funds, a shared seed will not heal that. It will make the fight faster. Use two wallets and a rule you can say: “stall USDT sits on Ada’s practice-sized hot wallet, watch-only on the tablet, surplus goes to an exchange IOU / a colder wallet once a week.” Rules are adult. Shared phrases in chat are not.

If you hire a shop assistant, they get a watch-only view or a separate till wallet you fund with a ceiling, not the family vault. Staff turnover is a leak event.

Guests on the Wi-Fi are not co-signers

A visiting cousin on the shop tablet should see a watch-only view, not a signer. Log out of anything that can spend before you hand a device to a guest. A fingerprint registered for “convenience” on a shared phone is a spender. Name it.

What this lesson is for

You can separate seeing from spending in a house or a stall. Next: death, family, and inheritance without folklore — the plan that is not a Telegram admin.

Say this out loud

- Watch-only shares a view. It does not share a seed. Do not “upgrade” a tablet by importing words.
- Two adults, two seeds is the boring default. Sending between them uses the same receive ritual as a client.
- One seed on two phones doubles the leak and doubles the quiet send.

- Shop QR and shop seed are different objects. The counter shows a door. The paper stays off the stall.
- Help with an app install, not with the paper. Video calls and group chats are cameras.

Next: death, family, and inheritance without folklore.

Lesson 4: Death, family, and inheritance without folklore (27 min)

Death, family, and inheritance without folklore

If nobody can find the words, the coins are a monument. If everybody can find the words, the coins are a fight.

By the end of this lesson you should refuse two folk stories: “they will figure it out from my phone PIN,” and “I’ll just put the twelve words in the family group so nobody is left out.” You should replace them with a plan you can say in one paragraph.

This academy does not write your will. It refuses to pretend self-custody is only a tech skill.

What actually happens without a plan

A holder dies. The family has the phone PIN and the exchange password on a sticky note. The self-custody seed was only in the holder’s head, or only in a photo album nobody can unlock, or only on a hardware device whose PIN died with them.

The exchange IOU might be recoverable with documents, next-of-kin process, and time. That is a company-and-law story. The self-custody wallet is gone if the combination is gone. Name which bucket each pile of value is in **before** it matters.

A hardware box without the PIN and without the paper is a brick. A paper without order is a puzzle. A passphrase nobody else knows is a second brick. Complexity you cannot explain to a tired relative is not a gift.

Bucket	What the family needs	What will not work
Custodial exchange / fintech	Legal process, logins if any, the company’s rules	A seed they do not have; a Telegram “recovery agent”
Self-custody software	The ordered words (and passphrase if any)	Phone PIN alone; IMEI; email password alone
Hardware	Device PIN **or** the seed backup; preferably the backup	A marketplace clone; a firmware from a helper
Watch-only tablet	Nothing to spend	Importing a guessed seed

Worked scenario. A holder in the family kept Crystal Stones and BNB on a phone wallet, seed in his head “because paper can be stolen,” exchange USDT in an example centralised exchange with a written password.

219. The exchange pile is an IOU. A spouse with documents may have a path. It will be slow. It is not nothing.

220. The phone wallet is a monument. PIN opens furniture. It does not reprint a seed that never existed on paper.

221. A helper on Facebook offers to recover the seed from the dead phone for a fee, leftover funds first. That is a second theft. This academy will not teach you to pay that person.
222. The adult plan, written while alive: paper or steel in a known place, a sealed letter, a lawyer or a trusted person, and a list of **which** buckets exist (exchange names, chain, that a BEP-20 token might need to be added by contract to be seen — 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00 as verify-only).
223. The letter should not sit in the same envelope as every identity photocopy if theft of that envelope would be total. Tradeoffs are allowed. Silence is not a plan.

DIAGRAM

Alive, today

- > list buckets (IOU vs keys)
- > drill the backup
- > one paragraph for a human
- > store paper so that human can find it without a group chat

Death with no paragraph

- > PIN and email are not a seed
- > helpers appear
- > keys-bucket is gone; IOU-bucket is a queue

Split knowledge is advanced and easy to botch

Some people split: one person has the location of the paper, another has a passphrase. That can work. It can also guarantee that after a funeral nobody can open anything. If you cannot run the backup drill with your own brain, do not design a two-person puzzle.

A sealed letter with a lawyer or a trusted person is ordinary adult behaviour in other parts of life. Use it if it fits your legal world. This course will not pretend it is the same in every country. It will pretend that WhatsApp is not a will.

ACADEMY NOTE Never put a seed in the same envelope as a full identity dump “for convenience” unless you have accepted that theft of that envelope is identity plus vault. Never send leftover funds to a stranger who promises to recover a dead relative’s wallet. We will not give that advice in a prettier costume.

What to put in the paragraph

Which buckets exist (exchange names, self-custody, hardware). Where the paper is, in language a tired person can follow. That BNB Smart Chain is chain id 56 and BscScan is the book. That a BEP-20 token may need adding by contract to be seen — and the Crystal Stones verify string if that token is in the pile. That passphrase is off, or the exact passphrase location if you defied the default. That nobody should pay a Facebook recovery agent.

Do not put the raw seed in a WhatsApp draft of that paragraph. The paragraph points. The paper sits. Two objects.

Law still applies

Self-custody does not delete tax, marriage, or probate law in your country. It only deletes the help desk. A plan that fights your law is a future court and a present leak. Use a professional if the amount would justify one. This academy will not draft documents. It will tell you that a group chat is not a professional.

What this lesson is for

You can speak inheritance without folklore. Next: the self-custody checklist you will reuse on every send, including the phrases that mean close the app.

Say this out loud

- Phone PIN is not a seed. Email is not a seed. A dead hardware box without paper is a brick.
- Name which funds are IOUs and which are keys before it matters. The playbooks differ.
- A paragraph for a human beats a group chat. Split puzzles are advanced.
- Recovery agents who want leftover funds first are thieves.
- Complexity the family cannot run is not love. It is a monument.

Next: the self-custody checklist.

Lesson 5: The self-custody checklist (26 min)

The self-custody checklist

Print this in your head. Use it before any amount that would annoy you to lose.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to run the list without looking, and you should recognise the phrases that mean close the app, hang up, and go back to a bookmark.

Before you create

- Official app or hardware from the maker. Trust Wallet and MetaMask are examples of wallet apps, not ads. Ledger and Trezor are examples of hardware, not ads.
- Pen and paper ready. Numbered lines. No screenshots.
- No café generator, no Telegram bot, no “academy portal.”

After you create

- Words written and confirmed in order.
- Restore proved with zero funds or a tiny practice amount.
- Paper not in the cloud, not in chat, not in the phone case.

Before you receive

- Network is the one the sender will use. For this academy’s token path: BNB Smart Chain, BEP-20, chain id 56.
- Address from your receive screen, not from a DM PDF.
- You can explain asset + network + standard. Memo/tag only if a CEX deposit page truly requires it.

Before you send

- Dropdown is the right book.
- First/last 6 match. Address book names are stickers.
- Tiny test if it matters. Explorer row before remainder.
- BNB reserved for gas. No Max on BNB if tokens still need a courier.
- No Approve on a mystery site. Connect is not Approve. Approve is not Send.

If something feels like support

- Academy, wallet brands, exchanges, the checkout processor, Crystal Stones “admins” will not DM you for a seed, a private key, 2FA, or remote desktop.
- Hang up. Open the real site from a bookmark.
- “Validate with your seed,” “pay gas to unlock,” “limited airdrop, approve now,” “send USDT, any network is fine” — close.

Phrase	Action	Object they want
“Validate with your seed”	Close	The vault
“Pay gas to this address to unlock”	Close	Your BNB, then your tokens
“Limited airdrop, approve now”	Close	Unlimited allowance
“Send USDT, any network is fine”	Close	A mix-up they will not refund
“Install this APK / this firmware”	Close	A clone of the app or the device
“Share screen, I’ll set gwei”	Close	The pen while you watch

You now have a key-manager mental model, a seed practice, a receive/send ritual, a leak playbook, and a household paragraph. The next module is a lab: official stores only, practice amounts only, no seed typed into a website. The next Basic course after this one — Exchanges & Your First Buy — is about the **on-ramp**: KYC, order books, and withdrawals onto the rails you just learned.

DIAGRAM

```

Create official --> paper --> restore proof
    |
    v
Receive: network + your screen + test + explorer
    |
    v
Send: dropdown + ends + gas reserve + sheet named out loud
    |
    v
Support phrases --> close --> bookmark

Empty and competent beats funded and confused.

```

Worked scenario. A student finishes this checklist out loud, then a chat shouts that Crystal Stones will “list tomorrow” and they must Approve a pool.

224. They name the object: this is Approve, not a send they started, not a lesson.

225. They do not buy because a chat shouted. This academy still does not tell them to buy.
226. They may add the published contract as a view:
0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00 on BSC. Viewing is not investing.
227. They keep the paper where the drill put it. They do not photograph it to “show they are ready.”
228. They go to Module 6’s lab with an amount they can lose, or with an empty wallet and a paper drill only.

ACADEMY NOTE Still not a buy order for Crystal Stones. You can add the contract to view. You can finish this course with an empty wallet. Empty and competent beats funded and confused. Paid-track checkout, when you meet it, is USDT on BNB Smart Chain (BEP-20) through academy checkout — not this token, not a chat 0x.

After a send, before you brag

- Explorer row matches the job you meant.
- You still have BNB for the next fee.
- You did not screenshot the seed in celebration.
- You did not paste the seed into a “certificate.”
- You named whether this pile is still an IOU on an exchange or keys you hold.

Weekly five-minute hygiene

Once a week is enough for a beginner: confirm the paper is where you left it; confirm the app is still the official publisher; confirm you did not connect a mystery site; confirm BscScan still matches the screen for an address you care about. Hygiene is dull. Dull is the point.

If you hold a view of Crystal Stones, confirm the contract has not been replaced in your wallet’s token list by a lookalike. The published string remains 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00. A new logo in the list is not a new truth.

One line you can text a friend

“Coins are on the chain, the app is a window, the paper is the combination, BNB pays BSC gas, USDT is not USDT on every road, Approve is a gun, support never needs the words.” If they want more, they can take this course. If a stranger wants more — the words, the screen, the 2FA — they are not your friend.

What this lesson is for

The list is the product. Take the quiz. Then the lab: set up without risking rent.

Say this out loud

- Official create, paper backup, proved restore. Cloud copies poison the setup.
- Full sentence: asset, network, standard, address. Test, explorer, gas reserve.
- Name the sheet: Connect, Sign, Send, Approve. If you cannot name it, reject it.
- Support never needs the words, the key, the 2FA, or the desktop.
- Empty and competent beats funded and confused.

Take the quiz. Then the lab — official stores, practice amounts, no seed on a website.

Module quiz (answers included for editors)

Q1. A marketplace listing sells a “new” hardware wallet with a seed card already filled in. What is it?

- A. A helpful gift that saves initialization
- B. A likely pre-loaded vault for the seller — buy from the maker and initialize yourself
- C. Required for BEP-20 tokens
- D. Colder than paper even if the seller kept a copy

Correct answer: B

Q2. The laptop shows a friend’s 0x; the hardware device screen shows a different 0x. What should you do?

- A. Confirm on the laptop because it is easier to read
- B. Reject on the device — the device screen is the destination the signer will authorise
- C. Type the seed into the laptop to see which is real
- D. Approve unlimited so both addresses can be paid

Correct answer: B

Q3. Chinedu wrote twelve words, skipped restore, and funded rent. The paper is in a moving box. What is true?

- A. The phone PIN will reprint the seed if the box is lost
- B. He has an unproven backup — a rumour — and is not ready to store an amount he would miss
- C. Email support can regenerate BIP-39 from his IMEI
- D. A photo of the box label is a second backup

Correct answer: B

Q4. Ada’s stall uses a tablet that only watches the receiving address. A helper says import the seed so they can refund. What happens if she does?

- A. The tablet stays watch-only by magic
- B. The stall device becomes a hot signer — a leak and a theft risk — watch-only was the point
- C. BscScan will block spends from a shop
- D. The academy requires shop seeds on tablets

Correct answer: B

Q5. Two spouses want to take USDT at a stall without putting words in WhatsApp. A sound Basic design is?

- A. Paste the seed in the couple chat so both can restore
- B. One seeded phone that can spend, plus a watch-only tablet that can only see
- C. One seed installed on every family phone
- D. A recovery agent as co-signer

Correct answer: B

Q6. A holder dies with an exchange password on a sticky note and a self-custody seed only in his head. What is likely?

- A. The phone PIN recovers both buckets
- B. The exchange IOU may have a legal path; the self-custody wallet is gone without the combination
- C. BscScan will transfer Crystal Stones to next of kin automatically
- D. A Facebook helper who wants leftover funds first is the official path

Correct answer: B

Q7. Which phrase should close the app immediately?

- A. "Here is the tx hash from BscScan."
- B. "Validate with your seed / pay gas to unlock / share screen so I can set gwei."
- C. "Add token using this published contract to view."
- D. "Leave a BNB reserve for the next send."

Correct answer: B

Q8. This academy's rule on hardware shopping and seeds in this module is?

- A. You must buy a Ledger this week to graduate
- B. Hardware is optional; never a pre-filled seed; academy will not ask you to pair a device or type words for a certificate
- C. Trezor is the only valid signer for Crystal Stones
- D. Companion-app clones from ads are recommended

Correct answer: B

Module 6: Lab: set up without risking rent

A guided dry-run. Official stores only. Practice amounts only. No seed typed into a website.

Lesson 1: Choosing an official wallet app without downloading a clone (26 min)

Choosing an official wallet app without downloading a clone

This module is a lab. You will not be asked to buy Crystal Stones. You will not be asked to type a seed into a website. You will use official stores, practice amounts you can lose, and BscScan as the book.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to install an example wallet app from a source you can defend, and you should recognise clone tells: a slightly wrong publisher, an APK from a group chat, a "Crystal Stones official wallet" that is not a wallet this academy ships.

Official store means the publisher, not the icon

Trust Wallet and MetaMask are **examples of wallet apps**. Pick one you will actually keep updated, or pick a hardware companion only if you already own a device from the maker. This academy does not need a brand loyalty oath.

On a phone, use the App Store or Google Play. Tap the publisher name. Compare it to the publisher named on the product's own website that **you typed**, not a sponsored first result. Clone apps copy icons, screenshots, and even review counts. They exist to catch the restore of a seed.

Do not sideload an APK from Telegram, WhatsApp, or a “faster download” site. Do not let a cousin install it for you from their files app. If a shop assistant offers a phone “already set up for crypto,” treat the wallet as hostile until you uninstall and reinstall from the official store, then create a **new** seed — the preinstalled one is not yours.

On a computer, MetaMask-as-example is a browser extension from the official extension store plus a publisher check. Fake extensions live in ads. Bookmark the real docs. Do not install from a banner that followed you after a search for Crystal Stones.

Source	Beginner verdict	Why
App Store / Play, publisher matched to the typed official site	OK for this lab	Still not an endorsement
Official hardware shop, sealed, you initialize	OK if you already chose hardware	Tamper risk if used or pre-seeded
APK / “mod” / Telegram file	No	Clone harvester
Shop phone with wallet preinstalled	No until you wipe and reinstall	Seed may already be known
Sponsored “MetaMask download” ad	No	Classic clone path
“Crystal Stones Academy wallet” APK	No	We do not ship a custodial app that needs your seed

Worked scenario. A student searches “Trust Wallet APK” because Play Store is slow.

- 229. The first download button is an ad. The APK asks for restore on first open.
- 230. If they restore a funded seed, the clone has the combination. If they create a new seed inside the clone, the clone may still exfiltrate it.
- 231. The adult path: wait for Play or App Store. Match publisher. Create later, on that official binary.
- 232. They do not “test the APK with a dummy seed” on the same phone they will later fund. Dummy seeds become habits.
- 233. If they already installed a clone, they do not type any real seed into it. Uninstall. Official install. New words if anything was ever entered on the clone.

DIAGRAM

```

Typed official website --> publisher name
      |
      v
App Store / Play / official extension store
      |

```

```
      v
Publisher match --> install --> stop
      |
      x  ads, APK chats, preinstalled shop phones, "academy wallet"
```

You have an app. You do not yet have a vault. That is the next lesson.

What this academy will never send you

A download link in email. A QR to an APK. A "student edition" wallet. A request to enable remote desktop so we can install it. If our name is on those, it is a costume. Course progress does not live in your seed.

After install, do not create the wallet yet if the room is public. Pen, privacy, next lesson. If the app nags you to back up to iCloud, that nag is the Notes-app trap in a tuxedo. You will write paper.

ACADEMY NOTE Crystal Stones Academy does not ship a wallet APK and will never ask you to install one to mark a lesson complete. Official stores only. If a mentor-shaped account sends a download, it is theft wearing a syllabus.

Review scores are not a publisher

Clones buy reviews. A 4.8 star APK with 80,000 ratings can still be a harvester. Publisher match plus typed official site beats the score. If the store listing's company name is a near-miss — one extra letter, a different country suffix — stop.

After install, before create: open the app's settings and see whether it is begging for a seed import as the first screen. Create is the lab. Import is how clones eat old vaults. If you came here with a funded seed, you still create a new lab vault. You do not import rent into a fresh install as a test.

After a clone scare

If you already typed a real seed into a clone, that is Module 2's leak lesson, not a reinstall footnote. New official app. New words. Move what you can. Retire the old phrase. Reinstalling the real app and typing the same words again is how you feed the clone's harvest to a second screen — the words are already burned.

What this lesson is for

You have a clean binary, or you know how to get one. Next: create a new wallet and prove the backup — offline write, then restore to a second profile if possible, or a paper drill.

Say this out loud

- Official store plus matched publisher. Icons are not proof. Ads are not stores.
- No APK from chat, no preinstalled shop wallet, no academy-branded seed app.
- A clone's job is to watch you type words. Do not give it a funded seed or a "test" seed you later reuse.
- Hardware, if you use it, comes from the maker and is initialized by you.
- Progress in this course does not require a special wallet build.

Next: creating a new wallet and proving the backup.

Lesson 2: Creating a new wallet and proving the backup (27 min)

Creating a new wallet and proving the backup

Create on the official app you just installed, or on a hardware screen if that is your signer. Write paper. Prove restore. Do not fund rent.

By the end of this lesson you should have numbered words on paper and evidence that those words open the same addresses — via the app’s confirmation quiz plus a restore to a second profile if you can do it safely, or a strict paper drill if you cannot.

Create, write, confirm

234. Be in a private place. No video call. No shop CCTV over your shoulder if you can avoid it. Airplane mode is optional and fine.
235. Tap Create, not Import, unless you are restoring a seed you already own. This lab is a **new** vault.
236. When 12 or 24 words appear, write them in order on numbered lines. Block letters. No photo. No printer. No Notes app “until I get paper.”
237. Complete the app’s confirmation quiz from the paper, not from memory of the screen.
238. Leave the optional passphrase **off** unless you can teach Module 2’s passphrase lesson and store a second secret. This lab’s default is off.
239. Write the date and “practice wallet” on the paper if it helps you not mix it with a later vault. Do not write the words in a title of a cloud file.

If the app offers iCloud or Google backup of the seed, refuse. That is a hot copy. You are practising self-custody, not a new kind of exchange.

Prove the backup

The in-app quiz is necessary and not sufficient. People tap the quiz while the words are still on the other half of the screen.

If the app allows a second profile, or you have a spare device that is yours, restore there from paper and check that the **address** matches the first view. Then remove the spare restore if it lives on a noisier device than you want. Each extra live copy is extra hot surface.

If you cannot restore on a second view without typing on a café PC, do a **paper drill**: cover the app, read the paper aloud privately, uncover, confirm every word. Then, later, when you have a clean spare, restore for real before the amount grows.

Never prove a backup by pasting words into a website “seed checker,” an academy lookalike, or a Discord bot.

Proof	Counts?	Note
In-app word-order quiz	Partial	Necessary. Easy to cheat while the screen still shows words
Restore on a second profile / spare you own	Yes	Best lab. Remove extra live copies you do not want hot
Paper read-back, screen covered	Partial	Better than nothing when no spare

		exists
Website “validate seed”	No	Theft
Photo of the paper	No	Leak

Worked scenario. Ngozi creates a wallet on the official app, writes twelve words, then sees a banner: “Verify backup — paste your phrase to continue the Crystal Stones lesson.”

240. That banner is not this course. She closes it.
241. She finishes the in-app quiz from paper.
242. She uses Android’s second user / a spare old phone of hers to restore. The 0x matches. She does not leave the spare signed-in in a shared house if that house is leaky.
243. She has proved the backup with zero funds. She is allowed to receive a practice amount next. She is not required to.
244. If the restore had shown a different 0x, she would not fund anything. She would check order, check passphrase-off, check she did not shuffle the paper.

DIAGRAM

```

Create on official app / hardware screen
|
v
Write numbered paper (no photo, no cloud)
|
v
In-app quiz from paper
|
v
Restore proof (second profile or strict paper drill)
|
v
Zero funds still OK – next lesson is a tiny receive, not rent

Website seed paste = stop. Wrong course. Theft.

```

One lab wallet

Do not create five seeds “for practice.” You will mix papers. One practice vault, labelled, stored like the real thing, even if it will only ever hold a tiny BNB. Habits transfer. Sloppy practice becomes sloppy funded.

If you already had a funded wallet, do **not** type that seed into this lab’s second profile as a demo. The lab is a new phrase. Keep old phrases off noisy extra devices.

ACADEMY NOTE Crystal Stones Academy will never require you to paste words into our site to mark this lesson complete. If a page says it is required, it is not us. Prove the backup on the official app, on paper, optionally on a spare you own.

If the words look “too common”

BIP-39 words are ordinary. “Apple” does not mean the vault is weak. Do not swap a word for a synonym. Do not add a 13th word as a joke. Do not skip a word that appeared twice — duplicates can happen. Copy the screen. The next lesson is receive, not poetry.

If you lose the paper before the restore proof, you do not hunt in the app’s settings for a “show seed” while sitting on a bus. You wait until you are private, you write again if the app will still show the phrase (some will, some will not after you skip), or you abandon that empty vault and create a new one. Empty is the time to be ruthless. Funded is too late.

What this lesson is for

You have a proven empty vault, or you know exactly which proof you still owe yourself. Next: first receive of a practice amount on BSC — tiny, right network, explorer.

Say this out loud

- Create, not import, for this lab. Write numbered paper. Passphrase off unless you can teach it.
- Refuse cloud backup of the seed. That is a hot copy.
- Prove restore on a spare you own, or do a strict paper drill. Websites do not validate seeds.
- One practice vault. Do not mix papers. Do not demo with a funded seed on a noisy extra device.
- Matching 0x after restore is the proof. Feelings are not.

Next: first receive of a practice amount on BNB Smart Chain.

Lesson 3: First receive of a practice amount on BSC (27 min)

First receive of a practice amount on BSC

Now the door. A tiny amount. The right book. An explorer row. Not rent.

By the end of this lesson you should have received a practice amount of **BNB** (native gas coin) on **BNB Smart Chain**, or you should have walked the ritual on paper if you are not moving value yet. BNB is the courier. Tokens wait until you can pay the courier.

This academy does not tell you where you must obtain BNB. An example centralised exchange, a friend who already holds it, a P2P desk you already trust — those are on-ramps. The next Basic course treats on-ramps in full. Today: if value moves, it moves as a test you can lose, to an address you control, on chain id 56.

The receive ritual, as a lab

245. Open your official wallet. Network = BNB Smart Chain. If you must add the network, you want chain id **56** and a reputable RPC, not a random pasted RPC from a chat.
246. Tap Receive. Copy the 0x from that screen. Check first 6 and last 6.
247. From the sending side — exchange withdrawal or a friend’s wallet — choose **BNB** on **BNB Smart Chain**, not BNB on the wrong product, not a token named BNB, not Ethereum.
248. Send a tiny amount. Wait. Do not nag the sender for a screenshot as proof.

249. Open BscScan from a bookmark. Paste **your** address. See the incoming BNB. That row is the lab pass.

250. If the wallet screen lags, believe the explorer. Delayed RPC is not theft. Do not send a second test because the icon is slow.

If you cannot move value this week, still do steps 1–2 and write your first 6 and last 6 in a private place that is **not** the seed paper. Knowing your door is part of the lab. Funding is optional. Competence is not.

Sender choice	What to select	Lab fail
Exchange withdrawal	BNB, BEP-20/BSC network, your 0x, no invented memo unless the page requires one	TRC-20, ERC-20, or a memo meant for someone else's product
Friend's wallet	Their dropdown = BSC, asset = BNB, ends match	They send a token named BNB on another chain
You, from another of your wallets	Same full sentence	Max-sending all BNB from a wallet that still holds tokens

Worked scenario. Yusuf withdraws “BNB” from an example exchange and picks a network that is not BNB Smart Chain.

251. The exchange shows success. His BSC wallet does not move. BscScan on chain id 56 shows nothing.

252. He does not paste the seed into a recovery bot. He reads the withdrawal record: which network did the exchange send on?

253. Rescue, if any, is an exchange support story — maybe, maybe not. This lab prefers not needing rescue: pick BSC, tiny amount, explorer, then (only if you want) a little more for later gas.

254. He tries again, tiny, on BSC. BscScan shows the row. The wallet catches up. Lab pass.

255. He leaves that BNB as a gas reserve for the next two lessons. He does not swap it into a mystery token.

DIAGRAM

Your receive screen (BSC)

|

v

Tiny BNB from a venue you chose

|

v

BscScan row on YOUR address

|

v

Wallet screen may lag --> wait, do not double-send

Wrong network / wrong asset / wrong door = different book. Do not “try all networks” with rent.

How much is a practice amount

An amount whose disappearance would annoy you for an hour, not a month. If you do not have a number like that, skip funding. Watch-only labs still teach the dropdown. Empty and competent remains the motto.

Do not ask a stranger in a Crystal Stones group to “send me gas.” That invitation is how hunters find hungry addresses. Do not post your 0x under “first BNB please.” Dust and drainers follow.

ACADEMY NOTE Practice with amounts you can lose. Prefer a test-send first. This academy will not reimburse a wrong-network withdrawal, will not send you gas, and will not ask you to receive Crystal Stones to pass the lab. BNB on BSC is the courier for later token views and a tiny self-send.

Adding BSC if the app is blank

Some example apps, especially browser wallets, start on Ethereum. Adding BNB Smart Chain means chain id 56, symbol BNB, a public RPC you got from documentation you typed, not from a DM. A wrong RPC can be a delayed helper or a malicious helper. If the app offers an official “add BNB Smart Chain” switch, prefer that to a stranger’s pasted JSON.

Then receive. Then explorer. Then you may add a token view in the next lesson. Order matters: courier first, costume jewellery second.

What the explorer row must show

Your address as the destination. BNB as the asset for this lab. Status success. The sending address can be an exchange hot wallet — that is normal. You are not looking for your name. You are looking for the door and the asset.

If you see a token transfer instead of BNB, you received a different object. Do not try to “convert it on a pop-up.” Note it, ignore mystery tokens, and do a BNB test if you still need the courier.

What this lesson is for

You can receive BNB on the right book, or you can honestly postpone funding. Next: add Crystal Stones by contract as verify-only, and read the token on BscScan — still not a buy.

Say this out loud

- Receive from your BSC screen. Chain id 56. Copy, check ends, tiny BNB, explorer row.
- Exchange dropdowns are network selectors too. BNB on the wrong road is the wrong object.
- Delayed wallet screens are not a dare to send twice. BscScan is the book.
- Do not beg strangers for gas. Do not post your address in a hunting ground.
- Funding is optional. The ritual is not.

Next: adding Crystal Stones by contract (verify, not buy) and reading the token on BscScan.

Lesson 4: Adding Crystal Stones by contract (verify, not buy) and reading the token on BscScan (28 min)

Adding Crystal Stones by contract (verify, not buy) and reading the token on BscScan

Adding a token is a view. BscScan is the book. Neither is a purchase.

By the end of this lesson you should have the published Crystal Stones contract in your wallet on BNB Smart Chain **or** you should have opened that contract on BscScan and read it like an adult. You should not have Approved anything. You should not have sent BNB to the contract “to activate.”

The public contract, as the project publishes it, is:

0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00

Treat that as a **reference to verify**. This academy will not tell you to buy. Crystal Stones’ RWA story is their claim to verify elsewhere. This lab verifies **which program** you are looking at.

On BscScan

256. Open BscScan from your bookmark. Confirm you are on the BSC explorer, not a fake.
257. Paste 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00.
258. You should land on a **token contract** page: a program, not a person’s empty wallet story. Note the name, the symbol, the decimals if shown, the contract address again — first 6 and last 6, then more of the middle.
259. Open your own address in another tab. If you hold none, you hold none. The holders list does not owe you a row.
260. If a second token named Crystal Stones appears on your address from an airdrop, compare **its** contract to the published one. Mismatch means clone. Do not tap Claim.

In the wallet

261. Network is BNB Smart Chain.
262. Add custom token. Paste the published contract. The app should fill a name and symbol from the chain. If it asks you to Approve, you are not adding a view. Reject.
263. A zero balance is a successful add. A non-zero balance means that address already held some — still not a lesson to buy more.
264. Do not add a token from a pop-up that said “you received Crystal Stones.” Add from the published string you typed yourself.

Lab move	Pass	Fail
Paste published contract on BscScan	Token page, address matches	Random Google clone, or a phishing explorer
Add token in wallet on BSC	View appears, no Approve sheet	Approve, WalletConnect from a DM, send BNB to contract
Ignore mystery airdrop	Hidden or leftover, not tapped	Claim site, unlimited allowance
Read your address on BscScan	You can find BNB and token tabs	Believing the wallet logo over the contract

Worked scenario. A student adds the token, sees 0, then a WhatsApp blast says “your academy allocation is waiting — connect to claim.”

265. This course did not allocate tokens. Connecting to claim is not a lab step.
266. They keep the view. They do not Approve. They do not sign a mystery message.

267. They reread the contract on BscScan and confirm it still matches
0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00.
268. If they want a non-zero number one day, that is a later life decision this academy will not make for them. The lab is the match, not the balance.
269. They still have a BNB reserve from the previous lesson so that a later tiny send can pay a courier — not so they can feed a claim contract.

DIAGRAM

```
Typed contract 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00
|
+--> BscScan token page (book)
+--> wallet custom token on BSC (view)
|
x Approve
x send BNB to the contract
x claim sites
x the checkout processor mix-up (paid tracks, when live, are USDT BEP-20,
not this token)
```

Name match is not contract match.

What you are not doing

You are not verifying a mine. You are not verifying a price. You are not paying tuition to this contract. Paid-track checkout, when live, is **USDT on BNB Smart Chain (BEP-20) through academy checkout**. Different rail. Different sentence. Do not send Crystal Stones to a USDT invoice, and do not send USDT to this contract.

If the wallet shows a different checksum casing, that can still be the same address. Compare without panicking. If the middle digits differ, it is not the same address.

ACADEMY NOTE This lesson is verify-only. Not a buy order. Not a claim. Not a deposit address. Academy staff will not send a second “updated contract” in a DM. If the published contract ever changed, you would confirm from the same kinds of sources you used here — not from a blast.

Two tabs, one string

Keep BscScan and the wallet add-token sheet open together. The string you paste in the wallet should be the string on the token page, not a string from a chat screenshot that “looks close.” Close is how clones live.

If your wallet already lists a Crystal Stones from an airdrop, hide it or ignore it. Add the published contract as a **new** custom token. Two rows with the same nickname can sit in one app. Only the contract tells you which row is the program this academy printed.

If you hold BNB from the previous lesson, do not swap it into the token as part of this lab. The lab is a view. Swapping is a later, optional life decision, and a sponsored swap is often a drainer.

What this lesson is for

You can point at the program on the book. Next: a tiny send to yourself, then graduation — what you can do, what still waits for later courses.

Say this out loud

- Adding Crystal Stones by contract is a view on BNB Smart Chain. It is not a purchase and not an Approve.
- The published contract to verify is 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00. Clone names do not count.
- BscScan is the book. A zero balance after adding can be an honest pass.
- Do not send BNB to the token contract to activate anything. Do not claim airdrops.
- Tuition, when it exists, is not this token and not this contract.

Next: a tiny send to yourself, then the graduation.

Lesson 5: A tiny send to yourself, then the graduation: what you can do, what still waits for later courses (28 min)

A tiny send to yourself, then the graduation

The last lab move is a send you cannot blame on a stranger: you to you, on BSC, tiny, then the explorer row. After that, we name what this course made you able to do, and what it did not.

By the end you should have either completed a self-send of practice BNB (or a tiny BEP-20 amount if you already held one), or you should be able to walk the steps without pretending a screenshot is a row.

Tiny send to yourself

Why to yourself: the destination is a door you control. You still practise paste, ends, gas, and explorer. You still can fail — wrong network, no gas, clipboard malware swapping even your own address. Self-sends are not a joke. They catch sloppy hands before a client is involved.

270. If you have only one address, send a tiny BNB amount to that same address, or create a second account in the same app (same seed, different child address) and send there. A second account is not a second backup. It is a second door on the same tree — fine for this drill.
271. If you want a cleaner drill, send from the practice wallet to a **watch-only** view of the same address on BscScan only — still one signer. Do not invent a second seed for five minutes and lose the paper.
272. Network BSC. Asset BNB for the courier drill. Amount tiny. Check ends. Confirm on the sheet. Wait.
273. BscScan: from, to, amount, success. Your wallet may lag. The book wins.
274. Leave a gas reserve. Do not Max. If you also send a tiny token, you still pay BNB. Do not send Crystal Stones to yourself as a way of “buying a round trip.” Viewing was the previous lesson.

If you have no BNB, skip the live send. Recite the checklist out loud. You still graduate this course as a person who can refuse a seed phishing page. Funded theatre is not the certificate.

You can do after this course	You still wait for
Name app, PIN, keys, chain as four objects	Exchange KYC, P2P, and first buy (next Basic course)

Create, paper, restore proof	Advanced revoke-allowance tools
Receive and send on BSC with a test and explorer	Complex dApp use, bridges, “best yield”
Add Crystal Stones as a verified view	Anyone’s permission to tell you to buy
Refuse seed / 2FA / remote-desktop theatre	Hardware shopping as a personality
Name Approve as a loaded gun	Safe unlimited on a venue you researched
A household paragraph	A lawyer-grade will this academy will not write

Worked scenario. Amaka sends 0.001 BNB to herself. Clipboard malware swaps the paste to a hunter. She checks last 6 on the confirm sheet, sees a mismatch, rejects.

275. That reject is a lab pass even if no send landed. The sheet did its job.

276. She copies again from the receive screen, checks ends, sends. BscScan shows her address on both from and to (or from account 0 to account 1).

277. She does not then Approve a “graduation dApp.” There is not one.

278. She puts the paper back. She does not post the tx hash in a public group with her life story. Explorers are public enough.

279. She can explain, out loud, that Crystal Stones Academy never needed her seed, that the contract 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00 was verify-only, and that the next course is on-ramps — not a command to empty an exchange today.

DIAGRAM

```

Practice BNB on BSC
  |
  v
Paste destination (self / account 1)
  |
  v
Check ends on THE SHEET
  |
  +--> mismatch --> reject --> copy again
  +--> match --> send --> BscScan row --> reserve left

```

Graduation is the ritual, not a token balance.

What still waits

Exchanges & Your First Buy: how an IOU on-ramp works, KYC, withdrawals that still need this course’s sentence (asset, network, standard). BNB Smart Chain for beginners: more of the chain itself. Crypto safety: drainers in more costumes. None of those courses will honestly ask for your seed either.

You may keep using a custodial exchange. You may never buy hardware. You may never hold Crystal Stones. You may hold a view of zero forever. The operating manual still applies whenever a key or an IOU is in play.

If this lab felt like a lot of paper for a tiny coin, that is the point. Self-custody is ops. People who skip ops become screenshots in group chats.

ACADEMY NOTE Graduation is not a wallet-connect ceremony. We will not ask for a seed, a private key, 2FA, remote desktop, or an Approve to issue a certificate. Practice amounts only. Education only. Never a buy order.

What you will still not do tomorrow

You will not import the lab seed into a second random app to “see Crystal Stones price.” You will not join a paid group that requires a screenshot of your phrase. You will not send leftover practice BNB to a recovery agent. You will not treat a certificate as a reason to Connect. The next course is the on-ramp. It still will not need the words.

What this lesson is for

You have a complete Basic operating manual for wallets, keys, and self-custody on BNB Smart Chain. Take the quiz. Then go to the next course when you are ready — not when a chat is shouting.

Say this out loud

- A tiny self-send practises paste, ends, gas, and explorer without a client in the story. The sheet can still save you from malware.
- Leave a BNB reserve. Do not Max. Do not Approve a graduation dApp. There is not one.
- This course made you able to name objects, back up a seed, receive and send on BSC, verify a contract, and refuse theatre.
- It did not tell you to buy Crystal Stones, empty an exchange, or worship a hardware brand.
- Academy staff still will never ask for the words. If someone does, they are not us.

Take the quiz. Then the next Basic course when you are ready — not when a chat is shouting.

Module quiz (answers included for editors)

Q1. A student downloads a Trust Wallet APK from a Telegram ad because Play Store is slow, then creates a seed inside it. What is the lab verdict?

- A. APKs are faster so they are preferred
- B. Treat it as a clone risk — uninstall, install from the official store with matched publisher, and do not reuse those words
- C. The academy can certify the APK if they paste the seed
- D. Creating a new seed inside a clone is always safe

Correct answer: B

Q2. Ngozi is asked by a webpage to paste her twelve words to “mark the backup lesson complete.” What should she do?

- A. Paste them; official-looking course pages are part of Basic
- B. Refuse — this academy never requires a seed paste; prove backup on the official app and paper
- C. Paste only eight words as a compromise
- D. Share screen so a mentor can type them for her

Correct answer: B

Q3. Yusuf withdraws BNB from an exchange but picks the wrong network. His BSC wallet is unchanged. What is the adult next step?

- A. Paste the seed into a recovery bot so they can hop the coins to BSC
- B. Read the withdrawal record, do not type the seed, and treat rescue as an exchange story — next tiny test must be BNB on BNB Smart Chain
- C. Approve unlimited on a “bridge” ad
- D. Send Crystal Stones to the exchange to unlock the BNB

Correct answer: B

Q4. You add Crystal Stones using 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00 and the balance is 0. Did the lab fail?

- A. Yes — a real add always airdrops tokens
- B. No — adding is viewing; a zero can be an honest pass, and this academy did not tell you to buy
- C. Yes — you must Approve a claim site
- D. No, but you should send BNB to the contract to activate it

Correct answer: B

Q5. A WhatsApp blast says your academy allocation is waiting. Connect and Approve to claim. What is true?

- A. It is Module 6’s required last step
- B. This course did not allocate tokens; Connect-and-Approve to claim is not a lab step
- C. You should send 2FA to the blast so they credit BscScan
- D. the checkout processor will convert the claim into USDT automatically

Correct answer: B

Q6. Amaka’s confirm sheet shows last-6 digits that do not match her own receive screen during a self-send. What should she do?

- A. Confirm anyway because it is to herself
- B. Reject, copy again from the receive screen, and only then send — clipboard malware can swap even a self-send
- C. Type the seed into a checker to regenerate the right last 6
- D. Max-send so the malware gets less

Correct answer: B

Q7. After this course, which skill still waits for a later Basic course rather than being required here?

- A. Refusing a site that asks for your seed
- B. Exchange KYC, order books, and a first on-ramp buy
- C. Checking first and last 6 characters

D. Leaving a BNB gas reserve

Correct answer: B

Q8. Crystal Stones Academy will ask for your seed, private key, 2FA, or remote desktop when?

A. At graduation from this lab

B. Never

C. If your BscScan row is missing

D. If you fail a quiz twice

Correct answer: B

Exchanges & Your First Buy

BASIC TRACK | slug: exchanges-first-buy | level: beginner | FREE

The third Basic course. An exchange is a company with its own ledger, not the blockchain. You will learn how a CEX account works, how KYC and 2FA actually protect you, how naira or other local money becomes a book-entry, how a first spot buy is sized, why BNB is needed for BNB Smart Chain gas, and how to withdraw on the correct network without vanishing the stack. Education only — this is not a buy order for any token, including Crystal Stones. Academy checkout, when live, is USDT on BNB Smart Chain (BEP-20) through academy checkout, not a chat wallet.

Module 1: What an exchange actually is

An exchange is a company with a ledger. Separate the website, the account, the order book, and the chain. Spot pairs, fees, and IOUs versus coins you can withdraw.

Lesson 1: The exchange is a company, not the blockchain (26 min)

The exchange is a company, not the blockchain

Most people meet crypto through an **exchange**, not through a seed phrase. That is normal. It is also where a lot of confusion starts, because the screen looks like a wallet and is not one.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to say, in your own words, what you actually own when a balance sits on Binance — an example of a centralised exchange, not “the only real one” — or on any similar platform, and what you do **not** own yet. The first heavy word is **exchange**: a company that keeps its own ledger of who is owed what, matches buyers and sellers, and sometimes sends coins on a public chain when you ask it to withdraw.

Four objects, with a company in the middle

In the wallets course you named four objects: app, device lock, keys, chain. On an exchange the picture is different. Smash them together and you will later swear “the blockchain stole my money” when a company froze a row in a database.

1. The website or app

The branded product. It can be cloned. Bookmark the official domain the same way you bookmark a bank. Do not arrive through a sponsored ad, a Telegram button, or a “login to claim” SMS. The app is a company product. Products have outages, updates, and fake twins.

2. Your account

Email plus password plus whatever extra lock you add. This is a **login**, not a seed. Resetting a password is possible. That is a feature of a company. It is also a door for SIM-swap and email-takeover attacks. If you lose the login, you write to support. If you lose a seed, there is no support. Different objects.

3. The company's ledger

The number you see — “12 USDT”, “0.02 BNB” — is a row in **their** database. They owe you, under their terms. They can freeze a withdrawal. They can halt a ticker. They can get hacked. The row is an **IOU**: an “I owe you,” a promise recorded in their book, not a coin sitting in an address whose keys you hold.

4. The chain

The public book — BNB Smart Chain, Ethereum, Tron, and the rest. You only touch it when you **deposit** (send from a wallet into their address) or **withdraw** (they send from their address to yours). Until then, you are not on-chain. BscScan will not show your name. It has never heard of your email.

Object	What it is	If it fails
Exchange app	A company product	Phishing clone, outage, fake APK
Account login	Identity the company recognises	Password reset theft, 2FA loss
Exchange balance	An IOU in their ledger	Freeze, insolvency, ticker halt
On-chain coins	Entries on BNB Smart Chain or another book	Only after a completed withdrawal

Why this design exists

Exchanges exist because a public chain does not take naira from a GTBank app, dollars from a card, or euros from a SEPA transfer. Someone has to:

- collect local currency through banks, cards, or other people
- keep an **order book** so a buyer and a seller can meet
- hold inventory of crypto
- send you coins when you withdraw, after their risk team says yes

That someone is a **business**. Businesses have licenses in some countries, grey areas in others, terms of service, support tickets, and failure modes. Treating an exchange like “the blockchain” is how people are shocked when a withdrawal is delayed for compliance, or when a company pauses a ticker, or when a hack empties a hot wallet and customers wait in a queue of creditors.

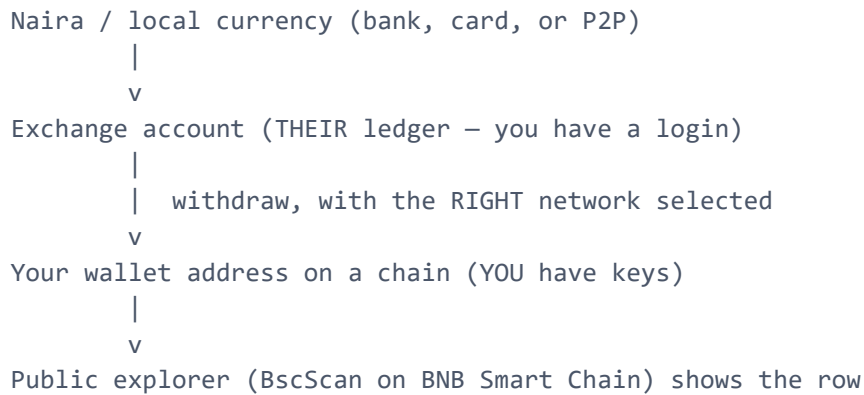
A bank is also a company with a ledger. You already live with that. The new skill is seeing the same shape in a crypto app that uses the word “wallet” on a button.

Worked scenario. Chinedu buys 50 USDT on an exchange using naira. The app shows 50 USDT. He tells a group “I now hold USDT on BNB Smart Chain.” He does not — not yet.

280. His naira left his bank and arrived, through P2P or a deposit corridor, as a credit on the exchange.
281. The exchange's internal book says they owe him 50 USDT.
282. There is no BscScan row with his personal address.
283. Self-custody starts when a **withdrawal** lands on an address whose keys he holds.
284. Until that row exists on the chain he chose, he has a company promise, not a coin.

If the company is honest and online, the promise is useful. If the company is frozen, insolvent, or phished through his login, the promise is a support ticket.

DIAGRAM



Named examples are examples, not a shopping list

This course will name Binance, Trust Wallet, BscScan, USDT, BNB, and Crystal Stones because students will meet those words. Naming them is not an endorsement and not an instruction to open an account today. If a platform is banned, slow, or untrusted in your country, the **ideas** still apply: company ledger, pair, fee, network, test send.

Crystal Stones, as a BEP-20 token on BNB Smart Chain, may or may not appear on any given exchange. Listing is a business decision. It is not proof of quality. You will learn to buy **practice** amounts of widely used assets — usually USDT and a little BNB for gas — so you can later move value on BNB Smart Chain. That is a skills path. It is not “buy Crystal Stones on this page.”

The public contract, to **verify** only, never as a buy order, is:

0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00

If a chat pastes a different address with the same name, it is a different object.

What “the exchange got hacked” actually means

When a CEX is hacked, the thief usually stole keys to **the company’s** hot wallet, not your seed — you never had a seed on that platform. Customer balances are rows. The company must decide, under law and their terms, who they still owe. That can take months. Insurance, if any, is their product, not a law of the chain.

This is why “not your keys, not your coins” is a slogan with a precise meaning: until withdrawal, you are a customer, not a key-holder. The slogan does not mean “never use an exchange.” It means know which layer you are on.

ACADEMY NOTE Academy staff will never DM you a “special deposit address” for tuition or a listing. Intermediate and Advanced tuition, when you reach it, goes through the academy’s published checkout: the checkout processor, paid in USDT on BEP-20. Not Crystal Stone token. Not PaynovaX. Not a wallet pasted in WhatsApp. An exchange login is not a seed, and nobody here will ask for either.

What this lesson is for

You are here so that “I have 50 USDT on the app” stops meaning “I have 50 USDT on BNB Smart Chain.” Those sentences describe two books. Mixing them is how people panic, get recovered by thieves, and blame the wrong layer.

Say this out loud

- An exchange is a company with its own ledger, not the blockchain.
- An exchange balance is an IOU until a withdrawal confirms on-chain.
- The app is not the chain. The login is not a seed.
- Deposit and withdraw are the moments you actually touch a public book.
- Naming a platform is not a buy order, and Crystal Stones is not on this page as a shopping list.

Next: the two big families — centralized and decentralized — and why beginners almost always start on a CEX.

Lesson 2: CEX versus DEX, without slogans (26 min)

CEX versus DEX, without slogans

People argue “CEX bad, DEX freedom.” That argument skips the job each one does. You need both words, defined, before you pick a door with naira in your pocket.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to say what a **CEX** is, what a **DEX** is, why someone with only local currency usually needs a CEX first, and why “Connect Wallet” is not automatically safer. PancakeSwap will be mentioned only as a DEX you are not using yet.

CEX — centralized exchange

A **CEX** is a company. You create an account. You usually pass **KYC** (Know Your Customer — they record who you are). You send naira or a card payment, or you use **P2P** (peer-to-peer: another user pays your bank, the company releases crypto). You trade on **their** matching engine. You withdraw when they allow it.

Binance is an example of a centralised exchange. So are many others. This course is not an advert for any of them. The shape is what you need: company, account, IOU, optional on-chain send later.

Strengths for a beginner:

- a door for local currency (bank, card, or P2P)
- password reset exists
- customer support exists (slowly)
- you can practise buying without holding a seed yet
- liquid pairs so a tiny market buy is usually boring

Costs:

- they can freeze you
- a phishing site can steal the login

- if the company fails, you are a creditor
- you are not in self-custody until withdrawal
- they can halt a ticker or pause withdrawals during chaos

None of that makes a CEX “fake crypto.” It makes it a **custodian**: they hold the keys to the coins that back (or are supposed to back) the IOUs on their screen.

DEX — decentralized exchange

A **DEX** is software on a chain. Uniswap on Ethereum is one family. PancakeSwap on BNB Smart Chain is a DEX you are not using yet. There is no account in the CEX sense. You **connect a wallet**. You swap token A for token B by signing a transaction. The pool is a **smart contract** — a program on the chain that holds liquidity and follows published rules.

Strengths:

- no company signup for the swap itself
- you already had to have coins on that chain
- the trade settles on-chain; you can look up the hash

Costs:

- you need a wallet and gas (BNB on BSC)
- a fake DEX domain will drain you
- **approvals** can be unlimited (the Safety course covers this in full)
- no help desk if you sign the wrong thing
- price impact on thin pools can wreck a small trade
- it generally cannot collect naira

A DEX does not “know your name.” That is not a moral halo. It also means the contract will not parent you.

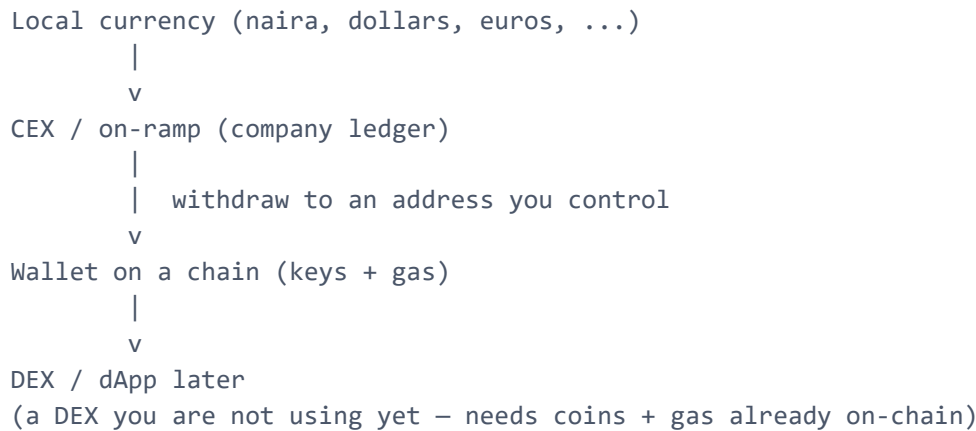
Question	CEX	DEX
Who holds keys during the trade?	The company	You
How do you get naira in?	Bank, card, P2P	You generally cannot; you arrive with crypto
Can they freeze you?	Yes	The contract will not “know you”; scams still can empty you
Beginner first buy of USDT with local money?	This is the usual door	Usually the wrong door
Where is the receipt?	Their order history	A transaction hash on an explorer

Worked scenario. Amaka hears “just swap on PancakeSwap, KYC is slavery.” She has only naira in a bank.

285. PancakeSwap cannot collect that naira. There is no “pay with GTBank” button on the chain.
286. She would still need a CEX, a P2P seller, or some other on-ramp first.
287. Even after she had USDT on-chain, she would need BNB for gas to swap.
288. The slogan skipped the plumbing. She has not failed. The advice failed.

289. When she later meets a DEX in Intermediate, she will already know she is signing away tokens from a wallet she controls — a different risk than a CEX login.

DIAGRAM



Hybrid screens that pretend to be both

Some exchange apps show a swap button that is actually their internal ledger. Some open a browser into a DEX. Read which one you are in.

If there is no on-chain transaction hash you can paste into BscScan, you did not use a DEX. You used a company. That is allowed. It is not “decentralized” because the button said Swap.

Some wallets offer a “buy crypto” button that opens a third-party on-ramp. That third party is another company: KYC, fees, delays. The wallet did not become a bank. It linked one.

Order of operations in this academy

- 290. Learn the CEX as a tool (this course).
- 291. Withdraw a **practice** amount to a wallet you control — only after the Wallets course habits are in your hands, not in a group chat.
- 292. Later courses treat DEX, liquidity, and token listings as a separate skill. You will not skip to a PancakeSwap ticker because a group called it “the Crystal Stones pool.”

A DEX listing is not a blessing. Anyone can create a BEP-20 and add a pool with a similar name. Verifying the Crystal Stones contract `0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00` on BscScan is the adult check. A pancake UI screenshot is not. This academy will not tell you to buy that token, on a CEX or a DEX.

Custody is a sliding scale, not a personality

You can:

- keep practice size on a CEX while you learn
- withdraw what you intend to hold yourself
- leave nothing on an exchange you do not have a reason to leave

“Not your keys” is a layer description, not a purity contest. Adults use companies and self-custody for different jobs, the same way they use banks and cash.

ACADEMY NOTE A DEX you are not using yet is still a thing you must be able to name, so a group cannot shame you into connecting a wallet this week. Connect Wallet on a DEX is not “safer by default.” It is a different risk: you can lose coins with one signature and no ticket number.

What this lesson is for

You should now be able to look at a screen and say “this is a company IOU” or “this is a wallet signature,” and refuse slogans that skip the on-ramp.

Say this out loud

- CEX means company, account, on-ramp, IOU until withdraw.
- DEX means on-chain program, wallet signature, no naira door.
- Beginners usually need a CEX first because they start with local currency.
- Connect Wallet on a DEX is not safer by default. It is a different risk.
- PancakeSwap is a DEX you are not using yet — not this course’s first buy.

Next: what you are actually looking at when the screen says BNB/USDT.

Lesson 3: Spot, pairs, and what a price is (26 min)

Spot, pairs, and what a price is

An exchange does not sell “crypto” as one product. It sells **pairs**. If you cannot read a pair, you cannot know what you paid.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to open a spot screen, name the base and the quote, say what bid, ask, last, and spread mean, and refuse the sentence “the price is X” as if the world had one official number. A **spot** market means: you buy or sell the asset now, for settlement on that platform’s books, not a bet on future price with borrowed money.

Spot is now. Leverage is a different sport

Spot = you pay with money you have on the platform, you receive a book-entry of the asset. If you buy 0.01 BNB with USDT, your USDT IOU shrinks and your BNB IOU grows, after fees.

Futures, margin, “100x,” perpetuals are how beginners donate money to the house. They are bets with leverage: borrowed size, liquidations, funding rates. This course is **spot only**. We name the other buttons so you can walk past them. An academy that hides the casino floor is how students fall in.

If a screen offers “cross,” “isolated,” “leverage,” or “futures,” you are not in the lesson you think you are in. Leave.

A pair is a price tag in another asset

BNB/USDT means: the price of one BNB, measured in USDT.

If the last trade was 600, one BNB cost 600 USDT **on that exchange, at that second**. Another exchange can show 599. A DEX pool can show 603. There is no single official world price. There are **venues**.

Base is the thing being priced (BNB). **Quote** is the measuring stick (USDT).

If you have naira and you want USDT, you are looking for a **USDT/NGN** (or NGN/USDT) door, or a P2P advert priced in naira — not a BNB chart. In other countries the quote might be USD, EUR, GBP, or a local currency the venue lists. Same idea: read both sides of the pair.

Pair	You are buying or selling	You are paying or receiving
BNB/USDT	BNB	USDT
ETH/USDT	ETH	USDT
USDT/NGN	USDT	Naira (on venues that list NGN)
BTC/USDT	BTC	USDT
A random TOKEN/USDT	That token	USDT — only if you meant to

Bid, ask, last, and the spread

The **bid** is what buyers are currently offering. The **ask** (or offer) is what sellers want. The **last** is the last trade that already happened. Last is history. It is not a promise that you can trade there now.

The **spread** is the gap between bid and ask. On a busy USDT pair the spread is tiny. On a thin token the spread is a trap: you “buy at 1.00” and can only sell at 0.92 immediately. That is not “the market crashed.” That is you paying the spread.

A **candle** is a picture of trades at one venue over a time bucket: open, high, low, close. It is not prophecy. This academy will not teach you to read candlesticks as a fortune. A screenshot of a green candle is a screenshot.

Worked scenario. A group screenshot shows Crystal Stones “pumping 40%.”

- 293. The screenshot is a 1-minute candle on a low-liquidity pair, possibly on a DEX you are not using yet.
- 294. The ask is one size. The bid is another. The last trade was a tiny print.
- 295. A market buy of a few hundred dollars would move the price against the buyer. That move is **price impact**, not a gift.
- 296. The chart lied by omission. Liquidity is part of the price.
- 297. Even if the ticker text says Crystal Stones, the contract on BNB Smart Chain must match ``0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00`` or it is a different object. This academy still will not tell you to buy it.

DIAGRAM

What the chart shows : last trade in a pair at one venue
 What you pay : last + spread + taker fee + later withdrawal fee
 What you hold after : a book-entry (CEX) or a token (DEX)

Price on a screenshot is not money in your control

Tickers are not contracts

Many tokens reuse names. “USDT” on that exchange might be:

- a book-entry the exchange calls USDT, redeemable as several on-chain flavours when you withdraw
- or a specific network’s USDT once you pick a withdrawal network

“Crystal Stones” on a random DEX is **not** automatically the project contract. Always match the address on BNB Smart Chain. If the ticker text matches and the contract does not, it is a different object. Logos are cheap. Contracts are the name.

The same warning applies to “BNB.” On a CEX, BNB is usually their IOU for the native coin of BNB Smart Chain. On a random chain, a token named BNB can be a toy. Read the network.

What a price is, said slowly

A price is **the last agreed exchange rate on that venue, for that pair, at that moment, for the size that actually traded**. It is not:

- the number on a paid Telegram channel
- the number on CoinMarketCap delayed by minutes
- the number you wish you had clicked
- a guarantee you can enter or exit there with your size

When people say “the market,” they usually mean a soup of venues. Your fill happens on one of them.

ACADEMY NOTE This academy will not teach you to read candlesticks as prophecy. A candle is a history of trades at one venue. It is not a promise. Education only — not a buy order for BNB, USDT, Crystal Stones, or anything else.

Venue price is not oracle price

Some apps show a “global” price pulled from a data company. That number can be useful as a glance. It is not the price you will get on the pair you are about to click. The fill happens on **this** venue’s book, plus **this** venue’s fee.

If a widget says USDT is 1.000 and your P2P seller wants 1,640 naira, you are not being cheated by mathematics. You are looking at two markets: a dollar-ish token on international venues, and a local naira door with its own spread. Speak both numbers. Do not average them in your head and call the difference theft.

When Crystal Stones appears as a widget somewhere, the same rule applies: a displayed number is not a bid you can exit on, and this academy is still not telling you to buy it.

What this lesson is for

You should now be able to look at a pair, name both sides, and treat “the price” as a venue fact plus spread plus fees — not a global truth.

Say this out loud

- Spot means now, with money you have. Leverage is a later, optional, dangerous topic — not this course.
- A pair prices one asset in another. Read both sides.
- Bid, ask, last, and spread are different numbers. Last is history.
- Ticker text is not a contract address.
- A screenshot of a candle is not money in your control.

Next: fees, so “I bought at the chart price” stops being a sentence you use.

Lesson 4: Fees, spread, and the price you actually paid (25 min)

Fees, spread, and the price you actually paid

Beginners compare chart prices and ignore the bill. The bill has several lines. Miss one and you think the exchange “stole” 2 USDT.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to name every line that sits between naira (or dollars, or euros) in a bank and coins you can actually move, and you should refuse the sentence “I bought at the chart price.” The heavy word is **all-in price**: what left your life, minus what you still control, including spread, trading fee, withdrawal fee, and later gas.

The fee stack on a CEX

1. Deposit / P2P / card cost

Your bank may charge. A card corridor may charge. A P2P seller’s naira price already includes **their** spread. If USDT is 1,610 naira on a blog and your seller wants 1,640, the 30 naira is a fee by another name. In a country with bank transfers or cards into an exchange, the corridor itself has FX markup, weekend delays, and sometimes a percentage. Same idea, different plumbing.

2. Trading fee

Maker and **taker**. A **taker** hits a resting order (a market buy is usually taker). A **maker** rests an order on the book. Beginners using market buttons pay taker fees. It is a percentage of the trade. Small, until you trade often. VIP schedules, BNB discounts, and coupon weeks are marketing. Learn the line on **your** receipt first.

3. Spread

Covered last lesson. On liquid USDT pairs, small. On exotic tokens, large. Spread is not printed as “fee” on some screens. It still left your pocket.

4. Withdrawal fee

A flat or percentage charge when coins leave the company to a chain. For USDT on BNB Smart Chain this is often modest. For USDT on Ethereum it can be ugly because **gas** is expensive and the exchange prices that in. This is one reason this academy standardises thinking on **BEP-20 / BNB Smart Chain** for practice — not because other networks are fake, because the fee behaviour is more beginner-survivable.

5. Network gas after you leave

Once USDT is in your wallet, moving it again costs **BNB** for gas on BSC. If you withdraw only USDT and zero BNB, you can be stuck looking at a balance you cannot move. You will buy a little BNB on purpose. That BNB is part of the first-buy cost, even if you did not think of it as a “fee.”

Line	When it hits	How to see it
P2P / on-ramp spread	When local money becomes a book-entry	Compare several adverts or corridor quotes; do not worship one screenshot
Bank or card charge	When fiat leaves your account	Bank SMS, card statement, FX markup
Trading fee	When you click buy or sell	Fee schedule + order receipt
Spread	During the trade	Bid versus ask
Withdrawal fee	When you leave	Withdrawal screen, before you confirm
Gas	On-chain moves later	Wallet estimate; needs BNB on BSC

Worked scenario. Tunde “buys 100 USDT.”

298. He pays 164,000 naira to a P2P seller whose advert was 1,640. A blog said 1,610. The 30 naira per unit is the on-ramp spread.

299. He then market-buys a tiny alt, pays a 0.1% taker fee, and pays a wide spread on a thin book.

300. He withdraws USDT on ERC-20 “because the letters look serious.”

301. The withdrawal fee plus Ethereum gas eats a painful chunk of a 100 USDT stack.

302. He writes “crypto is a scam.” Several of those lines were **choices**, not physics. The chain did not pick ERC-20 for him.

DIAGRAM

```

Local money
  -> P2P / bank / card spread
  -> CEX book-entry
  -> trading fee + spread
  -> withdrawal fee
  -> on-chain gas (BNB on BSC)
= what you still control

```

How to read a withdrawal screen

Before you confirm a withdraw, the screen must answer:

- **Asset** (USDT is not BNB)
- **Network** (BEP-20 / BSC is not ERC-20 is not TRC-20)
- **Destination address** (yours, copied from your wallet on that network)
- **Amount you send** versus **amount they receive**
- **Fee**

If any line is fuzzy, do not confirm. A 1 USDT or smallest-allowed **test send** exists for this reason. Module 5 is the ritual.

Cheap plus wrong network is not cheap. Paying a slightly higher withdrawal fee on the **correct** network is cheaper than a perfect fee on the wrong one.

What “zero fee” usually hides

Promotions that say “zero trading fees” often keep spread, withdrawal fees, and P2P markup. A pair with “zero maker fees” can still hurt a taker. Read the receipt, not the banner.

Card buys inside an app are famous for this: a comfortable button, a painful all-in FX rate. If you cannot see the all-in price before you confirm, you are not shopping. You are being billed.

ACADEMY NOTE Nobody in this academy is graded on getting the absolute cheapest fee. You are graded on not vanishing the stack. A slightly worse rate inside a platform with escrow is often cheaper than a “best rate” on WhatsApp with no parent. Academy paid-track checkout, when live, is USDT on BNB Smart Chain (BEP-20) through academy checkout — a published rail, not a discounted chat wallet.

Write the all-in on paper once

Before you call a fill “fine,” write four numbers:

303. Local currency that left your bank (or card).
304. USDT IOU that appeared (or crypto IOU).
305. Trading fee plus estimated spread on any conversion.
306. Planned withdrawal fee plus a little BNB for later gas.

Divide (1) by what you will still control after (4). That is your real rate. If you cannot write the four numbers, you are not ready to compare this CEX to a WhatsApp desk. The desk will always quote one pretty number and hide the rest.

VIP fee tiers, referral codes, and “zero maker” months are optional later. First-buy literacy is the four lines. A cheaper taker fee on the wrong network is still the expensive choice.

What this lesson is for

You should be able to reconstruct the all-in price of a first buy on paper, including the BNB you will need later, without calling the missing USDT “theft.”

Say this out loud

- Chart price is not the bill. The bill is spread plus fees plus later gas.
- Withdrawal fee and gas are part of the first-buy cost.
- On BSC you will need BNB to move tokens later. That BNB is not optional decoration.
- Cheap plus wrong network is not cheap.
- “Zero fee” usually moved the cost to another line.

Next: the last distinction in this module — an IOU you cannot spend on-chain versus coins you can withdraw.

Lesson 5: Custodial IOUs versus coins you can withdraw (26 min)

Custodial IOUs versus coins you can withdraw

The most expensive confusion in beginner crypto is this: the number on an exchange screen is treated as coins in a wallet. It is not. It is a **custodial IOU**.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to point at a balance and say whether you are a customer of a company or a key-holder on a chain, what “withdraw” actually does, and why “I bought, so it is in my wallet already” is false. **Custody** means: who holds the keys that can sign a spend.

Custodial means they hold the keys

When you buy USDT on a CEX, the company (or their custodian bank of wallets) holds the private keys to large addresses. Your 50 USDT is a row: “this customer is owed 50.” Thousands of customers can be owed USDT that sits, pooled, in a handful of on-chain addresses the company controls.

That design is how exchanges stay fast. Internal trades do not hit the chain. They rewrite rows. That is also why BscScan does not show your email.

Non-custodial (self-custody) means: keys you control can sign. The wallets course trained that habit. This course does not replace it. Moving from IOU to wallet is Module 6, and only after those habits.

What you can do with an IOU

With an exchange balance you can typically:

- trade it for another IOU on that platform (spot)
- sometimes send it to another user of the **same** platform (internal transfer — still their ledger)
- request a **withdrawal** to an address on a chain

You cannot:

- paste the exchange screen into BscScan and find “your” coins
- sign a DEX swap with that balance
- pay on-chain gas from a CEX USDT row without withdrawing
- prove to a stranger that you “hold” a token on-chain

Internal transfers feel like blockchain sends. They are chat between two rows. No public hash. If the company reverses them, the chain was never involved.

State	Where the coins live	What you hold	Who can freeze it
Funded, not withdrawn	Company wallets, pooled	An IOU	The company, courts, their risk team
Withdrawn, confirmed	The chain you chose	Coins at your address	Nobody’s help desk; the keys decide
Stuck on a withdrawal	In flight, or already on a chain	A ticket plus an explorer lookup	Mix of company process and chain finality
Wrong-network send	A chain you were not watching	Maybe recoverable, often painful	Panic does not help

Worked scenario. Fatima buys 80 USDT and 0.03 BNB on an example CEX. She screenshots the balances and posts “I’m on-chain now.”

- 307. She is not. Both numbers are IOUs.
- 308. She starts a USDT withdrawal on BEP-20 to her Trust Wallet — an example of a wallet app, not an endorsement — address on BNB Smart Chain.
- 309. After confirmations, BscScan shows a token transfer to her address. Now that slice is on-chain.
- 310. The BNB still on the exchange is still an IOU. Two books, two truths.
- 311. If she then tells a group “the exchange and BscScan disagree,” they should. She has not withdrawn the BNB yet.

DIAGRAM

```
[ CEX database ]
  Fatima: 80 USDT IOU
  Fatima: 0.03 BNB IOU
      |
      | withdraw USDT BEP-20
      v
[ BNB Smart Chain ]
  Fatima's 0x address: 80 USDT (BEP-20)
  Fatima's 0x address: 0 BNB   (until she also withdraws BNB)
```

Two screens. They SHOULD disagree until both withdrawals land.

Withdrawal is a company sending from their keys to yours

A withdrawal is not “download my coins.” It is:

- 312. You ask the company to reduce your IOU.
- 313. Their risk engine checks KYC, limits, whitelist, travel-rule data, fraud flags.
- 314. If yes, they sign an on-chain transaction from **their** address to **yours**.
- 315. The chain includes it. Explorers show it.
- 316. Their database marks your row down.

If step 2 says no, nothing hit the chain. You still have (or had) an IOU and a ticket. “The blockchain is slow” is the wrong sentence. The company has not broadcast yet.

Insolvency, halts, and why size still matters

If a company cannot honour withdrawals, customers become creditors. That has happened to platforms with huge brands. This academy is not predicting any named firm will fail. It is telling you the legal shape: an IOU is a claim, not a UTXO.

Practice size is how adults sleep. You do not need to withdraw every unit the hour you buy. You do need to know that un-withdrawn size is company risk plus login risk.

ACADEMY NOTE “I bought so it is in my wallet already” is the misconception this module exists to kill. A wallet you control is an address whose keys you hold. An exchange spot buy is a row. Academy checkout, when live, is USDT on BNB Smart Chain (BEP-20) through academy checkout to a published flow — still not “your exchange screenshot is payment.”

Why internal books exist, without romance

Matching trades on-chain for every tiny fill would be slow and expensive. Companies keep an internal book so that 10,000 customers can buy and sell USDT with each other without 10,000 BscScan rows. That convenience is the product. The cost is that you are waiting on their solvency, their support hours, and their risk engine.

You may keep practice size as IOU while you finish Wallets habits. You may withdraw when the destination is ready. Both are allowed. What is not allowed is pointing at the IOU and telling a group you are “on BSC now.” Words are part of safety. Wrong words recruit helpers.

What this lesson is for

You should now be able to hear “I have USDT” and ask the only adult follow-up: **where?** Company book, or which chain?

Say this out loud

- A custodial balance is an IOU. Coins you can spend on-chain start after a withdrawal confirms.
- Internal transfers on an exchange are still their ledger.
- Withdrawal is the company signing from their keys to yours, after their risk engine says yes.
- Exchange screen and explorer should disagree until you withdraw.
- This is still not a buy order for Crystal Stones or any other ticker.

Next module: the account itself — arriving at the real site, KYC, 2FA, and the humans who will try to talk the door open.

Module quiz (answers included for editors)

Q1. Ada sees 50 USDT on a centralized exchange. What does she actually have?

- A. Fifty USDT already sitting in her personal BscScan address
- B. An IOU in the company’s ledger until a withdrawal confirms on-chain
- C. A seed phrase the exchange mailed her
- D. Proof she holds Crystal Stones

Correct answer: B

Q2. Self-custody on an exchange starts when?

- A. You finish KYC
- B. You enable 2FA
- C. A withdrawal arrives at an address whose keys you hold
- D. You screenshot a green candle

Correct answer: C

Q3. A DEX like PancakeSwap is a poor first door for someone who only has naira because?

- A. DEXes are illegal everywhere
- B. It generally cannot collect naira; you must already have crypto and gas on that chain
- C. It requires a university degree
- D. It only lists Bitcoin

Correct answer: B

Q4. In the pair BNB/USDT, USDT is?

- A. The base asset being priced
- B. A gas token on Bitcoin
- C. The quote asset — the measuring stick
- D. Crystal Stones' contract

Correct answer: C

Q5. The spread is?

- A. A government tax on every Nigerian
- B. The gap between bid and ask, which is part of the real price you pay
- C. The withdrawal password
- D. A type of seed phrase

Correct answer: B

Q6. Why might you withdraw USDT on BNB Smart Chain (BEP-20) for practice instead of Ethereum (ERC-20)?

- A. ERC-20 is fake
- B. BSC withdrawal and later gas costs are typically more beginner-survivable; Ethereum gas can dominate a small stack
- C. BEP-20 cannot be stolen
- D. The academy forbids every other network

Correct answer: B

Q7. A ticker named Crystal Stones on a random DEX is the project token when?

- A. The name matches
- B. The logo is purple
- C. The contract on BNB Smart Chain matches 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00
- D. A Telegram admin said so

Correct answer: C

Q8. Which sentence is true after a spot buy on a CEX, before any withdrawal?

- A. The coins are already in your wallet because you clicked Buy
- B. The exchange screen and the chain should match immediately
- C. You hold a custodial IOU; the chain has not credited your personal address
- D. BscScan now lists your email as owner

Correct answer: C

Module 2: Account, identity, and login security

The account is a door. Build it as if someone wants the door. Bookmarks, KYC, 2FA, whitelist, fake support, passkeys, and when to freeze.

Lesson 1: Arriving at the real site (bookmarks, ads, clones) (26 min)

Arriving at the real site (bookmarks, ads, clones)

The most expensive click in this course is not “Buy.” It is **Login** on a fake domain.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to describe how you will open an exchange for the rest of your life, why ads and chat links are hostile until proven, and what to do if you already typed a password into a maybe-fake page. **Phishing** means: a fake page or app that looks like the real company, built to capture your login, your 2FA code, or both, in real time.

The bookmark ritual

Do this on a calm day, from a device you trust, before you have money on the account.

- 317. Type the brand into a search engine **once**, or better, use a URL you verified from more than one independent source — the company’s official X account, a long-standing app-store listing, documentation you already trust. Do not treat the first sponsored result as the company.
- 318. Check the domain character by character. `binance.com` is not `binance.com.security-login.ru`. A hyphen, an extra word, a unicode lookalike, a `.net` instead of `.com` — all of these have emptied accounts. Binance is an example of a centralised exchange here, not a command to use it.
- 319. Bookmark it.
- 320. Forever after, open the bookmark. Do not use the ad. Do not use the SMS. Do not use the pinned Telegram “login helper.”

The ritual feels fussy until the day you are panicked. Panic is when clones convert.

Arrival method	Verdict
Bookmark you saved on a calm day	Default
Official app from the real Apple / Google store listing you verified	Acceptable; still check the publisher name
Sponsored search ad	Hostile until proven
Link in email “withdrawals paused, login”	Hostile
Link in WhatsApp from “support”	Hostile
QR code on a flyer at a meetup you did not organise	Hostile until you type the domain yourself

Worked scenario. A student searches “Binance login,” taps the first ad, lands on a page that looks perfect, types email, password, and the authenticator code.

321. The phish relays the code in real time to the real site.
322. The student is logged in on the attacker’s session.
323. The withdrawal whitelist is empty. The stack is gone in minutes.
324. The real platform later says: we see a login from another device.
325. The chain did nothing. The door was the ad. BscScan has no row called “stolen by Google Ads.”

DIAGRAM

```
Calm day: verify domain --> bookmark --> only that
Panic day: email / SMS / ad --> clone --> they have the session
```

```
The clone does not need your seed.
It needs the login plus the 2FA you type while scared.
```

Apps versus browsers

A phone app from the official store reduces some phishing (you do not type a URL). It does not remove:

- fake apps with similar names
- overlay malware that draws a fake login on top of the real app
- a support chat inside a cloned APK
- a “helper” who wants remote desktop “to install it for you”

Install count and publisher name matter. Side-loading an APK “because the group dropped it” is how wallet clones harvest seeds — and how exchange clones harvest logins. An exchange login is not a seed. Both are still secrets. Academy staff will never ask for either.

If you use a browser on a shared cybercafe computer, assume the password is burned when you stand up. Public machines are not a security model.

Homograph and subdomain tricks

Look carefully at:

- `xn--` domains (punycode) that render as familiar letters
- `login-brand.something-else.com` — the real brand is not the registrable domain
- extra words: `brand-wallet.com`, `brandweb3.net`
- URL shorteners in SMS

Read the address bar, not the logo. Logos are copy-paste.

If you already typed it

If you already typed a password into a maybe-fake page, treat it as burned.

- From a **different** device if you can, open the **bookmarked** real site
- Change the password

- Enable or rotate 2FA
- Check sessions and devices
- Check withdrawal whitelist
- Move funds if the account still exists and you still control it

Do not “see if they logged in.” Assume they did. Speed beats dignity.

ACADEMY NOTE Crystal Stones Academy will never send you a “login to keep your progress” link that is not the site you already bookmarked. We will never ask for an exchange password. If a message uses our name and wants a login, it is a clone of us, not us.

Shared phones, family, and “just login for me”

A second beginner hole: someone you trust wants to “show you how.” They take the phone, type the password, maybe screenshot 2FA “so it is easier next time.” You have just expanded the session to a person who can be phished later, or who can panic-send.

If you must learn with a relative in the room, they watch. They do not type. They do not photograph. They do not keep the SIM. A family member with your SMS 2FA is a SIM-swap with extra steps.

Also refuse “let me send you the login link I use.” Their bookmark is not yours. Their SMS is not yours. Build your own calm-day door.

Public Wi-Fi plus a browser exchange login is how cafe sessions linger. Prefer the official app after you verified the publisher, or wait until you are on a network you trust. Convenience is how clones convert on travel days.

What this lesson is for

You should have one boring door into any CEX you use, and a reflex that ads, emails, and chat buttons are not that door.

Say this out loud

- Bookmark the real domain on a calm day. That is how you arrive forever after.
- Ads, emails, and chat links are hostile until proven.
- A clone can relay 2FA in real time and steal the session without a seed.
- Fake apps exist in stores and especially outside them.
- If you typed a password on a maybe-fake page, treat it as burned and rotate from the bookmark.

Next: KYC — what you are actually handing over, and why this academy will not tell you to fake it.

Lesson 2: KYC without folklore (what it is for, what it is not) (26 min)

KYC without folklore (what it is for, what it is not)

KYC means Know Your Customer. The company records identity because regulators, banks, and their own risk team demand it.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to say what KYC is for from the company's side, what it does **not** guarantee for you, and why bought accounts and “helpers” who upload your ID are how people lose both money and a legal story. You will usually send a government ID, a selfie or liveness check, sometimes proof of address, and sometimes questions about source of funds if amounts grow.

What KYC is for (from the company's side)

- they want bank rails and licenses
- they want to refuse sanctioned names
- they want to show an auditor they tried
- they want a freeze handle if law enforcement asks
- they want to make card and bank partners less nervous

None of that is folklore. It is the price of connecting a crypto company to the banking system. You can dislike it. You still need to understand it.

In Nigeria this often collides with BVN, NIN, and bank-name matching. In other countries it collides with passports, tax IDs, and proof of address. The paperwork changes. The idea does not: the company wants a human they can name.

What KYC is not

- It is not a guarantee the company is honest
- It is not a guarantee your coins are safe
- It is not the same as self-custody
- It is not optional on many major CEX on-ramps, even if a Telegram thread says “KYC is slavery”
- It is not Crystal Stones Academy collecting your passport in a mentor chat

A licensed firm can still be hacked, slow, or rude. An unlicensed desk can still steal. KYC is identity, not insurance.

Using stolen IDs, bought “verification services,” or someone else's BVN is **fraud**. This academy will not help you do that. If a platform is not available in your country, that is a jurisdiction fact, not a puzzle to cheat.

Honest path	Dishonest path this course will not teach
Use a platform that serves your country, with your own documents	Bought KYC, VPN theatre to evade residency rules, cousin's ID
Stay small on P2P with your own bank account, understanding the risk	Money-mule accounts, “receive for me”
If you cannot use a major CEX, use a licensed local on-ramp or wait	Fake papers
Minimise how many platforms hold your ID	Post your ID selfie in a group “for help”

Worked scenario. A group sells “KYC done accounts.” The buyer gets an exchange login.

326. Months later the original identity files a complaint, or the real owner recovers email.
327. The account is frozen with the buyer's USDT inside.
328. The buyer has no legal story that does not start with “I bought a stolen identity.”

329. Support will not side with the person who is not the name on the file.

330. Do not do this. There is no academy workaround.

DIAGRAM

You --> exchange compliance (expected, under their terms)

You --> random helper in chat (how accounts get stolen)

Academy login email is not an exchange KYC pack

We still will not ask for your seed, your BVN, or your ID card in a mentor chat.

Privacy versus secrecy

You can still:

- minimise how many platforms hold your ID
- not post your ID selfie in a group
- not send KYC photos through WhatsApp “helpers” who offer to upload for you
- use a platform that actually serves your country rather than collecting five grey-market logins

A helper who wants your ID photos plus selfie plus SMS codes is not helping. They are taking the account.

Secrecy would mean hiding from the law. This academy will not teach that. **Privacy** means not broadcasting your documents to strangers who do not need them.

Source-of-funds questions at larger sizes are also not a personal insult. They are the company protecting their banking relationships. Answer honestly or do not use that corridor. Lying on those forms is another kind of fraud.

When KYC meets withdrawals

A completed KYC file is often what lets larger withdrawals through. It can also be what lets a freeze land on a named human. Both are true. If you want bank rails, you are visible to that company. If you want to be only a key on a chain, you withdraw — after the Wallets course habits — and you accept that the on-ramp still saw you.

ACADEMY NOTE Crystal Stones Academy collecting an email for login is not the same as an exchange KYC pack. We still will not ask for your seed, your BVN, or your ID card in a mentor chat. Paid-track checkout, when live, is USDT on BNB Smart Chain (BEP-20) through academy checkout, not a request for your passport in WhatsApp.

What happens to the pictures

Your ID images sit on the company’s servers, and often on a vendor that does liveness checks. That is a data-hold. It is not a reason to use a fake. It is a reason not to multiply copies: no WhatsApp helpers, no “KYC agent” Telegram, no posting a selfie-with-passport in a group to prove you are real.

If a platform is blocked in your country, the adult options are: use a platform that serves you, use a smaller local on-ramp that is actually allowed, or wait. VPN-plus-foreign-ID is how accounts get closed with the IOU inside. This academy will not map that maze.

Source-of-wealth questions at larger sizes can feel nosy. They are the banking system talking through the CEX. Answer or do not use that size. Do not invent a story about “consultancy” if the naira was a salary. Lies on those forms follow the KYC name — yours.

What this lesson is for

You should be able to complete or refuse KYC as an adult: your documents, their terms, no folklore, no rented identity.

Say this out loud

- KYC is identity for a company that holds an IOU. It does not make the IOU on-chain.
- KYC is not a honesty stamp and not insurance.
- Fake KYC is fraud, not a life hack.
- Nobody should upload your ID “for you” in chat.
- Privacy is not posting documents. Secrecy from the law is not this course.

Next: 2FA that actually changes the outcome.

Lesson 3: 2FA that actually works (authenticator vs SMS) (27 min)

2FA that actually works (authenticator vs SMS)

Two-factor authentication means: password is not enough. The second factor is something the thief should not also have.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to rank SMS, authenticator apps, and hardware keys, say why “SMS 2FA is enough” is a dangerous sentence, and describe how you will back up an authenticator secret without photographing it into WhatsApp. An exchange login is not a seed. 2FA is still a door into the company that holds your IOU.

SMS is better than nothing and worse than people think

A code sent to your phone number. Problems:

- **SIM swap**: someone convinces the mobile operator they are you, takes the number, receives the SMS
- SMS can be read by malware or by a cloned notification
- operators and “customer care” are social-engineering targets
- SS7 and related telecom attacks exist; you do not need the engineering, you need the conclusion

Use SMS if the platform offers nothing else. Do not stay there. In Nigeria, SIM-registration stories and “customer care” theatre make this more than a Western blog scare. In other countries the same attack has a different script: port-out fraud, prepaid swap, a call to the carrier with last-four of an ID.

SMS 2FA is not “enough.” It is a step above a password alone.

Authenticator apps (TOTP)

TOTP means time-based one-time password: Google Authenticator, Authy, Aegis, and similar generate a rotating code from a **secret** that was shown as a QR when you enabled 2FA. Trust Wallet and MetaMask are examples of wallet apps, not 2FA apps — do not confuse them. An authenticator is a code clock. A wallet holds keys.

Rules:

- screenshotting the QR into WhatsApp is how 2FA gets stolen
- if you lose the phone **and** have no backup of the 2FA secret, you are in a support queue to recover the exchange
- write the 2FA backup codes / seed **on paper**, store with the same seriousness as a wallet seed — it is not a chain seed, but it opens the company door
- cloud-backed authenticators are convenient and are another account to harden

The 2FA secret is not your wallet seed. Do not store them on the same photo roll titled “crypto.” If that roll leaks, the thief has the exchange and a map to the wallet.

Hardware keys (FIDO / passkeys)

YubiKey and similar. You tap a physical device. Phishing sites have a harder time relaying this, because the key checks the real domain. If the exchange supports it for login **and** for withdrawals, this is the adult setting. Module 2’s last lesson returns to passkeys and sessions.

Method	Protects against casual password leak?	Fails when
SMS	Somewhat	SIM swap, operator social engineering
Authenticator app	Yes, if the secret is not photographed into the cloud	Phone loss without backup; malware reading the screen; real-time phish if you type the code into a clone
Hardware key	Best of the common options	You lose the keys and the backup; you approve a prompt you did not understand

Worked scenario. A student’s exchange password leaks in an old data breach.

331. Attacker tries login. SMS 2FA is on, but the student’s mobile number is on a SIM registered with a weak “security question.”
332. SIM swap on a Friday. Weekend withdrawals empty the account.
333. Authenticator on a separate device, plus a **withdrawal whitelist** (next lesson), would have changed the story.
334. The chain did not fail. Telecom and a weak second factor failed.
335. “I had 2FA” is not a complete sentence. Which 2FA?

DIAGRAM

```
Password  --+
          +--> both required --> session
2FA      --+
```

If the 2FA lives on the same stolen phone as the email,
you built one door with two locks on the same hinge.

Separate the doors

Ideally:

- email password ≠ exchange password ≠ wallet PIN
- 2FA for email is not SMS on the same SIM as exchange SMS
- recovery codes on paper, not in the same Google account that receives the exchange email
- the phone that receives email is not the only copy of the authenticator

This is annoying. It is cheaper than an emptied account.

Disable 2FA only when the platform forces a reset, and only on the bookmarked site. A popup saying “2FA expired, turn off to continue” is a classic steal.

ACADEMY NOTE Academy staff will never ask you to read a 2FA code into a chat, a voice call, or a remote-desktop session. Real support does not need the code. A thief does. SMS 2FA is not enough; do not type any 2FA into a page you arrived at from panic.

Losing the phone without losing the account

Plan the ugly day. Phone in a motorcycle taxi. Authenticator gone.

If you wrote the TOTP backup codes on paper, you restore the authenticator on a new device and keep the exchange. If the only copy was the old phone and SMS is the fallback on the same SIM you also lost, you are in a support queue with KYC selfies. That queue is slow. It is still better than a thief with SMS.

So: paper backup of 2FA in a place that is not the phone. Second device if you can afford it. Email 2FA not on the same SIM. This is housekeeping, not paranoia. People skip it because the QR was annoying on day one. Day one is when you still have time.

A password manager can store TOTP if you already trust that manager with a strong master password and its own 2FA. Do not invent a new cloud just for this. Do not put TOTP in the same camera roll as a wallet seed.

What this lesson is for

You should leave SMS as a stopgap, turn on an authenticator with a paper backup, and stop saying “I have 2FA” as if all second factors were equal.

Say this out loud

- SMS 2FA loses to SIM swap. It is not enough.
- Authenticator is the minimum grown-up setting. Backup the secret on paper.

- Do not type 2FA into a page you arrived at from panic. Clones relay codes in real time.
- Do not store the 2FA QR next to a wallet seed in the same camera roll.
- Hardware keys beat typed codes when the platform offers them.

Next: withdrawal whitelist, anti-phishing codes, and device lists.

Lesson 4: Withdrawal whitelist, anti-phishing codes, device list (26 min)

Withdrawal whitelist, anti-phishing codes, device list

Login theft is not the end of the story unless withdrawals are easy. You want withdrawals to be **sticky**.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to turn on three controls that turn a stolen session into a race you can still win: an address whitelist, an anti-phishing code, and a habit of reading the device list. A

withdrawal whitelist means: the company will only send coins to addresses you already approved, often after a delay when you add a new one.

Withdrawal address whitelist

Many CEX let you lock withdrawals to **known addresses** you control. Adding a new address emails you and waits (often 24 hours). A thief who has today's session still cannot send to their address until that delay passes — time for you to see the email and freeze.

Practical academy setup:

336. Create your self-custody address on BNB Smart Chain (you did this conceptually in the wallets course).
337. After a **tiny** test, whitelist **that** address for USDT and for BNB.
338. Leave whitelist **on**. The inconvenience is the feature.

If you need a new address, you wait. That wait is cheaper than a drain. Never whitelist an address a "broker," "mentor," or "academy agent" posted. If someone wants to be paid, they can wait for a test send you initiated to an address **you** verified. Intermediate tuition is not collected by a new wallet in a DM. When paid tracks go live, checkout is USDT on BNB Smart Chain (BEP-20) through academy checkout — a published flow, not a whitelist entry from chat.

Anti-phishing codes

An **anti-phishing code** is a word **you** choose that the real exchange embeds in its emails. If an email looks like Binance — an example of a centralised exchange — but does not show your code, it is fake. Set a code that is not your dog's name posted on Instagram, not "CrystalStones," not "1234."

The code does not encrypt anything. It is a glance test. Use it. Read emails for it before you click anything. Prefer still to open the bookmark rather than the button.

Device and session lists

Open the security page on a calm day. Learn what "this device" looks like. If you see a city you were not in, kick the session, rotate password and 2FA, check whitelist.

New device emails are not noise. They are the alarm. If you just logged in from a new phone, you should recognise the mail. If you did not, act as if the session is hostile.

Withdrawal lock / cooling-off

Some platforms pause withdrawals after a password change or a new device. Do not disable every safety timer because it slowed you down once. Thieves hate timers. That is the point.

Some platforms also let you set a **withdrawal password** separate from login. If offered, use a different secret. One password for everything is one leak for everything.

Control	What it buys you	How people turn it off
Address whitelist	Thief cannot instantly reroute	“I’ll just disable for this one send”
Anti-phishing word	Fake emails fail a glance test	Never set it
Device list	You notice a stranger session	Never look
Email for withdrawal	A second channel of alarm	Using an email they already have 2FA-less
Cooling-off after password change	Time	“Too annoying, I trade daily”

Worked scenario. Attacker has password plus 2FA from a cloned login page. They request a withdrawal to a new address.

- 339. Whitelist is on; the new address is not listed.
- 340. The platform refuses or starts a 24h wait and emails the student.
- 341. The student, who actually reads security mail on a bookmarked app, kills sessions, rotates 2FA, keeps the whitelist on.
- 342. Without whitelist, the story ends at “withdrawal complete.”
- 343. The coins never needed a seed. They needed a sticky withdrawal door.

DIAGRAM

```

Stolen session
|
v
Can they withdraw to a new address?
|
+-- whitelist ON, delay ON --> you have time
+-- whitelist OFF --> stack is gone

```

ACADEMY NOTE Whitelist the address **you** created, not an address a “broker” or “academy agent” pasted. Academy staff will never ask you to whitelist a Crystal Stones treasury, a the checkout processor address from chat, or a PaynovaX wallet. Published checkout, when it exists, is not a DM.

Adding the first address without bypassing the delay

The 24-hour wait when you add an address feels like the company is insulting you. It is the feature that makes a stolen session survive until morning. Do not file a ticket to “please speed whitelist, I am a VIP.” Thieves file that ticket too.

Add **your** BSC address after a tiny on-chain test has already landed, so you know the string is right. If you whitelist a mistyped address, you have built a sticky door to a void. Test, then whitelist, then leave it on.

If you must withdraw to a new address — new wallet after a phone death — accept the delay. Park the IOU. Anyone offering an “instant whitelist bypass” is offering to steal the delay from you.

Glance tests only work if you glance

Keep the anti-phishing word somewhere you will actually look on mail days. Instant whitelist bypasses are theft of the delay. Test the address on-chain first so you do not whitelist a mistype to a void.

What this lesson is for

You should treat whitelist, anti-phishing codes, and device lists as part of opening the account — not as extras for “serious traders.”

Say this out loud

- Whitelist turns a stolen session into a race you can still win.
- Anti-phishing codes make fake mail look fake. Still open the bookmark, not the button.
- Safety delays are not the enemy.
- Never whitelist a stranger’s address, including one that claims to be this academy.
- Check the device list on a calm day so a strange city is obvious.

Next: fake support, fake emails, fake job offers — the human interface to all of the above.

Lesson 5: Fake support, fake emails, fake job offers (26 min)

Fake support, fake emails, fake job offers

Once you have an exchange account, you become a target for people who will **talk** you into opening the door.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to name the three common human scripts — fake support, fake security email, fake job — and refuse them without a debate. **Social engineering** means: they do not break the cryptography. They break you.

The support impersonator

You tweet or post in a Telegram group that a withdrawal is stuck. Within minutes, “Binance Support” or “Crystal Stones Admin” DMs you. They have a badge they awarded themselves. They want:

- a screen share
- a “verification code”
- a seed (for a wallet problem that they have mapped onto your CEX panic)
- a login on a “ticket portal”

Real support sits behind the **bookmarked app**. They do not cold-DM you first. Crystal Stones Academy mentor chat will not ask for seeds, 2FA codes, or screen-control of your exchange. Support will not withdraw for you. Anyone who offers to “process the withdrawal from our side” is not support.

The security email

“Unusual login, click here.” You already know: bookmark, not the button. Check the anti-phishing word. If it is missing, it is fake. If it is present, still open the bookmark — codes can be stolen from layouts, and HTML is cheap.

SMS versions exist: “Your account will be closed in 30 minutes.” The timer is the hook. Real risk teams do not need you to sprint through a shortened URL.

The job / task offer

“Earn 2% per day executing trades for our desk. We deposit USDT, you forward it.” You are being recruited as a **mule**. The coins are stolen. When they bounce, your KYC is on the account that moved them. Decline.

Variants: “liquidity provider onboarding,” “test our new P2P desk,” “you are selected as a regional agent for Crystal Stones.” This academy does not hire through DMs to move coins. We do not pay salaries in forwarded USDT.

The recovery helper

“Your 2FA is broken, send the QR, I will reset.” No.

“Send 50 USDT to this verification wallet to unlock withdrawals.” No. That is a second invoice, not a fix.

Ask	Real support	Thief
Seed phrase	Never	Always eventually
2FA code in chat	Never	“to verify it is you”
Remote desktop	Never	“so I can see the error”
Deposit to a new address to “unlock”	Never	Standard
Work inside the bookmarked app ticket	Yes	They hate this
Withdraw on your behalf	No — you click withdraw	“We will process it”

Worked scenario. A student’s withdrawal is delayed for compliance — a real, boring delay.

344. A helpful admin on WhatsApp says send 50 USDT to a “verification wallet” to prove ownership.
345. The student pays. The delay was going to clear anyway. The 50 USDT is extra theft.
346. Always separate **the company’s slow process** from **a stranger’s urgent invoice**.
347. The student opens a ticket in the bookmarked app and waits.
348. No seed was requested this time. The money still left because the script sounded official.

DIAGRAM

Problem happens
|

```
+--> official app ticket --> wait, boring, sometimes works  
+--> DM that arrived after you posted --> assume thief
```

What real delays look like

Compliance holds, travel-rule questionnaires, weekend queues, and “we need a selfie again” are dull. They happen inside the app. They do not require you to pay a release fee to a new address. If the official ticket says wait, you wait. If a DM says pay, you do not.

Travel-rule extra questions — “who is the beneficiary, what is this for” — can appear on larger withdrawals. That is a company-and-law process. It is not a stranger in Telegram collecting a screenshot of your seed. Answer inside the ticket. Do not answer in a parallel chat that arrived second.

Phone calls exist too. A voice that says they are compliance and asks you to read a 2FA code is a thief with a phone. Real firms almost never need you to read a rotating code aloud. Hang up. Open the bookmark. See if a ticket you already opened asked for a call back on a number published in their help centre — not a number the caller dictated.

Crystal Stones clothing on the same scripts

Because you are in this academy, you will also meet clones of **us**. They will offer “priority listing,” “mentor allocation,” or “the checkout processor is down, use this wallet.” USDT on BNB Smart Chain (BEP-20) through academy checkout is the published checkout when paid tracks go live. It is not a Telegram wallet. It is not PaynovaX. It is not Crystal Stone token. Staff will not withdraw for you, will not take a seed, and will not send a job that is “forward this USDT.”

ACADEMY NOTE If you are actually stuck, log in from the bookmark, open support, and wait. Use a second channel only if **you** initiated it from documentation you already trusted. Do not let the thief pick the channel. Support will not withdraw for you. Academy staff will not either.

Why they know your ticket number

Some scams scrape public tweets or group screenshots that include a ticket ID, then DM “we saw case 483920.” A number is not proof they are the company. The company already has the case inside the app.

Similarly, job offers that know your KYC name from a leaked database will feel personal. Personal is not official. Official is the bookmark.

If you already sent a 2FA code to a DM, treat the account as compromised this hour: other device, bookmark, kill sessions, freeze, rotate. Shame is slower than a withdrawal. Do the freeze first. Tell the real ticket later that a clone harvested a code. Do not tell the clone you are onto them while they still have a session.

What this lesson is for

You should treat unsolicited help as an attack until the ticket you opened inside the real app says otherwise.

Say this out loud

- Support does not first-DM you. Support will not withdraw for you.

- Nobody needs your 2FA code, seed, or screen share in chat.
- “Earn by forwarding USDT” is mule work. Your KYC becomes the exit node.
- Official and slow beats unofficial and urgent.
- A verification wallet to “unlock” withdrawals is a second theft.

Next: passkeys, sessions, and when to freeze the account.

Lesson 6: Passkeys, sessions, and when to freeze the account (25 min)

Passkeys, sessions, and when to freeze the account

Passwords leak. Sessions linger. Adults need a freeze reflex.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to say what a **session** is, what a **passkey** is, when to kill every session, and when to freeze withdrawals rather than “wait and see.” This is still login security, not a seed. An exchange freeze is a company button. A wallet freeze does not exist — that is the wallets course.

What a session is

When you log in, the company hands your browser or app a **session token**: a secret cookie or app credential that says “this device is already you.” That is why you are not typing a password every tap. It is also why a stolen session can spend without re-typing the password until it expires or you kick it.

Sessions live until:

- you log out
- you kill them on the device-list page
- they expire
- the company invalidates them after a password change (if they bother)

“I closed the tab” is not logout. “I deleted the app” is not always logout. Open the security page and look.

Passkeys, in plain language

A **passkey** is a login secret stored in your device’s secure hardware (or a password manager that supports the standard), unlocking with your face, fingerprint, or device PIN. The site never sees a password you can type into a clone. The passkey is bound to the real domain more tightly than a password.

If your CEX offers passkeys or security keys for login, turn them on in addition to, not instead of, a still-protected email. Keep a backup method you control. Losing the only phone with the only passkey is a support queue.

Passkeys are not seeds. They open the company. They do not move on-chain coins by themselves.

When to freeze

Freeze (disable withdrawals, lock the account, kick sessions) when:

- you typed a password or 2FA on a maybe-fake page
- you see a device or city you were not in

- you received a withdrawal email you did not start
- your email was reset without you
- a “support” person had remote desktop, even “briefly”
- your SIM stopped working and you did not request a replacement

Do not wait to “see if anything happens.” Assume the session is already spending.

Practical order:

349. From a different device, bookmark, login (or account-recovery through official support).
350. Kill all sessions.
351. Change password. Rotate 2FA.
352. Confirm whitelist is on and only your addresses.
353. Freeze withdrawals if the platform has that button.
354. Only then look at balances.

Signal	Action
Unknown device on the list	Kick all sessions, rotate secrets, freeze withdrawals
Withdrawal email you did not start	Freeze first, argue later
SIM dead without you	Treat exchange SMS 2FA as burned; freeze from another channel
Remote desktop with “support”	Freeze. The account is compromised. Dignity later.
Passkey prompt you did not start	Deny. Then sessions page.

Worked scenario. Ijeoma’s phone shows a passkey prompt for her example CEX while she is cooking. She did not open the app.

355. She denies the prompt.
356. She does not tap “yes” to make the popup go away.
357. From a laptop she already bookmarked, she opens the real site, kills sessions, freezes withdrawals.
358. She finds a login attempt from another country.
359. Because whitelist was on, nothing left. The freeze was still correct. “Nothing left” is not a reason to skip the freeze next time.

DIAGRAM

```

Odd signal (prompt, email, dead SIM, strange city)
  |
  v
Deny / ignore the stranger's channel
  |
  v
Bookmark on a second device --> kill sessions --> freeze withdrawals
  |
  v
Rotate password + 2FA --> read whitelist --> then look at balances

```

Email is part of the account

If the thief has the email, password-reset is their tool. Put 2FA on email. Prefer authenticator or passkeys there too. An exchange with perfect 2FA and an email on SMS-only is a chain with a weak link labelled “forgot password.”

ACADEMY NOTE Freezing is reversible through official support. Sending coins to a “safe holding address” a stranger just pasted is often the actual theft. Freeze the company account. Do not “rescue” funds to a new wallet you have not verified with Wallets-course habits, and never to an address from chat.

Shared computers and leftover sessions

Internet-cafe or library logins leave sessions on machines you will never see again. If you ever used one, assume it is still live until you kill **all** sessions from a machine you own. Log out is a button. Session list is the proof.

Passkeys on a shared family tablet can let a relative approve a prompt they do not understand. If the device is communal, do not store the only passkey there. Prefer a device that is yours, plus a backup method you control.

Freeze is not a moral failure. It is a switch. Unfreezing through official support is allowed. Sending leftover IOUs to a “holding wallet” a voice on the phone just dictated is how freezes get converted into theft.

What this lesson is for

You should have a freeze checklist you can run while scared, without asking a group what to do.

Say this out loud

- A session is a lingering “already logged in.” Closing a tab is not logout.
- Passkeys bind login to the real domain better than typed passwords. They are not seeds.
- Odd prompt, odd email, dead SIM: freeze first, balances later.
- Kill all sessions, rotate secrets, confirm whitelist.
- Do not rescue funds to an address a stranger pasted.

Take the quiz. Then we fund the account — how local money becomes a book-entry without becoming a P2P casualty.

Module quiz (answers included for editors)

Q1. The default way to open an exchange is?

- A. The first Google ad
- B. A Telegram login button
- C. A bookmark you saved after verifying the domain on a calm day
- D. A WhatsApp PDF from a broker

Correct answer: C

Q2. A page that looks identical to an exchange and asks for password plus 2FA can?

- A. Not exist; logos are legally impossible to copy
- B. Relay those codes in real time and steal the session
- C. Only steal your email, never withdrawals
- D. Automatically protect you because 2FA is on

Correct answer: B

Q3. Buying a “KYC-ready” exchange account is?

- A. A recommended privacy tool in this course
- B. Fraud, and a freeze waiting to happen
- C. Required for Crystal Stones
- D. Safer than using your own ID

Correct answer: B

Q4. SMS 2FA is enough to protect an exchange account.

- A. True — SMS cannot be stolen
- B. False — SIM swap and operator social engineering beat SMS; authenticator or a hardware key is the grown-up setting
- C. True if you have a long password
- D. True on BNB Smart Chain because gas is cheap

Correct answer: B

Q5. A withdrawal address whitelist helps when?

- A. You want faster random withdrawals to new thieves
- B. A stolen session cannot instantly send to a new address; a delay or block gives you time
- C. You whitelist any address a DM sends
- D. You turn it off before every send

Correct answer: B

Q6. An anti-phishing code is?

- A. A second seed phrase
- B. A word the real exchange includes in its emails so clones look wrong
- C. A BEP-20 contract
- D. A P2P advert ID

Correct answer: B

Q7. Real exchange support will typically?

- A. Cold-DM you on Telegram after you complain in a group
- B. Ask for your seed to resync the order book
- C. Work from a ticket you opened inside the bookmarked official app, and will not withdraw for you

D. Require remote desktop in the first five minutes

Correct answer: C

Q8. You see a login device in a city you were not in. First adult move?

A. Wait a week to see if they withdraw

B. Ask a WhatsApp admin to withdraw for you

C. From a bookmarked second device, kill sessions and freeze withdrawals, then rotate secrets

D. Paste your seed into the exchange so they can restore the account

Correct answer: C

Module 3: Funding the account

Local money becomes a book-entry. Bank and card corridors, P2P escrow, stablecoins on the right network, and memos that are not optional.

Lesson 1: How local money becomes a book-entry (26 min)

How local money becomes a book-entry

You cannot wire naira to BNB Smart Chain. You cannot wire dollars into a BEP-20 contract either. A human process sits in the middle. Local money becomes a **book-entry**: a row on a company's ledger that says they owe you crypto, or — if you used a broker — a hope that someone else sent coins.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to name the three common doors (platform deposit, in-app P2P, off-platform human), say which one has a parent, and refuse the sentence "I paid, so I am on-chain."

On-ramp means: the process that turns national currency into an exchange IOU or into coins. It is not a chain feature.

1. Platform deposit from a bank or card

Some exchanges and local on-ramps let you send naira from **your** bank name to **their** corporate account, or pay a card. In other countries the corridor might be a bank transfer, SEPA, ACH, Faster Payments, or a card processor. The name on the sending account should match KYC. Paying from a friend's account is how compliance freezes start.

Delays are real. Weekend banking is real. A receipt is not a credit until **their** ledger shows it. Card corridors can look instant and still reverse days later as a chargeback — next lesson.

This door is dull. Dull is good. You are a customer of a company that already has your KYC, sending money down a pipe they published.

2. P2P inside a major platform

You pick an advertiser. You pay **their** personal or business bank details as the platform instructs. You mark "paid." They release USDT into your **exchange** balance (still an IOU). The platform holds a dispute process if they cheat.

This is how a huge amount of Nigerian crypto on-ramping actually happens. It is also a scam factory. The lesson after next is only about surviving it. Hold this for now: in-app P2P still lands as an exchange IOU, not as BscScan.

3. Local brokers and WhatsApp desks

A person you know, or a “dealer.” You send naira, they send USDT to an address. There is often **no** platform escrow. This is the highest trust requirement and the highest “the human vanished” rate. This academy does not romanticise it. If you use a person, you are doing an **OTC** trade — over-the-counter, a private deal — with no parent.

A better rate off-platform is often the price of no escrow.

Door	Escrow?	Typical fail	Where the money sits if it “works”
Platform naira / card / bank deposit	Company process	Name mismatch, delay, rejected deposit	CEX IOU
In-app P2P	Platform dispute	Fake receipt, delayed release, off-platform chat	CEX IOU
WhatsApp broker	Usually none	They take the naira and disappear; or they send on the wrong network	Maybe coins on some chain, maybe nothing

Worked scenario. A student pays a broker on WhatsApp because the rate is 15 naira better. Broker asks for the USDT address.

360. The student, trying to be advanced, pastes a Trust Wallet BEP-20 address. Trust Wallet is an example of a wallet app, not an endorsement.
361. Broker sends USDT **TRC-20** on Tron “because fees are lower.”
362. The student sees nothing in Trust Wallet on BSC.
363. The broker says “it is confirmed, check Tronscan.” The naira is gone. The coins exist on a chain the student was not watching.
364. Wrong book, again. A better rate bought a missing explorer row.

DIAGRAM

Your local money (naira, dollars, euros, ...)

```

|
+--> official platform rails --> credited IOU
+--> in-app P2P --> credited IOU (if release happens)
+--> off-platform human --> maybe coins, maybe lesson in pain
|
v

```

Still not BNB Smart Chain until a withdrawal (or a broker send) hits YOUR address on that chain

Match names and amounts

Send the exact amount the advert or invoice says. Do not add “for food” in the bank narration if the advert says not to. Do not round up to a lucky number. Bots and humans who want a dispute handle will use any mismatch.

Send from an account in **your** name, the name that matches KYC. A cousin’s transfer is a freeze waiting for a Monday.

In countries where the exchange takes cards or local bank rails, still read the name on the beneficiary. Corporate account of the platform is one thing. A personal account pasted in chat is another.

Rates are not this course

This course will not give you a current naira rate, a named broker, or a “best advert.” Rates move. People who DM rates into your academy chat are selling. Compare inside a platform you chose on purpose, on a calm day.

USDT is not “the dollar in your pocket.” It is a token brand that tracks a dollar by issuer promise, on several chains. The naira (or naira-to-dollar) conversion is a local market. Do not treat a Twitter screenshot as a central-bank print.

ACADEMY NOTE This academy will not quote a rate, name a broker, or tell you to buy Crystal Stones with the naira that just became an IOU. When paid tracks go live, tuition is USDT on BNB Smart Chain (BEP-20) through academy checkout — not a chat desk, not PaynovaX, not a personal account.

Other countries, same sentence

A learner in London might use Faster Payments. A learner in the euro area might use SEPA. A learner in the US might use ACH or a card. A learner in Lagos might use P2P naira. The plumbing changes. The sentence does not: **national currency became a company row, not a BscScan row.**

If your corridor is a local fintech wallet that then “buys USDT,” read whether you now have a fintech IOU, a CEX IOU, or an on-chain token. Three different bosses. The fintech app saying “USDT” without a network picker is usually still their ledger.

Do not skip this identification because the icon is green. Icons are not books.

What this lesson is for

You should be able to point at any funding story and say which door it is, whether escrow exists, and which book the credit will sit on if it works.

Say this out loud

- Naira — or any local currency — never sits on BNB Smart Chain. A door converts it into an IOU or into coins.
- In-app P2P has a dispute process. WhatsApp usually does not.
- Name mismatch is how freezes start. Exact amount, exact name.
- A better rate off-platform is often the price of no escrow.

- A credited exchange balance is still not a BscScan row.

Next: bank and card corridors — delays, chargebacks, and why “paid” is not “settled.”

Lesson 2: Bank / card corridors, delays, and chargebacks (26 min)

Bank / card corridors, delays, and chargebacks

Not every country lives on P2P. Many learners will fund an exchange through a **bank transfer** or a **card**. Those rails have parents. Parents can delay you, freeze you, and sometimes reverse you.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to say what a corridor is, why a receipt is not settlement, what a **chargeback** does to a crypto IOU, and why paying from someone else’s card is how accounts die. **Corridor** means: a permitted pipe between a national-currency system and a company’s ledger.

Bank transfers are messages between ledgers

When you send naira to an exchange’s corporate account, or dollars by ACH, or euros by SEPA, you are asking two banks (and sometimes a chain of correspondent banks) to rewrite books. Crypto is not in that sentence yet.

What can go wrong:

- **Name mismatch.** The sending account is not the KYC name. Compliance holds the deposit.
- **Reference / memo missing.** Some platforms need a code in the narration so they can attach the money to you. Next lesson treats memos on crypto deposits; fiat deposits have the same shape.
- **Weekend and cut-off times.** “I sent it” on Saturday is not “they have it” on Saturday.
- **Limits.** First-day caps, monthly caps, enhanced due diligence after a round number.

A bank SMS that says “debit successful” means your bank reduced your row. It does not mean the exchange credited you.

Cards feel instant and stay reversible

Card networks often allow a **chargeback**: the cardholder disputes a payment and the scheme may pull the money back. That protects shoppers. It also means:

- the exchange may delay withdrawals until the card payment is less likely to reverse
- if you chargeback after spending the IOU, the company will freeze you and possibly more
- “buy crypto with a credit card and cash out” is a how-to for fraud teams, not a life hack

If you fund with a card, assume withdrawals are sticky for a while. That delay is the company not wanting to be the exit node of a chargeback.

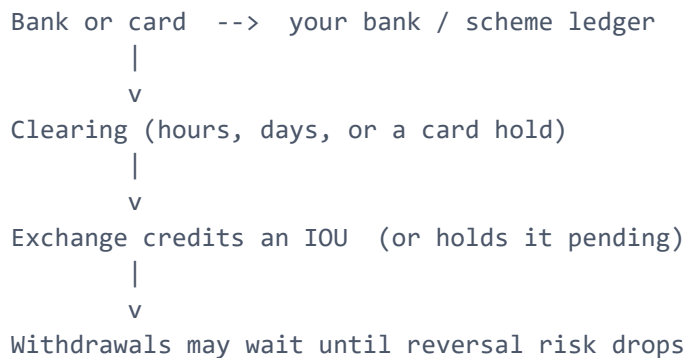
Rail	Feels like	Reversal risk	Typical beginner fail
Local bank transfer to platform	Hours to days	Lower than cards, not zero	Wrong name, missing reference, weekend
International wire	Days	Recovery is legal, not a button	Correspondent fees, SWIFT delays, compliance
Card	Seconds	Chargeback window	Instant buy, instant

			withdraw, then freeze
App-to-app fintech	Minutes	Depends on the fintech's partner banks	Paying from an account not in your KYC name

Worked scenario. Marta, outside Nigeria, funds an example CEX with a debit card for the equivalent of 200 USDT.

- 365. The card shows a hold immediately. The exchange shows a credit.
- 366. She market-buys USDT and tries to withdraw the same hour to a BSC address.
- 367. The exchange blocks the withdrawal: “risk review, card purchases withdrawable after X days.”
- 368. She calls it a scam. It is a chargeback window. The company is not her enemy for keeping the IOU un-withdrawable until the card rail is colder.
- 369. If she instead files a chargeback “because crypto is slow,” she may lose the account and still owe the company.

DIAGRAM



Do not mix names, do not “borrow a card”

Paying from a partner’s card, a business account that is not on the KYC file, or a friend’s fintech app is how you look like a mule. Even if you are innocent, the pattern is the pattern risk engines score.

If the platform publishes a corporate beneficiary, use it. If a chat says “our bank is down, pay this personal account,” you have left the corridor and entered OTC.

In Nigeria, some people bounce between bank transfer into a P2P seller and a platform NGN wallet. Those are still two doors. Read which book credited you. A NGN wallet on the exchange is local-currency IOU, not USDT, not BNB.

Delays are not always theft

Honest delays: weekends, first-deposit reviews, extra selfies, travel-rule fields, bank holidays in another country. Dishonest delays: a WhatsApp desk that has your naira and no coins. Distinguish by **where you paid**. Official beneficiary plus a ticket is a queue. Personal account plus silence is a problem.

ACADEMY NOTE This academy does not tell you to chargeback an exchange because a candle moved. Chargebacks on crypto buys are how people get banned and, in some places, investigated. If you cannot afford the practice size without clawing it back from a card scheme, the size is too large.

What to do while you wait

Waiting is when people invent side doors. They pay a cousin's account. They accept a WhatsApp rate. They file a chargeback because Saturday felt long.

While you wait: keep the bank receipt, keep the exchange deposit ID, do not send a second payment, do not let a DM "speed it up" for a fee. If Monday still shows nothing, ticket on the bookmark with those IDs. Banks also have investigation windows. Parallel DMs do not shorten them.

If your card issuer already reversed a crypto purchase you actually received as IOU, expect the CEX to claw the IOU or ban the account. You cannot keep both the USDT and the reversed naira. That is not a glitch. That is the rail.

What this lesson is for

You should fund through a pipe you can explain, wait for their ledger — not your bank SMS — and not treat a card credit as instantly withdrawable coins.

Say this out loud

- A corridor is a permitted pipe from national currency into a company book.
- Debit SMS is not an exchange credit. Exchange credit is not yet on-chain.
- Cards can reverse. Companies delay withdrawals for that reason.
- Pay from the name on the KYC file. Borrowed cards look like mule flow.
- Official slow rails beat unofficial fast personal accounts.

Next: P2P without becoming the victim — escrow, release, and why off-platform chat is the hole.

Lesson 3: P2P without becoming the victim (escrow, release, off-platform chat) (28 min)

P2P without becoming the victim (escrow, release, off-platform chat)

P2P means you trade with another person. The platform is supposed to **escrow** the crypto — lock it — until you pay, then **release** when both sides behave. Scammers attack the gaps.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to run a dull P2P buy or refuse a thrilling one, and you should treat "release before the goods" as a sentence that empties people. This is defensive. It is not a complete catalogue of every con. It is the patterns that empty beginners.

Rule 0 — stay on the platform

The moment someone says "Bank is down, let's finish on WhatsApp, I will send first," escrow is gone. Decline. Report. Find another advert.

Off-platform chat is how they delete the recording, send new bank details, and recruit you into a second payment. The trade UI is the parent. Private chat is the hole.

Fake receipts (you are selling)

You are **selling** USDT (they pay naira into your bank). They send a Photoshop transfer receipt. Your bank has not credited you. They pressure you to release because “I have a plane.”

Release only when the money is in your account, under your name, and you understand whether that credit can reverse. Instant alerts can still reverse in some rails. Know your bank. If you do not know, wait. A PDF is not a credit. A credit may still bounce. “Release before goods” — here the goods are final naira — is how sellers get emptied.

You are buying USDT — they say they paid

The opposite direction. You send naira to the seller’s bank details shown **in the app**. You mark paid. They stall. Open a dispute **in the app** with your real bank proof. Do not send a second payment. Do not take the argument to Telegram.

If they send a hash “I already sent USDT on-chain,” you are not even in a CEX P2P any more. Check nothing in panic. The escrowed IOU is the object. On-chain theatre is a distraction.

Wrong-name payments

Someone pays you from an account that is not the name in the P2P profile. That can be a stolen bank account. If you release, the real owner later reverses or files a police case and **you** look like the exit node. Cancel / dispute. Do not “just this once.”

Overpayment and refund theatre

They “accidentally” send more and ask you to refund the extra off-platform. The original payment later bounces. You refunded real money. Classic.

Chargeback after release

On some payment methods the naira can be clawed back after you released USDT. This is why experienced P2P sellers restrict methods. As a beginner **buyer**, prefer methods the platform ranks as robust, even if the rate is slightly worse.

Pressure line	Translation
“Release I have an emergency”	They want escrow gone before your bank is final
“Let’s go to WhatsApp”	They want no recording
“Pay an extra 2,000 for the agent”	New invoice, not in the trade
“Send to this other account, that one is down”	Off-script bank details
“I sent USDT already, here is a hash”	Could be a different chain, a different token, or a lie — check nothing; use the trade UI
“Release first, I am a verified merchant”	Verified is a badge, not final naira

Worked scenario. Blessing buys 100 USDT. Seller’s in-app account is Aisha.

370. Blessing’s bank transfer goes to Aisha as shown in the trade, exact amount, from Blessing’s own account.

371. She waits for her debit to show, marks paid, uploads the receipt **in the trade**.

372. Seller delays 20 minutes. Blessing does not send a second transfer. She does not move to WhatsApp.

373. She waits the timer and opens dispute.

374. The platform releases after seeing a matching bank debit. Boring. Correct.

If instead she had accepted new bank details in chat, she would be arguing with a ghost.

DIAGRAM

```
In-app trade open (crypto escrowed)
|
v
Pay EXACT details shown in the trade
|
v
Mark paid + proof in the trade
|
v
Wait for release or dispute in the app
|
X never follow new details in private chat
X never release because a PDF arrived
```

Reputation is a clue, not a guarantee

Completion rate, badge, “merchant.” Useful. Not a parent. A high-volume advertiser can still send a fake receipt on a busy night. Your rule is the bank book and the trade UI, not the badge.

If you are new, start tiny. A first P2P is a procedure test, not a salary conversion.

ACADEMY NOTE If a trade feels like a thriller, you are being played. Real P2P is dull: exact amount, exact name, wait, release. Adrenaline is a signal to stop. This academy will not match you with a seller and will not tell you to release early as a favour.

Buying versus selling are different jobs

As a **buyer** of USDT, your job is: exact details in the trade, one payment, proof in the trade, wait or dispute. You are trying not to pay twice and not to follow new accounts.

As a **seller** of USDT, your job is stricter: escrow is your friend, release is irreversible on the crypto side, PDFs are nothing, wrong-name naira is toxic, “release I have a plane” is a script. If you are new, prefer buying a tiny amount to learn the UI before you sell anything.

This academy is not training you to be a P2P desk. One practice buy is enough. Becoming a merchant is a business with police-report tails when a stolen bank account hits you. Stay small.

What this lesson is for

You should be able to complete a small in-app P2P without following a human off the rails, and you should never release on a picture of money.

Say this out loud

- Stay in the trade UI. Chat off-platform is a red flag.
- Receipts are not credits. Credits may still reverse — know your rail.
- Do not release before the goods: final money in your named account.
- Wrong-name money is toxic. Never pay twice. Dispute once.
- A hash in chat is not the escrowed IOU.

Next: stablecoins arriving from another chain — still the wrong book if you pick wrong.

Lesson 4: Stablecoins arriving from another chain — still the wrong book if you pick wrong (26 min)

Stablecoins arriving from another chain — still the wrong book if you pick wrong

USDT is a **brand** on several books. Depositing it onto an exchange is the same trap as withdrawing it, run in reverse.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to read a deposit screen, match asset plus network plus address plus memo if any, and refuse the belief that “USDT is one chain.” A **deposit address** is an address the exchange gave you for one asset on one network. It is not a universal USDT bucket.

The deposit screen is a filter, not a suggestion

When you tap Deposit USDT, the platform asks for a **network**. That choice mint a (or reveals a) deposit address for **that** book.

- **BEP-20 / BSC** — BNB Smart Chain. Address looks like `0x...`. This academy’s practice rail.
- **ERC-20** — Ethereum. Also `0x...`. Different book. Gas in ETH.
- **TRC-20** — Tron. Often `T...`. Different book entirely.
- Others: Solana, Arbitrum, Polygon, “omnichain” labels that beginners should not improvise with.

If you send BEP-20 USDT to a TRC-20 deposit address, you did not “almost get it right.” You wrote in the wrong notebook. Recovery, if any, is a support ticket plus a maybe. Small stacks often die there.

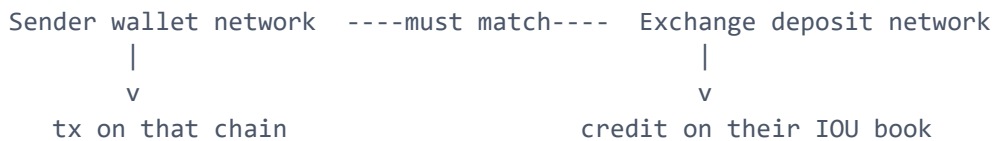
The `0x` shape is the trap between BEP-20 and ERC-20. Same text family. Not the same money.

You send	Exchange deposit set to	Result
USDT BEP-20	USDT-BEP20	Credit, after their confirmations
USDT BEP-20	USDT-ERC20 (0x address on Ethereum)	Wrong book; ticket territory
USDT TRC-20	USDT-BEP20	Wrong book
USDT ERC-20	USDT-ERC20	Credit, often slower and costlier
BNB (native)	USDT deposit address	Wrong asset, even on the same chain

Worked scenario. Efe has USDT on Tron in an old wallet from a previous year. He wants it on an example CEX to convert, then later withdraw on BSC.

- 375. He opens Deposit, asset USDT, and leaves the default network. The default is TRC-20 this week.
- 376. He actually copies a BEP-20 address from a different screen because it looked like his wallet's `0x`.
- 377. He sends TRC-20 USDT to an `0x` BSC deposit. The Tron explorer shows success. The exchange shows 0.
- 378. Support may or may not recover. A test send would have cost a few dollars and revealed the mismatch.
- 379. "USDT is USDT" was the false sentence. USDT is a name on several books.

DIAGRAM



If the arrows point at different chains, the IOU never appears.
The explorer of the SENDING chain will still say success.

Credits take confirmations, not feelings

Exchanges wait for a number of **confirmations** — extra pages of the book on top of your transaction — before they credit you. That is their risk policy, not a bug. BNB Smart Chain is usually faster than Ethereum. "It's been ten minutes" is not an argument. Paste the hash into the explorer **for the network you sent on**, then wait their counter.

Do not send a second deposit "to push it." If the first was wrong-network, the second can be wrong twice.

Incoming from a friend or a broker

If someone else sends USDT to your exchange deposit, you still pick the network they will actually use, and you still give them the address for **that** network. Read it back: asset, network, first 6 and last 6 of the address, memo if the screen shows one.

A broker who "always sends TRC-20" is not compatible with your BSC-only plan unless you accept a Tron deposit and later convert. Do not mix by accident.

Crystal Stones as a BEP-20 — contract `0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00` to verify only — is not USDT. Depositing it to a USDT address is the wrong asset. This academy still will not tell you to buy or deposit it.

ACADEMY NOTE If a deposit does not credit, stop. Copy the tx hash. Open the explorer for the network you used. Compare to the network the deposit screen named. Then open a ticket on the bookmarked app. Do not hire a recovery agent who wants a seed. There is no seed on an exchange deposit; they are fishing.

“USDT0”, bridges, and other labels you should not improvise with

Newer names — bridged USDT, “canonical” USDT, USDT on side-systems — will keep appearing. A beginner rule that survives the new labels: **if you did not choose that exact name on both sides of the send, do not send.**

Bridges are their own companies or contracts, with their own failure modes. This course does not teach bridging. If a desk says “send any USDT, we convert,” they are asking you to trust a private conversion. That is an OTC promise, not a network feature.

Test sends are cheaper than a support essay about a bridge you did not mean to use. If the deposit page lists five USDT flavours, pick one with your finger and say it out loud: “BEP-20 USDT to this 0x on BSC.” Then send that, tiny first.

What this lesson is for

You should treat every inbound stablecoin as asset-plus-network, test-sized, and you should never believe USDT is a single chain.

Say this out loud

- USDT is a brand on several books. BEP-20, ERC-20, and TRC-20 are not interchangeable.
- The deposit network must match the sending wallet’s network.
- Explorer success on the sending chain is not an exchange credit.
- Do not send a second stack to “push” a missing credit.
- Wrong asset (BNB into USDT, Crystal Stones into USDT) is also a wrong book.

Next: deposit memos and tags — why a missing memo is not “the blockchain ate it.”

Lesson 5: Deposit memos, tags, and why a missing memo is not “the blockchain ate it” (26 min)

Deposit memos, tags, and why a missing memo is not “the blockchain ate it”

Some deposits need more than an address. They need a **memo**, **tag**, **comment**, or **destination tag**: an extra number or string that tells a company whose IOU to credit, because many customers share one on-chain address.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to see a memo field and treat it as required, explain why the chain can confirm a transfer that the exchange still has not credited, and refuse the folklore that “the blockchain ate it.” **Memo** here does not mean a note to self. It is routing data for a pooled address.

Why companies use memos

On some networks (historically XRP, XLM, some EOS-like designs, and various exchange-specific setups), one hot wallet receives thousands of deposits. The **address** is the company’s. The **memo** is you.

If you send to the right address with no memo, the coins arrived — at the company — and they do not know which row to increment. The book of the chain is fine. Their customer database is stuck. That is a support ticket, not a vanished transaction.

BNB Smart Chain USDT deposits to a personal-looking `0x` address often do **not** use a memo. Do not invent one. Do not skip one when the screen shows the field as required. Read the screen you have, not a memory of a different coin.

What you did	Chain explorer	Exchange ledger
Right address, right network, memo correct (or not required)	Confirmed	Credit after their confirmations
Right address, right network, memo missing when required	Confirmed	No credit until they identify you — if they can
Wrong network	Confirmed on the wrong book	No credit
Memo present but for the wrong person	Confirmed	Maybe credited to someone else; ticket

Worked scenario. Kunle deposits an asset that shows Address plus Memo on his example CEX.

380. He copies the address carefully. He skips the memo because “I never needed one for USDT on BSC.”
381. The sending wallet confirms. The explorer of that chain shows success. He tweets that the blockchain ate his money.
382. The chain did its job. The company received coins into a pooled wallet with no customer tag.
383. He opens a ticket on the bookmarked app, pastes the tx hash, his user ID, the amount, and the time. He does not send a seed. There is no seed.
384. Recovery, if the firm offers it, can take days and sometimes a fee. A test send with the memo would have been cheaper.

DIAGRAM

```

Your wallet
  |
  v
On-chain tx to COMPANY address (+ memo/tag if the screen required it)
  |
  v
Company software reads memo --> credits YOUR IOU
  |
  X missing memo --> coins at company, no row for you yet

```

Memos are not optional when the screen says they are not

“Optional” on some wallets means the wallet will let you broadcast without one. The exchange still needs it. Optional in the sending UI is not optional in the receiving company.

Copy memo with the copy button. Check a few characters. Do not type a memo from memory in a chat. Do not use last week’s memo if you generated a new deposit. Some platforms rotate tags.

If the deposit screen says “no memo required,” do not paste a random number “for safety.” Extra data can break a simple transfer.

This is not a Crystal Stones BEP-20 thing by default

Crystal Stones on BNB Smart Chain is a BEP-20 at `0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00` (verify only). Ordinary BEP-20 transfers to an `0x` address do not use XRP-style memos. If a stranger says “send Crystal Stones with memo 1234 to unlock listing,” they are inventing a rail. Academy checkout, when live, is USDT on BNB Smart Chain (BEP-20) through academy checkout — follow **that** screen’s fields, not a chat memo.

How to talk to support when a memo was missing

Stay on the bookmarked app. Provide:

- tx hash
- amount and asset
- network you used
- timestamp
- screenshot of the deposit page (not of a seed, not of 2FA)

Never send a seed. An exchange problem has no seed. Anyone who says they need it to “find the memo on-chain” is a thief.

ACADEMY NOTE A missing memo is a labelling failure at the company, not a hole in BNB Smart Chain physics. Stop. Ticket. Do not send a second full-size deposit as a poke. Test sends exist so the first mistake is small.

Destination tags versus payment comments versus narrations

Three different “notes” get mixed:

- **Chain memo / tag / destination tag** — load-bearing for pooled crypto deposits.
- **Bank narration** — load-bearing for some fiat deposits; some P2P adverts forbid certain words.
- **Chat comment** — not load-bearing. A WhatsApp “memo: 44521” does not attach a chain memo.

If the CEX deposit screen shows a memo field, that is category one. Copy it. If a P2P advert says “do not write crypto in the bank narration,” that is category two. If a stranger sends a memo in chat for a BEP-20 USDT send that the official screen said needed no memo, that is category three — ignore it.

Mixing the three is how people put a bank story on a chain send and then blame BscScan.

What this lesson is for

You should read every extra field on a deposit screen as possibly load-bearing, and you should describe a missing credit without blaming “the blockchain” when an explorer already shows the tx.

Say this out loud

- A memo or tag routes a deposit into your IOU when many customers share one address.

- If the screen requires a memo, it is not optional even if the sending wallet allows a skip.
- Explorer confirmed plus exchange zero often means labelling, wrong network, or waiting on confirmations — not “the blockchain ate it.”
- Do not invent memos on ordinary BEP-20 USDT if the screen says none is required.
- Support gets a hash and a ticket, never a seed.

Take the quiz. Next module: a first spot buy, sized like an adult — including why you need BNB even if you bought USDT.

Module quiz (answers included for editors)

Q1. Naira becomes crypto on BNB Smart Chain by?

- A. Emailing the BNB validator set
- B. A human door (platform rails, P2P, or a broker) that credits an IOU or sends coins
- C. Typing naira into Trust Wallet
- D. Mining with a phone

Correct answer: B

Q2. The highest-risk common funding door is usually?

- A. In-app P2P with escrow
- B. A platform’s own naira or bank deposit
- C. An off-platform WhatsApp broker with no escrow
- D. A bank standing order to yourself

Correct answer: C

Q3. You should release P2P crypto when?

- A. You receive a pretty PDF receipt
- B. The buyer says they are at the airport
- C. The naira is actually in your account, the name is sane, and you understand reversal risk
- D. They send a second receipt in WhatsApp

Correct answer: C

Q4. A P2P counterparty wants to finish on WhatsApp because “the bank is down.” You?

- A. Agree, escrow is optional
- B. Decline and stay in the platform trade or cancel
- C. Send a seed for faster release
- D. Pay a second account they typed in chat

Correct answer: B

Q5. Ada sends USDT on TRC-20 to an exchange deposit address that was generated for BEP-20. What happened?

- A. USDT is one chain, so it will credit after a nap
- B. She wrote in the wrong book; explorer success on Tron is not a BSC or BEP-20 credit
- C. BscScan will show it automatically
- D. The memo will reroute it

Correct answer: B

Q6. A card-funded IOU may not be withdrawable immediately because?

- A. BNB Smart Chain is closed on weekends
- B. Card payments can chargeback; the company does not want to be the exit node yet
- C. KYC forbids all cards forever
- D. The checkout processor seized the card

Correct answer: B

Q7. Kunle's deposit is confirmed on the explorer but the exchange shows zero. A required memo was blank. Best description?

- A. The blockchain ate it
- B. The chain did its job; the company cannot label the IOU without the memo — open a ticket, do not send a seed
- C. He must publish his seed so validators can attach the memo
- D. Memos are always optional

Correct answer: B

Q8. Academy tuition checkout, when live, is?

- A. A Telegram wallet someone will paste
- B. PaynovaX
- C. USDT on BEP-20 through the published checkout, not a chat address
- D. A Crystal Stones token transfer with a memo of 1234

Correct answer: C

Module 4: A first spot buy, sized like an adult

Market versus limit, practice size, why BNB is fuel, a narrated first buy, order books and slippage, stop rules, and why screens disagree until you withdraw.

Lesson 1: Market, limit, and a practice size (26 min)

Market, limit, and a practice size

You have a naira-credited IOU, or a card-credited IOU, or you already hold USDT on the exchange. You want a little BNB, or you want to convert something. The two beginner buttons are **market** and **limit**. The third, unspoken button is **size**.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to say what each order type does, pick a practice size that does not change rent, and refuse the idea that clicking Buy made you a trader. **Practice size** means: an amount you can lose to a mistake — wrong network, fat-finger, a freeze — without missing rent, fees, or food.

Market

“Take the current ask (when buying) and just do it.” Fast. You pay the spread. On liquid pairs (BNB/USDT on a major CEX) this is how a first **small** buy should look. You are not trying to save 0.02%. You are trying to not miss-click.

A market order is usually a **taker** order: you hit resting liquidity. You will pay the taker fee. On a deep book that fee plus a tiny spread is the cost of being done.

On a thin book a market order **is** the candle. You can buy the next 3% of the book by yourself. If you cannot explain the 24-hour volume, you should not market-buy that pair.

Limit

“I will buy if the price reaches X.” Your order sits on the book as a **maker** (if it rests) until someone hits it — or it does not fill. Beginners leave limit orders and then also market-buy, doubling the position, then panic.

Limits are how you avoid paying a silly ask on a jumpy pair. They are also how you forget an order exists. For this course: **market on a liquid pair, tiny size**, unless you already understand why you are placing a limit, and you will check Open Orders before you do anything else.

Stop and **OCO** (one-cancels-the-other) are extra machinery. Walk past them until spot plus size is boring.

Size: practise with amounts you can lose

Define **practice** before you click:

- an amount that does not change rent
- an amount you can afford to mis-send on a wrong network once (you will try not to)
- not a month of salary “because the group said it will 10x”
- not borrowed money, not a credit-card float you plan to chargeback

If the number makes your hands shake, it is too large for a first buy. Shrink it. There is no prize for a large first fill.

This academy’s success metric is: you can narrate what you bought, what you paid in fees, and what still sits as an IOU. It is not: you caught a wick.

Move	Beginner default	Not this course
First conversion into USDT	Small, liquid, on-platform	Salary-sized “because the rate is good today”
First BNB for gas	Small; you need it later to move tokens	All-in on BNB as a trade
First withdrawal	Even smaller test, then the rest	The whole stack on an untested address
First thin alt / “Crystal Stones on a random book”	Not in this course	Ape because the ticker matches
Futures / 100x	Closed door	“Just a small leverage”

Worked scenario. Emeka funds 30,000 naira as practice.

385. He buys USDT on a liquid door — P2P or the platform’s listed pair — at a size that is not rent.
386. He market-buys a slice of BNB so a later wallet will have gas. Liquid pair. Tiny.
387. He does not hunt a 40x ticker the same evening. He does not open futures “just to see.”
388. He will withdraw a test in the next module. He still has rent.
389. That is a successful first buy even if the naira rate moved against him by 1%. The skill was the checklist, not the candle.

DIAGRAM

```

Liquid pair + market + small size --> boring fill --> IOU you can explain
Thin pair + market + pride         --> you are the candle
Limit + forgotten open order       --> surprise second fill
Hands shaking                      --> shrink the size; do not “be brave”

```

Slippage and fat-finger

Slippage is the difference between the price you glanced at and the price you got. On BNB/USDT spot on a major CEX, usually tiny. On a low-liquidity token, a market buy can print a ridiculous candle **you** made.

Fat-finger is the extra zero. Read the notional — “you will spend 20 USDT,” not “you will spend 200.” Some screens confirm in quote asset, some in base. Read both. If the confirm popup is a surprise, cancel.

Do not ape the next ticker. Stop rules live in a later lesson this module. Today’s rule is smaller: if you cannot name the pair, the size, and the fee line, you do not click.

ACADEMY NOTE This academy will not tell you to buy Crystal Stones, BNB, or USDT as an investment. BNB here is fuel you may need later on BNB Smart Chain. USDT is a practice stablecoin brand. Size is a safety tool. Education only.

Min notional, lots, and the “cannot place order” popup

If the platform rejects a 2 USDT buy, you may be under **minimum notional**. That is a house rule. Raise to the minimum if and only if the minimum is still practice money. If the minimum is no longer practice, that pair is not your first buy. Pick a more liquid pair with a smaller door, or wait.

Some pairs trade in awkward lot sizes. The confirm popup is where you catch “I wanted 10 USDT of BNB and I am about to spend 10 BNB.” Read the unit. Cancel is a skill.

Practice size also means: no adding funds mid-fill because a candle moved. The ticket you defined before the click is the ticket.

What this lesson is for

You should leave this page able to place a tiny market buy on a liquid spot pair and know that you still hold an IOU, not a personality as a trader.

Say this out loud

- Market on a liquid pair is the beginner default. You pay spread plus taker fee to be done.
- Limit orders are optional; they are how people double-fill if they forget Open Orders.
- If the size scares you, shrink it. Practice means you can lose it.
- You are not yet a trader because you clicked Buy.
- Thin books plus market orders make you the candle.

Next: the BNB problem — why you need BNB even if you bought USDT.

Lesson 2: Why you need BNB even if you bought USDT (26 min)

Why you need BNB even if you bought USDT

On BNB Smart Chain, **BNB pays gas**. USDT does not. Crystal Stones does not. A wallet full of tokens and 0 BNB is a display case you cannot open.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to say what native coin versus token means on BSC, why withdrawing USDT alone can strand you, and how you will get a little BNB without handing a seed to a “gas helper.” **Gas** means: the fee the network charges to include your signed instruction in the public book. On BSC that fee is paid in BNB.

Two layers on the same address

Your `0x` address on BSC can hold:

- **BNB** — native coin, used for fees. Sending BNB is a simple value transfer.
- **BEP-20 tokens** — USDT, Crystal Stones, everything else that is a **contract**. Spending a token means: sign a transaction, pay gas in BNB, the contract updates balances.

No BNB, no send, no approve, no swap. The tokens are still on the book. You are looking through glass.

This is not unique to BSC. Ethereum needs ETH. Tron has a different energy/bandwidth design. Solana needs SOL. The beginner pattern is always: the native coin is fuel; the stablecoin is cargo.

The stranded-USDT pattern

390. User withdraws **only** USDT from the exchange, network BEP-20, to Trust Wallet (an example of a wallet app).
391. They later want to send some to a friend, to the checkout processor, or to a dApp.
392. Wallet says insufficient funds for gas.

393. They google. A helper says “send me the seed, I will add gas.”

394. You already know how that ends. The helper adds nothing. They empty the USDT — if they can trick you into a signature or a seed — or they vanish with a “gas fee” you prepaid.

The fix is boring: when you withdraw, include a **small BNB** withdrawal too — more than one future transaction, less than a trophy. Same address, network BNB Smart Chain / BNB native, not a random BEP-20 named BNB.

You hold on BSC	Can you send it without BNB?
BNB	Yes (BNB pays for its own send)
USDT (BEP-20)	No
Crystal Stones (BEP-20)	No
A random airdrop token	No — and you often should not try

Worked scenario. Ngozi withdraws 40 USDT and 0.02 BNB to the same address.

395. Weeks later she moves 10 USDT. Gas is a fraction of that BNB.

396. She still has gas for mistakes and for a second send.

397. She never needed a helper. She never pasted a seed. An exchange login was never a seed either.

398. If 0.02 BNB feels mysterious, she looks at current gas on a real tx on BscScan **before** she withdraws. She wants many ordinary transfers of headroom, not a scientific minimum that fails when the network is busy.

399. If she had withdrawn USDT only, she would now be shopping for BNB under panic, which is how “gas station” scams sell.

DIAGRAM

Exchange IOU

```

|
+--> USDT on BEP-20 --> tokens in wallet (cargo)
+--> BNB on BSC      --> fuel to move those tokens
|
v

```

Later: the checkout processor USDT BEP-20 (academy checkout when live)
still needs BNB in the sending wallet to pay gas

Do not pay gas to a stranger address

Scams: “gas station” sites that ask for a seed, or that take USDT and never send BNB. If you need BNB, withdraw BNB from the **same** exchange you already use, to **your** address, or swap a tiny amount on a venue you already trust. Do not discover a new website on the day you are stranded.

Do not send USDT to a Telegram “I’ll swap you BNB.” That is P2P without escrow, under panic. Panic is their leverage.

PancakeSwap is a DEX you are not using yet. Do not connect a wallet to a clone swap to “turn USDT into BNB” on the night you are stuck. That is how approvals drain you. Come back in Intermediate with a calm brain.

How much BNB is “a little”

Enough for many simple token transfers, not a trading inventory. Amounts change with network conditions. Look at a few ordinary BscScan token transfers, read the BNB fee, multiply by a conservative number (tens of transfers, not two). Then add slack. Dust-level BNB that cannot pay one send is not fuel. It is a decoration.

ACADEMY NOTE Academy checkout for paid tracks later expects USDT on BNB Smart Chain. It still will not pay your gas for you. Keeping a little BNB is part of living on BSC. We will not tell you to buy BNB as an investment. We will tell you that tokens do not pay their own fare.

Paying academy checkout later, still needs fuel

When Intermediate checkout is live, you will send USDT on BEP-20 to the checkout processor through a published page. That send is an on-chain token transfer. It will not go through if the sending wallet has USDT and 0 BNB.

So the “little BNB” is not a trading opinion. It is fare for later adult payments, including tuition, including sending to a friend, including moving to a new device’s address. Buy it as a tiny spot conversion on the CEX, withdraw it as native BNB on BSC, keep it as fuel. Do not farm it through a stranger’s gas station.

If BNB’s naira price scares you, you need less BNB, not zero BNB. Look at fees on BscScan, multiply, add slack. Fear of the fuel price is how people skip fuel and then panic.

What this lesson is for

You should never withdraw a token-only stack to BSC and call the job done. Fuel is part of the first buy.

Say this out loud

- BNB is fuel on BNB Smart Chain. Tokens are cargo. USDT does not pay gas.
- Withdrawing USDT alone can strand you looking at a balance you cannot move.
- A helper who adds gas in exchange for a seed is a thief.
- Withdraw a little BNB on purpose, same address, native BNB on BSC.
- Panic gas stations and clone DEX sites are how stranded people get emptied.

Next: a full first-buy walkthrough, as a story you can copy as a checklist — not as a command to buy today.

Lesson 3: Walkthrough: a boring first buy (narrated, not a call to action) (28 min)

Walkthrough: a boring first buy (narrated, not a call to action)

This lesson stitches the course so far into one narrative. It is **education**. It is not an instruction to open an account this hour, not a rate quote, and not a buy order for Crystal Stones or any other token.

By the end you should be able to narrate Ife’s steps in your own words, including the step where Ife stops for the day. Meet Ife. Ife finished Crypto Foundations and Wallets. Ife wants a practice stack on BNB Smart Chain: USDT they control, plus BNB for gas. Ife can lose this amount without missing rent.

1. Decide the venue on a calm day

Ife picks a CEX that actually serves their country, using a bookmarked domain. Ife does not use a clone ad. Ife enables authenticator 2FA, sets an anti-phishing code, and does not photograph the 2FA QR into WhatsApp. Ife does not use SMS 2FA as the long-term lock. Binance, if Ife uses it, is an example of a centralised exchange, not a command.

Ife will later whitelist a withdrawal address. Not today, not a stranger's address.

2. Fund

Ife uses in-app P2P, or a bank/card corridor if that exists in Ife's country. Ife pays the **in-trade** or official beneficiary details, exact amount, own named account. Ife does not move to WhatsApp. USDT appears as an **exchange IOU**. Ife does not tweet a BscScan link. There is nothing to link yet.

If a card was used, Ife reads whether withdrawals are delayed. Ife does not rage at a chargeback window.

3. Keep a little BNB

Ife market-buys a small BNB amount against USDT on a liquid pair. Practice size. Ife does not spend the whole stack on a thin alt. Ife does not open futures. Ife checks the fee line on the receipt. Ife still holds IOUs.

4. Prepare the destination

Ife opens the **official** wallet app — Trust Wallet or MetaMask are examples of wallet apps, not endorsements — network **BNB Smart Chain**, copies the receive address by the wallet's copy button. Ife does not type it by hand. Ife does not paste into a chat "please confirm this is right." Clipboard malware is Module 5. Today Ife checks first 6 and last 6 on the wallet screen.

5. Withdrawal screen, read every line

- Asset: USDT
- Network: **BNB Smart Chain / BEP-20** (not ERC-20, not TRC-20, not a randomly named "BSC2")
- Address: paste, visually check first 6 and last 6
- Amount: a **test** first
- Fee: visible

Ife sends the test. Ife opens BscScan, pastes **their** address, waits for the token transfer row. Only then Ife sends the rest, and a separate small BNB withdraw. If the test does not show, Ife stops. Ife does not send the rest to "push it."

6. Whitelist and stop

After the test works, Ife whitelists that address for USDT and BNB. Future Ife is harder to steal. Ife does not then ape a ticker. Ife does not connect the wallet to a "claim Crystal Stones airdrop." Ife does not screenshot the seed. Ife does not tell a group the exact amount.

Step	Done when	Failure if skipped
Venue	Bookmark + authenticator 2FA + anti-phishing	Clone login

Fund	IOU visible; no off-platform side quest	WhatsApp broker, wrong name
BNB	Enough gas headroom bought as IOU, then withdrawn	Stranded USDT
Test withdraw	BscScan row on the right asset and network	Vanished stack
Rest + whitelist	Same address, same network	Stolen session later
Stop for the day	No airdrop, no thin alt, no futures	The night the group waited for

Worked scenario. This whole lesson is the worked scenario. Numbered as Ife lived it:

400. Calm venue. Real domain. Authenticator. Anti-phishing word.
401. Fund via a parented door. Exact name. Exact amount. IOU, not chain.
402. Tiny BNB on a liquid spot market. Still IOUs.
403. Copy address from wallet on BNB Smart Chain. Eyes on first 6 and last 6.
404. Test USDT on BEP-20. Explorer agrees. Then the rest. Then BNB native.
405. Whitelist. Stop. Rent still exists. No Crystal Stones purchase. No the checkout processor practice to a chat wallet — tuition, when live, is a published checkout, not tonight’s improvisation.

DIAGRAM

```
Calm setup --> fund IOU --> slice of BNB --> test USDT on BEP-20
--> explorer agrees --> remainder + BNB --> whitelist --> stop for the day
```

```
Any rush ("send now the window closes") --> abort
```

What Ife does not do that night

- does not connect the wallet to a DEX Ife is not using yet
- does not buy a clone token because the ticker is similar
- does not send Crystal Stones anywhere; Ife did not buy it, and this course did not ask Ife to
- does not pay a mentor who DMs a wallet
- does not skip the test because the fee “feels like a waste”

ACADEMY NOTE If any step feels like a rush, abort. Liquidity will still exist tomorrow. Thieves prefer tonight. This walkthrough is a checklist you can speak. It is not a push notification to buy.

Timing: this is not “tonight if the group is green”

Ife’s story is a sequence, not a clock. If KYC takes three days, the sequence waits. If a card corridor holds withdrawals for a week, the sequence waits. If the wallet seed is still in the camera roll, the sequence waits at the IOU.

Rushing the walkthrough to match a listing rumour is how step 5 (network radio) gets skipped. The walkthrough includes the word **stop**. If you cannot say stop, you are not narrating Ife. You are narrating the group.

Speak the walkthrough once without a phone in hand. Then, if you still want to practise with money you can lose, walk it slowly. This paragraph is still not a buy order.

What this lesson is for

You should be able to teach life's evening to someone else without turning it into a call to action or a branded advert.

Say this out loud

- A first buy is a checklist, not a mood: venue, fund, BNB, test, explorer, rest, whitelist, stop.
- Test send, then the rest. Explorer agrees, or it did not happen.
- Exchange IOU and on-chain coins are different chapters of the same evening.
- Stop after the boring win. Do not ape, and do not buy Crystal Stones because a walkthrough existed.
- This was narration, not an order ticket.

Next: order books, slippage, and “filled” versus “I meant to.”

Lesson 4: Order books, slippage, and “filled” versus “I meant to” (26 min)

Order books, slippage, and “filled” versus “I meant to”

The button says Buy. The book decides what you get.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to glance at an order book, say what a fill is, name slippage without folklore, and refuse the sentence “I meant to buy at the last price.” An **order book** is the list of resting bids and asks at a venue: people willing to buy or sell at stated prices, in stated sizes.

What the book is showing

Each **ask** is a sell order waiting. Each **bid** is a buy order waiting. Depth is how much size sits near the middle. A liquid pair has a thick book: many small steps. A thin pair has a cliff: one ask at 1.00 for dust, then 1.12 for more, then 1.40.

A **market buy** walks up the asks until your size is filled. Your average price is not the last trade and not the first ask. It is the weighted walk. That walk is **slippage** when it is worse than you glanced.

A **limit buy** at 1.00 sits until asks fall to you, or it sits forever. It will not chase. That is the feature. It is also why “I placed it” is not “I have the asset.”

Filled, partial, cancelled, rejected

Filled means the venue matched you. You have a new IOU mix. The receipt is the truth, not the candle you wanted.

Partial fill means some size matched. The rest is still live or was cancelled depending on the order type. Beginners see 40% filled, buy again, then the rest fills. Double. Check Open Orders.

Cancelled means you or the system pulled it. **Rejected** means the engine said no: insufficient balance, trading halt, pair delisted, min notional too small.

“I meant to” is not a status. The book does not hear intent.

You thought	Book did	Adult read
Last price was 600	Your market buy ate asks up to 601.2	Slippage on a liquid pair; usually small
Last price was 1.00 on a thin alt	Your market buy printed 1.18	You were the candle
I placed a limit	Unfilled, still open	You do not have the asset yet
It filled twice	Residual plus a second market	You did not look at Open Orders
I bought Crystal Stones	You bought a ticker with a similar name	Contract not checked; this course still did not ask you to buy it

Worked scenario. Sam sees BNB/USDT last = 600. Sam market-buys a practice size.

406. The first ask is 600.1 for plenty of size. Sam fills at about 600.1 plus taker fee. Boring. Correct for this course.

407. Sam then “just looks” at a thin TOKEN/USDT book. Last is 0.050. Sam market-buys the same pride size.

408. The book had 20 USDT of asks near 0.050, then a gap. Sam’s average is 0.061. The chart prints a spike. The group says “whale.” The whale was Sam.

409. Sam did not get the last price. Sam got the walk. “I meant to buy at 0.050” is a diary entry, not a refund.

410. Sam checks the spot receipt, not Twitter. The fill is final on the company’s book.

DIAGRAM

```

Asks stacked above
  1.18  |||||
  1.12  |||
  1.00  |      <-- last trade was here, tiny
Bids stacked below
  0.92  |||
  0.90  |||||

```

A market buy of large size climbs the ask stairs.
The last trade was a footstep, not a floor.

Min notionals, tick size, and halt buttons

Exchanges set a **minimum notional** (you cannot buy 0.0001 USDT of something). They set a **tick size** (price increments). They can **halt** a pair. None of these are the chain. They are house rules. If a halt hits, your unfilled limit sits in limbo until they say otherwise. Your filled IOU is still their IOU.

PancakeSwap, a DEX you are not using yet, does not have this same book. It has a pool and a curve. Different machine. Do not import DEX folklore into a CEX ticket.

How to not be surprised

- Read the confirm popup’s **estimated amount**
- Prefer liquid pairs for practice
- Cap size so a 1% walk is still practice money
- Look at Open Orders after every click

- Do not market-buy a thin book “because the screenshot was green”

ACADEMY NOTE Filled is a venue fact. It is not a moral verdict and not a chain settlement. You still have not withdrawn. Education only — we are not coaching you to scalp spread or to hunt Crystal Stones wicks.

Market orders on liquid pairs still deserve a glance at depth

Even BNB/USDT can gap around news. A one-second glance at the depth — is there size at this ask, or a paper-thin wall — is enough. If the wall is paper and your size is pride, switch to a limit you understand or shrink.

“Filled at a worse price than the YouTube thumbnail” is not refundable. Support will not unwind a spot fill because a candle looked different on another venue. The receipt is the venue’s truth.

If you placed a limit and it filled while you were asleep, that is the limit working. Check Open Orders and balances in the morning before you place another. Night fills plus morning markets is how size doubles without a second mood.

Intent is not a status on the receipt

Support will not unwind a spot fill because a thumbnail on another venue looked cheaper. The receipt is this venue’s truth. If a limit filled while you slept, that is the limit working — check Open Orders before you place another, or size doubles without a second mood. “I meant to buy Crystal Stones” is the same grammar: intent is not a fill, and this course still did not ask for that fill.

What this lesson is for

You should be able to look at a fill and describe it as a walk up (or down) a book, not as a broken promise from “the market.”

Say this out loud

- The order book is resting bids and asks at one venue. Last is history.
- A market order walks the book. Slippage is that walk.
- Filled is what happened. “I meant to” is not a status.
- Partial fills plus a second click are how people double a position.
- Thin books are how a beginner becomes the candle.

Next: do not ape the next ticker — stop rules before the button.

Lesson 5: Do not ape the next ticker — stop rules before the button (26 min)

Do not ape the next ticker — stop rules before the button

The most expensive hour after a first buy is the hour you feel competent.

By the end of this lesson you should have a written **stop rule**: a sentence you say before any extra click, especially when a group drops a ticker. **Ape** means: buy because of urgency, shame, or a screenshot, without a size, a pair, or a reason you could repeat tomorrow. This academy will not tell you to buy Crystal Stones. It will tell you to stop.

Competence is a mood, not a skill

You funded. You filled a liquid pair. You still hold IOUs. That is a procedure win. It is not a license to hunt 40x names. The brain treats “I did a thing in crypto” as “I should do more.” That is how practice size becomes rent.

Write the stop rules **before** you are in the chat. After is too late.

Stop rules you can actually use

- 411. **One practice ticket per day.** Ife’s evening is enough. Sleep.
- 412. **No ticker you cannot spell and cannot find a contract for.** If it is Crystal Stones, the only contract this academy will ever name is `0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00` on BNB Smart Chain, and naming it is verification, not a buy order.
- 413. **No futures, no leverage, no “copy trade.”** Spot only.
- 414. **No second asset because the first one “isn’t moving.”** Boredom is not a strategy.
- 415. **No size increase because you “understand it now.”** You understand a button. That is not alpha.
- 416. **If a message says “last chance,” it is not.** Liquidity, if real, will exist after you sleep. Thieves prefer tonight.

Trigger	What you tell yourself	What you do
Group screenshot, green candle	Screenshots are not fills	Close the chat; book still closed
“Crystal Stones listing incoming”	Listing is a business claim to verify, not a market order	Do not buy; this course forbids the ape
Thin alt, 8% spread	I would be the candle	Walk away
Friends made money	They did not publish their all-in fees or the ones who lost	Your practice size stays practice
Boredom after a successful test withdraw	Competence mood	Stop for the day

Worked scenario. After Ife’s boring first buy, a WhatsApp group posts “CSTN now, we go 10x, don’t miss.”

- 417. Ife wants to feel inside the room. Hands move toward Convert.
- 418. Ife reads the stop rules, out loud. One practice ticket per day. Already used.
- 419. Ife checks: is this even the contract `0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00`? The group paste is a different address with a similar name.
- 420. Ife buys nothing. Ife does not argue in the group. Arguing is how they keep you in the room until you click.
- 421. Next week some of the group is empty and asking for recovery agents. Ife still has the practice USDT and BNB. That is the win.

DIAGRAM

```
First boring fill
|
v
Competence mood ----stop rules----> go to sleep
|
X ape the next ticker
X open futures "just to see"
X raise size because "I get it now"
X buy a clone contract with the right letters
```

What about “research”

Research, for this academy, is: which book, which contract, which fee, which size you can lose. It is not a ten-page PDF from the group. It is not a YouTuber’s leverage tutorial. If you cannot write four lines — asset, venue, size, what still sits as IOU — you are not researching. You are hunting a feeling.

Crystal Stones’ RWA story, if you meet it later, is **their claim to verify**. It is not a market order. It is not this lesson’s homework.

The button is the last step, not the first

Before Buy:

- pair named, both sides
- spot, not futures
- size that does not change rent
- fee line visible
- stop rule still satisfied

If any line is missing, the button waits. The book will not send you a thank-you note for hesitating. Your future self might.

ACADEMY NOTE This academy’s Basic track is not a trading desk. We will not celebrate a profitable ape. We will celebrate a student who can narrate a fill and then not take a second one. You should not buy Crystal Stones because you finished a walkthrough.

Shame is a trading signal — for the other side

Groups use shame: “you still in USDT, coward.” Shame is not information about a book. It is social pressure toward a click. Your stop rules are allowed to sound boring in a loud chat. You do not owe the chat a conversion.

If you already aped once, the second rule is: do not ape-to-recover. The thin ticker that took 20% will not courteously give it back because you doubled. Practice size means you can close the app and still eat.

Write the rules on the same paper as the personal ledger. Rules that live only in a lesson file get forgotten at 11 p.m.

Put the phone in another room

A stop rule can be physical: after the first fill, the phone leaves the room. Ridiculous. Effective. Shame from a group (“still in USDT, coward”) is not book information. If you already aped once, do not ape-to-recover. Practice size means you can close the app and still eat.

What this lesson is for

You should have stop rules that survive a group chat, and you should treat “next ticker” as a test of those rules, not as opportunity.

Say this out loud

- Competence after a first fill is a mood. It is not a reason to raise size.
- Stop rules are written before the chat, spoken before the button.
- Last-chance tickers, clone contracts, and futures buttons are how practice size dies.
- Naming Crystal Stones’ contract is verification, not a buy order.
- One boring ticket, then stop for the day.

Next: when the exchange screen and the chain will disagree — they should, because you have not withdrawn.

Lesson 6: When the exchange screen and the chain will disagree (they should — you have not withdrawn) (26 min)

When the exchange screen and the chain will disagree (they should — you have not withdrawn)

After a spot buy, students open BscScan, paste an address, see zero, and panic. That panic is this lesson’s entire job.

By the end you should treat disagreement as the **expected** state until a withdrawal confirms, and you should know which screen is boss for which fact. **Boss screen** means: the ledger that is allowed to be right for that question.

Two questions, two books

Question A — What does the company owe me?

Boss: the exchange app, on the bookmarked site. Spot balances, open orders, funding history.

Question B — What does BNB Smart Chain say my address holds?

Boss: BscScan (or your wallet talking to BSC). Only updates when an on-chain transaction hits that address.

If you have not withdrawn, BscScan **should** show 0 at your personal address (or whatever was already there from earlier). The exchange showing 50 USDT and BscScan showing 0 is not a bug. It is two honest books describing two different objects.

Fact you want	Boss screen	Wrong screen
Available USDT IOU	Exchange spot wallet	BscScan
Open limit order	Exchange Open Orders	Your bank SMS
On-chain USDT at my 0x	BscScan token tab	Exchange screenshot
Whether a withdrawal left the company	Exchange withdrawal history plus explorer tx	A WhatsApp admin
BNB for gas on my address	BscScan + wallet on BSC	Exchange BNB IOU you have not withdrawn

Worked scenario. Ife has 40 USDT and 0.02 BNB as IOUs after the boring first buy. Ife has not withdrawn.

422. Ife pastes the Trust Wallet address into BscScan. Token tab: 0 USDT. BNB: 0.

423. A group member says “they stole it, the chain doesn’t see it.”

424. Ife says the sentence from Module 1: exchange balance is an IOU. The chain has never heard of Ife’s email.

425. Ife withdraws a test 1 USDT on BEP-20. After confirmations, BscScan shows 1 USDT. The exchange shows 39. Disagreement remains, smaller, and still correct.

426. Ife does not “fix” the remaining 39 by sending a seed to a helper who will “sync the chain.” There is nothing to sync. There is a withdrawal Ife has not clicked.

DIAGRAM

Exchange screen	BscScan at your 0x
40 USDT IOU	0 USDT
0.02 BNB IOU	0 BNB
	^
only after withdraw	
+-----+	

Disagreement is the diagram.

Agreement happens per asset, per successful withdrawal.

Internal transfers and “I sent it to my other account”

If you move USDT from Spot to Funding, or to another user of the same CEX, BscScan still shows 0. You shuffled rows. If you send to a friend who uses a **different** company, that is usually a withdrawal (on-chain) or an off-platform mess. Read the screen: does it ask for a network? Then you are leaving the building.

Explorers can also confuse you

BscScan will not show ERC-20 USDT. Etherscan will not show BEP-20 USDT. If you withdraw on BSC and search Etherscan, you will see 0 and think it failed. Wrong explorer is another disagreement that “should” happen.

Wallet apps hide tokens you have not “enabled.” The chain can hold a token the UI has not listed. BscScan token tab is the adult check, not a missing icon.

When disagreement is actually a problem

- Withdrawal history says complete, explorer of **that** network shows nothing — wait confirmations, then ticket with hash.
- Explorer shows a tx to a different address — paste attack (Module 5).
- Explorer shows the tx on TRC-20 while you thought BEP-20 — wrong network.
- Exchange balance dropped with no withdrawal you started — session theft; freeze.

Those are problems. “I bought and BscScan is zero” is not, by itself.

ACADEMY NOTE Do not let a helper “align the exchange with the chain” by taking remote control. The books are supposed to differ until you withdraw. Academy staff will not sync anything. the checkout processor checkout, when live, also will not show on your CEX screen; it will show on BscScan after you pay from a wallet that actually has USDT BEP-20 and BNB for gas.

Screenshots are not either book

A screenshot of the CEX can be old. A screenshot of BscScan can be a different address. A screenshot from a group can be edited. When you reconcile, open the live bookmark and the live explorer. Do not reconcile against photos.

If a helper says “see, BscScan shows your USDT” and the URL is not bscscan.com on an address you recognise, you are being shown theatre. Type the explorer yourself. Paste the address yourself from the wallet receive screen.

Disagreement before withdraw is expected. Fake agreement from a stranger’s screenshot is an attack.

Do not reconcile against photos, and do not use testnet

Open the live bookmark and the live explorer. A helper’s screenshot is theatre. Type bscscan.com yourself. Paste the address from the wallet receive screen. BSC testnet is a different book; practice money on mainnet (chain ID 56) will not appear there.

What this lesson is for

You should hear “the screens disagree” and ask “have I withdrawn that asset on that network?” before you ask “was I robbed?”

Say this out loud

- After a spot buy, the exchange screen and the chain should disagree. You have not withdrawn.
- Company book answers what they owe you. Explorer answers what your address holds.
- Internal transfers are still their ledger. No public hash.
- Wrong explorer (Etherscan for a BSC send) produces a fake zero.
- “Sync the chain” helpers are thieves. There is nothing to sync but a withdrawal you control.

Take the quiz. Next module: withdrawing without vanishing the stack — networks, test sends, paste attacks, explorers, dust and delays.

Module quiz (answers included for editors)

Q1. For a first tiny buy on a liquid pair like BNB/USDT, this course's default is?

- A. A 100x futures long
- B. A market order of practice size
- C. A grid bot
- D. Buying a clone ticker with the same letters

Correct answer: B

Q2. You withdrew USDT BEP-20 to your wallet and have 0 BNB. You can?

- A. Freely send the USDT
- B. Not send the USDT until you have BNB for gas
- C. Pay gas in USDT automatically
- D. Burn the token to create BNB

Correct answer: B

Q3. In the boring first-buy walkthrough, the rest of the USDT is withdrawn only after?

- A. A Telegram admin says go
- B. A test send shows on BscScan at your address on the right network
- C. You feel confident
- D. The exchange chat replies with a sticker

Correct answer: B

Q4. A market buy on a thin book fills far above last price. What happened?

- A. The blockchain reversed last
- B. Your order walked the asks; slippage made you the candle
- C. KYC failed
- D. USDT became another chain by itself

Correct answer: B

Q5. After a spot buy, before any withdrawal, BscScan shows 0 at your address. That means?

- A. The exchange stole the coins
- B. The screens should disagree — you still hold an IOU, not on-chain coins
- C. You must paste your seed to sync BscScan
- D. Academy checkout already took it

Correct answer: B

Q6. "I bought so it is in my wallet already" is?

- A. True for every CEX spot fill

- B. False — a spot fill is a company IOU until a withdrawal confirms
- C. True if 2FA is on
- D. True if the candle was green

Correct answer: B

Q7. A group says last chance to ape Crystal Stones tonight. This course says?

- A. Market-buy whatever address they paste
- B. Stop: this is not a buy order; verify is not a ticket, and one practice fill is enough for the day
- C. Open 10x futures for efficiency
- D. Pay a mentor wallet to be allocated

Correct answer: B

Q8. A stranger offers to “add gas” if you type your seed. You?

- A. Accept, they are kind
- B. Refuse — that is theft
- C. Send half the words
- D. Post the seed in the dispute chat for transparency

Correct answer: B

Module 5: Withdrawing without vanishing the stack

The dangerous hour: BEP-20 versus ERC-20 versus TRC-20, the test-send ritual, paste attacks, explorers over group chats, dust, outages, and travel-rule delays.

Lesson 1: BEP-20, ERC-20, TRC-20 — three books named USDT (28 min)

BEP-20, ERC-20, TRC-20 — three books named USDT

USDT is a **brand** of token issued on more than one chain. The letters are the same. The books are not.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to stand in front of a withdrawal screen, name the three flavours beginners actually meet, and refuse the belief that “USDT is one chain.” If you pick the wrong **network**, you can send value into a place your wallet is not watching — sometimes recoverable with expert help, often not for a beginner, occasionally gone.

Name the flavours you will actually meet

ERC-20 USDT — USDT as a contract on **Ethereum**. Addresses look like `0x...`. Gas is paid in ETH. Fees can be brutal on a small stack. Confirmations can feel slow. “ERC-20 is original” is a YouTube sentence, not a reason to spend a week of naira on gas.

TRC-20 USDT — USDT on **Tron**. Addresses often start with `T`. Fees are a different system. A BSC wallet will not show this by default. Many P2P desks love TRC-20 because it is cheap for them. Cheap for them is not “correct for your wallet.”

BEP-20 USDT — USDT as a contract on **BNB Smart Chain**. Addresses look like `0x...` — **the same shape as Ethereum**. Gas is BNB. This is the flavour this academy uses for practice and later for USDT tuition rails.

The 0x shape is the trap. People think “the address worked on Ethereum so it is the same money.” It is the same **text**. It is not the same **book**. Chain ID for BSC mainnet is **56**. Ethereum mainnet is **1**. Wallets that speak both still keep two ledgers.

Withdrawal network	Chain	Address look	Gas / fee reality	Explorer
ERC-20	Ethereum	0x...	ETH; can be expensive	Etherscan
BEP-20 / BSC	BNB Smart Chain	0x...	BNB; usually survivable for practice	BscScan
TRC-20	Tron	often T...	Different wallet/network entirely	Tronscan
Something else (Solana, etc.)	Other	Other shapes	Wrong wallet will not see it	That chain’s explorer

Worked scenario. Kelechi copies a Trust Wallet address while the app is on BNB Smart Chain. Trust Wallet is an example of a wallet app, not an endorsement. On Binance — an example of a centralised exchange — he selects USDT, network **ERC20**, because a YouTube thumbnail said “ERC20 is original.”

427. He confirms. Ethereum includes a transfer to that 0x address **on Ethereum**.
428. His Trust Wallet, still on BSC, shows 0. He thinks it failed.
429. It did not fail. It sat on another book. Recovering it means opening Ethereum on a wallet that can speak Ethereum, with ETH for gas, and understanding that this is now an Ethereum problem.
430. Panic-sending a second withdrawal “to try BEP20 as well” is how people double-lose.
431. He stops. He opens the withdrawal receipt, reads **ERC-20**, opens Etherscan, finds the tx. Only then does he plan recovery. He does not hire a Telegram agent.

DIAGRAM

Same 0x text

```

|
+--> Ethereum book (ERC-20 USDT)      [Etherscan]
+--> BNB Smart Chain book (BEP-20 USDT) [BscScan]
+--> (not) Tron book                  [Tronscan, usually T...]

```

Balances are NOT shared.

Picking a radio button is picking a notebook.

How to choose for this academy

If the destination is a BSC wallet you set up in the last course, the withdrawal network is **BNB Smart Chain / BEP-20**. Not “default.” Not “cheapest without reading.” Match the destination’s book.

Crystal Stones the project token is BEP-20 on BSC:

```
`0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00`
```

You cannot withdraw Crystal Stones as ERC-20 from an exchange that never listed it on Ethereum. You cannot magically bridge by picking a different radio button. This academy still will not tell you to withdraw it or buy it.

Other labels you may see: “BSC,” “BNB Smart Chain,” “BEP20 (BSC).” Those are trying to name the same book. “BNB Beacon Chain (BEP2)” is an older, different system. Do not pick BEP2 because it says BEP. Read the words **Smart Chain**.

Defaults are not your friend

Exchange UIs remember the last network, or they pick the cheapest, or they pick the most common in your country (often TRC-20 in some African P2P markets). None of those defaults can see your wallet. You can. Select every time as if the screen were blank.

ACADEMY NOTE If you already sent on the wrong network, stop. Do not send a second stack. Do not give a “recovery agent” your seed. BscScan / Etherscan / Tronscan — pick the explorer **for the network you actually selected on the withdrawal receipt** — and see if the tx is real. Recovery, if possible, is a careful later step, often with a wallet that speaks that chain. The Safety course covers panic behaviour.

Why desks push TRC-20 and YouTubers push ERC-20

P2P desks often prefer TRC-20 because their fee sheet likes it. Western thumbnails often say ERC-20 because they learned Ethereum first. Your wallet, if you set it up in the Wallets course for BSC, prefers BEP-20. Three tribes, three radios. None of them can see your screen.

Your sentence: “Destination is BSC, so USDT BEP-20, explorer BscScan, gas BNB.” If a desk cannot send that, you need a different desk or a conscious extra hop — not an accidental hop. Extra hops are how practice size dies in two books at once.

Never let a fee table pick the network for you. The cheapest wrong book is the most expensive line.

What this lesson is for

You should treat the network radio as the most expensive control on the withdrawal page — more expensive than the fee line.

Say this out loud

- USDT is a name on several books. BEP-20, ERC-20, and TRC-20 are not one chain.
- 0x does not mean BSC. It might be Ethereum. Match withdrawal network to the wallet’s network.
- Wrong network plus a second panic send is how losses double.

- BEP2 is not BEP-20. Smart Chain is chain ID 56. Explorer: BscScan.
- Crystal Stones is BEP-20 to verify, not a bridge experiment.

Next: the test-send ritual, written as a procedure you can run every time.

Lesson 2: The test-send ritual (tiny amount, wait, then the rest) (27 min)

The test-send ritual (tiny amount, wait, then the rest)

Every non-trivial withdrawal has two transactions: a **probe**, then the **rest**. People skip the probe because the fee feels like a waste. The fee is insurance.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to run the ritual without a group chat, and you should treat “I’ll send it all, I’m careful” as the sentence that empties careful people. A **test send** is a withdrawal small enough to shrug at, used to prove address, network, and asset before the amount that would hurt.

When a test is mandatory

- first time this asset leaves this exchange
- first time this address is used
- any time you changed network, device, or wallet app
- any time the amount would hurt if it vanished
- any time a human (broker, friend, “academy wallet”) is the destination — and for academy tuition, the destination is a published academy checkout, not a chat, when that exists
- after you reinstalled a wallet, even if the words look the same

If none of those apply and you sent to this exact whitelist yesterday, you can still test. Pride is cheaper than a probe.

Procedure

432. On the wallet, set the network to BNB Smart Chain. Copy the receive address with the copy button.
433. On the exchange, paste. Check first 6 and last 6 characters against the wallet screen — with your eyes, not with a friend in chat.
434. Select **BEP-20 / BSC** for USDT (or BNB native for BNB).
435. Send the smallest amount the platform allows, or a few dollars equivalent — an amount you can shrug at.
436. Wait. Open **BscScan**. Paste **your** address, not a hash a stranger sent. Wait for the token row (USDT) or the BNB balance change.
437. Confirm asset, network, amount, destination. Only then send the rest. Same screen, same network, same address, already checked.
438. If the test fails, stop. Do not send the rest. Do not “try a different network with the full stack.”

Test shows	You do
BscScan token tab: USDT arrived, right address	Send the rest, still checking first 6 / last 6
Nothing on BscScan, tx on Etherscan	You picked ERC-20. Stop. Do not send the rest on a third network.
Nothing anywhere after the exchange says complete	Wait confirmations; then ticket with their tx hash

Arrived at an address you do not recognise	Paste attack. Freeze. Do not “retry.”
Wallet icon missing but BscScan has the token	UI hide; the book is fine. Do not resend.

Worked scenario. Yemi is withdrawing 80 USDT of practice money plus a little BNB.

- 439. Yemi sends 1 USDT BEP-20 first. Fee feels annoying. Yemi pays it.
- 440. Twelve minutes later BscScan shows 1 USDT at Yemi’s address. Wallet app shows it after a refresh.
- 441. Yemi sends the remaining 79 on the same network to the same address, then a small BNB native withdraw as a separate test-and-rest if the BNB size also matters.
- 442. If step 2 had shown zero, Yemi would still have 79. That is the whole religion.
- 443. A friend said “just send it, you did this last month.” Last month’s address was a different phone. The ritual does not care.

DIAGRAM

```

Copy address (wallet, BSC)
|
v
Paste + eyes on first 6 and last 6
|
v
Network = BEP-20 / BSC (for USDT)
|
v
Tiny amount --> wait --> BscScan agrees
|
+-- yes --> send the rest
+-- no  --> STOP. Ticket or recover the test. Never the remainder.

```

Waiting is part of the ritual

Exchanges queue. Chains confirm. Wallets cache. Ten minutes of boredom is not a failed tx. Refresh BscScan, not the send button. “Still pending” on the exchange means they have not finished broadcasting. “Pending” on the explorer means the chain has the tx and has not finished burying it. Those are different pendings. Read which screen.

Do not speed things up by raising gas on a CEX withdrawal. You do not control that gas. They do.

Fees on two sends

Two withdrawal fees are still cheaper than one funeral. If the platform’s minimum is already your whole stack, you are too small to be doing this today, or you accept that the whole stack **is** the test — which means the stack should have been practice size.

ACADEMY NOTE Never ask a group to “watch the test with you” by pasting the address in public. You do not need an audience. You need BscScan. Academy staff will not confirm your test send in WhatsApp. We will also not take the rest “to keep it safe.”

Minimums that force the test to be the stack

If the CEX minimum withdrawal is 10 USDT and you only have 10, then 10 **is** the test. That means 10 had to be practice size from the start. Do not deposit a month of rent and then discover the minimum is the whole pile.

Some platforms let you internal-transfer 1 USDT to a second account you control as a drill. That does not test the chain. Only a withdrawal tests the network radio. Do not confuse an internal move with a probe.

When the test lands, whitelist. The ritual is not finished at the explorer row. Sticky withdrawals are part of arriving.

Overnight pending is a sleep, not a second send

If the test sits pending overnight, sleep. Morning-you can read the explorer. Overnight-you will invent a second network. Internal transfers are not probes; only a withdrawal tests the radio.

What this lesson is for

You should be unable to hit Confirm on a full-size first withdrawal without feeling that you skipped a step.

Say this out loud

- Tiny amount, wait, explorer agrees, then the rest.
- The test fee is insurance, not a waste.
- If the test fails, the remainder stays put. No second network with the full stack.
- Wait is part of the ritual. Refresh the explorer, not the send button.
- Last month's successful send does not bless a new device or a new network.

Next: paste attacks and poisoned addresses — why your eyes on first 6 and last 6 are not optional.

Lesson 3: Paste attacks and poisoned addresses (26 min)

Paste attacks and poisoned addresses

You can pick the right network and still send to the wrong person. The clipboard is a battlefield.

By the end of this lesson you should treat every paste as hostile until your eyes check it, and you should know what **address poisoning** looks like. **Paste attack** means: malware or a “helper” replaces the address in your clipboard with theirs after you copy. **Poisoning** means: someone sends you a tiny tx from an address that looks like one you use, hoping you copy **their** address from the history.

Clipboard malware

You copy your address from the wallet. A hidden program swaps it for an attacker address. You paste into the exchange. First 6 and last 6, if you only check those on some fonts, can be made to rhyme. So you check more than the ends, and you check against the **wallet screen**, not against the chat log of what you think you copied.

Defences:

- copy with the wallet’s button, paste once, look at the exchange field
- compare first 6 **and** last 6 **and** a chunk in the middle to the wallet screen
- a hardware wallet that shows the address on its own display is stronger; if you have one, use the screen on the device
- do not install “clipboard manager plus crypto” APKs from groups
- do not let remote-desktop “support” watch you copy

If the pasted address and the wallet disagree, assume malware. Do not send. Move the remaining IOU only after you are on a cleaner device. This is freeze-and-breathe territory from Module 2.

Address poisoning

Your explorer history shows:

- a real incoming 50 USDT from the exchange
- a later incoming 0.001 USDT (or a fake-token “USDT”) from an address that starts and ends like the exchange’s hot wallet, or like your own other address

You later copy “the address I always use” from history, and you copy the poison. You just volunteered.

Defences:

- do not copy destination addresses from explorer history
- copy from the wallet receive screen, or from a paper whitelist you wrote
- on BscScan, a dust incoming from a lookalike is a clue to ignore that from-address forever
- hide spam tokens; do not interact

What you copied from	Verdict
Wallet receive button, then eyes vs screen	Default
Hardware device display	Better
Exchange whitelist you added after a test	Good
BscScan history of lookalike dust	Hostile
WhatsApp “here is your address again”	Hostile
A PDF invoice from “the checkout processor support” in chat	Hostile — published checkout is not a DM

Worked scenario. Chika copies her BSC address, pastes into the CEX, checks first 4 characters, sends 70 USDT.

444. Last 4 also matched a lookalike the malware had prepared. The middle did not. She did not look at the middle.
445. BscScan shows the tx to an address that is not the wallet’s receive screen.
446. The chain did its job. The clipboard lied.
447. Chika stops. She does not send a second 70 “because maybe it will bounce.” It will not bounce.
448. She kills sessions, scans the phone, and treats the remaining exchange IOU as still hers — because she did not send it. Freeze is still wise if the device is dirty.

DIAGRAM

```
Wallet shows: 0xA1B2 ... 89CD
Clipboard may: 0xA1B2 ... 89CD    (honest)
               or 0xA1B2 ... 77EE    (swap)
               or 0xA1B2 ... 89CD    lookalike with different middle
```

Eyes: first 6, last 6, AND a middle chunk.
History on BscScan: not a copy source.

Chat is not a confirmation channel

“Please confirm this is my address” in WhatsApp is how people get a yes from a cloned contact. You do not need a friend to confirm your own receive screen. If you are paying someone else, you need an out-of-band check you already trust — not a like-reaction on a paste.

Academy tuition, when live, is USDT on BNB Smart Chain (BEP-20) through academy checkout through published checkout. It will not be a poisoned lookalike in a DM, and not PaynovaX.

Contract addresses are not destinations for a first withdrawal

Withdrawing USDT to the USDT **contract** address, or to Crystal Stones’ contract ``0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00``, does not “deposit into the token.” It can burn or strand funds depending on how that contract handles incoming transfers. You withdraw to **your wallet address**, the one that holds keys. Verify a contract to identify a token. Do not treat the contract as a mailbox.

ACADEMY NOTE If a paste already went wrong, the explorer is the truth. Do not chase with a recovery agent. Do not send more. Write down the tx hash. The Safety course is where panic gets a longer protocol. Today: eyes on the string, every time.

Unicode lookalikes in the middle of 0x

Attackers can use characters that look like ``0`` or ``l`` in some fonts. Ends match, middle is a different address. If anything feels off — extra length, odd glyphs — cancel. Paste into a plain text field that shows the raw string. Hardware screens that checksum the address are better than tired eyes at midnight.

Also refuse QR codes from chats for your **own** receive address. You have a receive button. A QR from “support” is their address with your logo. Scan-to-send malware exists on phones too. Official app camera for a destination you already verified is one thing. A QR that arrived with a threat is another.

What this lesson is for

You should be unable to confirm a withdrawal without a visual check that would catch both malware and a poisoned history copy.

Say this out loud

- The clipboard can lie. Check first 6, last 6, and a middle chunk against the wallet screen.
- Do not copy addresses from explorer history. Poison dust exists to be copied.
- Chat confirmation of your own receive address is theatre, not security.
- Do not withdraw tokens to a contract address. Your wallet address is the mailbox.

- A wrong paste will not bounce. Do not send a second stack after it.

Next: after confirm, you believe the explorer — not the group chat.

Lesson 4: After confirm: explorer, not the group chat (26 min)

After confirm: explorer, not the group chat

The withdrawal button is not the finish line. The finish line is a row on the public book.

By the end of this lesson you should know which explorer to open, what to paste, which fields prove a success, and why a WhatsApp screenshot is not evidence. An **explorer** is a website that reads a chain and shows transactions, addresses, and token transfers. For BNB Smart Chain that explorer is **BscScan**.

What to open

- BEP-20 / BSC → **BscScan**
- ERC-20 / Ethereum → Etherscan
- TRC-20 / Tron → Tronscan

If you are not sure which you picked, the exchange withdrawal receipt names the network. Believe that line, then pick the explorer that matches. Do not pick the explorer a group member likes.

Paste **your address** or **the tx hash from the exchange**. Do not paste a hash a stranger sent “to help you look it up.” Hashes can be real transfers on a different chain, a different token, or someone else’s 1 USDT.

What success looks like on BscScan

For USDT: a **token transfer** row, contract matching the USDT BEP-20 the exchange uses, **To:** your address, amount matching what the receipt said (minus their fee, depending on how they display it). Status success. Enough confirmations that your wallet also sees it.

For BNB: a native transfer, value in BNB, to your address.

A failed on-chain tx is rare for a CEX withdrawal (they usually do not broadcast losers), but “dropped” and “replaced” exist. Read the status. Pending for a long time is wait, then ticket — not a group vote.

You see	It means	You do
BscScan token transfer to you, right asset	It landed	Update your personal ledger; stop
Etherscan success, you wanted BSC	Wrong book	Stop; do not send again; recover later if you can
Tronscan success, wallet on BSC shows 0	Wrong book	Same
Group screenshot of a green tick	Theatre	Ignore
“Support” hash that is a different token	Distraction	Only the receipt’s hash

Worked scenario. Ife’s test 1 USDT shows “completed” on the example CEX.

449. Ife copies the tx hash from the **bookmarked** withdrawal history, not from a DM.
450. Ife opens BscScan, pastes the hash. Token transfer: USDT, to Ife's address, 1 USDT.
451. Ife also pastes the address into BscScan and sees the same row on the token tab.
452. A group admin says "I don't see it, send again." Ife does not. The book sees it. The admin is not a ledger.
453. Ife sends the rest only because step 2 matched. Ife does not post the hash publicly. Public hashes plus amounts are a shopping list for thieves.

DIAGRAM

```
Exchange: "withdrawal complete" + tx hash
  |
  v
Explorer for THAT network
  |
  +-- success, right To, right asset --> believe the book
  +-- success, wrong chain/token      --> you mis-picked; do not retry blind
  +-- nothing                          --> wait confirmations, then official
ticket
```

Group chat is not on this diagram.

Wallets can lag; explorers less so

A wallet app might need a network switch, a pull-to-refresh, or a custom token add. BscScan already knows. If BscScan has the USDT and the app does not, add the token (the real USDT BEP-20 contract, not a lookalike) or wait. Do not withdraw again.

If you add a custom token, you are pointing the UI at a contract. Verify the contract. Crystal Stones, if you ever add it to look, is `0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00` — looking is not buying.

Tickets, not tributes

If the explorer of the named network shows nothing after a honest wait, open a ticket in the bookmarked app. Include hash, amount, asset, network, time. Do not pay a "priority investigator." Do not send BNB to a "boost address." Those are invoices.

ACADEMY NOTE Academy staff will not "confirm your hash" in WhatsApp as a substitute for BscScan. If someone wearing our name wants you to send a follow-up payment to make the explorer update, they are a thief. Explorers update because miners/validators included a tx, not because you paid a mentor.

How to read a BscScan token transfer without folklore

Open the tx. Check:

- Status: success, not dropped
- Token contract: the USDT you expect on BSC, not a spam token with the same letters
- From: the exchange hot wallet (it will not be your email)
- To: your address, matching first 6 / last 6 / middle

- Amount: the receive amount

If those five match, you are done. Comments at the bottom of BscScan are public graffiti. They often say “this is a scam, contact recovery.” That graffiti is the scam. Never message addresses from tx comments.

Save the hash in the personal ledger. Do not save it as a tweet.

Ignore BscScan comments

The comments under a tx are public graffiti, often “contact recovery.” That graffiti is the scam. Never message those addresses. If the five fields (status, contract, from, to, amount) match, you are done. Refreshing send is not refreshing the explorer.

What this lesson is for

You should retire the group chat as a settlement layer and replace it with the explorer of the network on the receipt.

Say this out loud

- After confirm, the explorer of that network is the boss, not the group chat.
- Paste your address or the receipt’s hash. Never a stranger’s “helper” hash.
- Success is the right asset to the right To. A green screenshot is theatre.
- If the wallet lags and BscScan shows the token, do not withdraw again.
- Tickets live in the bookmarked app. Boost-address invoices are theft.

Next: dust, leftovers, outages, and travel-rule delays — the unglamorous ways money sits still.

Lesson 5: Dust, leftovers, outages, and travel-rule delays (26 min)

Dust, leftovers, outages, and travel-rule delays

Not every missing unit was stolen. Some of it is **dust**, some is a leftover IOU, some is an outage, some is law.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to name those four stalls, and you should not feed them to a recovery agent. **Dust** means: an amount so small that fees make moving it silly. **Travel rule** means: extra identity information some platforms must collect before they let a withdrawal of a certain size leave, because regulators asked.

Dust and leftovers

After fees, you may have 0.40 USDT IOU on the exchange and 0.0002 BNB on-chain. Moving the BNB can cost more than it is worth. That is dust. Leave it, or live with it as leftover fuel if it still pays a send.

Leftovers also happen because you bought 0.01 BNB and withdrew 0.009 after a fee. The 0.001 is not missing. It is the bill, or it is below minimum withdrawal.

Do not “clean out” dust by connecting the wallet to a random sweeper site. Sweepers ask for signatures that can take the tokens that are **not** dust.

What you see	Likely cause	Adult move
0.30 USDT IOU, min withdraw is 1	Below minimum	Leave it or add size later; do not chase
Wallet shows 0.00015 BNB	Dust relative to gas	Leave as leftover fuel or ignore
Withdrawal pending 40 minutes, status page shows incident	Outage	Wait on their status page; no DM helpers
Withdrawal form asks who the beneficiary is	Travel-rule questionnaire	Answer honestly in the official form, or cancel; never in chat
Exchange down, Twitter says hack	Maybe, maybe rumour	Freeze assumptions; official status; do not send seeds

Worked scenario. Tobi withdraws most USDT, leaves 0.8 because the minimum is 1. He also has 0.001 BNB on-chain after gas.

- 454. He calls both “stolen by fees.” One is a min-withdraw leftover IOU. One is dust.
- 455. A site offers “dust aggregator — connect wallet.” He does not.
- 456. Next week the exchange has an outage. His remaining 0.8 is stuck as an IOU. Uncomfortable, not a chain failure.
- 457. When withdrawals reopen, a travel-rule popup asks for beneficiary details because he raised size. He fills it on the bookmarked site. He does not photograph the form into a group.
- 458. A DM says “pay 20 USDT to release travel rule.” He reports it. The popup never asked for a prepayment.

DIAGRAM

```

Still sitting somewhere
|
+-- below min withdraw --> leftover IOU
+-- smaller than gas    --> dust
+-- company incident    --> outage queue
+-- extra identity form --> travel-rule delay
+-- actually stolen      --> freeze, sessions, whitelist (Module 2)

```

Treat the last one as last, after you have named the first four.

Outages

Exchanges pause deposits, trades, or withdrawals. Chains can also clog; BSC is usually cheap and quick, not always. During a pause, your IOU is still their IOU. Spamming withdrawals can lock funds in “processing.” Read the status page from the bookmark, not a Twitter clone.

If the company is truly insolvent, you are a creditor. That is law, not a Telegram reverse-tx. This academy will not pretend a recovery wizard can un-insolve a firm.

Travel-rule and compliance delays

Larger withdrawals, new devices, new addresses, and some corridors trigger questionnaires: who owns the destination wallet, what is this for, source of funds. Annoying. Expected. Fill them in the official UI. Lying is fraud. Paying a stranger to “fast-track compliance” is theft plus, sometimes, a mule story.

Weekend plus a new whitelist address plus a first-time BEP-20 USDT withdrawal is a pile of delays that can look like a hack. It is often just the pile.

Do not donate leftovers to a stranger

“I’ll sweep your dust if you send the rest plus seed” is not a service. Neither is “send leftover USDT to this gas address.” If you want BNB, withdraw BNB. If you want the leftover IOU, wait until you are above minimum, or accept it as tuition to the fee schedule.

ACADEMY NOTE Crystal Stones Academy will not collect dust, leftovers, or “listing deposits.” Paid tracks, when live, are USDT on BNB Smart Chain (BEP-20) through academy checkout at a published checkout. A travel-rule delay on your CEX is your CEX. We cannot click withdraw for you, and anyone who says they can is not us.

When an outage meets a panic send

The pattern: withdrawals paused, group screams, someone DMs an “emergency OTC” that will take your IOU off-platform. That OTC is hunting people who cannot wait. If the IOU is practice size, you can wait. If it is not practice size, that was the earlier mistake.

Official status pages lie slowly. DMs lie fast. Prefer slow.

If travel-rule asks for the owner of the destination wallet, and the owner is you, say you. If the owner would be a cousin you are hiding, you are in a story this academy will not help you write. Cancel the withdrawal. Do not invent a beneficiary.

What this lesson is for

You should classify a stall before you escalate, and you should keep leftover size away from sweeper sites and chat invoices.

Say this out loud

- Dust is too small to move sanely. Leftovers are often min-withdraw or fees, not theft.
- Outages freeze IOUs. Status page, not DMs.
- Travel-rule forms belong in the official UI. They are not a 20 USDT chat invoice.
- Sweepers and gas-for-dust sites are how leftover tokens become missing tokens.
- Name the stall before you call it stolen.

Take the quiz. Last module is a lab: you will narrate a first buy and a first withdrawal without doing one, including the wrong-network failure.

Module quiz (answers included for editors)

Q1. USDT on BEP-20, ERC-20, and TRC-20 is?

- A. One chain with three nicknames
- B. Three different books sharing a brand name; pick the network that matches the destination
- C. Always interchangeable because 0x is 0x

D. Only real on Ethereum

Correct answer: B

Q2. Kelechi withdraws USDT to a BSC wallet but selects ERC-20. The BSC wallet shows 0. What should he do first?

- A. Immediately send the same amount on TRC-20 to push it
- B. Stop, read the receipt's network, open that chain's explorer, and not send a second full stack
- C. Paste his seed to Binance support in Telegram
- D. Assume BscScan is broken

Correct answer: B

Q3. The test-send ritual is?

- A. A waste of fees for careful people
- B. Tiny amount, wait until the right explorer agrees, then send the rest
- C. Ask the group chat to approve the hash
- D. Send half the seed with the test

Correct answer: B

Q4. Clipboard malware is dangerous because?

- A. It changes chain ID 56 to 1 inside BNB
- B. It can swap the pasted address so you withdraw to the attacker
- C. It prints extra USDT
- D. It disables 2FA legally

Correct answer: B

Q5. After a withdrawal shows complete, the boss record is?

- A. A WhatsApp screenshot from an admin
- B. The explorer for the network on the receipt, showing the right asset to the right address
- C. A YouTube comment
- D. a payment Telegram

Correct answer: B

Q6. A required memo was skipped on a deposit to a pooled address. Best description?

- A. The blockchain ate it
- B. The chain confirmed; the company cannot label your IOU — ticket, no seed
- C. Memos are always optional
- D. BscScan will invent the memo overnight

Correct answer: B

Q7. Address poisoning hopes you will?

- A. Enable 2FA
- B. Copy a lookalike address from explorer history and send to the attacker
- C. Use a bookmark
- D. Pay gas in BNB

Correct answer: B

Q8. Travel-rule extra questions on a large withdrawal mean?

- A. You must pay a DM to unlock
- B. A compliance form on the official site; answer there or cancel — not a chat invoice
- C. The token is fake
- D. Support will withdraw for you if you read 2FA aloud

Correct answer: B

Module 6: Lab: narrate a first buy without doing one

Records you actually keep, screens after a withdrawal, self-custody only after Wallets habits, a spoken lab including wrong-network failure, and an honest fence around what this course is not.

Lesson 1: A personal ledger is not Twitter (records you actually keep) (26 min)

A personal ledger is not Twitter (records you actually keep)

If you cannot say what you paid, what you hold, and where it sits, you did not finish a first buy. You performed one.

By the end of this lesson you should have a private **personal ledger**: a written record for yourself, not a feed. **Personal ledger** means: the notes you keep of dates, venues, amounts, fees, networks, tx hashes, and which book the value sits on. It is not a Twitter thread. It is not a WhatsApp flex. It is not tax advice — we are not your tax advisor — it is how adults remember.

What you actually write down

For each movement, at least:

- date and time (your timezone)
- venue (which CEX, which wallet app — examples, not ads)
- asset and amount
- what you paid in local currency or in USDT, all-in if you can
- network, if any chain was touched
- tx hash, if any chain was touched

- where it sits **now**: CEX IOU, or which chain at which address (first 6 / last 6 only in the notes if you are paranoid about screenshots)
- whether a test send already blessed this destination

You do not need fancy software. Paper, a local encrypted note, a spreadsheet that is not a screenshot in a group. Do not photograph this next to a seed. Do not put a seed in the ledger. An exchange login is not a seed either — do not store passwords here.

Record	Why it exists	Wrong home for it
All-in naira (or dollars) spent	So you cannot lie to yourself about “profit”	A group chat
Withdrawal tx hash	So a ticket has a spine	Twitter
Network used	So you do not “remember BEP-20” incorrectly	Memory
Current book (IOU vs chain)	So screens that disagree do not scare you	A mentor DM
Seed phrase	Does not belong in this ledger	Anywhere digital, period

Worked scenario. Ife, after the narrated evening, writes four lines in a notebook kept with household papers, not in the camera roll.

459. “12 Mar — example CEX — P2P — 30,000 naira → 18.2 USDT IOU (seller rate 1,648; no off-platform chat).”
460. “Same day — market-bought 0.02 BNB, still IOU. Receipt fee 0.02 USDT.”
461. “Same day — test 1 USDT BEP-20, hash 0xabc... on BscScan, then remainder, then 0.02 BNB native. Address 0xA1B2...89CD. Whitelist on.”
462. “Sitting now: 0 USDT on CEX, ~17 USDT BEP-20 in wallet, ~0.019 BNB after gas. Practice. Not Crystal Stones. Stop.”

Ife does not post line 3. A hash plus an amount is a map.

DIAGRAM

```
Public feed (Twitter, group)
  "I'm in crypto now"  <-- not a record

Personal ledger (private)
  date, venue, amount, fee, network, hash, current book
  |
  v
You can answer "where is it?" at 2 a.m. without a stranger
```

What you do not record in public

Balances. Full addresses. Screenshots of 2FA. KYC photos. The anti-phishing word. A boast that you “just withdrew 500.” Thieves read. Family members who will nag you into sending to a cousin’s broker also read.

If you teach someone Ife’s checklist, teach the checklist. Do not teach your numbers.

This is not a tax opinion

Some countries tax trades, some tax withdrawals, some ignore you until a threshold. This academy is **not a tax advisor**. A personal ledger makes a later conversation with a professional possible. A Twitter flex makes it worse. Keep receipts. We will not tell you how to file.

In Nigeria, in the UK, in the US, the forms differ. The adult habit does not: write down what moved.

Reconciliation once, calmly

Once a week, not once a candle: does the CEX still show what you think? Does BscScan still show what you think? If not, you either forgot a fee, forgot an internal transfer, or you have a Module 2 problem.

Reconciliation is how disagreement becomes a sentence instead of a panic.

ACADEMY NOTE Crystal Stones Academy will never ask you to screenshot your personal ledger into mentor chat. We do not need your balances. Paid checkout, when live, is USDT on BNB Smart Chain (BEP-20) through academy checkout — you will have a payment receipt there too. Keep it private. It is not a group trophy.

One page you could hand a professional later

Imagine a calm accountant, years later, asking what you did in 2026. Your ledger should let you say: this naira left this bank on this day, became this USDT IOU on this venue, then this hash on BSC. That is enough for a professional to start. A folder of memes is not.

You do not need to be that accountant. You need to not destroy the trail. Do not delete exchange emails. Do not reset the app before you export order history if the platform offers export. Do not keep the only copy of the ledger on the same phone that holds the only authenticator.

If you stop using crypto after this course, the ledger still earns its keep: you can see that you did not “lose everything to the blockchain” — you paid spread, fees, and maybe one lesson-sized mistake.

Do not title a cloud note “seed plus ledger”

The ledger can live on paper or in an encrypted local file. The seed cannot live there. Keep a second copy of the ledger somewhere that is not the only phone with the only authenticator. Export order history if the platform offers it before you delete an app.

What this lesson is for

You should be able to answer “where is the practice stack?” from a private page, not from memory and not from a like-count.

Say this out loud

- A personal ledger is private records: date, venue, amount, fee, network, hash, current book.
- Twitter is not a ledger. A group flex is not a receipt.
- Do not store seeds or passwords in the ledger. Do not post hashes with amounts.
- This is not tax advice. It is how you stay honest with yourself.
- Reconcile CEX and explorer calmly. Disagreement has a name.

Next: when screens disagree after a withdrawal — the other direction of the same skill.

Lesson 2: When screens disagree after a withdrawal (26 min)

When screens disagree after a withdrawal

Module 4 taught disagreement **before** withdraw (they should). This lesson is disagreement **after**.

By the end you should walk a diagnostic that names the book that is behind, without feeding the problem to a chat. **After** means: you clicked withdraw, the company said something, the explorer said something, the wallet said something, and they are not the same picture.

The three screens

- 463. **Exchange withdrawal history** — their claim: pending, completed, failed; sometimes a tx hash.
- 464. **Explorer of the network on the receipt** — the chain's claim.
- 465. **Wallet app** — a view of the chain, sometimes stale, sometimes on the wrong network, sometimes hiding a token.

Truth order: explorer of the named network first, then exchange, then wallet UI. The wallet is a window. Windows get dirty.

Exchange	Explorer (right network)	Wallet	Name it
Completed + hash	Success, right To	Shows token	Done. Update personal ledger.
Completed + hash	Success, right To	0	UI lag / wrong network in app / token not added
Completed + hash	Success, **wrong** To	0	Paste attack. Stop.
Completed + hash	Empty after a real wait	0	Ticket with hash; do not resend
Pending, no hash	Empty	0	Company has not broadcast. Wait or official ticket. Not a chain issue.
Failed	Empty	0	IOU should have bounced back. If not, ticket.
Completed	Success on **other** explorer	0 on BSC	Wrong network. Do not send again.

Worked scenario. After Ife's rest-of-stack USDT withdraw, the CEX says complete. BscScan shows the USDT. Trust Wallet (example app) shows 0.

- 466. Ife does not resend. Ife checks the wallet is on BNB Smart Chain, not Ethereum.
- 467. Ife pulls to refresh. Still 0. Ife opens BscScan token tab: USDT is there.
- 468. Ife adds the token in the UI if needed, verifying the USDT BEP-20 contract — not a lookalike, not Crystal Stones by accident.
- 469. The wallet catches up. The personal ledger already believed BscScan.
- 470. If instead BscScan had been empty, Ife would wait confirmations, then open a bookmarked ticket with the hash. Ife would not ask the group to "boost."

DIAGRAM

```
Withdraw clicked
|
v
History hash? --no--> company queue (wait / ticket)
|
yes
v
Right explorer: tx to me, right asset?
|
+-- yes, wallet 0 --> fix the window (network, refresh, add token)
+-- yes, wrong To --> paste attack; stop
+-- no, other chain --> wrong network; stop
+-- no, nowhere --> wait, then official ticket
```

Partial truths that feel like theft

- Withdrawal fee deducted, amount on-chain is less than you typed. Read “receive amount” on the receipt.
- Token shows as a duplicate USDT with a different contract. One is spam. Do not swap it. Hide it.
- BNB arrived, USDT did not, because you only sent BNB so far. Two withdrawals, two waits.
- Travel-rule hold: history says processing, no hash. That is Module 5, not a missing chain.

What you say to support (and not to anyone else)

Hash, asset, amount, network, time, your user ID. No seed. No 2FA. No remote desktop. No “please withdraw for me.” If a responder asks for those, you are not in the real ticket.

Do not post the problem with your full address and remaining balance in a group. You will collect helpers.

A worked delay that is not theft

Withdrawals also stall for boring reasons that still make screens disagree.

- The company is waiting on its own hot-wallet queue. History: processing. Explorer: empty. Wallet: 0. You wait. You do not pay a boost address.
- Travel-rule form not submitted. History: on hold. Explorer: empty. Fill the official form.
- You looked at Etherscan for a BEP-20 send. Explorer you opened: 0. Right explorer: success. Wrong window.
- Token transferred but the wallet is still on Ethereum mainnet in the network picker. Switch to BNB Smart Chain (chain ID 56), then refresh.

Write the stall in the personal ledger as a named stall, not as “hacked.” If twenty minutes later the explorer still has nothing and the receipt has a hash, then ticket. If there is no hash, it has not hit a chain. Calling it “the blockchain ate it” is the Module 3 folklore again.

If two assets were supposed to move — USDT and BNB — disagreement can be one success and one queue. Read each withdrawal row separately. Do not treat a BNB arrival as proof the USDT also moved.

ACADEMY NOTE Screens after a withdrawal are allowed to lag. They are not allowed to send you to a recovery agent. Academy staff will not debug your hash in a DM as a substitute for BscScan. We will also not take the leftover IOU “to test the rail.”

Two assets, two diagnostics

USDT can succeed while BNB is still queued, or the reverse. Run the table once per withdrawal row, not once per mood. People see BNB arrive and assume USDT “must be in there.” Token tab and native balance are different lines on BscScan.

If a spam token named USDT arrived from a poisoning address at the same time as the real USDT, the wallet might show two. Hide the spam. Do not swap it. The real one matches the contract the exchange named. Looking is allowed. Tapping Approve on a spam token is how disagreement becomes a drain.

What this lesson is for

You should diagnose a post-withdraw mismatch in five minutes of reading screens, and only then, if needed, open an official ticket.

Say this out loud

- After withdraw, explorer of the receipt’s network is first, exchange history second, wallet UI third.
- Wallet zero plus explorer yes is a window problem, not a resend.
- Explorer yes to the wrong To is a paste attack. Stop.
- No hash yet is a company queue, not a broken chain.
- Support gets a hash in a real ticket, never a seed, and they will not withdraw for you.

Next: moving from IOU to a wallet you control — only after Wallets course habits.

Lesson 3: Moving from IOU to a wallet you control — only after Wallets course habits (26 min)

Moving from IOU to a wallet you control — only after Wallets course habits

Self-custody is not a reward for clicking Buy. It is a set of habits from the Wallets course, reused here.

By the end of this lesson you should know **when** to withdraw, **what** must already be true about the destination, and **why** this academy will slow you down if those habits are missing. **Self-custody** means: keys you control can sign. If those keys are a screenshot in WhatsApp, you did not move to safety. You moved to a more honest way to get robbed.

Prerequisites, said as a gate

Do not withdraw practice USDT to a wallet until you can say yes to:

- I can explain that the wallet does not hold coins; the chain does
- I have a seed backup that is not a photo, not a cloud note, not a group admin’s “safe keep”

- I can switch the app to BNB Smart Chain on purpose
- I can copy a receive address without typing it
- I know BNB is gas and USDT is not
- I will not connect this wallet to a DEX I am not using yet tonight
- Nobody, including academy staff, has asked for the seed — and I would refuse

If any line is no, the stack can stay as a CEX IOU of **practice size** while you go back to Wallets. Company risk is real. Seed-in-chat risk is often larger for a beginner who just got excited.

Ready	Not ready
Paper or steel seed, offline	Seed in camera roll / email / “mentor”
Address copied from receive on BSC	Address from a group PDF
Will test-send	Will send all because fees
2FA + whitelist on the CEX	SMS 2FA, empty whitelist
Will stop after withdraw	Will connect PancakeSwap clone same hour

Worked scenario. Chinedu finished this course’s walkthrough in his head, then installed a wallet in a hurry during a live “listing.”

471. He screenshots a 12-word phrase “just for tonight.”
472. He withdraws the whole IOU to that wallet, no test, network default TRC-20.
473. He has left a company IOU and arrived in a wallet whose seed is a photo, on the wrong chain.
474. The honest move, which he skipped, was: keep practice size on the CEX until the seed was offline, then test BEP-20, then rest, then stop.
475. This academy would rather he stay a customer of a CEX for another week than become a key-holder with a photographed seed. That is not endorsement of any CEX. It is ranking of failures.

DIAGRAM

```

Wallets course habits in place
|
v
CEX IOU of practice size
|
| test BEP-20 --> explorer --> rest + BNB
v
Address you control, seed offline, gas present
|
X skip habits --> photograph seed, wrong network, DEX same night

```

What “a wallet you control” is not

- an exchange “web3 wallet” tab you do not have the seed for
- a broker’s address they “made for you”
- a the checkout processor address from chat (tuition, when live, is published checkout — you pay it, you do not custody it)
- Crystal Stones’ contract

- a multi-sig you do not understand yet

Control is: you can sign, you can restore from your backup, nobody else must.

Size still matters after you withdraw

On-chain coins have no “forgot password.” Practice size remains the rule. If the number would wreck you, it is too large to learn on, whether it sits as IOU or as BEP-20.

You do not have to withdraw everything. Leaving a little IOU for fees and a later send is allowed. So is withdrawing all practice funds if the CEX is just a door. That is a preference, not a purity test. What is not allowed is withdrawing into sloppy keys.

ACADEMY NOTE This academy will never ask you to move IOUs into a “shared academy wallet,” a PaynovaX account, or a Crystal Stones treasury for safekeeping. Self-custody is yours. Checkout is the checkout processor USDT BEP-20 when paid tracks exist. Two different rails. Neither is a DM.

The hurry that skips the seed backup

The usual skip: KYC finished Friday, group is loud Friday night, wallet installed Friday night, seed photographed “temporarily,” full stack withdrawn Friday night, DEX connected Saturday because PancakeSwap — a DEX you are not using yet — had a ticker with the right letters.

Put the seed on paper **before** the first inbound test. Confirm you can restore on a second view (or at least that the paper is readable) before the rest of the stack moves. If that feels slow, good. Slow is the gate.

If you already photographed a seed, that wallet is burned for serious size. Practice dust can stay while you create a new wallet with a paper backup, then test-send to the new address. Do not “delete the photo and hope.” Photos leak from clouds you forgot you enabled.

A CEX IOU of practice size for one more week is cheaper than a burned seed with your whole experiment on it. That is ranking of risks, not an advert for leaving funds on exchanges forever.

Paper first, inbound second

Put the seed on paper before the first inbound test. If you already photographed a seed, that wallet is burned for serious size — make a new one with paper, then test-send. A CEX IOU of practice size for one more week is cheaper than a burned seed with the whole experiment on it.

What this lesson is for

You should treat withdrawal as a promotion you earn with Wallets habits, not as the default last step of a hyped evening.

Say this out loud

- Self-custody starts when a withdrawal lands at an address whose keys you hold and whose seed is offline.
- If Wallets habits are missing, practice size can stay an IOU while you go back.
- A photographed seed is not safety. It is a more honest theft.

- Do not withdraw into a broker's mailbox or a contract address.
- Size still matters on-chain. There is no forgot-password.

Next: the full lab recap — speak a first-buy and first-withdrawal out loud, including the wrong-network failure.

Lesson 4: Full lab recap: speak a first-buy + first-withdrawal out loud, step by step, with the wrong-network failure included (28 min)

Full lab recap: speak a first-buy + first-withdrawal out loud, step by step, with the wrong-network failure included

This is the exam you give yourself in a kitchen, not on a live book.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to speak a complete first-buy and first-withdrawal, then speak the wrong-network failure, without opening an account. If you cannot speak it, you are not ready to click it.

Lab means: rehearsal. Not a buy order. Not a Crystal Stones allocation.

Part A — speak the happy path

Say this, filling the blanks with your own country's rail (naira P2P, or bank, or card):

476. I arrive at the exchange through a bookmark I saved on a calm day, not an ad.
477. I created the login myself. It is not a seed. I use authenticator 2FA, not SMS as the long-term lock.
Anti-phishing word is on. I will whitelist after a test.
478. I fund through a parented door: in-app P2P or official bank/card. Exact name, exact amount. I do not follow WhatsApp. I do not release before the goods if I am the seller.
479. Local money becomes an IOU. I write that in a personal ledger. BscScan is still zero. It should be.
480. I market-buy a practice size of USDT if I still need it, and a little BNB on a liquid pair. Spot only. Size I can lose. I do not ape a ticker.
481. Destination: official wallet app, network BNB Smart Chain, copy receive. Eyes: first 6, last 6, middle chunk.
482. Withdrawal: asset USDT, network BEP-20 / BSC, test amount. I wait. BscScan token tab agrees. Then the rest. Then BNB native, tested if the size matters.
483. I whitelist that address. I stop for the day. I do not open a DEX I am not using yet.

If you skipped a sentence, go back. The skipped sentence is where people vanish stacks.

Part B — speak the wrong-network failure

Now speak the failure on purpose, so your mouth knows it:

484. I copy a BSC `0x` address.
485. I leave the withdrawal network on ERC-20 or TRC-20 because it was the default, or because someone said it was cheaper.
486. The company says complete. My BSC wallet shows 0.
487. I do **not** send a second full stack on another network.

488. I read the receipt. I open the explorer **of that network**. I find the tx. I now know which book I wrote in.
489. Recovery, if any, is later, with a wallet that speaks that chain, and never with a seed sent to a helper.
490. My personal ledger records: “wrong network, test size, stopped.”

The lab is not complete until Part B is as fluent as Part A.

Spoken line	If you cannot say it
Bookmark, not ad	You will phish yourself
IOU, not chain, after fund	You will panic at BscScan zero
BNB is fuel	You will strand USDT
Test then rest	You will donate the stack to a typo
Receipt names the network	You will double-send
Explorer, not group	You will pay a helper
Stop for the day	You will ape

Worked scenario. Two students rehearse out loud. Ada speaks Part A cleanly and mumbles Part B. Emeka forces both.

491. Next week Ada funds for real, skips the test, picks TRC-20, loses practice size, and says the course failed her.
492. The course asked her to speak Part B. She skipped the lab.
493. Emeka does a 1 USDT test, sees BscScan, sends the rest, still has rent.
494. Neither was told to buy Crystal Stones. Neither paid a Telegram the checkout processor. Emeka has a hash in a notebook.
495. This is the pass mark: speech first, tiny size second, silence in groups third.

DIAGRAM

```

LAB (kitchen, no live funds)
  Part A happy path --> mouth can teach Ife
  Part B wrong network --> mouth can stop a second send
    |
    v
LIVE (practice size only)
  same words, slower, with explorers

Skip lab --> live panic --> helpers

```

Part C — the sentences you refuse

Speak these refusals too:

- “SMS 2FA is enough.” No.
- “Support will withdraw for me.” No.
- “USDT is one chain.” No.
- “Release, I sent a PDF.” No.
- “I bought so it is in my wallet already.” No.

- “Memo is optional.” Not when the screen required it.
- “the checkout processor is a Telegram wallet.” No. USDT BEP-20, published checkout, when paid tracks exist.
- “Send Crystal Stones to this contract to join.” No. Verify ``0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00`` is not a buy, not a mailbox.

ACADEMY NOTE If you are speaking this lab in a classroom, use fake amounts. Do not pass phones around with live 2FA. Do not shout addresses. Rehearsal is not a funding round.

Grade yourself with a listener

If another adult is willing, they listen without coaching. They tick a paper list: bookmark, 2FA, fund as IOU, BNB fuel, copy address, BEP-20, test, explorer, rest, whitelist, stop, wrong-network stop. Any tick they cannot hear, you do not have.

If you are alone, record a voice note you will delete, and listen once. Mumbles are skips.

Do not run the lab with live 2FA codes spoken into a room. Do not pass a phone around a classroom with an open exchange session. Rehearsal uses fake amounts and fake last-4s. Live practice, later, is solo, tiny, and quiet.

What this lesson is for

You should be able to teach the happy path and the wrong-network stop to another adult, as speech, without opening a live book.

Say this out loud

- I can narrate venue, fund as IOU, tiny spot BNB, test USDT on BEP-20, explorer, rest, whitelist, stop.
- I can narrate the wrong-network failure and the rule: no second full send.
- Exchange login is not a seed. Explorer is not a group admin.
- the checkout processor is not a chat wallet. Crystal Stones is not this lab’s buy.
- If I cannot speak it, I do not click it.

Next: what this course does not make you.

Lesson 5: What this course does not make you (not a trader, not a tax advisor, not “ready to ape Crystal Stones”) (26 min)

What this course does not make you (not a trader, not a tax advisor, not “ready to ape Crystal Stones”)

A Basic course that ends in a coronation is a funnel. This one ends in a fence.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to list what you are **not**, as clearly as what you can do. That list is the product. **Not** is not an insult. It is how you keep the practice stack.

You are not a trader

You can describe a spot pair, a fee, a fill, and a stop rule. That is literacy. It is not a desk. You have no edge because you finished a quiz. You should not sell signals. You should not manage a cousin's salary. You should not open futures to "make back" a P2P spread.

If you later study trading, that will be a different course with different honesty about how often beginners lose. It is not smuggled in here as a trophy.

You are not a tax advisor, lawyer, or compliance officer

You know KYC exists, chargebacks exist, travel-rule forms exist. You do not know your filing position. Do not tell a group "P2P naira is invisible." Do not tell a group "BscScan is anonymous enough." Laws attach to people. This academy will not help you hide.

You are not "ready to ape Crystal Stones"

Crystal Stones is a BEP-20 token on BNB Smart Chain. The contract, to **verify** only, is:

```
`0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00`
```

Verification is not a market order. Listing rumours are not a market order. A purple logo is not a market order. RWA claims are **their claim to verify**, not our instruction. This course trained rails: CEX IOU, BNB gas, BEP-20 withdrawals. Rails are not a buy.

Anyone who says "you finished Exchanges, now ape CSTN" is not this academy.

This course made you	This course did not make you
Able to name an IOU versus on-chain coins	A profitable trader
Able to fund through a parented door	A P2P merchant with a public rate
Able to refuse SMS-only 2FA and fake support	Invincible
Able to test-send BEP-20 USDT	Ready to ape Crystal Stones
Able to say the checkout processor is USDT BEP-20 checkout	A collections agent for chat wallets
Able to keep a personal ledger	A tax advisor

Worked scenario. A student finishes the last quiz and lands in a Telegram that says "Academy class of today — deposit Crystal Stones to this wallet for whitelist."

496. The student names the object: a chat wallet, not the checkout processor, not BscScan of their own address.

497. The student does not pay. The student does not argue long enough to be worn down.

498. The student can still verify the real contract later, on BscScan, without sending.

499. The student still has practice USDT and BNB, or still has an IOU, depending on whether they withdrew.

500. That refusal is the graduation, not a fill on a thin book.

DIAGRAM

What you can do

explain CEX, KYC, 2FA, P2P, spot, BNB gas, BEP-20, test send, explorer

Fence

no trader identity

no tax advice

no Crystal Stones buy order

no chat checkout

no seed to anyone

no “support will withdraw for me”

What you can do tomorrow, if you choose

- Rehearse the lab out loud again
- If — and only if — you choose to practise with money you can lose, run Ife’s checklist at practice size
- Keep the personal ledger
- Go on to the BNB Smart Chain beginner course without a new ticker

You can also do nothing with money this month. Literacy does not expire overnight. FOMO does.

Payments for this academy, said once more

When Intermediate or Advanced checkout is live, it is **the checkout processor**, paid in **USDT on BEP-20**. Not Crystal Stone token. Not PaynovaX. Not a wallet pasted in WhatsApp. Not an exchange screenshot as payment. If that sentence ever collides with a DM, the DM is fake.

ACADEMY NOTE Education only. We will not tell you to buy or sell any asset, including BNB, USDT, and Crystal Stones. We will tell you that an exchange is a company, that a withdrawal is a chain write, and that the people who skip those sentences pay for everyone else’s screenshots.

What “next course” is for

BNB Smart Chain for beginners will teach the chain those withdrawals land on: chain ID 56, BscScan more slowly, gas, tokens as contracts. Safety will teach panic, approvals, and recovery-theatre. Neither will crown you a trader. Neither will tell you to ape Crystal Stones.

If a marketer uses this certificate — when certificates exist — as a buy signal, they are lying about the fence. You can show them this lesson’s title.

You may still, independently, choose to buy or not buy any asset with money you can lose, after you can speak the lab. That choice will never be this academy’s instruction. The fence stays up even if a future you climbs it. We did not open the gate.

Literacy is the output. A fill is optional.

You are allowed to finish this course and do nothing with live funds for a month. If a marketer treats a future certificate as proof it is time to ape Crystal Stones, they are lying about the fence. Next courses teach the chain and safety. They still will not crown a trader.

What this lesson is for

You should leave Basic's third course as a careful beginner with language, not as a newly minted ape with a brand.

Say this out loud

- I am not a trader because I can click Spot. I am not a tax advisor because I know KYC exists.
- I am not ready to ape Crystal Stones. The contract is to verify, never a buy order on this page.
- the checkout processor USDT BEP-20 is published checkout, not a Telegram wallet.
- Support will not withdraw for me. An exchange login is not a seed.
- I can fund, size, test-send, and stop — or I can wait. Both are adult.

This was Exchanges & Your First Buy. Next in Basic is the chain those withdrawals land on: BNB Smart Chain for beginners.

Module quiz (answers included for editors)

Q1. A personal ledger is?

- A. A Twitter thread of green candles
- B. Private records of date, venue, amount, fee, network, hash, and which book the value sits on
- C. A shared academy spreadsheet of seeds
- D. BscScan's email newsletter

Correct answer: B

Q2. After a withdrawal the explorer shows USDT at your address but the wallet app shows 0. You?

- A. Withdraw the same amount again to push it
- B. Treat explorer as boss; check network, refresh, add the real token — do not resend
- C. Paste the seed into the wallet's support chat
- D. Ask an admin to withdraw for you

Correct answer: B

Q3. You should move an IOU to self-custody when?

- A. The same night a group lists Crystal Stones
- B. Wallets course habits are in place: offline seed, BSC network on purpose, test send, no DEX panic
- C. A broker made a wallet for you
- D. SMS 2FA is on

Correct answer: B

Q4. In the lab, the wrong-network failure includes?

- A. Sending a second full stack on another network to push it
- B. Stopping, reading the receipt's network, opening that explorer, and not sending the rest blind

- C. Calling a recovery agent with your seed
- D. Releasing P2P because a PDF arrived

Correct answer: B

Q5. This course makes you a trader.

- A. True — one spot fill is a desk
- B. False — it is literacy about IOUs, fees, and withdrawals, not a trading identity
- C. True if you bought Crystal Stones
- D. True if you used futures once

Correct answer: B

Q6. Academy paid-track checkout, when live, is?

- A. A Telegram wallet labelled academy checkout
- B. PaynovaX
- C. USDT on BNB Smart Chain (BEP-20) through academy checkout through published checkout — not Crystal Stone token, not a chat paste
- D. Support withdrawing for you after you read 2FA

Correct answer: C

Q7. “I bought so it is in my wallet already” after a CEX spot fill is?

- A. True
- B. False — you have an IOU until a withdrawal confirms on the right chain
- C. True if the pair was BNB/USDT
- D. True after KYC

Correct answer: B

Q8. The Crystal Stones contract in this academy is for?

- A. A required buy at the end of the lab
- B. Verification only — not a mailbox, not a buy order, not a chat deposit
- C. ERC-20 withdrawals from every CEX
- D. Checkout invoices in CSTN

Correct answer: B

Blockchain & BNB Smart Chain for Beginners

BASIC TRACK | slug: bnb-smart-chain-beginners | level: beginner | FREE

The fourth Basic course. A blockchain is a public book of sealed pages. BNB Smart Chain is one specific book (chain id 56) where BNB pays gas and BEP-20 tokens — including Crystal Stones — are rows in contracts. You will learn blocks, validators, RPCs, why 0x addresses look the same on Ethereum and BSC, how to add a token by contract, how gas and nonce work, and how to read BscScan until it is boring. Education only — verifying a contract is not a buy order.

Module 1: A blockchain as a public book

Blocks, hashes, miners versus validators, why many chains exist, confirmations, and what a transaction actually contains — without hero worship or graduate maths.

Lesson 1: Pages that seal: blocks and hashes (26 min)

Pages that seal: blocks and hashes

A **blockchain** is a public book with a special filing rule. New pages, called **blocks**, include a fingerprint of the previous page. Rewriting an old transfer means rewriting every page after it, in public, against a network that will not agree with your private copy.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to explain a block without saying “crypto magic,” say what a **hash** is for, and tell a friend why a pretty screenshot is not the book.

A ledger, again, with a filing rule

Crypto Foundations called a **ledger** the official list of balances and transfers. A bank ledger is private. Staff, software, and courts decide who may read it and who may change it. A blockchain ledger is copied by many computers, and the rule for adding a page is public.

That is the whole design bet in one sentence: **publish the book, and make quiet edits expensive.**

It is not a bet that prices are honest. It is not a bet that every token named Crystal Stones is the project. It is not a bet that you cannot lose a key. It is a filing rule.

A village savings group’s notebook is a ledger. If the secretary erases a line and nobody else has a copy, the group may never know. A blockchain is closer to this: every serious participant keeps a copy, and each new page is sealed so that yesterday’s pages are awkward to rewrite without everyone noticing.

A block is a sealed page, not a coin

A **block** is a batch of recent transactions plus some filing data: a time, a reference to the previous block, and a hash. Think of a day's worth of signed slips stapled together, then stamped, then the stamp copied onto the next day's cover.

Height is how many pages from the start. Block 0 is the **genesis** block — the first page. You do not need the birthday. You need the picture: the book has an order.

People say “it is in a block” as if that were a blessing. Inclusion in a block means: this instruction was packed into a sealed page that the network is currently treating as official. It does not mean the token is a good investment. It does not mean the person who sent it is honest. It means the book accepted a signed instruction.

A hash is a fingerprint, not encryption

A **hash function** takes any input — a page, a file, a sentence — and produces a short, fixed-length fingerprint. Change one comma, the fingerprint changes completely. For the functions these networks use, you cannot usefully work backwards from the fingerprint to the original.

Block N contains the hash of block N-1. If you tamper with an old transfer, block N-1's hash changes, so block N no longer points at it, so block N+1 breaks too. Everyone else's copy still has the old chain. Your rewrite is fanfic.

This is why people say a blockchain is “immutable.” That word is too loud. A more precise beginner sentence: **this book's history is expensive to quietly rewrite, because each page is glued to the previous fingerprint.**

It is not encryption. Encryption hides. A hash does not hide the page. The page is public. The hash only proves “this is the page we fingerprinted,” the way a wax seal proves a letter was not swapped after it left the office.

Word	Plain meaning	What beginners get wrong
Block	A sealed page of recent transactions plus a fingerprint of the previous page	“A block is a coin”
Hash	A fingerprint of data; change the data, change the print	“A hash is a password”
Height	How many pages from the start	“Higher height means a better investment”
Chain	Pages linked by fingerprints	“All chains are one book with nicknames”
Genesis	The first page	“I need to read it to use a wallet”

Worked scenario. Chidi's cousin sends a link to a “private blockchain explorer.” The page is beautiful. It shows 4,000 USDT arriving in Chidi's address, with a hash, a block number, and a green tick.

501. Chidi opens the real public explorer for the chain he actually uses — for this academy, BscScan for BNB Smart Chain — from a bookmark, not from the cousin's link.

- 502. He pastes his address. There is no such transfer.
- 503. He pastes the hash from the pretty page. The real explorer does not know it.
- 504. He does not ship goods. He does not send “verification BNB.” He closes the tab.
- 505. The cousin hashed a pretty HTML page. They did not add a page to the book the network actually runs. Fingerprints on a fake site are decoration.

DIAGRAM

```
Block 100 --> hash-of-100 sits inside Block 101
Block 101 --> hash-of-101 sits inside Block 102
Block 102 --> hash-of-102 sits inside Block 103
      |
      v
Change one transfer in 100
      |
      v
hash-of-100 changes --> 101 no longer points at it --> 102 and 103 break
      |
      v
Honest nodes still have the old chain. Your rewrite is ignored.
```

What this does not mean

Say these so they stick, because this is where slogans start:

- It does not mean the **price** of a token is honest.
- It does not mean a token named Crystal Stones on a clone contract is the project.
- It does not mean you cannot lose keys. The book can be public and your secret can still walk.
- It does not mean every chain is equally hard to lean on. Who writes the next page is the next lesson.
- It does not mean a screenshot of a hash is a payment.

It means **this book’s history is expensive to quietly rewrite**. That is a filing fact. Treat it as a filing fact.

How wallets and explorers use this without you seeing it

Your phone wallet does not usually store the entire book. It asks a helper computer for “what does this address hold?” and “please broadcast this signed page-request.” An explorer like **BscScan** is a searchable window onto the same book. Both are views. The book is the network’s copies of sealed pages.

If the view lies, the book may still be honest. That is why this course will make you open the explorer yourself, from a bookmark, until it is boring. You do not need to compute a hash by hand. You need to know why BscScan’s history for a transaction is a better argument than a WhatsApp screenshot with a green tick drawn on it.

ACADEMY NOTE Academy rule: you do not need to compute a hash by hand, and this classroom will not pretend you do. You need to know why a public explorer’s history for a transaction is a better argument than a screenshot. If someone will not give you a hash you can paste into the real explorer, they have not shown you a page of the book.

What this lesson is for

You are here so that “blockchain” stops being a mood and becomes a filing system: sealed pages, fingerprints, a public copy, an expensive rewrite. Module 2 will name one specific book — BNB Smart Chain, chain ID 56. Module 5 will make you read that book until the tabs are ordinary. None of that is a buy order.

Say this out loud

- A blockchain is a public ledger whose new pages include a fingerprint of the previous page.
- A block is a sealed page of transactions, not a coin and not a blessing.
- A hash is a fingerprint. Change the page, change the print. It is not a password and not encryption.
- Quiet rewrites fail because honest copies still have the old fingerprints.
- A fake explorer can hash a pretty page. That is decoration, not the book.

Next: who is allowed to write the next page — miners versus validators, in beginner language.

Lesson 2: Who writes the next page (miners vs validators) (26 min)

Who writes the next page (miners vs validators)

If anyone can add any page, the book is graffiti. If only one office can add a page, you have a company database with extra branding. Public chains sit in between: many participants compete or take turns under a published rule.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to say, in plain words, what a **miner** does, what a **validator** does, why BNB Smart Chain is not Bitcoin, and why your phone wallet is usually a guest at someone else’s computer.

If anyone can write, the book is graffiti

A public ledger still needs a **writer rule**. Without one, two people could publish two different “next pages,” each claiming to spend the same coins, and the copies would split forever. That is the **double-spend problem** from Foundations, now as a staffing question: **who is allowed to propose the next sealed page?**

The network answers with a **consensus** rule. Consensus here is not a group chat about whether you are a good person. It is a rule for one question: **which page is the next official page?**

Your job as a beginner is not to become a researcher. Your job is to notice that “it is on the blockchain” is an incomplete sentence. Which book? Who writes pages on that book? How expensive is a cheat?

Proof of Work, in beginner language

Proof of Work (PoW) is Bitcoin’s original style. Machines burn electricity racing to find a rare hash. The winner proposes a block. Other machines check that the page follows the rules, then they start racing for the next one.

Why burn energy? To make a long fake history expensive. To rewrite a week of Bitcoin pages you would need to outrun the honest energy of the network for that week, in public. That cost is the point. It is also why Bitcoin is slower and why fees can be high when many people want space on the next page.

A **miner** is a participant who spends that energy to propose pages. A **mining pool** is a group of miners sharing work and rewards. Pools can concentrate power. “Many machines” is not the same as “many independent decision-makers.” Hold both facts.

Proof of Stake, and the BSC flavour

Proof of Stake (PoS) is a different cost model. **Validators** lock coins (**stake**) and risk them if they cheat. Instead of burning electricity to race, they take turns or get chosen under a published rule. Cheating is supposed to cost the staked coins.

BNB Smart Chain uses a **Proof of Staked Authority** style design: a limited, named set of validators produce blocks. It is faster and cheaper than Bitcoin. It is also a **different trust story**. You are trusting a smaller writer set more than you trust “anyone with a mining warehouse.”

This academy will not pretend those two sentences are a PhD. You need the beginner consequence:

Design	Who writes the next page	Beginner consequence
Bitcoin Proof of Work	Miners racing with energy	Slow, often expensive, extremely hard to quietly rewrite; not where Crystal Stones lives
Ethereum-style Proof of Stake	Validators who stake coins	A public chain with a different cost for cheating
BNB Smart Chain (staked authority flavour)	A limited validator set	Fast, cheap gas in BNB; a more concentrated writer set; EVM-like tools
A random new chain with a shiny logo	Unknown	Do not move rent money there because a logo is shiny

Worked scenario. A friend says “BSC is not a real blockchain because it has few validators.”

506. You do not defend a brand. You name objects.

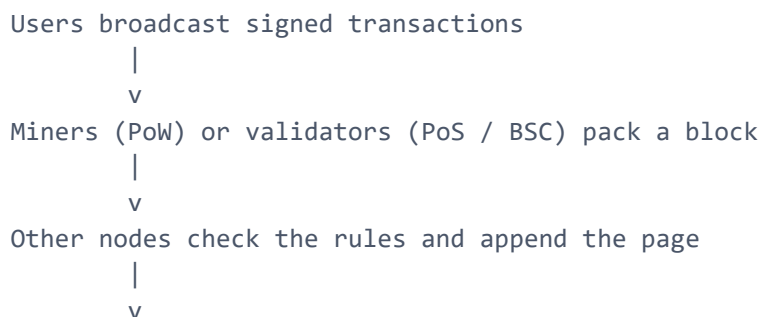
507. You say: BSC **is** a blockchain — blocks, hashes, a public ledger, a writer rule.

508. You say: it has a **more concentrated** writer set than Bitcoin. That concentration is why fees are low and why some people prefer Bitcoin or Ethereum for large settlement.

509. You say: Crystal Stones lives on BSC as a BEP-20 token. That is geography, not a holiness ranking.

510. You use BSC for practice **knowing that tradeoff**, not pretending it is Bitcoin, and not pretending it is “fake” because it is not Bitcoin.

DIAGRAM



Explorers and wallets read the result

|

v

Your phone is usually in this last box – a reader, not the whole book

A node is a copy of the book; your phone usually is not

A **node** is a computer running the software that stores and checks the book. A **full node** keeps enough history to check the rules itself. An **RPC** is a counter on a node: a way for wallets and apps to ask questions (“what does this address hold?”) and to submit signed transactions.

Your phone wallet is usually **not** a full node. It asks an RPC. That is why a malicious RPC or a fake app can lie even when the chain is honest. The book can be public and your window can still be a lie.

Running your own node is a later skill. Today: know that you are usually a guest at someone else’s RPC, and that BscScan is a widely used window, not a pope.

The tradeoff you actually live with

Bitcoin’s cost is energy and slowness. Ethereum’s cost is gas that can spike. BSC’s cost is a smaller validator set. **There is no free rail.**

This academy teaches BSC because Crystal Stones is a BEP-20 on that book, because USDT-on-BSC is a practical rail for later paid-track checkout, and because cheap, fast blocks are how beginners survive their first practice sends. We will not pretend that choice is ideologically pure. We will teach you to name it.

When someone says “BSC = Bitcoin,” they have smashed two books into one word. Bitcoin is a chain with a PoW writer rule and a native coin called bitcoin. BNB Smart Chain is a different book, chain ID 56, native coin BNB, validator-style writers. Same idea of sealed pages. Not the same staff, not the same coin, not the same fees.

ACADEMY NOTE Academy rule: “more concentrated than Bitcoin” is a precise sentence, not an insult and not a reason to send a seed to a stranger who promises a “decentralised upgrade.” Running your own node is optional. Knowing that you are usually asking someone else’s RPC is not optional.

What this lesson is for

You now have a staffing model for a public book: miners race, validators take turns or get chosen, BSC uses a small named set on purpose. The next lesson is why the industry shipped many books instead of one, and why that fact will try to empty a beginner’s wallet.

Say this out loud

- Someone has to write the next page under public rules, or the book is graffiti or a private office.
- Proof of Work makes cheating expensive with energy. Proof of Stake makes cheating expensive with staked coins. They are different cost models, not different religions.
- BNB Smart Chain is a real blockchain with a smaller validator set than Bitcoin — a tradeoff, not a spell, and not “Bitcoin with a yellow logo.”
- A node stores and checks the book. A phone wallet usually asks an RPC instead of being the whole book.

- A malicious RPC can lie about balances even when the chain is honest.

Next: why there is not one chain to rule them all.

Lesson 3: Why many chains exist (26 min)

Why many chains exist

Beginners want one chain, one coin, one app. The industry shipped dozens. That is not only greed — though greed is present. It is also different design choices: different writer rules, different fee markets, different programming engines, different communities.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to say that many chains means many books, not many nicknames for one book, and you should be able to refuse a bridge because a group dropped a URL.

Different jobs, not different stickers

A **chain** is a ledger with its own pages, its own native coin, its own writer set, and its own rules. Tokens on that chain are rows in contracts on that book. They do not automatically exist on another book.

Rough beginner map, without worship:

- **Bitcoin**: conservative settlement, Proof of Work, native bitcoin. Slow on purpose.
- **Ethereum**: a world computer for **smart contracts** — programs stored on the chain — often more expensive when busy.
- **BNB Smart Chain**: Ethereum-like contracts, cheaper fees, different validator story, huge retail activity. This course's home book.
- **Others** (Solana, Tron, and a long list): other speed, fee, and tooling bets.

None of these is “the official chain of crypto.” Crypto is not a company. It is a family of public-ledger designs. People who say “just use the blockchain” without naming which one are either selling or lost.

EVM compatibility is a shape, not a shared balance

EVM means **Ethereum Virtual Machine** — the engine that runs contracts on Ethereum. BSC is **EVM-compatible**. That is why:

- addresses look like Ethereum (0x and forty hex characters)
- a wallet app such as MetaMask — an **example of a wallet app**, not an endorsement — can add BSC as a network
- a contract written for Ethereum can often be deployed on BSC

It is also why people send funds to the “same address” on the wrong network. Compatibility of **shape** is not a shared **balance**. The letters can match. The books do not merge.

This is the sentence you will reuse until it is a reflex: **same 0x text, different planet.**

Bridges sit between books, and they are how people lose funds

A token on one book does not automatically exist on another. **Bridges** try to represent value across books, usually by locking on one side and minting a representation on the other. That extra machine is extra trust. Bridges are a major hack magnet.

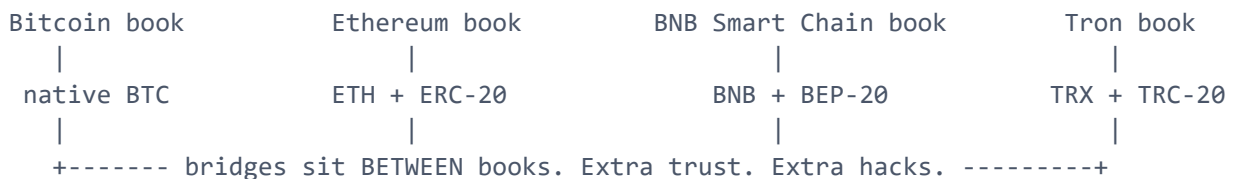
This Basic course's rule is blunt: **do not bridge practice funds because a group dropped a URL**. Module 4 will give bridges one honest lesson of their own. Today you only need the geography: bridges are not a dropdown that “makes the chains one chain.” They are a separate, risky system.

You see	True meaning	Beginner move
Same 0x address on Ethereum and BSC	Same key can speak both books; balances are separate	Watch the network chip, then the explorer of that network
“We bridged it”	A different, risky system now holds a claim	Do not follow a chat-group bridge
“It’s the same MetaMask”	The app can switch books; it does not merge them	Switching the dropdown does not move coins
“USDT is USDT”	Ticker stickers collide; ERC-20 USDT and BEP-20 USDT are different objects	Name the chain, then the contract
A clone “Crystal Stones” on another chain	A different contract, usually a trap	Verify the BSC contract; do not chase the name

Worked scenario. Crystal Stones is a BEP-20 on BNB Smart Chain. A clone deploys “Crystal Stones” on Ethereum or on a random extra chain. The name matches. The logo matches. A caption says “we are now multi-chain, bridge here to get the real one.”

511. Ada opens the project’s long-standing site — not a Google ad, not a pinned tweet from an account created yesterday.
512. She copies the published contract: 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00.
513. She pastes it into BscScan, on the real domain. That is the object this academy means.
514. She does not bridge into the clone. She does not add the clone by name search.
515. BscScan still shows the real contract on chain 56. The clone is a different object. The name was a sticker.

DIAGRAM



Crystal Stones, as this academy references it, lives on the BSC book.

Crystal Stones lives on one book unless the project itself publishes otherwise

This academy's default practice network is BNB Smart Chain. Crystal Stones, as the project publishes it, is a BEP-20 there. If the project ever truly lived elsewhere, that would be a slow public fact you could verify on more than a Friday-night DM. Treat surprise "we migrated, bridge now" messages as clones.

Academy tuition rails, when you reach paid tracks, are USDT on **BNB Smart Chain**, not "USDT somewhere." The multiplicity of chains is why that sentence is so picky. USDT on BNB Smart Chain (BEP-20) through academy checkout is not Crystal Stones token and not some other brand. Geography first.

How to talk about "the chain" without lying

Useful beginner sentences:

- "I am on BNB Smart Chain, chain ID 56."
- "I need BNB for gas on that book."
- "This USDT is the BEP-20 one, not the Ethereum one."
- "This token's identity is the contract address, not the name."

Useless beginner sentences:

- "It's on the blockchain."
- "USDT is USDT."
- "Same address so it will arrive."
- "BSC is Bitcoin."

ACADEMY NOTE Academy rule: we teach BSC because Crystal Stones is a BEP-20 and because USDT-on-BSC is a practical rail. That is curriculum geography, not a commandment to ignore Bitcoin forever, and not a commandment to bridge because a caption said "multi-chain."

What this lesson is for

You now have a map of many books. Compatibility of tools is not a merged balance. Bridges are optional and, for this track, later and dangerous. The next lesson is what happens after you press send: pending, included, buried — and why "I sent it" is not cash.

Say this out loud

- Many chains means many books, not many nicknames for one book.
- EVM-compatible means similar tools and address shape, not shared balances.
- Same 0x letters on Ethereum and BSC are not the same pile of coins.
- Bridges sit between books. They are extra trust. Basic does not use them because a group dropped a URL.
- Crystal Stones lives on BNB Smart Chain unless you can verify otherwise from more than a chat message — and verifying is not a buy order.

Next: confirmations, finality, and why "0/1" is not a payment.

Lesson 4: Confirmations and finality for a beginner (26 min)

Confirmations and finality for a beginner

A transaction is **broadcast**, then **included in a block**, then **buried under more blocks**. Those stages are not the same. A wallet banner that says “submitted” is not a payment. A shopkeeper who ships against a screenshot is making a donation.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to wait like an adult: pending is not paid, one confirmation is young, burial is stronger, and you will not import Bitcoin’s folklore blindly onto BNB Smart Chain.

Broadcast: you spoke; the book has not sealed a page

Your wallet sent a signed message to an RPC. The **mempool** is the waiting room of instructions not yet packed into a block. Explorers may show **pending**. Pending is not paid. It can vanish, be replaced, or sit until the gas price is acceptable to whoever is writing pages.

“I sent it” in a chat is a human sentence. It is not a ledger sentence. The ledger sentence is: **is this hash included in a block on the book we agreed to watch?**

If the RPC never accepted it, or the fee is too low, or the nonce is stuck (Module 4), the book does not have a page yet. Refreshing the app does not create a page. Shouting in a WhatsApp group does not create a page.

Included: one confirmation is real and young

When a validator packs the transaction into a block, you have **one confirmation**. This is real-but-young. On busy chains, rare **reorganisations** — the network switching a very recent page for another valid page — can still shuffle the youngest blocks.

For a shop selling a small item, 1 confirmation on BSC is often treated as “probably fine.” For a large over-the-counter receive, people wait longer. For a stranger demanding shipment of a phone against a “submitted” banner, you wait until the explorer shows success, the right token contract, the right amount, your address.

Finality, in conversation, means: reversing this would be hard enough that we will treat it as settled. Different chains have different gadgets and different speeds. Do not import Bitcoin’s “wait 6 blocks” folklore blindly onto BSC, and do not treat 0 confirmations as cash.

Buried: each new page on top is another confirmation

Each new block on top of yours is another **confirmation**. Burial is stronger than inclusion. On a fast chain, burial happens quickly. That is a feature for retail. It is not a reason to skip the pending stage.

BSC is fast. Bitcoin is slow. Ethereum has its own finality gadgets. The skill is: **name the stage, then name the chain, then decide whether this receive is large enough to wait.**

Stage	What happened	Shopkeeper meaning
Broadcast / pending	Signed message is in a waiting room, or sitting at an RPC	Not paid

1 confirmation on BSC	Packed into a block	Usually accepted for small goods; still wait for your own large receives
Many confirmations	More pages on top	The argument gets easier
Replaced / dropped	A different transaction took that nonce, or the fee was ignored	You are not paid; check nonce and gas later in this course
Success on explorer, wrong token	A transfer happened, but not the contract you care about	You were not paid in the asset you named

Worked scenario. A buyer sends Crystal Stones and immediately demands shipment based on a wallet “submitted” banner.

516. Amaka does not ship. She asks for the transaction hash.
517. She opens BscScan from a bookmark. She pastes the hash.
518. The explorer still says pending. She still does not ship.
519. A few minutes later the first hash disappears. The buyer raised gas on a **different** transaction and the first one died. A new hash appears, or none does.
520. If she had shipped at “submitted,” she would have shipped for free. She waits until the explorer shows success, the Crystal Stones contract 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00, the right amount, her address.

DIAGRAM

```

Sign
--> broadcast (pending)    not paid
    --> included in a block    young
        --> more blocks on top    safer to treat as paid
If it never leaves pending, you are not paid.
If a different nonce replacement lands instead, you are not paid for the first hash.
```

Do not mix folklore across books

Bitcoin culture says “wait six confirmations” for large receives. That number is a convention for that book, not a law of physics. BSC blocks are faster, so “six” is a different amount of wall-clock time and a different security story, because the writer set is different.

Two mistakes, both expensive:

- Treating BSC’s 0 confirmations as cash because “BSC is fast.”
- Waiting an hour for six Bitcoin-style confirmations on a 2-dollar test send and then calling the network broken.

Match the wait to the size and to the chain. For this academy’s practice amounts, “explorer says success, right token, right address” is the ritual. For amounts you would miss, wait longer, and still use the explorer, not the app banner.

The shopkeeper rule, written once so you can reuse it

Never take “I sent it” as final. Take the explorer status for the hash. Confirm:

- status success, not pending, not failed
- the token contract you named, not a lookalike
- the amount
- your address as the recipient of that token transfer

This is the same muscle as the exchanges course, now with vocabulary. Module 5 will make each explorer tab boring. Today you only need the stages: broadcast, include, bury.

ACADEMY NOTE Academy rule: shipment against a screenshot is a donation. Pending is not paid. A replaced transaction is not paid. Practice this on tiny amounts so the first time you care, the ritual is already in your hands.

What this lesson is for

You now have stages instead of a vibe. The next lesson opens the envelope: what fields actually sit inside a transaction, and why a USDT send can show 0 BNB value and still be real.

Say this out loud

- Pending is broadcast, not paid. A “submitted” banner is not cash.
- Inclusion in a block is real and young. Burial under more blocks is stronger.
- Fast chains still have a pending stage. Do not skip it because BSC is cheap.
- Do not import Bitcoin’s “wait 6” as a superstition, and do not treat 0 confirmations as a payment.
- Shipment against a screenshot, or against the wrong token contract, is a donation.

Next: what is actually inside a transaction.

Lesson 5: What a transaction contains (28 min)

What a transaction contains

A **transaction** is a signed instruction. On EVM chains — Ethereum, BNB Smart Chain, and cousins — it is not a photograph of money flying. It is a message that says: the holder of this key authorises this exact change, and here is the fuel money for the writer set.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to name the fields that matter to a beginner, and you should know why sending a token often shows **value = 0** on the explorer’s native line.

A signed instruction, not a screenshot

The important fields, in beginner language:

- **from** — the address whose key signed. This is the authority. If this key did not sign, this transaction is not from that person, no matter what a chat says.
- **to** — an address. It might be a person’s wallet (**externally owned account**), or it might be a **contract** — a program on the chain.
- **value** — native coin attached. On BSC that coin is **BNB**. On Ethereum it is **ETH**. Token sends often have value = 0 because the token movement lives inside the contract call.

- **data** — extra payload. Token transfers live here. So do approvals. So do drains. You do not need to read hex. You need to know this field exists.
- **gas limit / gas price** — how much fuel you allow, and what you bid per unit of work.
- **nonce** — a counter per sender, so your transactions have an order. Module 4 will make this painful and then useful.
- **signature** — proof the from-key approved this exact message. Change any field, the signature no longer matches.

A screenshot of a wallet can fake every one of these visually. The book cannot fake the signature without the key. That is why we paste hashes into explorers.

Native send versus token send — the confusion that never dies

Sending **BNB** to a friend: **to** is the friend, **value** is the BNB, **data** is empty (or nearly empty). The explorer's native value line is the story.

Sending **USDT** as a BEP-20 token: **to** is usually the **USDT contract**, **value** is usually 0, **data** says “transfer this amount to my friend.” The friend appears in the **token transfer** records, not only as **to**.

This is why people look at the wrong BscScan panel and panic. They see “BNB transferred: 0” and think the USDT failed. The token tab tells a different story.

Crystal Stones, as a BEP-20, behaves like that token send. You are not mailing a rock. You are asking the Crystal Stones contract to update its list: subtract from you, add to them. The contract address is 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00. Verifying that address is not a buy order.

Approvals and swaps are transactions too

An **approval** is a transaction that tells a token contract: this **spender** may move up to N of my tokens later. Value is usually 0. It still costs gas in BNB. It is not “just connecting.” Module 4 will separate connect, sign, and approve. Today: know that an approval is a real on-chain instruction you can later see.

A **swap** on a decentralised exchange is usually a call to a **router** contract. **to** is the router. Value might be BNB if you are selling BNB. The token hops show up as several internal movements. One signature authorised the bundle. Module 5 will teach you not to panic at hops.

Intent	to	value (native BNB)	Where the movement shows
Send BNB	Friend's address	BNB amount	Transaction value
Send USDT (BEP-20)	USDT contract	Usually 0	Token transfer records
Send Crystal Stones	Crystal Stones contract	Usually 0	Token transfer records
Approve a spender	Token contract	0	Approval / event; spender may pull later
Swap on a DEX	Router contract	Maybe BNB	Several internal hops plus token transfers

Worked scenario. A student sends 20 USDT on BSC to pay a freelancer.

521. They copy the freelancer's 0x from a channel they already trust, after confirming the network chip is BSC.
522. They send. BscScan overview shows "BNB transferred: 0."
523. They think it failed. They almost send again.
524. They open **Token transferred**. It shows 20 USDT, from them, to the freelancer, status success.
525. They do not send again. Native value and token value are different rows. Sending twice would have been a second payment.

DIAGRAM

Simple BNB send:

you ---- value = BNB ----> friend

Token send (USDT, Crystal Stones, any BEP-20):

you ---- value = 0, data = transfer ----> token contract

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v

friend's token balance
on that contract updates

You do not need to decode hex; you need the right tab

Input data on BscScan looks like a curse. You are not required to read it. You are required to:

- open the hash on the real explorer
- read status
- read **to** (person or contract?)
- read native value
- read token transfers (which contract, which amount, which recipient)
- read the fee in BNB

If those lines match the job, the transaction did the job. If a stranger wants you to paste input data into a "decoder" that then asks to connect a wallet, that is not homework. That is a trap.

ACADEMY NOTE Academy rule: a transaction is a signed instruction, not a screenshot and not a chat claim. Token sends often show 0 BNB value. Look at token transfers. Approvals are transactions too. You will not be asked to decode hex in Basic, and you will not be asked to launch a token. Those are later, or never, depending on the track.

What this lesson is for

You can now open a hash and name the envelope. Module 1's book metaphor is complete enough to use: pages, writers, many books, stages of settlement, fields inside an instruction. Module 2 names BNB Smart Chain as a specific book — chain ID 56, BNB for gas, BEP-20 tokens, the 0x trap.

Say this out loud

- A transaction is a signed instruction. The key that signed **from** is the authority.

- Native **value** is BNB on this chain. Token sends often show 0 there because the movement is inside the contract call.
- When you send a BEP-20, **to** is usually the token contract, and the friend appears in token-transfer records.
- Approvals and swaps are transactions too. They still cost BNB gas.
- You do not need hex. You need the right BscScan tab, the right contract, the right amount, the right address.

Take the quiz. Module 2 names BNB Smart Chain as a specific book.

Module quiz (answers included for editors)

Q1. A hash of a block is best described as?

- A. A password for the validator WhatsApp group
- B. A fingerprint of the page's contents; change the page, change the print
- C. The price of BNB that day
- D. A seed phrase in shorter form

Correct answer: B

Q2. If someone edits an old transaction on their laptop copy of the chain, what happens?

- A. Everyone's balances secretly change worldwide
- B. Crystal Stones must list on a major exchange
- C. Their copy no longer matches honest nodes, who ignore it
- D. Gas becomes free as a reward

Correct answer: C

Q3. A friend says "BSC is Bitcoin." The precise reply is?

- A. Yes — same book, different logo
- B. BSC is a company database, not a blockchain
- C. They are the same because both use 0x addresses
- D. BNB Smart Chain is a different public book with a smaller validator set, native BNB, and chain ID 56 — not Bitcoin

Correct answer: D

Q4. Your phone wallet typically does which of these?

- A. Stores the entire BSC history locally as a full node
- B. Asks an RPC node for balances and broadcasts your signed transaction
- C. Prints new BNB when you shake the phone
- D. Acts as the only validator on chain 56

Correct answer: B

Q5. Ada sees the same 0x on Ethereum and on BSC. That means?

- A. Balances are pooled and USDT on either book spends as one pile
- B. The letters are a coincidence and the keys are unrelated
- C. The same key can speak both books; the balances are still separate
- D. Gas paid in BNB also pays Ethereum fees

Correct answer: C

Q6. A buyer sends a screenshot of a wallet “submitted” banner and demands shipment. You should treat the payment as?

- A. Already final cash
- B. A confirmed Crystal Stones listing event
- C. Impossible on BSC because the chain is fast
- D. Not paid until the real explorer shows the hash included, successful, right token, right amount, your address

Correct answer: D

Q7. When you send BEP-20 USDT, the transaction’s to-field is usually?

- A. Your friend’s address as native BNB value
- B. The USDT contract, with the friend inside the call data / token-transfer records
- C. Satoshi’s address as a required tribute
- D. The academy Mentor inbox

Correct answer: B

Q8. BscScan shows 0 BNB value on a USDT send. That often means?

- A. The send failed by definition and you must retry
- B. Native value is 0 because the movement is a token transfer — check that tab
- C. The hash is fake if value is 0
- D. You must resend twice to “unlock” the token

Correct answer: B

Module 2: BNB Smart Chain as a specific book

Why BSC exists, chain ID 56, RPC, mainnet versus testnet, BEP-20 versus leftover names, the 0x trap, native coin versus token, and how a wallet adds the network.

Lesson 1: Why BSC exists in the first place (26 min)

Why BSC exists in the first place

BNB Smart Chain (BSC) is an EVM-compatible public chain associated with Binance's history. People use it because fees are usually low enough for small transfers, because wallet apps already know how to speak EVM, because a huge number of tokens — including Crystal Stones — live there as **BEP-20**, and because retail in Africa and Asia already met it through exchange withdrawals labelled BEP-20.

It is not “the official chain of crypto.” It is a popular book with a specific owner-history and a specific fee market. This lesson is history without worship.

By the end you should be able to separate three objects that share a yellow family resemblance: **Binance the company**, **BNB the coin**, and **BSC the chain**.

Not the official chain of anything

Crypto is not a company with a headquarters that picks a winner. Bitcoin does not appoint BSC. Ethereum does not appoint BSC. Binance — **an example of a centralised exchange**, not “the only real one” — launched and promoted an EVM chain so that Ethereum-style apps could run with cheaper fees and with BNB as gas.

That is a product decision. Product decisions can be useful. They are not commandments. You can use BSC without loving the company. You can dislike the company and still need to read chain ID 56 because that is where a token you are verifying lives.

This academy teaches this book because Crystal Stones is a BEP-20 here, and because later paid-track checkout uses USDT on BEP-20. Curriculum geography. Not a personality test.

EVM cousin: cheaper, faster, different trust

Ethereum showed that a public chain could run programs, not only simple payments. Those programs are **smart contracts**. When Ethereum is busy, **gas** — the fee for work — can spike. Small transfers feel silly. Retail looks for a cousin: same Ox shape, same wallet apps, lower fees.

BSC is that cousin. Faster blocks. Cheaper gas, usually paid in BNB. A smaller validator set, as Module 1 already named. You import Ethereum's **tools** and also Ethereum's **footguns**: unlimited approvals, fake tokens, phishing apps that look like dashboards.

“Cheaper and faster” is not “safer.” It is a different point on the slider. Adults pick rails on purpose.

BNB the coin versus BSC the chain versus Binance the company

BNB started as an exchange token. It is also the **native coin** of BNB Smart Chain: it pays gas, and it can be sent as value. Holding BNB as an IOU on an exchange is not the same as holding BNB on-chain in a wallet you control. Same name, again. The wallets course already taught IOU versus on-chain. Keep it.

BSC is the book. Mainnet chain ID **56**. Explorer people actually use: **BscScan**. Native coin: BNB. Token standard: BEP-20.

Binance the company is a business. It can list tokens, freeze accounts, change withdrawal screens, and get regulated. Using BSC does not mean you have a Binance account. Having a Binance account does not mean you are already on-chain.

Name	Role	Common smash-together
BNB	Native coin of BSC; pays gas; also a trading asset on venues	"I bought BNB on an exchange so I am on BSC"
BSC	The chain / book (chain ID 56 on mainnet)	"BSC is Binance, so it is not a blockchain"
BEP-20	The token standard on that book, ERC-20-style	"BEP-20 is a kind of Bitcoin"
BscScan	A popular explorer for that book	"The explorer is the chain"
Binance	An example of a centralised exchange	"The company, the coin, and the chain are one object"

Worked scenario. A student buys "BNB" on an exchange and thinks they are already on BSC, ready to add Crystal Stones as a custom token.

526. They still have an IOU. The exchange's ledger says the company owes them BNB.

527. They open a self-custody wallet — Trust Wallet or MetaMask as **examples of wallet apps**, not endorsements — and the BNB balance is 0 because nothing has been withdrawn.

528. They try to send a token. The wallet refuses: no gas.

529. They withdraw **BNB on the BSC network** (not Ethereum, not a leftover Beacon label, not a random "BNB Chain" fossil without reading the info icon) to their 0x.

530. After the explorer shows success, they have native gas in the wallet they will use. Buying the ticker on a venue was step zero, not arrival.

DIAGRAM

Binance the company != BNB the coin != BSC the chain

You can use BSC without loving the company.

You still need BNB on that chain to pay gas.

An exchange balance called BNB is an IOU until you withdraw it onto the book.

What "smart chain" is trying to say

Smart contracts are programs stored on the chain. Tokens, decentralised exchanges, and NFT markets are contracts. BSC copied Ethereum's programming model so developers could deploy cheaply.

This course will **not** teach you Solidity. This course will **not** teach you how to launch a token. That is Advanced, and even there it is not a side hustle we will sell you. Today you only need: the book can hold programs, and those programs can keep lists of who holds a ticker.

That design imported Ethereum's accidents. Fake BEP-20s are cheap to deploy. Approvals can drain you later. A "dashboard" can ask you to sign a permit. Safety is the next course. This course gives you the geography so Safety has nouns.

Why this academy stays on this book for Basic

We could teach Bitcoin first as settlement religion. We did not, because your next practical tasks — verifying Crystal Stones, practising a BEP-20 receive, later paying tuition in USDT on BEP-20 — happen here. We could pretend all chains are equal. They are not. We name the tradeoff and we stay.

ACADEMY NOTE This academy can teach BSC because Crystal Stones is a BEP-20 and because USDT-on-BSC is a practical rail. That is curriculum geography, not a commandment to ignore Bitcoin forever, and not a buy order for BNB, USDT, or Crystal Stones.

What this lesson is for

You can now say why BSC exists without worship and without sneering. Three objects, one book, BNB as gas. Next: the numbers wallets hide — chain ID, RPC, mainnet versus the practice book called testnet.

Say this out loud

- BNB Smart Chain is an EVM-compatible public book with cheap-ish fees and a smaller validator set — a cousin of Ethereum, not Bitcoin, and not “the official chain.”
- BNB pays gas on that book. An exchange IOU named BNB is not yet gas in your wallet.
- BEP-20 is the token rule-set on that book.
- Company, coin, and chain are three objects. Smash them and you will withdraw to the wrong place.
- This classroom uses BSC as geography. It will not tell you to buy.

Next: the numbers wallets hide — chain ID 56, RPC, mainnet versus testnet.

Lesson 2: Chain ID 56, RPC, mainnet vs testnet (28 min)

Chain ID 56, RPC, mainnet vs testnet

Wallets pick a network from a dropdown. Under the dropdown are numbers. The numbers are the lesson. The dropdown is a sticker.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to say **BNB Smart Chain mainnet is chain ID 56**, say what an **RPC** is without calling it a password, and treat **testnet** coins as fake — not naira, not a salary, not a thing you sell in a P2P chat.

Chain ID exists so a signature cannot be replayed on the wrong book

EVM chains have a **chain ID** so a signature meant for one book cannot be **replayed** on another. Replay would mean: you signed “pay 1 native coin to Ada” on one chain, and a thief broadcasts the same signature on a different chain where you also have funds.

- BNB Smart Chain **mainnet**: chain ID **56**
- BSC **testnet** (practice fake coins): a different ID (historically 97; if a UI shows something else, you are not on 56)
- Ethereum mainnet: chain ID 1

If a “support agent” sends an RPC and a chain ID that is not 56, you may be looking at a fork, a testnet, or a trap. Your real USDT will not be there. Your real Crystal Stones will not be there. The letters of your 0x might still look right. The book is wrong.

RPC is a counter, not a church, and not a seed

The **RPC** is how a wallet talks to a node. It is a URL. Your wallet asks it questions and hands it signed transactions to broadcast. Official and well-known public RPCs exist. Wallet apps often bundle one.

Random RPCs in a Discord or WhatsApp can:

- lie about balances
- spy on your IP and addresses
- in nasty setups, try to get you to sign the wrong thing (the signing still happens in the wallet — stay awake)

An RPC is **not** a password. It is **not** your seed. If someone says “paste your seed into the RPC to connect faster,” they are stealing. If someone says “the RPC password is the twelve words,” they are stealing with extra vocabulary.

Adding a network by hand in MetaMask (example of a wallet app): name, RPC, chain ID **56**, symbol BNB, explorer <https://bscscan.com>. Prefer the wallet’s built-in BSC where it exists. Prefer a documented public RPC over a QR from a stranger.

Mainnet is the book with real value; testnet is a practice book

Mainnet is the book with real value. Real BNB. Real BEP-20 USDT. Real Crystal Stones, if you ever hold them — this course does not require that.

Testnet is a playground with fake coins from a **faucet**. A faucet is a tap that gives practice units so developers and students can try transactions without lighting real money. Testnet Crystal Stones is not Crystal Stones. Testnet BNB is not BNB. Testnet coins are not worth naira. Anyone offering to “buy your testnet BNB for cash” is either confused or running a social engineering drill.

Never send mainnet USDT to a testnet address because someone said “it is cheaper.” Different books. Different IDs. Fake money on one side, real money on the other.

Network	Chain ID (BSC family)	Value	Beginner use
BSC mainnet	56	Real	This course’s book
BSC testnet	not 56 (historically 97)	Fake / practice	Optional playground; not a salary
Ethereum mainnet	1	Real, different book	Do not mix with BSC receives
A random “BSC Ultra”	whatever they typed	Assume hostile	Stop

Worked scenario. MetaMask is on Ethereum mainnet (chain ID 1). A student pastes a BSC USDT receive address into a dApp that builds an Ethereum USDT transaction.

531. The 0x letters match their wallet. They feel safe.

532. They do not read the network chip. They sign.
533. USDT leaves on Ethereum. Their BSC wallet still shows the old BEP-20 balance, or shows nothing of this send.
534. The freelancer on BSC is not paid. A different book moved.
535. Correct ritual, every time: read the network chip **before** signing. For this academy, the chip should mean BSC, chain ID 56, when the job is BSC.

DIAGRAM

```
Wallet network chip
|
+--> BSC 56 + known RPC + bscscan.com --> the book this course means
+--> Ethereum 1                      --> different book, real money, not BSC
+--> testnet (not 56)                 --> fake coins, not naira
+--> unknown chain ID + unknown RPC  --> stop
```

Bookmark the explorer yourself

Bookmark **bscscan.com** yourself. Fake explorers exist with one extra letter, a hyphen, or a different ending. The explorer URL you add in a wallet should be the one you intend to trust. Ads on the real explorer are not the explorer; Module 5 will repeat that.

If a “support” person sends you an RPC, a chain ID, and an explorer in one screenshot, read each field. Chain ID 56 and a lookalike explorer is still a lookalike explorer. RPC from a stranger plus chain ID 56 is still a stranger’s window onto the book.

ACADEMY NOTE Academy rule: mainnet BSC is chain ID 56. RPC is a helper; random helpers can lie. Testnet is fake money — not worth naira, not a P2P product. Your seed never belongs in an RPC field, a Discord form, or a “faster node” website.

What this lesson is for

You can now inspect the dropdown instead of trusting its sticker. Next: the leftover names on withdrawal screens — BEP-20, BEP-2, Beacon, opBNB — because fossils still bite.

Say this out loud

- BNB Smart Chain mainnet is chain ID 56.
- An RPC is how a wallet talks to a node. It is not a password and not a seed.
- Testnet is a practice book with fake coins. Those coins are not worth naira.
- Read the network chip before every signature.
- A random Discord RPC and a fake explorer are hostile until proven otherwise — and “proven” means more than a screenshot.

Next: BEP-20 versus older BEP-2 names that still confuse withdrawal screens.

Lesson 3: BEP-20, BEP-2, and leftover names (26 min)

BEP-20, BEP-2, and leftover names

Withdrawal screens still show fossils. Beginners lose funds not because cryptography failed, but because a dropdown said “BNB” and they did not read the help text.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to pick **BEP-20 / BSC / chain 56 / 0x** on purpose, and abort if the example address starts with bnb1 or if the label is opBNB when you meant mainnet BSC.

BEP-20 is the token standard on this book

BEP-20 is the token standard on **BNB Smart Chain**. It is ERC-20-style: a contract keeps a list of balances, and transfers are calls to that contract. Crystal Stones is BEP-20. USDT you want in a Trust Wallet-style 0x receive screen on BSC is BEP-20.

BEP-20 is not a coin of its own. It is a rule-set. Saying “I sent BEP-20” without naming the token is like saying “I sent a spreadsheet row” without naming the sheet.

ERC-20 is the cousin standard on Ethereum. **BEP-20 USDT is not ERC-20 USDT**. Same sticker. Different books. Different contracts. If an exchange withdraws ERC-20 and your wallet is watching BEP-20, you will stare at an empty list and think the money died. It may be sitting on Ethereum, waiting for you to open that book, with ETH for gas, not BNB.

BEP-2 is a leftover from an older Binance chain

BEP-2 is an older standard on the **Beacon Chain** (the earlier Binance Chain, not the same execution environment as BSC). Addresses looked like **bnb1...**, not 0x. If you withdraw BEP-2 to an 0x wallet, pain. If you withdraw BEP-20 to a bnb1 address, pain.

Many venues have retired or renamed this. You may still see it. If you see **BEP-2 / Beacon**, that is **not** the Trust Wallet 0x receive screen from the wallets course. It is not chain 56. It is not where Crystal Stones lives as this academy references it.

Do not “try it anyway because BNB is in the name.” Names collide. Formats do not.

“BSC”, “BEP20(BSC)”, “BNB Chain”, “opBNB”

Labels vary by venue. Read the help text, not the vibe of the word BNB.

opBNB is a layer-2 in the Binance family — **another book** again. Addresses may still look like 0x. That is the trap. Do not pick it because it says BNB. Pick the one that matches chain 56 mainnet, 0x destination, BEP-20 if you are moving a token.

“BNB Chain” without an info icon is ambiguous. Open the info icon. You want chain ID 56 and an 0x example. If the example starts with bnb1, abort. If it says Ethereum / ERC-20, abort. If it says Tron / TRC-20 / T-address, abort.

Label you might see	Typical meaning	Destination shape	Is it this course’s book?
BEP20 / BSC / BNB Smart	This course’s book	0x...	Yes, if chain ID 56

Chain			
ERC20	Ethereum	0x... (different book)	No
TRC20	Tron	T...	No
BEP2 / Beacon	Old Binance Chain	bnb1...	No
opBNB	A different BNB-family chain	0x... but not chain 56	No

Worked scenario. An exchange UI writes “BNB Smart Chain (BEP20).” Good. Another UI writes “BNB Chain” with no explanation.

536. Tunde opens the info icon on the second UI.
537. He looks for chain ID and address format.
538. If he sees chain ID 56 and an 0x example, he proceeds with a **tiny test** first.
539. If he sees bnb1, he aborts. That is not his EVM wallet.
540. If the popup does not name chain ID or address format, he either does a shrug-able test send or picks a venue that speaks clearly. Ambiguous labels are how fossils bite.

DIAGRAM

```

Want tokens in an EVM wallet (MetaMask / Trust Wallet examples) on BSC
|
v
Need BEP-20 / BSC / chain 56 / 0x
|
X not BEP-2
X not ERC-20
X not TRC-20
X not opBNB by accident
X not “BNB” as a vibe

```

How this bites a USDT withdrawal

The exchanges course already told you: the network dropdown on a USDT withdrawal is the whole game. This lesson names the fossils inside the Binance-family labelling.

You want USDT that will show in your BSC wallet and spend with BNB gas. That is BEP-20 USDT on chain 56. It is **not**:

- ERC-20 USDT (Ethereum; needs ETH for gas)
- TRC-20 USDT (Tron; T-addresses)
- a BEP-2 remnant
- opBNB because it was first in the list

If you already sent to the wrong book, recovery is sometimes “open the correct network with the correct native gas.” It is never “Telegram recovery admin.” Safety will labour this. Today: pick the label on purpose.

“BNB” as a withdrawal asset is a different dropdown from “USDT on BSC.” Withdrawing the native coin BNB onto chain 56 is how you get gas. Withdrawing USDT as BEP-20 is how you get the token. People pick BNB

when they meant USDT, or pick a BNB-family fossil when they meant chain 56, and then say “crypto stole from me.” The dropdown stole from them. Read it twice. Send a shrug-able test.

ACADEMY NOTE If the info popup does not name chain ID or address format, do a test send of a shrug-able amount or pick a venue that speaks clearly. Ambiguous labels are how fossils bite. This academy will not tell you that every withdrawal UI is well written. Some are not. That is why you read.

What this lesson is for

You can now treat withdrawal labels as a decoding job. Next: the 0x trap in one place, because same letters on two books still deserve their own lesson.

Say this out loud

- BEP-20 means tokens on BNB Smart Chain, 0x addresses, chain 56.
- BEP-2 is an old chain with bnb1 addresses — not your EVM wallet.
- BEP-20 USDT is not ERC-20 USDT. Same sticker, different book, different contract.
- opBNB is another book. Do not pick it because it says BNB.
- Read the info icon for chain ID and address format, not the vibe of the word BNB.

Next: the 0x trap on two books — same letters, different planet.

Lesson 4: The 0x address trap on two books (26 min)

The 0x address trap on two books

Your seed on an EVM wallet can produce the **same 0x text** for Ethereum and for BNB Smart Chain. That is convenient. It is also the expensive confusion that sits right behind “USDT is USDT.”

By the end of this lesson you should be able to say: same letters, different planet; network first, then copy, then withdraw; recovery is “open the other book,” not “send a seed to support.”

Same key, two ledgers

The private key signs EVM transactions. The **chain ID** inside the signed message says which book. Balances:

- ETH and ERC-20 tokens live on Ethereum
- BNB and BEP-20 tokens live on BSC
- they do **not** add up

You can be funded on one and empty on the other with the same letters in the receive box. The wallet app is a window. Switching the dropdown changes the window. It does not merge the piles.

This is not a bug in “the blockchain.” It is two books sharing a key format because they share an engine family. Shared format is not shared money.

How to not mix them

Ritual, in this order:

541. Set the wallet **network** first. For this academy's practice, BSC — chain ID 56.
542. Copy the receive address **after** the chip is right. (The letters may look the same anyway. The chip is for you, not for the alphabet.)
543. Set the exchange withdrawal to that **same** network. BEP-20 / BSC, not ERC-20, not TRC-20.
544. Send a tiny test. Confirm on the explorer of that network. BscScan for BSC. Etherscan for Ethereum.
545. Only then send the rest.

If you skip step 1, you will still copy a valid-looking 0x. Validity of letters is not validity of book.

If you already mixed them

If you sent ERC-20 to your 0x and your BSC wallet shows 0, look at **Etherscan**, not only BscScan. If you sent BEP-20 and Etherscan is empty, look at BscScan. If both explorers are empty, it may not have left the exchange, or the hash is wrong, or it is still pending.

You may still control the key that owns the other book. Recovery is: open the **correct network** in a wallet that can speak it, with the **native gas of that network** (ETH on Ethereum, BNB on BSC). It is not: a Telegram recovery bot. It is not: a “cross-chain unstucker” that wants a seed. It is not: bridging through a sponsored tweet.

If the destination was a contract that only exists on one chain, or an exchange deposit address tagged for one network, recovery may be a support ticket at that venue — slow, sometimes impossible — not a miracle dApp.

Symptom	Likely reality	First honest move
Sent ERC-20 to 0x, wallet on BSC shows 0	Funds may be on Ethereum	Check Etherscan; you need ETH to move them
Sent BEP-20, Etherscan empty	Funds may be on BSC	Check BscScan; you need BNB to move them
Both explorers empty	Not included yet, never left the CEX, or wrong hash	Check the venue's withdrawal history and the hash
A helper wants a seed to “merge the chains”	Theft	Close the chat

Worked scenario. Ada sends USDT BEP-20 correctly to her wallet. Then she sends “the same” USDT to the same 0x from another venue but leaves that venue on ERC-20.

546. She now has two piles on two books.
547. She only watches BscScan. She thinks half vanished.
548. A group admin says “same address so it must be there, send 0.1 BNB to this helper to unlock the hidden ERC-20.”
549. She refuses. She opens Etherscan. The ERC-20 USDT is there.
550. Two books, one string. She will need ETH as gas on Ethereum if she wants to move that pile. She will not send BNB to a stranger to “unlock” Ethereum.

DIAGRAM

```
Seed --> same 0x string
      |
      +--> Ethereum balances (ETH, ERC-20)    --> Etherscan
      +--> BSC balances (BNB, BEP-20)        --> BscScan
```

Watch BOTH explorers if you used BOTH networks.
Better: use one network on purpose.
This academy's default practice network is BSC.

Prefer one practice network

This academy's default practice network is BSC. Pick it on purpose every time rather than "whichever the dropdown remembered." One practice network means one explorer, one gas coin, one withdrawal label. That is how you get reps without collecting recovery stories.

When you later need Ethereum for some other reason, you will treat it as a second book with a second gas coin, not as "the same wallet so the same money."

Copy-paste still bites even when the network is right. Messaging apps insert invisible characters. A trailing space can break a checksum. Paste into the wallet, look at the first six and last four characters out loud, compare to the explorer or the paper you already checked. If a cousin reads the address over a phone call, they will get one character wrong. Do not take addresses by voice.

ACADEMY NOTE Academy rule: same 0x, different books, different balances. Network first, then copy, then withdraw. Recovery is "open the other book with that book's native gas," not "send a seed to support." Prefer one practice network so you are not always on both planets at once.

What this lesson is for

The 0x trap now has its own shelf in your head. Next: native coin versus token — BNB as fuel and value, tokens as rows in contracts, and why sending BNB to a token contract is not a purchase.

Say this out loud

- Same 0x letters on Ethereum and BSC do not mean the same account-as-balance. The key can speak both books; the money is not shared.
- Network first, then copy the address, then set the withdrawal to that same network.
- If you mixed books, open the explorer for the book you actually sent on. Do not send a seed to a recovery admin.
- BEP-20 USDT is not ERC-20 USDT even when the receive letters match.
- Prefer one practice network. This academy's is BSC, chain ID 56.

Next: native coin versus token — fuel versus rows in a contract.

Lesson 5: Native coin versus token (26 min)

Native coin versus token

On BNB Smart Chain there is one **native** asset — **BNB** — and a universe of **tokens** implemented as contracts. Mixing those two objects is how people “deposit to the contract to mint” and light their gas on fire.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to say where BNB lives, where Crystal Stones lives, and why your wallet address is the pocket while the token contract is the rule-book.

Native: the chain’s own coin

BNB on BSC is native. That means:

- it is not a BEP-20
- it pays **gas**
- it appears as **value** on a simple send
- the chain’s existence does not depend on a single token contract

You can send BNB to a friend’s 0x the way you send a native payment: **to** is the friend, **value** is the amount. You still pay a little extra BNB as the fee. If you try to empty the tank to zero in one send, the wallet may refuse, because the fee has to come from somewhere.

Without BNB, you can **see** tokens and you cannot **move** them. Holding a large BEP-20 balance with 0 BNB is like having inventory in a locked shop. The book shows the inventory. The door needs fuel.

Token: a row in a contract’s list

A **token** on BSC is a **contract** — a program plus storage — that keeps a list: address → balance. When you “hold Crystal Stones,” you are an entry in that contract’s mapping. The contract, as this academy references the project, is 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00. That sentence is verification geography. It is not a buy order.

USDT as BEP-20 is the same shape: a different contract, a different list. The sticker “USDT” is also used on Ethereum and Tron. The list is not shared.

If you sent BNB to the token **contract** by mistake (as native value), you may have gifted the program, not “converted.” Token contracts are not shop tills that automatically swap native coin into the ticker. Some contracts have functions that accept BNB. Many do not send it back to strangers. “Deposit to the contract to mint” from a YouTube comment is how people donate.

Your wallet address holds both; the contract address is not your pocket

Your **wallet address** (an externally owned account) can show:

- BNB (native)
- USDT according to the USDT contract
- Crystal Stones according to the Crystal Stones contract
- a pile of spam tokens you never asked for

The **token contract address** is the program. It is not a deposit box with your name on it. You interact with it by sending a transaction that calls a function — transfer, approve, and later, if you ever use a DEX, a router. You do not mail native BNB into it as if it were a person named Crystal.

Action	Result
Send BNB to a friend's 0x	Friend can spend BNB (after inclusion)
Send BNB to a token contract address as value	Often stuck; not a swap; not a purchase
Send token via the contract's transfer	Friend's token balance updates
Hold token with 0 BNB	You can see it; you cannot move it
Add a token to the wallet display	A sticker on the window; coins do not move

Worked scenario. A student wants Crystal Stones. A YouTube comment says “deposit BNB to the contract to mint.”

551. They withdraw BNB from an exchange **to the Crystal Stones contract address**.
552. BscScan shows a native BNB send **to** the contract. Token transfers do not show a mint to them.
553. The contract did not mint them a gift. They sent native BNB into a program that does not have a withdraw-for-strangers button.
554. Correct pattern, if they ever buy at all — this course does not require it — is a centralised exchange trade, or later a DEX swap they understand. Not mailing fuel into a program.
555. Correct pattern for holding: BNB and tokens **in your wallet address**. Interact only through known functions.

DIAGRAM

Your wallet address (the pocket)

- BNB (fuel + native value)
- USDT contract says you have X
- Crystal Stones contract says you have Y

The token contract address (the rule-book)

- keeps the list
- is NOT your piggy-bank deposit box
- mailing BNB into it is not a purchase

This academy will not tell you to buy

You can finish this course, including the labs, without purchasing Crystal Stones, USDT, or extra BNB beyond a tiny gas practice if you even do that. Verifying a contract is literacy. Adding a token to a display is literacy. Neither is a market order.

RWA claims around Crystal Stones — minerals, vaults, backing — are **project claims to verify** in the legal and audit world. They are not classroom proof that a vault exists. A BEP-20 balance is a row in a contract. A row in a contract is not a gold bar in your hand.

ACADEMY NOTE Never “send tokens to the contract to buy.” Buying, if you ever do it, is a DEX swap or a CEX trade — different skills, later or optional. Sending native BNB into a random contract as if it were a person is a classic loss. This classroom is still not a buy order.

What this lesson is for

Native versus token is now a reflex. Last lesson of this module: what it actually means when a wallet “adds BSC.” You are pointing a window at a book, not installing a new universe.

Say this out loud

- BNB is native on BSC. It pays gas and can be sent as value. Tokens are rows in contracts.
- Your wallet address is the pocket. The token contract is the rule-book, not a deposit box.
- Holding a token with 0 BNB means you can see it and you cannot move it.
- Sending native BNB into a token contract is not a purchase and often sticks.
- Crystal Stones is a BEP-20 row, not native gas, and verifying its contract is not a buy order.

Next: how a wallet “adds BSC” — you are pointing the window at a book.

Lesson 6: How a wallet “adds BSC” (24 min)

How a wallet “adds BSC”

When a wallet “adds a network,” you are not downloading a chain into the phone. You are pointing the window at a book: RPC, chain ID, native symbol, explorer. The book was already there. Your seed, if it is an EVM seed, could already speak that book. The dropdown was just looking at a different one.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to add BSC on purpose — chain ID 56 — and refuse a dApp popup that fills a lookalike RPC.

You are pointing the window, not installing a universe

A wallet app is a key manager plus a picture of whatever book you pointed it at. **Add network** fills in:

- a human name (“BNB Smart Chain”)
- an **RPC** URL (the counter)
- **chain ID 56**
- native currency symbol **BNB**
- an explorer URL, which should be <https://bscscan.com> if that is the window you intend

If chain ID is wrong, stop. If someone wants you to scan a QR that fills an RPC you cannot read, stop. If the explorer field is a lookalike, stop. The name can be honest while the RPC is a liar.

Trust Wallet often has BSC built in. MetaMask may need Add network. Both are **examples of wallet apps**, not endorsements. Built-in is still a window. Confirm the chip before you sign.

The fields, again, as a checklist

When you add by hand, read every line:

- Network name: can be fake; the number matters more
- RPC: known public endpoint, or the wallet’s own suggestion, not a Discord gift
- Chain ID: **56**

- Currency: BNB
- Explorer: <https://bscscan.com>

Chain ID is the line that stops replay across books. If a form says 56 but the RPC hostname is a lookalike of a known host, cancel and add from the wallet's own list or from documentation you already trust.

Built-in versus custom versus dApp popup

Three doors, different manners:

- **Built-in BSC** — still confirm you are on it before signing. Dropdowns drift.
- **Custom network form** — you type the fields. Slow. Honest if you type honestly.
- **“Add network” popup from a dApp** — the site suggests fields. Convenient. Also how a trap chain gets installed with a friendly name.

A dApp can suggest chain ID 56 and a hostile RPC. A dApp can suggest a friendly name and chain ID something-else. Read. You are not being rude. You are doing the job.

Wallet behaviour	Your job
Built-in BSC	Still confirm you are on it before signing
Custom network form	Chain ID 56, known RPC, known explorer
“Add network” popup from a dApp	Read fields; dApps can suggest a trap chain
QR from a stranger that “auto-fills BSC”	Do not scan

Worked scenario. A dApp pops “Add Binance Smart Chain” with chain ID 56 but an RPC hostname that is a lookalike.

556. The student does not tap Approve because the name looks right.
557. They cancel the popup.
558. They add BSC from MetaMask's own list, or from documentation they already trust, checking chain ID 56 and bscscan.com.
559. Extra thirty seconds. Fewer surprises.
560. They still read the network chip before every later signature, because adding the network once is not a blessing that lasts if they switch to Ethereum and forget.

DIAGRAM

Need BSC

- > wallet's built-in or documented add
- > chain ID 56
- > known RPC
- > explorer bscscan.com
- X not a popup from a sponsored dApp you just met
- X not a QR in a WhatsApp status
- X not “BSC Ultra” with a new ID

Multiple networks in one seed is normal and dangerous

You can hold BSC, Ethereum, and others behind one seed. That is normal EVM life. It increases the number of ways to pick the wrong dropdown. For this academy, keep the chip on BSC when you mean BSC.

Adding a network does not make a fake app honest. The wallets course covered clones. It still applies. Official store, official app. Adding BSC on a fake APK gives a thief a window and a key.

You do not need ten wallets. One official software wallet for practice, later hardware for amounts you would miss. More apps is more clone surface.

Adding BSC does not give you BNB. The window can be aimed perfectly at chain 56 and still show 0. That is not a broken add. That is an empty fuel gauge. People “add BSC” and then rage that Crystal Stones will not send. They needed native BNB on that address, not a second copy of the network form. Do not pay a site that claims to “activate BSC” after you added it. Activation is a scam word. The book does not need a blessing. It needs a signed transaction and a fee in BNB if you want to write. Reading needs even less: BscScan already reads without the wallet.

If you add BSC twice with two RPCs, you may see two entries that look like twins. Delete the one with the stranger’s URL. Keep chain ID 56 and the explorer you intended. Twins are how people later sign on a liar window that still says “BNB Smart Chain” at the top.

ACADEMY NOTE Academy rule: adding BSC is pointing a window at chain ID 56. It is not a purchase, not a node, and not a reason to scan a stranger’s QR. Prefer the wallet’s built-in or documented network list. dApp popups are suggestions, not commands.

What this lesson is for

Module 2 is a specific book: why it exists, its numbers, its leftover names, its 0x trap, its native coin, and how a wallet aims at it. Module 3 puts tokens and the Crystal Stones contract under the light — as literacy, not a pitch.

Say this out loud

- Adding BSC means pointing the wallet’s window at chain ID 56, a known RPC, symbol BNB, explorer bscscan.com.
- The book was already there. You did not install a universe.
- dApp “add network” popups are suggestions. Read the chain ID and the RPC.
- One honest wallet beats five random APKs.
- The network chip is part of every send, even after you added the network once.

Take the quiz. Module 3: tokens, contracts, and Crystal Stones as a case — verify, do not buy.

Module quiz (answers included for editors)

Q1. On BNB Smart Chain, gas is paid in?

- A. USDT
- B. Crystal Stones

- C. BNB
- D. Naira

Correct answer: C

Q2. BSC mainnet chain ID is?

- A. 1, same as Ethereum, because they share 0x addresses
- B. 56
- C. 97 as the only mainnet
- D. 20, because BEP-20

Correct answer: B

Q3. A stranger says the RPC password is your seed phrase. You should?

- A. Paste it so the node will sync faster
- B. Treat that as theft — an RPC is a URL, not a seed
- C. Send it only if they work at Binance
- D. Use the first three words, which are enough

Correct answer: B

Q4. Testnet BNB and testnet tokens are?

- A. Redeemable 1:1 for mainnet and worth naira on P2P
- B. What Crystal Stones must be bought with
- C. Play money on a different book, not a salary
- D. A type of seed phrase

Correct answer: C

Q5. BEP-20 USDT compared with ERC-20 USDT is?

- A. The same object; the letters 0x merge the piles
- B. A different token on a different book, even if the receive letters match
- C. The Tron version with a T-address
- D. Native gas on BSC

Correct answer: B

Q6. BEP-2 / Beacon withdrawals typically use addresses like?

- A. 0x on chain 56
- B. bnb1... on the old chain — not your EVM 0x wallet
- C. T... on Tron
- D. Email addresses

Correct answer: B

Q7. The same 0x on Ethereum and BSC means?

- A. Balances are pooled
- B. USDT ERC-20 will show inside a BSC token list automatically
- C. Gas is shared between the books
- D. The same key can own accounts on both books; the money is not shared

Correct answer: D

Q8. Sending native BNB to a token contract address to “mint” usually?

- A. Buys the token at a guaranteed price
- B. Is not a swap and can stick the BNB in the contract
- C. Mints Crystal Stones 1:1 as a classroom fact
- D. Pays academy tuition

Correct answer: B

Module 3: Tokens, contracts, and Crystal Stones as a case

What a contract address is, reading the Crystal Stones page on BscScan as literacy, clones, decimals, admin keys, and adding a token by contract rather than by search.

Lesson 1: What a contract address is (26 min)

What a contract address is

An EVM address is 20 bytes, shown as 0x plus 40 hex characters. Two important kinds live in that same clothing: a person's key, and a program. Mixing them is how names become traps.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to say that **address is identity, name is a sticker**, and the Crystal Stones contract this academy references is a string to verify, not a buy order.

Externally owned versus contract

An **externally owned account (EOA)** is a person or wallet, controlled by a key. Your Trust Wallet or MetaMask receive address is this. If the key signs, the account spends.

A **contract** is code deployed on-chain. No seed. It does what its bytecode and its owner permissions allow. You cannot “log in” to a contract with a password. You call functions by sending transactions.

Both look like 0x plus forty characters. The explorer will usually label a contract as a contract. Your job is to notice the label. Sending native BNB to a contract as if it were your cousin is Module 2's failure mode. Sending tokens to a lookalike contract because the name matched is this module's.

Why the string matters more than the name

Anyone can deploy a contract and call it Crystal Stones, USDT, or BNB2. The **address** is the identity. Names in wallets are stickers. Logos are stickers. Telegram titles are stickers.

Crystal Stones, as this academy references the project:

0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00

on BNB Smart Chain. Save it from a source you trust — the project’s long-standing site and official channels you already verified, not a Google ad, not a WhatsApp status. Compare character by character when you add a token.

This classroom does not certify that the project’s mineral story is true. RWA claims are **project claims to verify**. A contract address is only the on-chain object those claims point at. Verifying the pointer is not a purchase and not a vault tour.

Checksum is a stop sign

Some letters are uppercase on purpose (**EIP-55 checksum**). The mix of upper and lower case is a built-in typo check. If you paste and the wallet warns about checksum, stop and re-copy. It may be a typo. One wrong character is a different person or a different program — often a black hole.

Do not “fix” the address from memory. Do not accept a helper’s version with two characters different “because of formatting.” Copy, paste, compare.

Contracts can also be **proxies**: one address you see, another address that holds the logic. Explorers sometimes show “Read as Proxy.” That is Intermediate. Today you only need: the address you paste is still the identity of the token you mean. A helper who says “use this implementation address instead, the other one is outdated” is often handing you a clone. Stay with the token address the project published and that BscScan’s token tracker uses for transfers.

Creating a contract is cheap. That is why identity cannot be a vibe. The next lessons will show you clones that look more official than the real tracker. Your defence starts here: the string, checksum, more than one source.

Object	Controlled by	Example job	Identity
EOA	Private key / seed	Your pocket	The 0x your wallet shows
Token contract	Its code, plus owner keys if the code allows	Balances of a ticker	The 0x of the program
DEX router	Its code	Swaps	A different 0x; not the token
Explorer page	A website	A view	A URL; not the contract itself
Name / logo	Whoever deployed or whoever designed a sticker	Marketing	Not identity

Worked scenario. Two BscScan pages: the real Crystal Stones contract, and a clone created yesterday with extra supply and a similar name.

561. Wallet search by name shows both. The clone may even sit higher if someone paid to spam it.
562. A student who adds via an airdrop popup gets the clone. Their “balance” is a row in the wrong list.

563. A student who pastes 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00 from a source they already verified gets one contract.
564. They still might not buy. This course does not require it. They refused a fake.
565. If a checksum warning appears, they stop and re-copy rather than ignoring the yellow text.

DIAGRAM

```
Name sticker --> many possible contracts
Logo          --> many possible contracts
Address       --> one contract on that chain
```

Always add by address from a verified source.
Verifying is not a buy order.

You will meet this string again

You will paste it in the token-page lesson, in the add-token lesson, and in Module 6's lab. Repetition is the point. Scammers win on the day you are tired and search by name.

Write it in your own notes, from a source you trust, and compare. Do not trust this paragraph alone if you are about to move funds — open the project's long-standing site as well, and confirm the explorer. Multiple sources. Module 6 will make that a lab.

ACADEMY NOTE This lesson is still not a buy order. It is how you refuse fakes if you later look at a token at all. Academy staff will not DM you a "new contract." A surprise migration is hostile until a slow public verification exists.

What this lesson is for

Identity is now a string. Next: a guided look at the Crystal Stones page on BscScan — holders, transfers, contract tab — as literacy, not a pitch.

Say this out loud

- Address is identity. Name and logo are stickers.
- An EOA is controlled by a key. A contract is code, with no seed to "log in."
- Crystal Stones, as this academy references it, is 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00 on BSC — verify, do not treat that as a buy.
- Checksum warnings are stop signs. Do not improve an address from memory.
- Add tokens by contract from a source you already verified, not by a popup's name.

Next: a guided look at the Crystal Stones token page on BscScan.

Lesson 2: Reading the Crystal Stones token page on BscScan (28 min)

Reading the Crystal Stones token page on BscScan

Open BscScan from a bookmark, not from a chat link. Paste:

0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00

You should land on a **contract / token** page on the real domain. Check the domain character by character. This lesson is literacy. It is not a pitch. This academy will not tell you to buy.

By the end you should know what holders, transfers, and the contract tab are for, and you should know that a **verified** contract is not a safe investment.

Domain first, then the sticker

Fake explorers exist. Ads on the real explorer exist. If the page asks you to **connect a wallet to view** a public balance, you are probably not on BscScan. Public balances do not need your seed.

Contract / token name and symbol are stickers. Confirm they match what the project publishes. Clones will also set pretty stickers. The address is still the identity.

Decimals and total supply are mechanical, not a price

Decimals say how many places the token uses to display. The chain stores integers. Wallets hide this. Display bugs happen when a wallet assumes 18 and the token uses 9, or the reverse. Confirm amounts on the explorer's token-transfer row, which usually formats with the token's own decimals.

Total supply is how many units the contract says exist (in display terms). This is **not** market cap, not price, not "backed by a vault." It is a number in a program. Tokenomics as a subject is later. Today: know the number is a contract fact, and a PDF that disagrees with the contract is a PDF.

Holders and transfers are history, not a promise

Holders is the list of who has a balance. Huge concentration in a few addresses can matter later. Today: know the tab exists. Do not harass holders in DMs. A big holder is not a promise of price, of vaults, or of your future. Module 5 will labour this.

Transfers is the living history of the token. This is how you verify "someone paid me Crystal Stones." Filter the contract, read from, to, amount, status. A group screenshot is not this tab.

If a group claims "the team dumped," this tab is where you look — and you may still not know whether a move was a DEX swap, a CEX deposit, or a lie. Looking is the skill. Repeating a caption is not.

Contract tab: verified is hygiene, not a blessing

If BscScan shows **verified** source code, the published source matches the bytecode the chain is running. Unverified means you are trusting a black box. Verification is good hygiene. It is not a halo.

Verified scam contracts exist. People publish readable code that still lets them pause you, mint on you, or trap a sale. "Verified" means "you can read what it does if you can read it." It does not mean "safe investment." It does not mean "the mineral vault is real." It does not mean this academy tells you to buy.

Read contract lets you read public numbers without connecting a wallet. **Write contract** is a way to send transactions through the explorer. Do **not** write — especially owner functions — because a YouTube comment said to. Connecting a wallet to BscScan write is still connecting a wallet.

Tab	Beginner use	Not a license for
Name / symbol	Compare to the project's published	Trusting a clone with a prettier logo

	sticker	
Decimals / supply	Mechanical display and a contract number	Price targets
Holders	Curiosity about concentration	A target list, a promise, a vault proof
Transfers	Did a payment happen?	Ignoring the contract address
Contract (verified?)	Hygiene: can the source be matched to bytecode?	“Verified = safe investment”
Read	Numbers without signing	None — this is the safe tab
Write	Usually not for you today	Owner clicks because a comment said so

Worked scenario. A group claims “the team dumped Crystal Stones, it is over.”

566. Ngozi does not reshare the caption. She opens BscScan from a bookmark.
567. She pastes 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00. Domain is real. Address matches.
568. She opens Transfers. She looks at large recent moves. She does not yet know what each address is.
569. She notices that a pretty caption is not a from/to/amount/status row. Sometimes the story is a DEX hop. Sometimes it is a CEX deposit. Sometimes it is a lie.
570. She still does not buy or sell because a classroom said to. She learned to look. She closes the tab without connecting a wallet.

DIAGRAM

```

BscScan token page (real domain)
  Transfers --> payments
  Holders    --> concentration, not a promise
  Contract   --> verified code / owner – hygiene, not a blessing
  Read       --> numbers without signing
  Write      --> not your beginner tool
  Ads        --> not the product; never connect from a banner

```

RWA claims are not this page

crystalstones.org may describe minerals, supply figures, taxes, burns. Those are **website / whitepaper parameters**. This BscScan page shows the on-chain object: transfers, holders, code status. A classroom paragraph is not a receipt for a vault. A receipt would be legal title, custody, and audit you can follow. We will not invent that receipt.

ACADEMY NOTE If the page asks you to connect a wallet to **view** a balance, you are probably not on BscScan. Public balances do not need your seed. Verified source is not a safe-investment stamp. This academy will not tell you to buy because a contract tab is green.

What this lesson is for

You can walk a token page without being sold to. Next: clones, similar names, and fake liquidity — because the search box is hostile.

Say this out loud

- The Crystal Stones token page is identity plus history plus code status, not a shop window.

- Supply is a contract number, not a price and not proof of a vault.
- Transfers settle payment arguments. Holders are not a promise.
- A verified contract means the source matches bytecode. It does not mean a safe investment.
- Connect-wallet to “view” is a red flag on an explorer clone.

Next: clones, similar names, and fake liquidity.

Lesson 3: Clones, similar names, and fake liquidity (26 min)

Clones, similar names, and fake liquidity

Creating a BEP-20 is cheap. Creating a pool with a stolen logo is cheap. The industry calls them **scam tokens**, **honeypots**, **clones**. You will meet them the moment you search a name.

By the end of this lesson you should refuse name search, refuse surprise “migration” DMs, and treat a pretty chart as theatre until you know which contract you are looking at.

Cheap to deploy is the whole problem

Anyone with a little BNB can deploy a contract and name it Crystal Stones, USDT, or Tesla. The chain will accept the deployment because the chain does not parent you. The book records the program. The book does not certify the sticker.

That is why this academy repeats the address. **0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00**. Extra spaces, Cyrillic letters, “Crystal Stone” singular, “Crystal Stones 2.0,” “official Crystal Stones v3” — different objects. Some will even show a prettier chart than the real one, because painting a chart is cheap too.

Honeypot, in beginner language

A **honeypot** is a contract that lets you buy but not sell, or takes a ruinous fee on exit, or blacklists the buyer. The chart only goes up on the way in. You are not a trader. You are the exit liquidity of nobody.

You do not need to be a contract reader to take the beginner precaution: **do not buy a token you found by name search**. If you cannot explain which contract you are interacting with, you are not investing. You are volunteering.

This course will not teach you how to launch a token so you can be on the other side of that chart. Advanced is not Basic, and it is not a side hustle we will sell you in a footnote.

Liquidity captions deserve the same coldness. “Locked LP,” “burned LP,” “huge liquidity” are words. Intermediate will ask which locker contract, until when, and whether the lock is even of the pair you think. Basic’s version: a clone can show a pool with stolen logos and a number that looks like money. If you cannot paste the token contract and the pair contract into BscScan yourself, you do not have liquidity. You have a graphic.

Fake volume is the sibling. A bot can buy and sell with itself. A chart can go up and to the right on a token nobody else can exit. “Daily volume” on a name-search result is not a reason to paste an unknown address into a swap. It is a reason to close the tab.

Name search is hostile; fake volume is theatre

Trust Wallet's add-token search, PancakeSwap search, Gecko-style sites — they index **many** contracts. Ranking is not holiness. Ranking can be spam, paid placement, or volume painted by a bot loop.

Tiny buys in a loop can paint a chart. If you cannot see **who** is trading and whether sells succeed for strangers, you do not have a market. You have theatre. "Liquidity" in a caption is not the same as a pool you can exit.

Check	Why	Beginner action
Address match	Identity	Paste the known contract; ignore the rest
Name search	Hostile index	Do not use it to pick what to hold
Pretty chart	Can be painted	Not sellability
Born-yesterday + huge APR	Smell	Walk away
Surprise migration DM	Clone attempt	Treat as hostile
"Add this new contract tonight"	Classic drain setup	Academy staff will not do this

Worked scenario. Search "Crystal Stones" on a DEX aggregator. Five results. One address matches. Four do not. The four may even show a prettier chart.

571. The student only opens the matching address: 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00.
572. They still might not buy — this course does not require it — but they did not buy a trap.
573. A DM arrives: "we migrated, add this new contract tonight, old one is dead."
574. They treat it as hostile. Migrations, if they ever happened, would be a public, slow, verifiable event — not a Friday night surprise.
575. They do not approve a spender "to migrate." They do not send BNB to a helper.

DIAGRAM

```

Search by name --> a pile of lookalikes
Paste address --> one contract
Chart without identity --> theatre
Surprise migration DM --> clone attempt

```

```

If you will ever interact, paste.
If you will not interact, you still learned to refuse.

```

Academy staff will not migrate you in a chat

Write this until it is boring: Crystal Stones Academy staff never ask for seed phrase, private key, 2FA codes, or remote screen control. They also will not send you a "new contract because we migrated, add this now" in a DM.

If a real migration ever existed, you would verify it the slow way: official long-standing site, explorer, more than one source, time to think. Basic does not ask you to migrate anything.

ACADEMY NOTE Cheap to clone a name. Expensive to undo a buy. Search by address. Pretty chart is not sellability. Surprise “migration” DMs are hostile. This classroom is still not a buy order for the real contract either.

What this lesson is for

You now treat the search box as an adversary. Next: decimals, supply, and what tokenomics is not — so a PDF cannot outshout a contract.

Say this out loud

- Creating a BEP-20 with a stolen name is cheap. That is why address is identity.
- A honeypot lets you buy and then blocks or wrecks selling. Name search is how people walk in.
- Pretty charts can be painted. They are not proof you can exit.
- Surprise migration DMs are hostile. Academy staff will not send you a new contract on a Friday night.
- Paste the known address. This academy will not tell you to buy it.

Next: decimals, supply, and the tokenomics claims you should not swallow yet.

Lesson 4: Decimals, supply, and what tokenomics is not (26 min)

Decimals, supply, and what tokenomics is not

People quote “billion supply” or “only 1 million” as if that were price. **Price × supply** fantasies belong later. Today, mechanical facts: how wallets display integers, what total supply actually is, and why a PDF is not bytecode.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to refuse a rocket-emoji tokenomics page as a substitute for the contract, and you should know that decimals are a display rule, not a naira price.

Decimals are a display rule

If **decimals** = 18, one display token is 10^{18} base units in the contract. Wallets hide this. You see “1.0.” The chain sees a giant integer.

Bugs: a site shows 0.000000000000000001 as “you received 1.” Another site shows 1 as “you received 0.000000000000000001.” Always confirm amount on BscScan’s token transfer, which usually formats with the token’s decimals.

Decimals do not set the naira price. They do not hide the owner. They do not replace gas. They tell wallets how to place a decimal point. If a helper says “your decimals are locked, send BNB to unlock,” they are stealing.

Supply is a contract number; mint is a capability

Total supply can be fixed or mintable. If the contract owner can **mint**, they can create more tokens. That is not automatically evil — some designs need it — and not automatically fine — it can dilute holders. Read whether mint is possible only if you later care about holding. BscScan’s Read functions often expose owner and totalSupply without a signature.

A PDF that says “max supply 100 million” is a **policy**. A mint function that still exists is a **capability**. Capabilities beat PDFs when they disagree. The next lesson is the full decentralisation test: admin keys, pause, mint. Today, park this sentence: **the chain describes what the program can do, not what a designer hopes they will do.**

What tokenomics is not

Tokenomics means, in later courses: how tokens are created, allocated, released, taxed, and used. You cannot audit that from a sticker pack.

Tokenomics is not:

- a guarantee of price
- a reason to skip the contract address
- a PDF with a rocket emoji
- “2% reflections” as a job replacement
- classroom proof that a mineral vault exists
- a reason this academy tells you to buy

Crystal Stones’ deeper economics belong in a later ecosystem course if you ever take it. Basic only trains you not to confuse a PDF with bytecode.

Claim in a PDF	Mechanical question	Who wins if they disagree
“Limited supply”	Can owner mint? Is there a hidden mint role?	The contract’s capability
“LP locked”	Locked where, until when, which locker contract?	The locker, if it is real — later skill
“Renounced”	Owner is zero — also means bugs cannot be patched	Explorer owner field, not the caption
“Audited”	By whom, which commit, paid by whom?	Scope of the audit, not the badge
“RWA backed”	Legal title, custody, audit you can follow?	Not a classroom paragraph

Worked scenario. A PDF says max supply 100 million. BscScan totalSupply is 100 million today. An owner mint function still exists.

576. A student quotes the PDF in a group as “proof the supply cannot grow.”
577. Another student opens Read contract, or at least remembers this lesson: capability versus policy.
578. They do not need to be developers. They need the question: **can someone still mint?**
579. If yes, the PDF described a hope. The chain described a button.
580. They still do not have a buy or sell order from this classroom. They have a better question.

DIAGRAM

```

PDF / Telegram --> marketing (policy, hope, story)
Contract code  --> capabilities (mint, pause, tax, owner)
Price chart    --> yesterday's trades (not tomorrow)
RWA brochure   --> claims to verify in the legal world

```

Do not mix the four.

Display bugs are not theft, and theft is not a display bug

If the wallet shows a strange amount, check the explorer before you panic-send a “correction” or click a “fix decimals” site. If the explorer shows the amount you expected, the wallet display is late or wrong. If the explorer shows 0, you were not paid in that contract — clone, pending, or never sent.

Do not let a display bug bounce you into a helper. Helpers who fix decimals want keys.

A “billion supply” scare and a “only 1 million” brag can describe the same human wealth if the price is different. That is why Basic will not let you use supply as a personality test. You are allowed to notice mint capability. You are not required to compute a fully diluted naira figure in this course. Anyone selling you a target from a supply slide is doing marketing. Marketing is not consensus. Crystal Mentor, when you use it, must refuse investment instructions. So must this page.

Taxes and burns, if a project claims them, are also mechanical only when they actually execute on transfers. A PDF can say 2% forever. A contract can let an admin change the tax. Capability versus policy, again. Intermediate can read those functions. You can already refuse the PDF as bytecode.

ACADEMY NOTE Crystal Stones’ deeper economics belong in a later course. Basic only trains you not to confuse a PDF with bytecode. RWA numbers on a website are not explorer facts. This academy will not repeat market-cap targets as if they were consensus.

What this lesson is for

Mechanical numbers now have a shelf. Next: the decentralisation test from Foundations, reused on this book — admin keys, pause, mint — without turning you into a Solidity reader.

Say this out loud

- Decimals tell wallets how to display integer base units. They are not a naira price.
- Total supply is a contract number. If mint still exists, a PDF’s “limited supply” is a policy, not a lock.
- Tokenomics is a later subject. A rocket PDF is not bytecode.
- RWA backing is a claim to verify, not a classroom receipt for a vault.
- Confirm amounts on BscScan’s token transfer, not on a site that wants to “fix decimals.”

Next: admin keys, pause, mint — the decentralisation test reused from Foundations.

Lesson 5: Admin keys, pause, mint — the decentralisation test (28 min)

Admin keys, pause, mint — the decentralisation test

Foundations already gave you a test for the most abused word in crypto: **decentralised**. This lesson reuses it on BNB Smart Chain tokens, including Crystal Stones as a case you inspect, not a case you are told to buy.

By the end you should be able to ask who can mint, who can pause, and who you must trust, without reading Solidity for a living.

Decentralised is a test of power, not a vibe

In this academy it has a testable meaning: **no single office can unilaterally rewrite the ledger, freeze every user, or change the rules without the network noticing.**

A token can sit on a public chain and still be a company product. BSC can be a public book — with a concentrated validator set, as Module 1 said — and a BEP-20 on it can still have an **admin key**. Those layers stack. Slogans smash them.

An **admin key** means a privileged secret the deployer kept so they can mint, pause, blacklist, change taxes, or upgrade. It is not automatically evil. It is automatically power. Power should be named.

The five questions, now with a token page

When a site says decentralised, ask, slowly:

- 581. Can I verify the contract address from more than the project's banner?
- 582. Can the team **pause** transfers?
- 583. Can they **mint** extra tokens?
- 584. Can they pull the trading pool (a **rug** — they yank the money and leave you holding a name)?
- 585. If the website dies, does the token still exist on the chain?

For Crystal Stones, the public BEP-20 this academy references is still 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00. Treat that as a **reference to verify**, not a request to buy. Always check the address on a block explorer yourself.

You may not yet be able to answer questions 2–4 from source code. You can still look at BscScan's contract tab, owner field, and project documentation, and you can still refuse a slogan that will not survive the questions. Intermediate will do contracts for real. Basic gives you the questions so you are not helpless in a Telegram argument.

Pause, mint, blacklist, upgrade, renounce

Pause means an admin can stop transfers. Useful in an emergency. Also a freeze button.

Mint means new units can be created. Useful in some designs. Also a private printer.

Blacklist means selected addresses cannot move the token. Useful against thieves, in the team's story. Also a way to trap you.

Upgrade means the code can be swapped. A company product with a patch cycle. Do not call it unchangeable.

Renounced means the owner was set to a zero address — the team gave up the admin keys, if that is actually true on-chain. That can be safer against silent minting and also **unable to fix a bug**. Renounce is not a halo. An audit is not a halo. Audits have **scope**. They are not insurance.

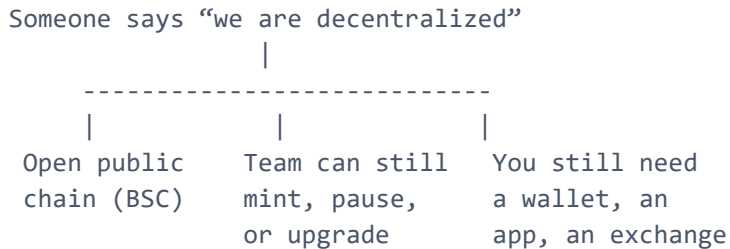
Power	What it can do	Honest sentence
Mint	Create more tokens	"Supply can grow if this role exists"
Pause	Stop transfers	"They can freeze movement"
Blacklist	Block selected addresses	"Some holders can be trapped"

Upgrade	Swap the code	“This is a product, not a stone tablet”
Renounce	Drop the owner key	“They cannot patch; they also cannot quietly mint — if it is real”
Audit badge	A report with a scope	“Someone checked some things, paid by someone”

Worked scenario. A website says “fully decentralized token.” You ask five questions and get: the team can pause transfers, they can mint, liquidity sits in a pool they can empty, and the only market is their own site.

586. The chain underneath may still be public. BSC still seals pages.
587. The **product** is not decentralised. You have used the layer test.
588. You do not need to argue in caps. You name the powers.
589. If the product is Crystal Stones, you still verify the contract, and you still treat RWA vault stories as claims, not as this classroom’s proof.
590. You do not send a seed to a stranger who promises to “decentralise your wallet.” That sentence is theft.

DIAGRAM



Ask the five questions. Do not stop at the sticker.

RWA does not skip the test

A real-world-asset story says the token points at off-chain things. That claim lives in the legal and audit world. It does **not** turn an admin key into a halo. It does **not** make a clone safe. It does **not** make this classroom a vault inspector.

If the website dies, a BEP-20 can still exist on BSC as a list of balances. That is the chain layer. Whether anyone will buy those balances, and whether a mineral title exists, are different layers. Keep them separate and you cannot be slogan-bullied.

ACADEMY NOTE Holding the secret that controls coins is power and liability. A “decentralised” token sitting inside a centralised exchange account is, for practical purposes, an IOU from that exchange. Admin keys on the token are a different office of power. Name both. This academy will not tell you to buy because a page says renounced, audited, or RWA.

What this lesson is for

You reused Foundations’ test on this book. Last lesson of the module: adding a token by contract so the icon appears without a trap, and without imagining that adding is buying.

Say this out loud

- Decentralised is a test of power: who can mint, pause, upgrade, or freeze.
- An admin key is a privileged secret. Name it. Do not treat a slogan as a substitute.
- Renounced and audited are not halos. Verified source is not a safe investment.
- RWA claims are claims to verify, not classroom proof of vaults.
- A token can live on a public chain and still be a company product.

Next: adding a token by contract, not by search.

Lesson 6: Adding a token by contract, not by search (26 min)

Adding a token by contract, not by search

If BscScan shows you received Crystal Stones but the wallet hides it, the wallet's **display list** is incomplete. You add the token **as a custom token**. That is a sticker on the window. It is not a purchase. It is not an approval. It does not move coins.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to import by address and refuse every other method.

The only beginner-safe method

591. Copy the contract from a source you already verified — for Crystal Stones:

0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00

592. Confirm the wallet network chip is BSC (chain ID 56).
593. In the wallet, Add custom token / Import token.
594. Paste. Confirm the wallet reads symbol and decimals from the chain.
595. Do not “improve” the address from memory.

Do **not** tap a token that appeared unsolicited in the list with a “claim” button. That is Safety's territory. Do **not** search the name and pick the highest-volume result. Do **not** import a file from Telegram. Do **not** scan a stranger's QR.

Why search fails, and why adding is not buying

Search returns clones ranked by who paid or who spammed. Paste beats search.

Adding a token to the display does **not** move coins and does **not** approve a spender. It is a sticker on your window. Approvals are a different popup — read the title. Module 4 will separate connect, sign, and approve. Today: if the popup says Approve, you are not adding a display sticker. You are loading a gun.

People lose this distinction under excitement. “I added Crystal Stones” is not “I bought Crystal Stones.” You can add a token you hold zero of. You can hold a token you have not added, and BscScan will still tell the truth.

The same trap exists for USDT. Importing “USDT” by name can fetch the Ethereum contract, a clone, or a spam ticker with a fake dollar column. You want the **BEP-20** USDT contract on chain 56, copied from a

source you already use for that ticker — an exchange’s withdrawal help page you trust, or a bookmark you made in a calm hour — not the first search hit. If the wallet is on Ethereum when you paste a BSC contract, the import will look haunted: wrong decimals, zero that is not a real zero, or a refusal. Network chip first. Always.

A custom-token screen that asks you to **type** symbol and decimals instead of reading them from the chain is a yellow flag. Prefer the path that fetches from the contract. If you must type, you are now trusting a tweet. This academy would rather you re-copy the address than invent 18 because “everyone uses 18.”

Method	Use?	Why
Paste known contract on BSC	Yes	Identity
Wallet name search	No	Hostile index
Telegram “import file”	No	Easy malware
Airdrop popup / Claim	No	Drain theatre
QR from a stranger	No	You cannot see the string
Send BNB to the contract to mint	No	Not a purchase; often a stuck send

Worked scenario. Wallet shows only BNB. BscScan token transfers show USDT and Crystal Stones.

596. The student does not open a claim site.
597. They add USDT by its **BSC** USDT contract (not Ethereum’s), after copying from a source they trust for that ticker.
598. They add Crystal Stones by 0xe252Fcb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00.
599. Icons appear. No claim site. No buy. No approve.
600. If a popup titled Approve appears, they reject it. That was not import.

DIAGRAM

```

Explorer says you hold it
|
v
Network chip = BSC 56
|
v
Custom token + paste contract
|
v
Display catches up

X search by name
X claim button
X approve popup pretending to be import
X “adding a token buys it”

```

You can finish the lab without spending

Module 6 will ask you to add BSC and a token on a practice wallet without buying. This lesson is the skill that lab uses. If you have no BNB and no tokens, you can still paste the contract and see a zero balance. Zero is a legitimate display. It is not a failure. It is not a reason to “activate” anything with a stranger.

If the wallet cannot fetch symbol and decimals, you may be on the wrong network, or the RPC is lying, or you pasted a typo. Check the chip. Re-copy. Do not type decimals from a tweet. Do not download a “token list pack” from a group. Lists are how clones arrive in bulk.

If you already see Crystal Stones in the wallet because the app recognised the contract, you do not need to import it again. Duplicate imports do not double your coins. They only confuse the window. The book did not change.

Adding is not a listing and not a purchase

Importing a sticker does not list a token on an exchange. It does not tell Binance (example of a CEX, not the only one) anything. It does not move naira. People post “I added it, we are listed.” They added a display row. Celebrate literacy, not a market event this classroom did not promise.

ACADEMY NOTE Adding a token to the display does not move coins, does not approve a spender, and does not buy anything. This academy will not tell you to buy Crystal Stones because you now know how to import the sticker. Read the popup title. Import is not Approve.

What this lesson is for

Module 3 is identity: contracts, the Crystal Stones page as literacy, clones, mechanical supply, admin power, and import-by-address. Module 4 is the human operating manual: gas, nonce, connect versus approve, replacements, and why bridges wait.

Say this out loud

- Display lists omit tokens. Explorers do not, for that contract.
- Import by pasting the known address on chain 56. Search by name is hostile.
- Adding a token is not an approval and not a purchase.
- Claim popups are not import.
- You can add Crystal Stones as a display sticker and still hold zero. That is allowed. This course does not require a buy.

Take the quiz. Module 4: using BSC as a human being with a wallet.

Module quiz (answers included for editors)

Q1. On BSC, Crystal Stones is?

- A. Native gas, like BNB
- B. A BEP-20 token: a balance inside a contract
- C. An ERC-20 on Ethereum by definition
- D. A Binance IOU that cannot exist on-chain

Correct answer: B

Q2. The identity of Crystal Stones on BSC is?

- A. The logo colour

- B. The contract 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00
- C. Any token named Crystal
- D. The first Google image result

Correct answer: B

Q3. A BscScan page shows the contract source as verified. That means?

- A. It is a safe investment and this academy says to buy
- B. The mineral vault is classroom-proven
- C. The published source matches the bytecode — hygiene, not a blessing; verified scams exist
- D. Gas will be refunded forever

Correct answer: C

Q4. If an explorer clone requires Connect Wallet to view a public balance?

- A. That is normal BscScan behaviour
- B. Treat it as hostile — public balances do not need your keys
- C. You should paste the seed to speed it up
- D. It means the token is verified

Correct answer: B

Q5. A honeypot token typically?

- A. Pays your rent
- B. Lets you buy and then blocks or wrecks selling
- C. Is the definition of BEP-20
- D. Has chain ID 56 as a safety feature

Correct answer: B

Q6. A DM that says “we migrated, add this new contract tonight” is?

- A. Standard BSC maintenance
- B. Hostile until a slow public verification exists — treat as a clone attempt
- C. How all BEP-20s upgrade weekly
- D. Required by chain ID 56

Correct answer: B

Q7. If a PDF says limited supply but the contract can mint?

- A. The PDF always wins
- B. BscScan is wrong by law
- C. Mint is only a sticker and cannot change balances
- D. The capability on-chain is what actually matters

Correct answer: D

Q8. Adding Crystal Stones as a custom token in a wallet?

- A. Buys the token with naira automatically
- B. Approves a DEX router to spend it
- C. Does not move funds and is not a purchase — it is a sticker on the window
- D. Requires sending BNB to the contract to mint

Correct answer: C

Module 4: Using BSC as a human

Gas and failed transactions, nonce and stuck sends, connect versus sign versus approve, speeding up and cancelling, and why Basic does not use bridges.

Lesson 1: Gas, gwei, and failed transactions (28 min)

Gas, gwei, and failed transactions

Gas is work. **Gas price** is what you pay per unit of work, in tiny pieces of BNB. Wallets hide the maths. You still need the outcomes: a failed transaction can still cost fuel, and “failed tx is free” is a beginner myth that this lesson exists to kill.

By the end you should leave a little BNB in the tank, treat one failure as information, and refuse a site that wants a seed to “un-revert.”

Gas is the meter, paid in the native coin

On EVM chains you bid for block space. The bid is not USDT. It is not Crystal Stones. On BSC it is **BNB**. **Gwei** is a tiny unit of that native coin, used to write the price of gas without a pile of decimal zeros. You do not need to convert gwei by hand. You need: the wallet will show a fee in BNB; that fee goes to the writer set for work, including work that failed.

If you hold a large token balance and 0 BNB, you can see the tokens and you cannot move them. Scammers will say “send gas to this address to unlock.” Real gas is taken **inside** your transaction from your own BNB, not mailed to a stranger first.

You pay for failed work

On EVM chains, if a transaction **fails after inclusion** — out of gas, a contract said no, slippage too low — you **still pay gas** to the validators. The token transfer does not happen. Beginners see “failed” and “BNB gone” and think theft. It can be the meter running on a failed call.

That is the myth to kill: **failed tx is free**. Not on this book. Not on Ethereum. Pending-and-never-included is different: if it never lands in a block, that gas is not burned on-chain (you can replace it). Included-and-failed burns gas.

Three common failure modes

Out of gas. The **gas limit** was too low for the contract's work. Wallet estimates can be wrong on weird contracts. Raising the limit slightly is normal. Raising it to infinity on a mystery contract is how you overpay a honeypot's loop.

Insufficient funds for gas. You tried to send tokens without enough BNB, or you tried to send **all** BNB including the amount needed to pay for the send. Leave a little BNB behind. Do not empty the tank to zero on a token send.

Contract reverted. The program said no: not enough allowance, paused token, honeypot, bad slippage, you are blacklisted. The revert message on BscScan (if any) is a clue. A "helpful" site that says "click to un-revert" is a thief.

Wallet message	First check	Do not do
Insufficient funds	BNB balance versus gas plus value	Send BNB to a stranger to "unlock"
Failed / reverted	BscScan status and error	Retry five times on a clone dApp
Pending forever	Gas price too low, or nonce stuck	Paste a seed into an unstucker
Success but no token	Wrong token, display list, or you called something else	Claim-site "fix"
Out of gas	Limit too low for that call	Infinite limit on a mystery contract

Worked scenario. A student tries to swap on a clone router. The transaction fails. About 0.0004 BNB is gone.

601. They think "failed is free," so they retry. It fails again. More BNB gone.
602. They retry five times. They have paid a tutorial fee to a trap.
603. Correct: one failure → open BscScan from a bookmark → read status **failed** → stop.
604. They do not paste a seed into an "un-revert" site. They do not approve a new spender to "recover the gas."
605. They keep remaining BNB. Small gas is why people get careless, then interact with a contract that loops.

DIAGRAM

Submit

```
--> included + success --> state changed, gas paid
--> included + fail    --> state not changed, gas still paid
--> never included     --> no gas burned on-chain (you can replace)
```

Failed-and-included is not free.

Pending-forever is a nonce or fee problem, not a reason to retry blindly.

One failure is information; five retries on a clone are a donation

BSC gas is usually small. "Usually" is why people skip reading the popup. Small gas is not a reason to skip. A looping contract can still take a bite, and a drained token approval later can take the rest.

If you did not intend a swap and the **to** is a router, stop. If you intended a simple send and it reverted, read the explorer before you raise gas and smash send again. You may be on the wrong token, the wrong chain, or a paused contract.

Gwei numbers in a wallet's advanced settings are easy to over-touch. On BSC, default estimates are usually enough for a simple send. Dragging gas to "fastest" on a 2-dollar test is how you pay more than the thing you moved. Dragging it to zero is how you sit pending and then invent nonce 13. Leave the advanced panel closed unless you are replacing a stuck nonce on purpose.

"I will pay gas in USDT" is a sentence from a different product, or from a liar. On this book, writers take BNB. A dApp that offers to "take the fee in token" is wrapping extra contract risk around the meter. Basic does not need that wrapper. Keep a little BNB and use it as the meter.

ACADEMY NOTE Academy rule: failed transactions can still cost BNB. Leave fuel in the tank. One failure is information. Five retries on a clone is a donation. Nobody needs your seed to "refund gas."

What this lesson is for

The meter is now honest. Next: nonce — the send counter that, when stuck, makes people think BSC is down.

Say this out loud

- Gas on BSC is paid in BNB. Tokens do not pay the meter.
- A transaction that fails after inclusion can still cost BNB. Failed is not free.
- Leave BNB for gas. Do not empty the tank to zero on a token send, and do not mail gas to a stranger to "unlock."
- Out of gas, insufficient funds, and revert are different problems. Read the explorer once before retrying.
- One failure is information. Five retries on a clone dApp is a donation.

Next: nonce, pending, and the stuck send.

Lesson 2: Nonce, pending, and stuck sends (26 min)

Nonce, pending, and stuck sends

Every EVM account has a **nonce**: how many transactions it has already had included. The next transaction must use the next number. This stops replay and orders your sends.

By the end of this lesson you should wait or replace the stuck number, and you should refuse to pile new sends — or paste a seed into an "unstucker."

Nonce is your send counter, not a mystery tax

If your last successful transaction used nonce 11, the next one must be 12. If 12 is pending with too-low gas, nonce 13 (your "retry") sits behind it **forever**. Wallets sometimes hide this and you think BSC is down.

Pending means broadcast, not included — Module 1. A stuck pending nonce is a traffic jam you caused by bidding too low, or by losing connectivity, or by replacing badly. It is not a reason to create a new wallet and hand funds to a helper.

Nonce is not a fee. It is not a password. It is not “the RPC PIN.” You will not find it on a seed phrase card. Explorers show it on a transaction page as a number. Your next send is last-success plus one. If a site asks you to paste a seed to “reset nonce,” they are stealing. If a site asks you to send leftover funds to a recovery address to “clear the counter,” they are stealing with extra steps. The counter lives on the book. It increments when a transaction from your address is included. That is all.

Wallets sometimes show “already known” or “replacement transaction underpriced.” Those sentences mean: you tried to reuse a nonce without bidding enough to beat the one already sitting in the waiting room. Raise the bid on **that** number, or wait. Do not invent nonce 99 because a forum said so.

What to do, as a beginner

- 606. Look at BscScan address page: pending versus last **successful** nonce.
- 607. Do not fire five new sends.
- 608. In MetaMask (example of a wallet app), “speed up” or “cancel” the **stuck** nonce. Cancel is a 0-value transaction to yourself with the same nonce and higher gas. Trust Wallet UIs differ; the idea is the same: replace the stuck nonce, do not stack new ones.
- 609. If you do not understand the UI, wait. Cheap gas on BSC often clears. Waiting is underrated.

The next lesson is the full picture of speed-up and cancel, and why refreshing the app is not a chain action. Today you need the queue: one stuck number blocks the next numbers.

What not to do

- a “nonce unstucker” website that wants a seed
- switching RPC ten times and sending more
- creating a new wallet and transferring **via a helper** who will hold the funds
- treating a stuck 8-minute BSC transaction as an emergency that justifies a new APK

Hardware wallets and some mobile apps make replacement awkward. Then waiting is the professional move.

Picture	Action	Trap
One pending, nothing after	Wait or speed up that nonce	Unstucker site
Many pendings	You queued behind a stuck nonce; stop adding	“Just keep sending”
Success on explorer, wallet pending	RPC lag; refresh the view, do not resend	Duplicate payment
Wallet says failed, explorer pending	Believe the explorer	Smash send

Worked scenario. Nonce 12 is pending 20 minutes. A student sends again (nonce 13). Both sit.

- 610. They open a “fast BSC” dApp, sign something unrelated, still pending.
- 611. An hour later nonce 12 lands, then 13 — a duplicate USDT send they did not want. They paid twice.

- 612. Correct was: wait or replace nonce 12 only.
- 613. They look at BscScan. They see two pending. They stop.
- 614. They do not paste a seed. They either wait or use the wallet's speed-up on nonce 12.

DIAGRAM

```
Nonce 11 success
Nonce 12 pending <--- only this may be replaced
Nonce 13 queued behind 12
Nonce 14 would queue behind 13

Do not add 14.
Replace 12, or wait.
```

The explorer is the referee, not the app banner

If BscScan shows success and the wallet still shows pending, the book is ahead of the window. Wait, pull to refresh, or switch RPC once if you know a documented one. Do not send again. Duplicate sends are how a “stuck” moment becomes a double payment.

If BscScan shows nothing and the wallet says sent, the RPC may have accepted a message the validators are ignoring. Still: one nonce. Wait or replace. Do not invent a second instruction.

Nonce gaps are rare for beginners and usually mean a wallet bug or a replacement that landed in an order you did not expect. Do not fill a gap because a forum said to “post empty transactions for missing numbers.” Look at the last **successful** nonce on the explorer. The next one is plus one. That is the whole arithmetic.

If you used two devices with the same seed at once, they can fight over the same counter. One phone broadcasts 12, the other also broadcasts 12 with a different job. One wins. The other dies or sits. For practice, one device. The wallets course already preferred that. BSC does not cancel the advice.

ACADEMY NOTE A stuck 8-minute BSC transaction is not an emergency that justifies a new app or a seed-paste. Unstucker sites are hostile. Nonce is a counter. Treat it as a counter.

What this lesson is for

You can see the queue. Next: the three popups that are not the same — connect, sign, approve — because “I only connected” is how USDT leaves later.

Say this out loud

- Nonce is your send counter. The next transaction must use the next number.
- A stuck pending nonce blocks every later number. Do not pile new sends.
- Wait or replace the stuck nonce. Do not paste a seed into an unstucker.
- If the explorer shows success and the wallet shows pending, that is lag, not a reason to resend.
- Cheap BSC gas often clears if you wait. Waiting is a skill.

Next: Connect versus sign versus approve.

Lesson 3: Connect versus sign versus approve (28 min)

Connect versus sign versus approve

Three different popups. Mixing them is how “I only connected” becomes “my USDT left.” This is the BSC-flavoured version of a lesson Safety will repeat until it is a reflex.

By the end you should read the title of every popup, reject what you cannot explain, and know that viewing BscScan needs no approve.

Connect: the site learns your address

Connect means the site learns **which address** you selected. It cannot take coins by connect alone. It can now **show you** tailored scams (“your address is eligible”). Connecting to a random site is still unwise because of that targeting, but it is not a transfer.

Connect is not KYC. Connect is not a purchase. Connect is not an approval. It is a handshake that reveals a public 0x. Public is the word: that address was already on a public book. Revealing it to a hostile site still gives them a targeting list with you on it.

Sign: a message, sometimes a delayed yes

A **signature** proves you control the key. Some messages are logins. Some are **typed data** that a scam will later use as a **permit** (a gasless-style approval). Read: does this look like “Sign in to this site” or “Permit unlimited USDT”? If you cannot tell, **reject**.

Signing is not “free so it must be harmless.” The harm is not the gas. The harm is what you attested. If a site needs a signature to “prove you are human” and the text is a blob, reject. You can use BscScan without this.

Approve: you load a spender’s gun

Approve is an on-chain transaction. You pay gas in BNB. You tell a token contract: “this **spender** may move up to N of my tokens.” DEX routers need some allowance if you ever swap on purpose. **Unlimited** allowance to a mystery spender is how drainers finish you days later without another click that looks like a send.

Approve is not a send. Tokens may not move yet. The next **transferFrom** can move them without a popup that says “send.” BscScan will show the approval, then later a transfer from your address **by the spender**. The chain is honest. The reading was not.

Beginners do not need to approve anything to **view** a token on BscScan. Pancake-style sites will ask for approve. Fake Crystal Stones dashboards will too. The difference is **which spender** and **why you are there**. If you are there because a sponsored link said “dashboard,” you are in the wrong shop.

Popup	Moves tokens now?	Danger	Beginner default
Connect	No	Targeting, fake UI after	Only to sites you typed yourself
Sign message	Not by itself; permits can be a delayed yes	Read or reject	Reject blobs
Send / transfer	Yes	Wrong address / network	Tiny test, explorer

Approve	Not yet — it loads the gun	Unlimited + unknown spender	Reject if you cannot name the spender
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Worked scenario. A student connects to a “Crystal Stones dashboard” from a sponsored link.

- 615. Connect succeeds. They think they are safe because nothing moved.
- 616. Next popup: Approve USDT unlimited. They think it is KYC. They confirm.
- 617. Later a transferFrom empties USDT. BscScan shows: first an approval, then a transfer from their address by the spender.
- 618. The chain did what they signed. A helper now offers to “reverse the approve” via another site. That helper is the second drain.
- 619. Correct: connect was already optional. Approve was the loaded gun. Viewing BscScan needed neither.

DIAGRAM

```

Connect --> site knows your address      (not a payment)
Sign     --> you attested a message      (read it; permits exist)
Approve  --> spender may take tokens later (loads the gun)
Send     --> tokens move now

```

Viewing BscScan sits in none of these boxes.

Read the title, then the spender, then the amount

Ritual:

- Title says Connect? You are revealing an address.
- Title says Sign / Sign in? Read the message. Blob? Reject.
- Title says Approve / Set allowance? Name the spender. Unlimited? That is a loud yes. Mystery spender? Reject.
- Title says Send / Confirm transaction with a transfer? Check network chip, token, amount, destination.

If you cannot name those objects, you are not ready to press. That is not cowardice. That is Basic.

Permit-style signatures deserve one extra sentence because they blur Sign and Approve. A **permit** is a signed message that a contract can later use as if you had approved, sometimes without a separate approve transaction. You may not see a BNB fee at the moment you sign. You may still have loaded the gun. If the message lists a spender and a token and a huge amount, it is not a login. Reject. Safety will show more of this family. Today: blob plus token plus spender equals no.

You do not need to connect a wallet to BscScan to finish this course’s labs. If a page will not show a public balance without connect, you are on the wrong page.

ACADEMY NOTE The Safety course repeats this until it is a reflex. Here you only need the BSC-flavoured version: real DEX use will ask for approve; fake dashboards will too. Beginners do not need to approve anything to view a token on BscScan. This academy will never ask you to approve a spender in a DM.

What this lesson is for

Three popups now have names. Next: speeding up, cancelling, and why “refresh the app” is not a chain action — the sibling of the nonce lesson, with the myth that pulling down on a screen unsticks a book.

Say this out loud

- Connect reveals the selected address. It is not a transfer.
- Sign can still be a permit. Read or reject. A blob is a no.
- Approve loads a spender’s gun. Unlimited plus unknown spender is how drainers finish you later.
- Viewing the real BscScan needs no connect, no sign, no approve.
- “I only connected” is not a defence if you also approved.

Next: speeding up, cancelling, and why refreshing the app is not a chain action.

Lesson 4: Speeding up, cancelling, and why refresh is not a chain action (26 min)

Speeding up, cancelling, and why refresh is not a chain action

Wallets offer buttons that look like magic: Speed up, Cancel, Refresh. Only two of those talk to the book, and they talk by **replacing a nonce**. Pulling down on a screen does not unstick a blockchain.

By the end of this lesson you should know what speed-up and cancel actually broadcast, and you should stop treating the app as the chain.

Speed up is the same nonce with a higher bid

Speed up means: take the stuck instruction (same nonce, same intent) and rebroadcast it with a higher gas price so writers prefer it. If it works, one of the two versions lands. The nonce is consumed once. You pay more BNB for the same job.

You are not “pushing the chain.” You are raising your bid for the same queue slot. If the original was a USDT send to Ada, the replacement should still be a USDT send to Ada, not a new adventure.

Cancel is a 0-value send to yourself with the same nonce

Cancel, in MetaMask-style wallets (example, not endorsement), usually means: broadcast a tiny (often 0) native send **to your own address**, same nonce, higher gas. If that replacement lands first, the original instruction dies. You paid gas to do nothing, on purpose, to free the queue.

Cancel does not rewind a transaction that already succeeded. If BscScan already says success, there is nothing to cancel. You would be trying to spend a nonce that is already used. The wallet may confuse you. The explorer should not.

Trust Wallet and other mobile UIs may not expose these buttons cleanly. Then waiting is the professional move, as the nonce lesson said. A stuck few minutes on BSC is common. A helper who needs a seed to cancel is a thief.

Refresh is a window action, not a book action

Refresh reloads what the RPC last told the app. It can clear a stuck spinner. It can fetch a success the app missed. It cannot:

- include a pending transaction
- raise gas
- cancel a nonce
- reverse a send
- “unstick” validators
- turn testnet coins into naira

If the book has not included you, pulling down on the screen is like staring at a post-office window. Useful to see. Not a stamp.

People mash refresh, then mash send. That is how nonce 12 and 13 both exist. Believe the explorer, then wait or replace.

Button or habit	Talks to the chain?	What it actually does
Speed up	Yes, if it broadcasts a replacement	Same nonce, higher gas, same intent
Cancel	Yes, if it broadcasts a 0-value self-send	Same nonce, higher gas, original dies if this lands
Refresh / pull down	No	Reloads the window from an RPC
Force-close the app	No	Restarts the window
Reinstall the app	No	Still the same book if you still have the key
New APK from a helper	Hostile	Often a drain

Worked scenario. Kemi’s USDT send sits pending. She force-closes Trust Wallet, reopens it, pulls to refresh, and the banner still says pending.

620. She almost sends again. She remembers nonce.

621. She opens BscScan from a bookmark. The hash is pending. The book agrees with the banner, for once.

622. Refresh did nothing to the book. That is correct behaviour. Refresh is not supposed to stamp a page.

623. She waits. On BSC, cheap gas often clears. Ten minutes later the explorer says success.

624. If it had sat an hour, she could try the wallet’s speed-up on **that** nonce, or wait more. She does not download a “BSC booster” APK.

DIAGRAM

Stuck pending

+--> Refresh app	--> new picture of the same book (no new page)
+--> Speed up	--> replacement, same nonce, higher bid
+--> Cancel	--> 0-value to self, same nonce, higher bid
+--> Send again	--> new nonce, queued behind the stuck one (bad)
+--> Helper APK	--> drain

The book moves when a writer includes a transaction.
The app moving is not the book moving.

Explorer first, button second

Before speed-up or cancel:

- Paste the hash on BscScan.
- If success, stop. Refresh the wallet. Do not replace.
- If failed-and-included, the nonce is already consumed. You may send a **new** transaction if you still want the job. That is not a cancel.
- If pending, you may wait, speed up, or cancel.
- If the hash never appeared, the RPC may have eaten a ghost. Wait; do not spray new nonces.

Speed-up that changes the destination is not speed-up. It is a new idea wearing an old nonce. Some malware wallets offer “speed up” that actually builds a send to a thief. Watch the **to** and the token row on the replacement, the same way you watch the first send. If cancel is not a self-send, it is not cancel.

On BSC, “stuck” often means “two minutes feels like a year because we were told the chain is instant.” Instant is a marketing word. Fast is real. Pending is still pending. Set a timer. Look at the explorer once. Then look again. Do not look every two seconds in a group chat that is offering APKs.

ACADEMY NOTE Refreshing the app is not a chain action. Speed-up and cancel are nonce replacements. If you do not see those buttons, waiting is allowed. Nobody needs your seed to refresh a public book.

What this lesson is for

The app is a window; replacements are extra bids; refresh is not a stamp. Last lesson of this module: bridges, in one honest stretch of prose, because they are how people lose funds and Basic does not use them yet.

Say this out loud

- Speed up is the same nonce with a higher gas bid, not a prayer.
- Cancel is usually a 0-value transaction to yourself with the same nonce and higher gas.
- Refresh reloads the window. It does not include, cancel, or reverse a transaction.
- If the explorer already says success, there is nothing to cancel and nothing to resend.
- A booster APK or unstucker site is hostile.

Next: bridges in one honest lesson — Basic does not use them yet; they are how people lose funds.

Lesson 5: Bridges in one honest paragraph (24 min)

Bridges in one honest paragraph

A **bridge** tries to represent value on a second book, usually by locking coins on one chain and minting a representation on the other. That extra machine is extra trust. Bridges are a major hack magnet. This Basic course does not use them. They are how people lose funds.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to refuse a bridge URL, stay on one book, and say why “we are multi-chain” is not a beginner instruction.

The honest paragraph, then the unpacking

Here is the paragraph, stated as policy: **do not bridge practice funds because a group dropped a URL**. You already have enough ways to lose money on one chain — wrong network, no gas, fake token, unlimited approve. A bridge adds a second book, a lock contract, a mint contract, and often a website that can lie about all three. Stay on BNB Smart Chain for this track. If you need USDT on BSC, withdraw BEP-20 USDT from a venue onto chain 56. Do not “wrap,” “teleport,” or “migrate” through a caption.

That is the lesson. The rest is why the paragraph is not cowardice.

What a bridge actually is

Two books do not share balances. Module 2 already said this. A bridge is a machine in the middle:

- you send asset A on chain 1 to a contract or custodian
- something mints or releases asset B on chain 2
- you now hold a representation, not necessarily “the same coins teleported”

If the lock is hacked, the representation on the other side can become an unbacked IOU. If the website is fake, you approved a drainer and never reached a real lock. If the representation is a clone token with a similar name, you bridged into a honeypot.

Official-looking bridges still get hacked. Random bridges in chats are theft with extra steps. This classroom will not give you a “safe bridge list” for Basic, because the skill you need first is **not bridging**.

Why beginners lose funds here

The pitch is always convenience: “BSC is cheap, Ethereum is where the real one lives, just bridge.” Or: “Crystal Stones is multi-chain now, bridge to claim.” Or: “Your USDT is stuck on the wrong network, bridge it back.”

Each pitch skips the objects:

- which lock contract
- which minted representation (address, not sticker)
- who runs the operators
- what happens if the website dies mid-way
- what gas you need on **both** books to finish

People also bridge because they already mixed ERC-20 and BEP-20 and want a miracle. Sometimes a venue’s own withdrawal on the correct network is the boring fix. Sometimes you open the other book with that book’s gas. A chat-group bridge is the expensive fix.

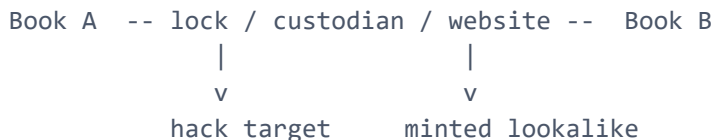
Situation	Boring fix	Bridge pitch
Need USDT on BSC	Withdraw BEP-20 USDT, chain 56	“Bridge from Ethereum, sponsored URL”
Sent ERC-20 to your 0x	Open Ethereum, need ETH for gas	“Bridge to BSC to see it in Trust

		Wallet”
Clone says multi-chain	Ignore; verify the BSC contract	“Bridge to the new Crystal Stones”
Stuck pending on BSC	Wait or replace nonce	“Bridge out to unstick”
Want cheaper fees	You are already on BSC	“Bridge to a mystery L2”

Worked scenario. A WhatsApp status offers “official Crystal Stones bridge — migrate to the new chain this weekend or lose your tokens.”

- 625. Funke does not click. Academy staff do not migrate people in statuses.
- 626. She opens the long-standing project site, not the status.
- 627. She verifies 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00 on BscScan. The object this academy means is still on chain 56.
- 628. She does not connect a wallet to the bridge site. She does not approve a spender named Router or Migrator.
- 629. She stays on one book. She still has not been told to buy. She has been told not to teleport.

DIAGRAM



Basic track: stay on BSC (chain 56).

Do not follow a URL into the middle box.

What to do instead, for this academy

Stay on BNB Smart Chain. One explorer: BscScan. One gas coin: BNB. One token standard: BEP-20. One Crystal Stones contract to verify. If paid tracks open, tuition rails are USDT on BEP-20, not “USDT somewhere” and not a bridge of Crystal Stones token.

Intermediate will do contracts and DeFi for real, including the right to learn why bridges are hard. Advanced is not “how to chase every chain.” Basic’s job is to keep you on one book long enough to read it.

If you already bridged by accident before this lesson, do not “bridge back” through the same chat. Open the destination book’s explorer. See what representation you hold. Safety’s incident habits apply. This course’s rule going forward is still: stay on 56 for practice.

ACADEMY NOTE Academy rule: Basic does not use bridges. They are how people lose funds. “Multi-chain” in a caption is not a homework assignment. Official-looking lock contracts still get hacked; chat-group bridges are assumed hostile. Stay on chain 56 for this track.

What this lesson is for

Module 4 is the operating manual: the meter, the queue, the three popups, the replacement buttons, and a closed door labelled Bridge. Module 5 makes BscScan boring so you do not need a helper to read your own book.

Say this out loud

- A bridge locks on one book and mints a representation on another. Extra machine, extra trust, extra hacks.
- Basic does not use bridges. Stay on BNB Smart Chain, chain ID 56.
- Wrong-network USDT is often fixed by opening the correct book or withdrawing correctly, not by a chat URL.
- Surprise “migrate this weekend” bridges are clone theatre.
- This academy will not tell you to teleport Crystal Stones, USDT, or BNB because a caption said multi-chain.

Take the quiz. Module 5: BscScan until it is boring.

Module quiz (answers included for editors)

Q1. A swap transaction is included on BSC and then fails. The BNB fee is usually?

- A. Always fully refunded because failed tx is free
- B. Still paid for the failed work — failed is not free
- C. Charged in Crystal Stones instead
- D. Charged in naira by the validator WhatsApp

Correct answer: B

Q2. If nonce 8 is stuck pending, you should?

- A. Broadcast nonce 9 through 15 quickly
- B. Paste the seed into an unstucker website
- C. Wait or replace nonce 8; do not pile new nonces
- D. Switch to TRC-20 to clear BSC

Correct answer: C

Q3. Connect Wallet by itself?

- A. Sends all USDT
- B. Is the same as unlimited approve
- C. Changes chain ID to 1
- D. Reveals the selected address; it is not a transfer

Correct answer: D

Q4. An unlimited token approval to an unknown spender?

- A. Is required to view BscScan
- B. Lets that spender pull tokens later without a new “send” popup
- C. Only works on Bitcoin
- D. Is the same as a hardware PIN

Correct answer: B

Q5. Refreshing or force-closing the wallet app?

- A. Includes the pending transaction in the next block
- B. Cancels the nonce automatically
- C. Reloads the window from an RPC — it is not a chain action
- D. Bridges your funds to Ethereum

Correct answer: C

Q6. A wallet “cancel” on a pending EVM send typically?

- A. Rewinds a transaction that already succeeded
- B. Broadcasts a 0-value tx to yourself with the same nonce and higher gas
- C. Requires your seed on a third-party site
- D. Is done by pulling down to refresh

Correct answer: B

Q7. This Basic course’s rule on bridges is?

- A. Always bridge to save fees, using any URL in a group
- B. Bridge Crystal Stones every Friday to stay official
- C. Do not use them yet — they are extra trust and a common way to lose funds; stay on chain 56
- D. Bridges are the same as adding a custom token

Correct answer: C

Q8. You need to approve a spender to?

- A. Read a public token page on the real BscScan
- B. Copy your receive address
- C. Enable 2FA on an exchange
- D. Let a contract (like a DEX router you intentionally use) move your tokens — not to view an explorer

Correct answer: D

Module 5: BscScan until it is boring

Address page, transaction page, internal versus token versus BNB value, holders, logs and approve, and how to distrust a screenshot.

Lesson 1: The address page (26 min)

The address page

Paste an 0x into BscScan. You get a **dossier**. Not a social profile. Not a credit score. A public list of what this book says about that address: native balance, token rows, signed instructions, token transfers, internal hops.

By the end of this lesson you should pick the panel that matches the question, hide spam tokens with fake USD values, and bookmark the real explorer instead of walking in through a chat link.

Domain, then paste, then pick a panel

Use a bookmark for **bscscan.com**. Visiting your own address through a chat link is how fake explorers get a session. If the page demands Connect Wallet to show a public number, you left the real product.

An address page is for **one** 0x. Your wallet address is an EOA. A token contract is a different page with extra token tabs. Do not mix them. If you paste the Crystal Stones contract, you are reading the program, not your pocket. If you paste your receive address, you are reading your pocket.

BNB balance is the fuel gauge

Native BNB sits at the top. If this is 0, token sends will fail for gas even if tokens are huge. That is Module 2 and Module 4 again. The address page is where you confirm it without trusting the app's spinner.

A huge BNB number you do not remember earning is either a different address, a screenshot lie, or a unit you misread. Believe the explorer after you confirmed the domain and the 0x.

BEP-20 tokens, including poison

A list of token contracts that have a balance for this address. Hide zero spam if the UI allows. **Poison tokens** with huge fake USD values appear here — dust with a made-up price so you look rich, or so you click a “claim” or “convert” link. Do not click those links. Do not swap the spam “to recover the value.” Do not approve a spender to “clean” the list.

The USD column on a mystery ticker is theatre. The Crystal Stones row, if present, should match the contract 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00 if that is the object you mean. Name first, then amount.

Transaction list versus token transfers

Transactions are what this key signed (and some it received as native). Useful for “what did I approve?” and “what did I send as BNB?”

Token transfers (BEP-20) is the view you want for USDT or Crystal Stones incoming. If you are checking whether you were paid 100 Crystal Stones, this is the panel. Filter the contract. Read from, to, amount, status.

Internal txs are BNB moved by **contracts** on this address's behalf — a DEX sending leftover BNB back, for example. Beginners skip this and then think a swap “stole” BNB that was actually a hop. The next two lessons unpack hops. Today: know the panel exists so you do not panic at extra rows.

Panel	Question it answers	Trap
BNB balance	Can they pay gas?	Treating 0 as “the wallet is broken”
BEP-20	What tokens does the book say they hold?	Fake USD on spam tokens; claim links
Tx list	What did this key sign?	Missing a token receive that lives on another tab
Token transfers	Did a specific ticker move?	Looking at a clone ticker with a similar name
Internal	Did a contract move native BNB in a hop?	Calling every hop theft

Worked scenario. You are checking whether you were paid 100 Crystal Stones.

630. Bookmark bscscan.com. Paste **your** address, not a screenshot of someone else's.
631. Ignore the spam token with a \$50,000 sticker. Do not click it.
632. Open Token transfers. Filter the Crystal Stones contract
0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00.
633. If there is a row from the payer, amount 100, success, you were paid. If there is only a fake token named similarly, you were not.
634. You still do not connect a wallet from an ad banner.

DIAGRAM

```
Address page (real bscscan.com)
  BNB balance    --> fuel
  BEP-20 list    --> rows, including spam (do not click)
  Signed txs    --> what this key authorised
  Token transfers --> ticker payments
  Internals      --> native hops inside programs
```

Pick the panel that matches the question.

Bookmark your own address on the real explorer

Once. From a domain you typed. Then use that bookmark when a stranger says “check this.” You can still paste a hash they send — hashes are public — but you paste it into **your** explorer, not theirs.

The address page also shows **analytics** and ads. Treat analytics as optional decoration. Treat ads as hostile until you have a reason not to. A banner that says your address is “flagged” and must connect to unflag is not BscScan's core product. Public pages do not parent you with a connect button.

If you paste a contract address by mistake, you will see a contract dossier, not your pocket. The BNB on a token contract is not “your” BNB. Module 2 already warned you not to mail fuel into a program. The address page will tempt you to click **Write**. Do not. You are here to read.

ACADEMY NOTE Bookmark your own address on **real** BscScan. Visiting it through a chat link is how fake explorers get a session. Fake USD values on spam tokens are bait. Public pages do not need your seed.

What this lesson is for

The dossier now has named drawers. Next: the transaction page, field by field, so a hash is something you can read aloud.

Say this out loud

- An address page is a dossier for one 0x on this book, not a social profile.
- Token transfers settle ticker arguments. The native tx list is a different drawer.
- Fake USD values on mystery tokens are bait. Do not click claim links.
- Zero BNB on the address page means you cannot move tokens, even if the token list looks rich.
- Bookmark the real explorer. Do not walk in through a chat link.

Next: the transaction page, field by field.

Lesson 2: The transaction page (26 min)

The transaction page

A **tx hash** is the id of one instruction. Paste it on BscScan. You get a page that should answer: did it land, who signed, who was called, what native BNB moved, what tokens moved, what it cost.

By the end of this lesson you should read those fields in order, and you should share hashes — not seeds — when you ask a knowledgeable friend.

Status is the first word, not the last

Success, fail, pending. Fail still has a hash. Success is not “success for the token you wanted” until you read token transfers. A successful call to the wrong contract is a successful mistake.

Pending is Module 1: not paid. Failed-and-included is Module 4: gas may still be gone. Do not let a green UI in a wallet outrun a red status on the explorer, or the reverse. The explorer is the referee if the domain is real.

From, to, and value

From is the key that signed, for a normal send. **To** may be a person or a contract. Click through. If you intended a friend and **to** is a router, you signed a swap or a drain, not a gift.

Value is native BNB. Token sends: often 0. You already know this. Still look. If you intended to send BNB and value is 0, you may have signed a token call instead. If you intended USDT and value is a lot of BNB, you may have signed the wrong thing.

Token transfers and the fee

Transaction action / tokens transferred is the human summary. Still verify amount and **token address**, not only the sticker. Crystal Stones must be 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00 if that is the object you mean. A sticker “CST” on a different contract is a different object.

Gas used / price / BNB fee is what the send cost. Useful when arguing “the exchange took 8 USDT” — sometimes it was a different transaction’s fee, sometimes it was the CEX withdrawal fee, sometimes it was a failed loop. Name the hash, then the fee.

Logs / input data exist. Later-you may care. Today: know they exist. Do not paste input data into a “decoder” you just met if it asks to connect a wallet. The next lesson but one will show approve as something you can see without decoding hex by hand.

Field	Beginner read	Common misread
Status	Did it land?	Green wallet banner versus explorer
To	Person or contract?	Assuming to is always the friend on a token send
Value	Native BNB only	“0 means failed”
Token transfers	The actual USDT / Crystal Stones movement	Believing the sticker without the contract
Fee	BNB spent	Blaming a CEX for an on-chain fee, or the reverse

Worked scenario. Hash from an exchange withdrawal.

- 635. From: a venue hot wallet. To: your EOA.
- 636. Token transferred: USDT on the BSC contract you expected, amount 49 after a 1 USDT fee they already showed.
- 637. Status success. Native value 0, which is normal.
- 638. Argument over. Wallet still catching up is irrelevant. Refresh is a window. The book already wrote the page.
- 639. You share this hash with a friend who asked “did it leave?” You do not share a seed.

DIAGRAM

```
Hash --> status --> from/to --> token transfers (contract + amount) --> fee
If those are right, the tx did the job.
If to is a mystery contract and you meant a friend, the job was not a gift.
```

Hashes are public; seeds are not

A hash cannot drain you. Anyone can look it up. That is the point of a public book. A seed can drain you. When you ask for help, paste the hash and the address — the public ones — into a conversation with someone you actually know. Not into a “support” form that also asks for words.

If a helper says they cannot help without the seed, they cannot help. They can steal.

Write a four-line card when you are checking a payment, and keep it until the argument is over:

- Hash: (paste)
- Status: success / fail / pending
- Token contract + amount + recipient (or native BNB value + recipient)
- Fee in BNB

That card is what a shopkeeper reads. It is also what you send to a knowledgeable friend. It is not a screenshot. It is not “the wallet went green.” If the card’s token contract is not the one you named, the payment you named did not happen, even if status is success.

Some explorers show a friendly **Transaction Action** summary (“Transfer 20 USDT to ...”). Use it as a hint, then still click the token address. Summaries can sticker-match a clone. The contract string cannot, if you compare it.

Input data that looks like a hex dump is not a second payment. Do not paste it into a “decoder bot.” If you needed a human method name, BscScan’s Method field is the beginner tool. Module 5’s logs lesson will continue that. Today: status, from, to, value, token tab, fee.

ACADEMY NOTE Share hashes, not seeds, when you ask a knowledgeable friend. A hash cannot drain you. A seed can. Success on the explorer is not success for the ticker you wanted until the token-transfer row matches the contract you named.

What this lesson is for

A hash is now a document you can narrate. Next: three different records people smash together — internal transfers, token transfers, and BNB value.

Say this out loud

- Paste the hash on the real explorer. Status first: pending, fail, or success.
- To-a-contract means you called a program. To-a-friend should look like that if you meant a gift of BNB.
- Value 0 is normal for token sends. Look at token transfers for the ticker and the contract.
- The BNB fee is on this page. Name it before you blame a venue or a “hidden tax.”
- Hashes are public. Seeds are not. Anyone who needs a seed to read a hash is a thief.

Next: internal transfers versus token transfers versus BNB value.

Lesson 3: Internal transfers versus token transfers versus BNB value (26 min)

Internal transfers versus token transfers versus BNB value

Three different records. Mixing them is how people misread swaps, panic-post in a group, and then sign a “revoke” on a helper’s site that is the actual drain.

By the end of this lesson you should check **final balances versus intent**, and you should treat a helper who needs a new signature to “explain a hop” as hostile.

BNB value is the native line

The transaction's **value** field is native BNB attached to that instruction. Simple send of BNB to a friend: this line is the story. Token send: this line is often 0. Swap selling BNB: this line may be the BNB you spent into the router.

If you look only here, you will think USDT failed, or you will miss that you just dumped BNB into a program.

Token transfers are the BEP-20 story

The token contract emitted "A sent N to B." This is your USDT / Crystal Stones story. Filter by contract address, not by ticker sticker. A swap may show several token rows: you gave token A, you received token B, a pool address sat in the middle.

If you wanted to send USDT to a friend, success looks like one token transfer, your EOA → friend EOA, on the USDT contract you meant. If you see a router in the middle and you did not intend a swap, you signed the wrong app.

Internal transactions are native hops inside programs

A contract called another contract and moved **native BNB**. A DEX router might: take your BNB, send BNB to a pool, send leftover BNB back. You will see internals that are **not** you signing each hop. Your **one** signature authorised the whole bundle.

Why it looks like theft: you signed one swap. BscScan shows four internals and three token hops. A scammer zooms in on one hop — "they took your BNB to this pool." That is how the swap works. The question is whether the **final** balances match what the UI promised, not whether hops exist.

If you did **not** intend a swap and you still see a router as **to**, that is a different story — you signed the wrong app. Then we care a lot about hops.

BNB value, token transfers, and internals can all be true at once on one hash. A swap selling BNB for USDT might show: native value into the router, token transfers of USDT out to you, internals of BNB hopping through a pair. None of those rows is "the extra secret theft row." They are the same job, sliced three ways. Theft, when it is theft, looks like: you meant a friend, **to** is a mystery spender, token transfers leave to an address you do not know, and a helper wants a new signature. Different picture.

If you are only sending BNB to a person, you should not need a token tab to explain it, and you should not need internals. If those extra rows appear, you called a program. Stop and name the program before you add a second hash.

A third misread: BNB **value** is 1.2, internals show 1.2 leaving to a router, token tab shows USDT in. Someone says "they took your 1.2 twice." They counted the same native coins in two drawers. Count each drawer once. End balances still win.

You wanted	Success looks like	Panic misread
Send USDT to a friend	One token transfer, your EOA → friend EOA	"Value 0 so it failed"
Send BNB to a friend	Native value, no token needed	"Internal row means a hack"
Swap BNB → USDT on a DEX you	Multiple hops; you end with more	"The pool stole BNB"

meant	USDT, less BNB	
Approve only	Approval event, tokens not moved yet	“Nothing happened so I should retry”

Worked scenario. A student swaps a little BNB for USDT on a real DEX they meant to use.

- 640. They see a hop to a pair contract. They panic-post in a group.
- 641. A “helper” says it is a drain, please sign a revoke via **their** site.
- 642. The helper’s site is the drain. Final balances already matched the swap.
- 643. The student needed a reading lesson, not a helper. They check ending BNB down, USDT up, fees in BNB, status success.
- 644. They do not sign the helper’s revoke. They bookmark BscScan harder.

DIAGRAM

```

One signature
--> router
    --> pool
    --> token contract
    --> maybe BNB refund

```

Many rows, one intent.
Check end balances versus what you meant.
If you did not mean a swap, a router as to is a problem.

End balances are the adult summary

Write four numbers when you are confused:

- BNB before and after (fuel plus any native you meant to move)
- token A before and after
- token B before and after
- fee on the hash

If those four match the job, hops are plumbing. If they do not, you have a real problem — wrong app, failed swap, clone token — and Safety’s incident habits matter more than a group helper.

ACADEMY NOTE If you did not intend a swap and you still see a router as to, that is not plumbing to ignore. Then hops matter. A helper who needs a signature to explain a hop is selling a drain. Token tab = BEP-20 story. Internals = native hops. Value = native BNB on that instruction.

What this lesson is for

Three records, one intent, end balances as the summary. Next: the token tracker and holders — and why a big holder is not a promise.

Say this out loud

- Native value is BNB on that transaction. Token sends often show 0 there.

- Token transfers are the BEP-20 story. Filter by contract, not by sticker.
- Internal transactions are often normal contract hops. Check final balances versus intent.
- A helper who needs a new signature to “explain” a hop is selling a drain.
- If you did not intend a swap, a router as to is not a hop to shrug at.

Next: token tracker, holders, and why a big holder is not a promise.

Lesson 4: Token tracker, holders, and why a big holder is not a promise (26 min)

Token tracker, holders, and why a big holder is not a promise

BscScan’s **token tracker** is the token’s homepage on the explorer: supply, holders, transfers, contract. You met it in Module 3. This lesson slows down on **holders**, because screenshots of “whales” are used to sell courage and to sell panic.

By the end you should read concentration as a fact, not as a prophecy, and you should not harass holders in DMs.

The tracker is identity plus statistics

Paste 0xe252Fcb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00. You should see a token tracker for that contract on the real domain. Circulating and total supply figures here are contract-side (and sometimes explorer-side estimates). They are still not market cap as a promise. They are not naira. They are not a vault.

Transfers, you already use. Holders, you will now use without turning it into a hunt.

Who a “big holder” might be

A large balance can be:

- a **liquidity pool** contract (tokens sitting in a pair so people can swap)
- a **centralised exchange** hot or cold wallet (an IOU factory, not a fan)
- a **treasury** or team wallet (power, not a halo)
- a **locker** contract (maybe locked, maybe not — Intermediate)
- a person
- a clone’s marketing wallet on a different contract you opened by mistake

You often cannot tell from the 0x alone. Labels on BscScan help when they exist and can be wrong when they are crowdsourced. “Whale bought” in a group is usually a hop into a venue or a pool, or a lie.

A big holder is **not**:

- a promise the price will rise
- proof a mineral vault is full
- a reason to copy-trade their next move
- a person you should DM to beg for tokens
- a reason this academy tells you to buy

Concentration is a layer of the decentralisation test

Foundations: if ten wallets own almost everything, those ten people **are** the economy, even if the software looks open. That is **holder concentration**. It is a different question from “how many validators exist” and from “is the source verified.”

You can look. You should not turn looking into a conspiracy hobby on day one. You should not publish someone’s address with a threat. You should not assume an exchange wallet is “the team dumping” every time it sends to a pool.

Holders also change when people deposit to a CEX: many small addresses become one hot wallet. That looks like “a whale accumulated” if you only watch the CEX address, and like “retail dumped” if you only watch the small ones. Both captions can be written from the same hour of transfers. The tracker does not know the story. It knows balances.

If you are using Crystal Stones as the case, remember the RWA layer again. A large treasury-looking wallet does not prove gold, lithium, or a title deed. It proves that 0x holds a number in the contract 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00. Numbers on a list are not vaults. This classroom will not pretend they are.

Thing you see	Adult reading	Not a license for
Top holder is a pool	Normal if people trade the token	“Guaranteed liquidity forever”
Top holder is a CEX	Many users’ IOUs behind one address	“The exchange promised listing forever”
Top holder is an unlabeled EOA	Power is concentrated	Doxxing, begging, copy-trading
Many tiny holders	Distribution exists	“Community will never sell”
A screenshot of holders	Easy to fake (next lesson)	Belief without the live page

Worked scenario. A Telegram caption: “whale just bought 8 million Crystal Stones — listing imminent.”

- 645. Emeka does not buy. This academy did not tell him to.
- 646. He opens the tracker from a bookmark, contract pasted, real domain.
- 647. He opens the large incoming transfer. The “whale” is a pool or a venue wallet, or it is a transfer between two team-looking addresses, or it is real. He may not know.
- 648. He notices the caption skipped the contract address. A clone tracker would have served the same caption.
- 649. He closes the tab. A big holder is not a promise. He has homework in Safety next, not a long position from a classroom.

DIAGRAM

```

Token tracker
  supply  --> contract number, not a vault
  transfers --> payments
  holders  --> concentration
                |
                +--> pool / CEX / treasury / person / unknown
                |

```

v
a fact about the list, not a prophecy

Do not harass holders

Public book does not mean public consent to be bothered. Do not DM random large addresses. Do not scrape the list for “leads.” Do not treat a holder as customer support. If you need the project, use official channels you already verified — and still do not send a seed.

RWA claims stay in their layer. A large holder does not prove gold in a box. A classroom does not certify mines.

ACADEMY NOTE A big holder is not a promise of price, listing, or vaults. Concentration is a fact you may note. It is not a hunting list. Screenshots of holder tabs are as fakeable as any other screenshot — the next lesson is that distrust, made systematic.

What this lesson is for

Holders are now a statistic with manners. Next: logs, method names, and approve as something you can see — still without teaching Solidity.

Say this out loud

- The token tracker is identity plus history plus a holder list, not a shop.
- A large balance may be a pool, a CEX, a treasury, or a person. Labels can be wrong.
- A big holder is not a promise of price, listing, or a mineral vault.
- Holder concentration is part of the decentralisation test, not a reason to harass anyone.
- Captions about whales that skip the contract address are theatre.

Next: logs, method names, and “approve” as something you can see.

Lesson 5: Logs, method names, and “approve” as something you can see (28 min)

Logs, method names, and “approve” as something you can see

You do not need to decode hex. You do need to notice that BscScan often writes a **method name** in English — transfer, approve, transferFrom, swapExactTokens... — and that **logs** are the contract’s receipts.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to find an **approval** after it happened, know that it loaded a spender’s gun, and refuse a decoder site that wants a wallet connect.

Method names are labels on the instruction

On a transaction page, BscScan often shows a method: **transfer**, **approve**, **transferFrom**, **multicall**, a swap name, or “Transfer” as a native send. These labels are decoded for humans. They can be missing, or a contract can use a weird name. Still: if you see **approve**, you did not “only connect.” You authorised a spender.

transfer on a token contract is the usual “send this ticker to this address.” **transferFrom** is a spender moving tokens you already allowed. If you see transferFrom and you were not the signer but your tokens moved, look backward for an approve (or a permit signature) to that spender.

This course will not teach you to write these functions. Advanced is not hiding in a Basic footnote. Reading the label is enough.

Logs are receipts the contract emitted

Logs (events) are how contracts announce “this happened” in a way explorers index. A Transfer event is why the token-transfer tab exists. An Approval event is why you can see a spender and an amount later.

You can open Logs and feel lost. That is allowed. Use the human tabs first: Token transfers, and the Approval line many explorers surface. If you ever need the raw log, you still do not paste it into a stranger’s decoder that then asks to connect.

Approve as something you can see tomorrow

Module 4 said approve loads a gun. This lesson says the gun is visible on the book.

After you approve (if you ever do, on purpose):

- the transaction status is success
- method may read approve
- an Approval event names the **spender** and the **amount** (unlimited often shows as a huge integer)
- your token balance may not have changed yet
- later, a transferFrom can empty you without a popup that looks like send

You can also use BscScan’s token-approval checker tools **on the real domain** as a read-only view, when you are ready. Safety will labour revoking. Today: know you can see it. Revoking is a later transaction that costs BNB. A site that revokes by taking a seed is not revoking. It is emptying.

What you see	What it usually meant	What to do
Method: transfer	A token send	Check token contract, amount, recipient
Method: approve	Loaded a spender	Name the spender; if unknown, treat as incident
Method: transferFrom	Spender moved tokens	Find the earlier approve/permit
Method: swap... / multicall	A program bundle	Check end balances versus intent
Logs: Approval	Receipt of allowance	Same as approve
Logs: Transfer	Receipt of a token move	Same as token-transfer tab

Worked scenario. Last month a student tapped Approve on a “dashboard.” Today USDT is gone.

650. They open their address on BscScan. They do not download a helper APK.
651. They find a successful **approve** from last month, spender they do not recognise, amount unlimited.
652. They find today’s **transferFrom**, same spender, their USDT leaving.
653. The chain is consistent. The missing skill was reading the popup last month, and reading the method name today.

654. Safety will teach incident response. This lesson only proves the book still shows the gun and the shot. They still do not paste a seed to “reverse logs.”

DIAGRAM

```
Approve tx
  method: approve
  log: Approval(spender, amount)
    |
    v
Days later
  method: transferFrom
  log: Transfer(you -> attacker)
    |
    v
Balance gone; book still honest; helper who wants a seed is the second shot
```

You still do not need hex

If method is blank, use token transfers and the to-address. If you see gibberish input data, do not become a hobby decoder this week. Blank plus a mystery **to** plus an approve-shaped token row is enough to stop and not retry.

BscScan sometimes shows **Approve (Spender)** in a friendly box. That box is the lesson. Write the spender address in your notes if you are studying an incident. Compare it to the router you thought you were using — if you were using one on purpose. If you cannot name the spender, you should not have approved it, and you should not approve it now “to see what happens.”

You will not be asked to call Write Contract to mint, pause, or launch anything. Those buttons exist. They are not homework. Curious clicking on Write is how people donate.

ACADEMY NOTE You do not need Solidity to see an approve. Method names and Approval events are enough. A decoder that asks to connect a wallet is not a classroom tool. Verified bytecode still does not mean a safe investment. This academy will not ask you to approve a spender to “complete the lesson.”

What this lesson is for

Approvals are now visible objects, not moods. Last lesson of the module: distrust a screenshot of BscScan, because HTML is cheap and edited pixels are cheaper.

Say this out loud

- Method names like transfer, approve, and transferFrom are human labels on an instruction. They are not hex homework.
- Logs are receipts. Transfer events feed the token tab. Approval events show a spender and an amount.
- An approve can succeed without moving tokens yet. That is the gun, not the shot.
- transferFrom is often the shot that uses an earlier approve.
- Do not paste input data into a decoder that wants a wallet connect.

Next: how to distrust a screenshot of BscScan.

Lesson 6: How to distrust a screenshot of BscScan (26 min)

How to distrust a screenshot of BscScan

HTML is cheap. Image editors are cheaper. A green tick on a PNG is not a page of the book. This lesson is how you refuse payment theatre, fake explorers, and cropped hashes.

By the end you should paste, not squint, and you should treat “check this screenshot” as “give me a hash for my bookmark.”

Anyone can draw an explorer

A scammer can:

- clone the BscScan layout with one extra letter in the domain
- screenshot a real page and edit the amount
- screenshot a testnet page and crop the word testnet
- screenshot a successful transfer of a **clone token** with the same sticker
- show pending as success with a green overlay
- show someone else’s address as yours

Your defence is not a sharper eye for pixels. Your defence is **independent retrieval**: you open the real domain from a bookmark, you paste the hash or the address, you read the live page.

If they will not give a hash, they have not shown you a page of the book. Module 1 already said this about fake explorers. Now it is a habit with a checklist.

Domain, network, contract, amount, your address

When someone sends a picture:

655. Ask for the **tx hash** as text, or the address as text. If they refuse, you are done.
656. Open **bscscan.com** from your bookmark — not from their link.
657. Paste. Confirm you are not on testnet unless you meant testnet.
658. Confirm the **token contract** if it is a token payment. Crystal Stones means 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00, not a lookalike.
659. Confirm **your** address as recipient, the amount, and status success — not pending, not fail.
660. Ignore ads. Do not connect. Do not download their “verifier app.”

A screenshot that matches the live page is redundant. A screenshot that disagrees with the live page is a lie. A screenshot with no hash is a poster.

They send	You do	You do not
PNG of a green tick	Ask for hash, paste into your bookmark	Ship goods
Link that looks like BscScan	Type bscscan.com yourself, paste the hash	Click through, then connect

Testnet cropped	Check the network chip on the live page	Treat fake coins as naira
Clone token success	Compare contract character by character	Trust the sticker
“Private explorer”	Refuse	Enter a seed to “decrypt the page”

Worked scenario. A buyer sends a crisp screenshot: 1,200 USDT to Amaka, BscScan chrome, green success, her 0x visible.

- 661. She asks for the hash as text. They stall. They send another screenshot, zoomed.
- 662. She still does not ship.
- 663. They send a link. She does not click. She types bscscan.com, pastes her address, opens token transfers, filters USDT on the BSC contract she already uses.
- 664. There is no 1,200. There is a 1,200 of a clone ticker on a different contract in their PNG, or there is nothing.
- 665. She keeps the goods. She does not argue about pixels. The live book was the argument.

DIAGRAM

```

Screenshot --> pixels (cheap)
Their link --> their window (hostile until proven)
Your bookmark + pasted hash --> the book this course means

```

```

If they cannot give a hash, they have not paid.
If the live page disagrees, they have not paid.

```

Edited images and “too busy to paste”

People who actually paid can paste a hash. It is one copy. Stalling is a signal. “The hash is in the screenshot, just zoom” is a signal. “Our accountant is offline, ship now, hash later” is a signal.

You can be polite and still refuse. This is the same shopkeeper rule as confirmations, now with distrust of pictures. Safety will add impersonation and fake support. Today: pictures of explorers are not explorers.

Phone screenshots have extra tells you should not over-trust: status-bar clocks, unread-message badges, a URL bar cropped out. A careful thief crops those. That is why the skill is not “spot the fake PNG.” The skill is independent retrieval. Even a perfect screenshot of a real payment to someone else is not a payment to you. Paste your address. Filter the token. See the row, or do not.

Video “screen recordings” of BscScan are the same family, with motion. A recording of a domain you did not type is theatre with a soundtrack. Ask for the hash. Paste it yourself. If they say the recording is enough because they are in a hurry, they are in a hurry to be paid twice — once in goods, once in the coins they never sent.

Fake explorers versus fake pictures of the real one

Two different lies. A lookalike domain can show a live-looking page that is not the book. A PNG can show the real layout with a fake amount. Independent retrieval kills both: you typed bscscan.com, you pasted the hash, you read your address. If their link was the only way to “see it,” they needed you off the book.

ACADEMY NOTE A screenshot of BscScan is not BscScan. Independent retrieval — bookmark, paste, live page — is the skill. Ads, clones, testnet crops, and edited amounts are all cheaper than paying you. This academy will not accept a screenshot as proof of tuition either, when paid tracks exist; the rail will be specified, and the book will still be the referee.

What this lesson is for

Module 5 is BscScan until it is boring: dossier, hash, three records, holders without prophecy, approve as a visible object, pictures that do not count. Module 6 is the lab: verify without spending, then a map of where this course sits on the Basic track.

Say this out loud

- HTML and image editors are cheap. A green tick on a PNG is not a page of the book.
- Ask for a hash as text. Paste it into your bookmarked bscscan.com.
- Compare token contract, amount, your address, and status on the live page.
- A link that looks like BscScan is not a reason to skip typing the domain.
- If they will not give a hash, they have not shown you a payment.

Take the quiz. Module 6: labs you can finish without buying anything.

Module quiz (answers included for editors)

Q1. On an address page, incoming Crystal Stones should be confirmed under?

- A. The ads sidebar
- B. Token transfers for that contract
- C. A Telegram screenshot only
- D. The validator set list

Correct answer: B

Q2. A huge USD price next to a mystery token on BscScan often?

- A. Means you are rich
- B. Is spam / poison pricing; do not click claim links
- C. Is paid by BNB validators to you
- D. Replaces KYC

Correct answer: B

Q3. On a USDT send, native “Value” is often 0 because?

- A. The tx failed
- B. Tokens move in the token-transfer records, not as native BNB value
- C. BSC cannot move USDT
- D. You must use TRC-20

Correct answer: B

Q4. Sharing a tx hash with a friend?

- A. Gives them your seed
- B. Is public information and cannot by itself drain the wallet
- C. Approves their spender
- D. Is forbidden by chain ID 56

Correct answer: B

Q5. Internal transactions on a swap you intended are?

- A. Proof of theft by definition
- B. Often normal contract hops; check final balances versus intent
- C. A reason to paste a seed
- D. Only possible on Bitcoin

Correct answer: B

Q6. A caption says a whale bought millions of Crystal Stones. You should treat that as?

- A. A classroom buy order
- B. Proof the mineral vault is full
- C. A holder-list story that is not a promise — verify the live tracker and the contract, or ignore it
- D. Automatic listing on every exchange

Correct answer: C

Q7. After an approve transaction succeeds, BscScan can show?

- A. Nothing, because approve is off-chain
- B. An Approval event / method name naming the spender — the gun is visible even if tokens have not moved yet
- C. A mandatory refund of all BNB
- D. Your seed phrase in the logs

Correct answer: B

Q8. Someone sends a screenshot of BscScan showing they paid you. You should?

- A. Ship immediately; pixels are the book
- B. Ask for the hash as text and paste it into your bookmarked bscscan.com
- C. Connect a wallet to their link to decrypt the image
- D. Send a seed so they can “confirm the screenshot on-chain”

Correct answer: B

Module 6: Lab: verify without spending

Verify the Crystal Stones contract from more than one source, read public transfers, add BSC and a token without buying, collect common failures, and see where this course sits on the Basic track.

Lesson 1: Lab: verify the Crystal Stones contract from more than one source (26 min)

Lab: verify the Crystal Stones contract from more than one source

This lab spends zero BNB. You will not buy. You will not connect a wallet to an ad. You will make three sources agree on one string, or you will refuse the string.

By the end you should treat a single banner as insufficient, and you should know what to do when sources disagree.

Why more than one source

Scammers clone sites and change one character. Search ads sit above the real site. A screenshot of BscScan is not BscScan. One source is how clones win. Two sources that agree is a start. Three is a habit.

This academy references Crystal Stones as a BEP-20 on BNB Smart Chain at:

0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00

Treat that as a **classroom pointer to verify**, not as the only source and not as a buy order. If the long-standing project site and the explorer disagree, you do not “pick the one with the nicer logo.” You stop.

Steps — do them in order

666. Write the string above in your notes, by pasting, not by memory.
667. Open the project’s **long-standing official site** the way you already verified it in earlier courses — typed URL, not a Google ad, not a WhatsApp status. Find the published contract. Copy it.
668. Compare character by character with your notes. Upper and lower case matter for checksum. If they disagree, stop and find why. Do not average them.
669. Open **bscscan.com** from a bookmark. Paste the string. Confirm you are on a token/contract page on the real domain, chain consistent with BSC mainnet, not a connect-wallet clone.
670. Confirm the page’s address matches. Look at the contract tab: is source verified? Remember: verified is hygiene, not a safe-investment stamp.
671. Optional third source: a long-standing official social channel you already trust, not a lookalike with one extra letter. If it disagrees, trust the mismatch. Do not “update” to the new one from a DM.
672. Do **not** connect a wallet. Do **not** add funds. Do **not** follow a banner that says “add to MetaMask” on an ad.

You just practised the only identity skill that matters for a token: **independent retrieval from more than one place**.

Lab output	Passes if	Fails if
------------	-----------	----------

Official site contract	Exact match, character by character	You used an ad, or you skipped the compare
BscScan page	Real domain + exact address	Connect-wallet clone, extra letter in domain
Notes	You have the string written from a paste	You memorised and “fixed” two characters
Wallet connect	You did not	You signed anything
Buy	You did not	You thought the lab required a purchase

Worked scenario. Google shows two Crystal Stones sites. One is an ad.

673. Yemi ignores the ad. She types the URL she already knows, or she uses a bookmark she made in a calm hour.
674. Site A shows 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00. BscScan agrees.
675. Site B, from the ad, shows a contract that differs in two characters. A “verify on BscScan” button on Site B points at a lookalike explorer.
676. She does not add Site B’s token. She does not message Site B’s live chat. She keeps Site A’s string, confirmed on real BscScan.
677. She still has not bought. She has refused a clone. That is a completed lab.

DIAGRAM

```

Source 1: long-standing official site
Source 2: bscscan.com bookmark
Source 3 (optional): official channel you already trust
    |
    v
All agree on 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00
    |
    v
You have an identity, not a buy order

```

If they disagree --> stop. Do not average. Do not take the DM.

What disagreement means

If the site and BscScan disagree, possibilities include: you opened a fake site, you opened a fake explorer, the project published sloppily, or a migration story is in play. Basic’s move is **stop**. Not “bridge to the new one.” Not “the DM has the new contract.” Module 3 already called surprise migrations hostile. Intermediate can learn how real migrations are evidenced. You do not have to solve it tonight with rent money.

RWA claims on the site still sit in the legal layer. Matching a contract does not prove a vault. It proves you found the on-chain object the site pointed at — if the site was real.

Print the string, or write it in a paper notebook you already use for wallet habits — not in a cloud doc titled “SEED AND CONTRACTS.” The contract is public. Your seed is not. Do not store them in the same

photograph. Do not paste the contract into a random “validator” that then asks for the seed to “complete verification.” Verification is eyes on two pages. It is not a form.

If you finish this lab and a friend asks for “the contract,” you may share the public string. You may also tell them to do this lab themselves. Sharing a string is not a buy order, and it is not tech support for a clone they already imported.

Ads and “add to wallet” banners on the explorer

The live BscScan page may offer a button that adds the token to MetaMask. Prefer your wallet’s own custom-token screen so you see the string you paste. Explorer ad slots have served malware. A banner that says “verify wallet to confirm contract” is not this lab. This lab is two or three calm pages agreeing.

ACADEMY NOTE Academy staff will not DM a replacement contract. Google ads are hostile until proven. Verifying 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00 from more than one source is literacy. It is not a buy order, not tuition, and not proof of mines.

What this lesson is for

You now have a repeatable identity check. Next lab: read a public transfer — BNB and a BEP-20 — and narrate from, to, fee, status like a shopkeeper.

Say this out loud

- One banner is not enough. Compare the official site and BscScan, character by character.
- The Crystal Stones contract this academy references is 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00 — verify, do not treat that as a buy.
- If sources disagree, stop. Do not average. Do not take a Friday-night DM.
- This lab spends zero BNB and needs no wallet connect.
- Verified source on BscScan is still not a safe-investment stamp.

Next: lab — read a public transfer (BNB and a BEP-20) and narrate from, to, fee, status.

Lesson 2: Lab: read a public transfer and narrate it (28 min)

Lab: read a public transfer and narrate it

You will open a real BNB send and a real BEP-20 send on BscScan and write four facts: **from, to, fee, status**. You will not send. You will not connect. You will narrate like a shopkeeper, not like a fan.

By the end you should be able to say a hash out loud without confusing native value with token value.

What you need

- A bookmark to bscscan.com
- A notebook or a notes app (not a screenshot gallery as your only record)
- Optional: your own address if you have ever received on BSC — or any public hash from the Crystal Stones token transfers tab. Public is public. You are not spying. You are reading a book.

Do not use a hash a stranger DMs you as the only object, unless you paste it into **your** explorer. The last module already taught screenshot distrust. This lab is the positive version: retrieval and narration.

Part A — a BNB (native) transfer

678. On BscScan, open any recent successful transaction that sends native BNB from one EOA to another.

The token-transfer section may be empty. That is fine.

679. Write: from (0x), to (0x), value in BNB, status, BNB fee, whether it is pending/fail/success.

680. Say out loud: “This is native value. To is the recipient. Token tabs can be empty and the pay still real.”

681. If **to** is a contract, write that down. Native BNB into a contract is not automatically a gift to a person.

You have just read a native send. That is half of Module 1’s envelope, made boring.

Part B — a BEP-20 transfer

682. Open the Crystal Stones token page: 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00 on real BscScan. Or open BEP-20 USDT if you prefer a ticker you already know. Either works. This is not a buy.

683. Open **Transfers**. Pick any successful row. Open its hash.

684. Write: status, from, to of the **token transfer** (the recipient of the ticker), amount, token contract, native value (often 0), BNB fee, and whether the transaction **to** is the token contract (normal for a token send).

685. Say out loud: “Native value 0. Token tab shows the movement. I was not looking at a failure. I was looking at the wrong row until I opened token transfers.”

686. Open the recipient address. Confirm the token appears in their BEP-20 list, or that the transfer row exists even if they have not added a display sticker.

Narration line	BNB send	BEP-20 send
from	Signer EOA	Signer EOA
to (tx field)	Usually the friend	Usually the token contract
to (token transfer)	n/a	The friend
value	BNB amount	Often 0
fee	BNB	BNB (still)
status	success / fail / pending	same words, check token row too

Worked scenario. A student is asked in a group: “Did this hash pay 50 USDT?”

687. They refuse the group’s screenshot as proof.

688. They paste the hash into bookmarked BscScan.

689. Status success. Native value 0. Token transferred: 50 USDT, contract they expected, recipient they expected, fee in BNB written down.

690. They answer with those facts, not with “yes I saw green.”

691. If the token contract were a clone, they would say “success for a different object.” They would not say “USDT arrived.”

DIAGRAM

```
Bookmark BscScan
--> paste hash
--> status
--> from / to
--> native value
--> token transfers (contract, amount, recipient)
--> BNB fee
--> write it down
--> close the tab, keys still yours
```

Pass / fail for this lab

You pass if you have two short narrations on paper: one native, one token. You fail if you connected a wallet, clicked an ad, or shipped goods against a PNG. You also fail if you still say “value 0 means failed” after Part B.

You do not fail for picking a random public transfer. Public transfers are the point. You do not need to use your own money. You do not need Crystal Stones in your pocket. You need the sentences.

If you cannot find a simple EOA-to-EOA BNB send on the first try, open a busy address — an exchange hot wallet labelled on BscScan is fine — and pick a native transfer from its list. You are reading public data. You are not “hacking Binance.” You are practising the shopkeeper voice on a real page.

For Part B, if Crystal Stones transfers are sparse in the hour you look, use any BEP-20 with a verified tracker on the real domain. The skill is the rows, not the ticker. When you return to Crystal Stones, the rows mean the same thing. Write the contract you actually used so you cannot later pretend a clone was the lab.

A narration that only says “it went through” fails this lab. A narration that names from, to, fee, status, and which tab held the movement passes.

If Part A and Part B are the same hash because you picked a swap, write both narrations from that one hash: native line, then token lines, then fee once. That is legal. It also proves you can see three drawers. Prefer a simple send for Part A if you can find one, so the contrast stays sharp.

ACADEMY NOTE Ads on the explorer that say “your wallet is at risk, connect” are not the product. Use a blocker if you can. Never connect from a banner. This lab spent zero BNB. Narrate from, to, fee, status. Native and token are different rows.

What this lesson is for

You can read a payment. Next lab: add BSC and a token on a practice wallet without buying, so the window matches the book without a claim site.

Say this out loud

- I can narrate a BNB send: from, to, value, fee, status.
- I can narrate a BEP-20 send: native value often 0, movement on the token tab, fee still in BNB.
- Success for a clone contract is not the payment I named.
- This lab does not require my own funds or a wallet connect.
- A hash I paste into my bookmark beats a screenshot in a group.

Next: lab — add BSC and a token on a practice wallet without buying.

Lesson 3: Lab: add BSC and a token on a practice wallet without buying (26 min)

Lab: add BSC and a token on a practice wallet without buying

You will point a practice wallet at chain ID 56 and import Crystal Stones by contract. You will not buy. You will not approve a spender. You may see a zero balance. Zero is a legitimate result.

By the end you should have a window aimed at the right book, with the right sticker, and no extra signatures.

What you need, and what you do not

You need an official wallet app from an official store — Trust Wallet or MetaMask as **examples**, not endorsements. You need the wallets-course habits: real app, real backup already done, no photographing of seeds today.

You do **not** need to buy BNB, USDT, or Crystal Stones. If you already have a tiny BNB leftover from the exchanges course, leave it. Do not top up because this lab asked. If you have nothing, the display can still show 0.

Testnet is optional. If you use testnet, remember it is fake coins, not naira, and not this academy's Crystal Stones. Prefer mainnet display with zero balances over testnet confusion.

Steps — network first, then token

- 692. Confirm you are in the official app. If you are not sure, stop and reinstall from the store you already trust. Do not use an APK from a group.
- 693. Add or select **BNB Smart Chain**. Chain ID **56**. Known RPC. Explorer <https://bscscan.com>. Prefer built-in BSC. Refuse a dApp popup from a site you just met.
- 694. Read the network chip. It must mean BSC before you copy or import anything.
- 695. Add custom token. Paste:

0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00

- 696. Confirm the wallet reads symbol and decimals from the chain. Do not type decimals from a tweet. Checksum warning? Stop, re-copy.
- 697. Look at the display. Balance may be 0. That is a pass.
- 698. If a popup says Approve, Claim, or Connect to a dashboard, **reject**. You were importing a sticker.
- 699. Optional: open BscScan, paste the same contract, confirm the sticker you see matches the tracker. Still no connect.

You may also add BEP-20 USDT the same way if you already know that contract from a source you trust. Still not a buy. Do not search “USDT” and tap the first result.

Step	Pass	Fail
------	------	------

Network	Chain ID 56, chip reads BSC	Random “BSC Ultra”, QR from WhatsApp
Token	Paste known Crystal Stones contract	Name search, airdrop, Telegram file
Popups	None, or you rejected approve/claim	You approved a spender
Balance	0 is allowed	You sent BNB to the contract to “mint”
App	Official store	Helper APK

Worked scenario. A practice phone shows only BNB (or shows nothing). BscScan would show Crystal Stones if this address had any. It does not.

- 700. The student still imports the contract. Display shows 0 CST.
- 701. A banner inside a clone of the explorer says “Add to MetaMask — limited airdrop.” They do not use the banner. They used the wallet’s own import.
- 702. They take no screenshot for a group “proof of holding.” Zero is not shame. This course did not require a bag.
- 703. They confirm chain ID 56 still selected after a reboot, because dropdowns drift.
- 704. Lab done. No buy. No approve. Window pointed at the book.

DIAGRAM

```

Official wallet
--> add/select BSC, chain ID 56
--> custom token, paste CST contract
--> display updates (maybe 0)
X  buy
X  approve
X  claim
X  send BNB to the contract

```

If import fails

Wrong network is the first suspect. RPC lying is the second. Typo is the third. Re-copy from notes you made in the previous lab, not from memory. Do not “download a token list pack.” Do not pay a site to add tokens.

If the wallet wants BNB before it will even show a custom token, that is a UI quirk or a fake app. Real custom-token import is a display action. Try the official app’s documented path. Do not send gas to a stranger to unlock import.

After import, open your receive address on BscScan (bookmark, paste). If the book says 0 of that token and the wallet says 0, they agree — lab complete. If the book says you hold it and the wallet says 0, you imported the wrong contract or you are on the wrong network. That mismatch is the whole point of this course. Fix the window. Do not buy to “make it show.” Do not claim an airdrop to “force a balance.”

If you share a screenshot of the wallet with a group to prove you finished the lab, crop the full address if you want privacy, but know that the 0x is already public. Do not share a seed. Do not let a “tutor” remote-control the phone to add the network for you. Pointing the window is the skill. If someone else taps it, you did not take the lab.

If the icon appears with a surprise balance

A spam token can appear without import. That is not this lab succeeding. That is a poison sticker. Hide it if the UI allows. Do not tap claim. The lab is the Crystal Stones contract you pasted, even if the number is 0, even if a fake “Crystal” sits above it with a cartoon dollar amount.

ACADEMY NOTE Adding a network and adding a token are window actions. They are not purchases, not approvals, and not a reason to scan a QR. Zero balance is a complete lab. This academy will not tell you to buy Crystal Stones so the icon looks nicer.

What this lesson is for

Your window now matches the book on purpose. Next: the failure collection — wrong chain, no BNB for gas, fake token, approval drain teaser — so the whole course fits on one page of scars you do not have to earn.

Say this out loud

- I can point a practice wallet at BSC, chain ID 56, without a stranger’s QR.
- I can import Crystal Stones by pasting 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00.
- Adding a token is not buying it and not approving a spender.
- A zero balance is a valid lab result.
- Claim and approve popups are not part of import.

Next: common BSC beginner failures, collected.

Lesson 4: Common BSC beginner failures, collected (28 min)

Common BSC beginner failures, collected

This lesson is a scar list you do not have to earn. Four failures show up so often they have their own smell: **wrong chain, no BNB for gas, fake token, approval drain**. Each one already had a full lesson. Here they sit in one place so your memory can find them under stress.

By the end you should name the failure in one sentence, name the first honest check, and name the trap that pretends to be a fix.

Failure 1 — wrong chain

You sent BEP-20 when the venue was on ERC-20, or you watched BscScan for a send that lived on Ethereum, or you picked opBNB / BEP-2 / TRC-20 because the label said BNB or USDT.

First check: network chip, withdrawal info icon, explorer of that network. Same 0x is not the same pile.

Fake fix: a bridge URL, a recovery admin, a “merge chains” dApp. Real fix: open the book you actually sent on, with that book’s native gas, or contact the venue if you sent to a tagged deposit address. Safety will labour incidents. Today: do not double-send while panicking.

Failure 2 — no BNB for gas

You hold USDT or Crystal Stones and 0 BNB. The wallet refuses. Or you emptied BNB to zero in the same send that needed a fee.

First check: address page BNB balance on BscScan.

Fake fix: “send gas to this helper to unlock.” Real gas is taken inside your transaction from your own BNB.

Real fix: get a small amount of BNB **on BSC** into **your** address — tiny, from a venue or a person you actually know — not to a contract, not to a stranger’s “unlocker.”

Failed transactions can still burn the BNB you did have. Do not retry a clone five times.

Failure 3 — fake token

You added by name search, claimed an airdrop, or trusted a screenshot of a clone. The sticker said Crystal Stones. The contract did not.

First check: character-by-character compare with 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00 on real BscScan. Verified source still does not mean safe investment.

Fake fix: “migrate to the new contract tonight,” “swap the fake into the real on this DEX.” **Real fix:** stop interacting. Do not sell into a honeypot hoping to “get some value back” unless you know what you are doing — and Basic’s answer is you do not, yet. Leave it. Learn the paste habit.

Failure 4 — approval drain teaser

You connected, then approved unlimited USDT to a dashboard. Days later transferFrom emptied the account. Or you are one popup away from that story.

First check: BscScan method names and Approval events. The gun is visible.

Fake fix: a revoke site that wants a seed, a “support” screen-share, a booster APK. **Real fix:** if nothing is approved yet, reject. If something is approved, Safety’s revoke-on-the-real-explorer path, with BNB for gas, on the real domain — not a chat link. This course only teases that path on purpose. Do not improvise with a helper.

Failure	One-sentence name	First honest check	Do not
Wrong chain	Same letters, different book	Chip + explorer of that network	Chat-group bridge
No BNB for gas	Tokens visible, door locked	Address page native balance	Mail BNB to a stranger
Fake token	Sticker is not identity	Paste known contract	Name search, migration DM
Approval drain	You loaded a spender’s gun	Method approve / Approval event	Seed-to-revoke, unlimited “just in case”

Worked scenario. Four friends in one week, four failures.

705. Ada’s USDT is on Ethereum; she is watching BscScan. She opens Etherscan instead of a recovery bot.
706. Bola’s CST display is fat; BNB is 0. He does not pay an unlocker. He notices the fuel gauge.

707. Chika imported “Crystal Stones 2.0.” She compares contracts, stops, does not swap the clone.
708. Dapo approved a dashboard. He sees the Approval event. He waits for Safety instead of pasting a seed into a revoke clone.
709. None of them needed a new religion. They needed the names.

DIAGRAM

Stress

```
--> name the failure (chain / gas / fake / approve)
--> first honest check on bookmarked BscScan
--> refuse the fake fix (bridge / unlocker / migration / seed-revoke)
```

The book is still the referee.
Helpers who need keys are not referees.

Honourable mentions, one line each

Pending treated as paid. Failed treated as free. Refresh treated as a chain action. Screenshot treated as BscScan. Sending BNB to a token contract to mint. Testnet coins sold as naira. RPC that wants a seed. Adding a token believed to be a purchase. Verified contract believed to be a safe investment. Those are this course, compressed. If you can name them, you are ready for Safety’s people-and-programs version.

ACADEMY NOTE Practice with amounts you can lose. Prefer a test send first when you ever send at all. Academy staff never ask for seed phrase, private key, 2FA codes, or remote screen control. A helper who needs any of those to fix a BSC failure is the failure.

What this lesson is for

The scar list is now a checklist. Last lesson: where this course sits on the Basic track — behind you, here, and Safety next, with Intermediate still not a licence to launch tokens.

Say this out loud

- Wrong chain: same 0x, different book. Open the explorer for the network you actually used.
- No BNB for gas: you can see tokens and cannot move them. Do not mail fuel to a stranger.
- Fake token: paste the known contract. Name search and migration DMs are hostile.
- Approval drain: approve loaded a gun you can see later on BscScan. A seed-revoke site is the second shot.
- Failed txs can still cost BNB. Refresh is not a chain action. Screenshots are not the book.

Next: how this course sits on the Basic track.

Lesson 5: How this course sits on the Basic track (24 min)

How this course sits on the Basic track

You now have a map of **one** book: BNB Smart Chain. Fluency on BscScan is not employment, not a signal group, and not a requirement to buy Crystal Stones. It is literacy so the next course — Safety — has nouns to work with.

By the end of this lesson you should know what sits behind you, what this course actually certified, what you still should not do, and why Intermediate is not a weekend of launching tokens.

Behind you

- **Crypto Foundations** — ledgers, keys as power of attorney, the decentralisation test, Crystal Stones as a BEP-20 to verify not to buy.
- **Wallets, Keys & Self-Custody** — who holds the key, seed as backup, send and receive without mixing networks.
- **Exchanges & Your First Buy** — the naira door, IOUs, BEP-20 withdrawals, tiny tests.

Those three make this course's examples make sense. If a word still feels foggy — ledger, IOU, seed, withdrawal network — return there. Skipping is how people arrive on BscScan and still paste a seed into an unstucker.

This course

You can now, without slogans:

- describe a blockchain as sealed pages with hashes
- say BSC is not Bitcoin: chain ID 56, BNB gas, smaller validator set, EVM-like tools
- treat RPC as a window, testnet as fake, BEP-20 as the token rule-set
- refuse the 0x trap and leftover names (BEP-2, opBNB, ERC-20 USDT)
- verify 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00 from more than one source
- import a token by contract without buying it
- name gas, nonce, connect, sign, approve, speed-up, cancel, refresh
- refuse bridges for Basic
- read BscScan until the tabs are boring, including an approve you can see
- distrust a screenshot

That is a lot. It is still not “I understand DeFi.” It is not “I should deploy a BEP-20.” It is not “the mineral vault is proven.”

Ahead

Crypto Safety & Common Scams is next on Basic. The people and programs that use everything you just learned against you: phishing, approvals, impersonation, fake support, incident response. You now have enough surface — keys, RPCs, explorers, approvals — that adversaries become the lesson.

Intermediate will do contracts and DeFi for real: reading more of a contract tab, using a DEX on purpose, thinking about pools and slippage without treating them as a job. It will still not be a command to put rent in a pool.

Advanced is where “how to launch a token” would even be allowed to appear, with the risks attached, not as a side hustle in a Basic footnote. This course did not sneak it in.

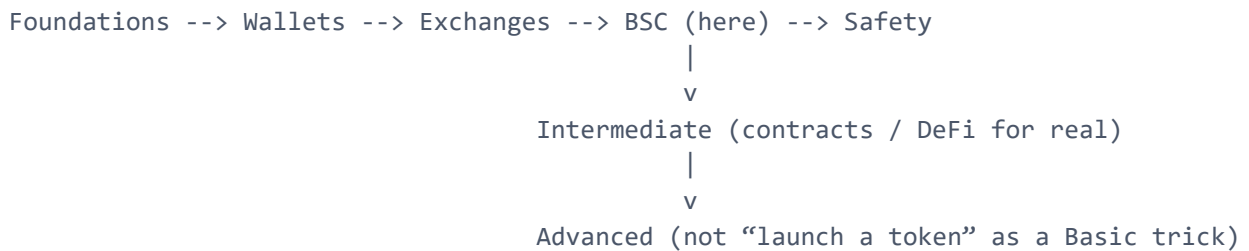
Skill	Good for	Not a license for
Read chain ID 56	Correct withdrawals	Trusting every BSC token

Read token transfers	Confirming payment	Ignoring honeypots
Know approvals exist	Pausing a popup	Approving unlimited “just in case”
Verified contract	Hygiene	Safe investment, vault proof, buy order
Add token by address	Honest display	Believing you purchased
Refuse bridges	Keeping funds on one book	Calling every other chain fake

Worked scenario. A cousin finishes this course and asks, “so should I buy Crystal Stones and then bridge to the new chain the group mentioned?”

710. You say: this academy will not tell you to buy.
711. You say: the contract to verify is 0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00 on BSC.
Verifying is not a buy order.
712. You say: Basic does not use bridges. Surprise multi-chain DMs are hostile.
713. You say: Safety is next because skill without adversaries is incomplete.
714. You say: RWA claims are claims. A classroom is not a vault receipt.

DIAGRAM



Each course makes the next one’s examples make sense.

What you still should not do

- bridge because a caption said so
- deploy a token because a tutorial skipped the risks
- treat BscScan ads as product UI
- send rent money to a clone because you can now read a hash
- treat testnet as naira
- paste a seed into an RPC, a decoder, or an unstucker
- confuse USDT on BNB Smart Chain (BEP-20) through academy checkout (later tuition rail) with Crystal Stones token

Practice, if you practise sends at all, with amounts you can lose. Prefer a test send first.

ACADEMY NOTE Crystal Stones Academy is still education. Fluency on BscScan is not employment, not a signal group, and not a requirement to buy the token. Staff will never ask for a seed, a private key, 2FA, or remote control. Paid-track checkout, when it exists, is USDT on BEP-20 — not Crystal Stones, not a DM address.

What this lesson is for

The Basic track still has Safety. You have the book. Next you meet the people who lie about the book. Take the quiz. Then go to Safety with your explorer bookmark already made.

Say this out loud

- I can describe BNB Smart Chain without slogans: chain ID 56, BNB for gas, BEP-20 tokens, BscScan as a window.
- I can verify the Crystal Stones contract from more than one source and still not treat that as a buy order.
- I can match common failures to honest checks: wrong chain, no gas, fake token, approval drain.
- Safety is next because skill without adversaries is incomplete.
- Intermediate will do contracts and DeFi for real. This course did not teach Solidity or how to launch a token.

Take the quiz.

Module quiz (answers included for editors)

Q1. The Crystal Stones lab in this course requires?

- A. A mandatory token purchase
- B. Read-only verification on the real contract, with no wallet connect required to view
- C. Unlimited USDT approve
- D. A testnet faucet cashed out to naira

Correct answer: B

Q2. When verifying the contract, sources disagree by two characters. You should?

- A. Average the two strings
- B. Take the version from a Friday-night DM
- C. Stop — do not use either until you know why they disagree; do not treat a banner as enough
- D. Send BNB to both contracts to see which mints

Correct answer: C

Q3. Narrating a BEP-20 payment, native Value is 0 and token transfers show 20 USDT. That usually means?

- A. The payment failed
- B. The token movement is on the token tab; native 0 is normal
- C. You must resend on ERC-20
- D. BscScan cannot see USDT

Correct answer: B

Q4. Adding BSC and Crystal Stones on a practice wallet without buying is complete when?

- A. You have purchased a bag so the icon is not zero

- B. Chain ID 56 is selected and the known contract is imported; zero balance is allowed
- C. You approved a dashboard to “activate” the token
- D. You sent BNB to the contract to mint

Correct answer: B

Q5. You hold a BEP-20 token but BscScan shows 0 BNB on your address. The first honest issue is?

- A. The token is fake by definition
- B. You cannot pay gas to move it until you have BNB on BSC in that address — do not mail BNB to a stranger to unlock
- C. You must bridge to Ethereum
- D. RPC password must be the seed

Correct answer: B

Q6. A group says the real Crystal Stones migrated and you must bridge this weekend. Basic’s move is?

- A. Bridge immediately via their URL
- B. Refuse — Basic does not use bridges; surprise migrations are hostile until slow public verification exists
- C. Approve unlimited USDT to “reserve” the new token
- D. Paste the seed so they can migrate it for you

Correct answer: B

Q7. This course’s map puts Safety next because?

- A. BSC will be switched off
- B. You now have enough surface (keys, RPCs, explorers, approvals) that adversaries become the lesson
- C. You are required to buy Crystal Stones first
- D. P2P is illegal to mention

Correct answer: B

Q8. Launching your own BEP-20 after this course is?

- A. The hidden homework
- B. Required to pass the lab
- C. Not taught here — Advanced / later, and not a Basic side hustle
- D. Safe because you can read BscScan

Correct answer: C

Crypto Safety & Common Scams

BASIC TRACK | slug: crypto-safety-scams | level: beginner | FREE

The fifth and last Basic course. The chain will settle a theft as calmly as a gift. You will name your actual threat model, the four doors attackers use, phishing and fake apps, people scams (giveaways, romance, fake jobs, fake Crystal Stones or Binance support), approval drains, and what to do in the first hour if something already went wrong. This is the immune system for the whole academy. Education only. Crystal Stones Academy will never ask for a seed phrase, and will never DM you a recovery agent.

Module 1: Your actual threat model

You are the security team. What attackers actually want, the four doors (device, account, chain permission, human), practice amounts, and the academy never-ask-seed rule written so you can quote it.

Lesson 1: You are the security team (26 min)

You are the security team

A bank has fraud analysts, a frozen-card button, and a number a human answers. Self-custody gives you **finality** — a completed send is not a customer-care undo. It also gives you **the job**.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to say, in your own words, what a threat model is, which security model you are in for each pile of value you hold, and why “I am careful” is not a defence unless it is a checklist.

Finality is the feature that also fires the security team

Finality means: after a payment has settled under the system’s rules, there is no help desk that reverses it because you are sorry. You already met this idea in Foundations. It is the reason crypto can settle a gift across a border on a Sunday. It is also the reason the same rails will settle a theft with the same calm.

A card network often has a **chargeback**: a customer disputes a payment and the scheme may reverse it. That parenting is expensive. It is why merchants get frozen, why KYC exists, and why a stolen debit card is sometimes a phone call instead of a funeral. Public chains mostly do not parent you. The book is public. The signature was valid. The transfer is done.

This is not a sermon against self-custody. It is the job description. If you hold keys, you are the security team. If you hold an exchange IOU, you share the job with a company — and you can still fail your half by handing them a phished login.

Three security models, named so you stop mixing them

People lose funds because they describe the wrong model. They say “the blockchain will freeze it” about an exchange IOU, or “I’ll call support” about an on-chain send.

1. Bank / card model. You plus an institution’s security team. Reversal is sometimes possible. Identity checks are the price. A freeze can save you and can also lock you out.

2. Centralised exchange model. You plus the company’s security team. The number on the screen is an **IOU** — a row in their ledger, not coins at an address you control. They may freeze a withdrawal. They may recover an account if you still pass their identity checks. They will not reverse an on-chain withdrawal that already left. Binance, here and in the rest of this course, is **an example of a centralised exchange**, not “the only real one.”

3. Self-custody model. You. The coins sit on the chain at an address whose **private key** you control. A **private key** is the secret that can sign. A **seed phrase** is the human backup of that secret (usually 12 or 24 words). There is no parent. There is also no password reset.

Model	Who is on the security team	What a parent can still do	What a parent cannot do
Bank / card	You + the institution	Freeze, reverse some payments, replace a card	Invent cash you already handed to a stranger
Centralised exchange	You + the company	Kill sessions, reset a login, sometimes freeze an IOU	Reverse a completed on-chain withdrawal; invent a seed you leaked
Self-custody	You	Nothing at the protocol layer	The chain will not “refund” a valid signature

Worked scenario. Amaka keeps 40 USDT on an exchange she bookmarked, 15 USDT in a software wallet she uses to practise, and her salary in a bank. On Monday a Telegram “support agent” wants her seed “to unsuspend Crystal Stones.” On Tuesday a Google ad wants her exchange password. On Wednesday her debit card is cloned.

715. She names the model for each pile before she answers anyone.

716. The seed request is self-custody. There is no support agent. She refuses. The 15 USDT stays.

717. The Google ad is the exchange model. She ignores the ad, opens her bookmark, and does not type a password into a search result. The 40 USDT IOU stays.

718. The cloned card is the bank model. She calls the number on the back of the **physical** card, not a number in an SMS. The bank may reverse some charges.

Three piles. Three models. One person who stopped treating “careful” as a personality.

DIAGRAM

```

Bank model:      you + institution's fraud team
Exchange model:  you + company's security team
                  (you can still get phished)
Self-custody:    you
                  (the chain will settle a theft as calmly as a gift)
  
```

Name the model before you answer a message.

What “threat model” means in this academy

A **threat model** is an honest list: what you have, who might want it, which attacks are actually likely, and what you will refuse even when your hands shake.

Yours, as a Crystal Stones Academy beginner, is not “a nation-state implant in the CPU.” That sentence is how people skip the boring work. The likely list is ordinary:

- phishing sites and fake apps
- impersonation in Telegram, WhatsApp, SMS, and X
- P2P receipt fraud (you already saw this in the exchanges course)
- unlimited **approvals** on clone dApps — an approval is on-chain permission for a spender to pull tokens later
- friends, cousins, and “helpers” who should not hold keys
- your own panic, which is a tool attackers manufacture on purpose

Ordinary is what empties wallets. Movie hackers are a distraction. If your threat model is “I am not important enough to hack,” you have already lost the plot. Attackers do not need you to be important. They need you to be hurried.

“I am careful” is not a control

Careful is a story people tell after they pasted a seed into a Google Doc “backup,” used SMS as their only 2FA, and connected a wallet to three airdrop sites this week. **2FA** means **two-factor authentication**: a second proof besides the password, such as an authenticator app code. SMS 2FA is a weak second factor because a **SIM-swap** (someone convincing your mobile operator to move your number) can steal the texts.

Careful, in this course, is a checklist you can run when you are tired. Module 6 will hand you a weekly one. Today you only need the posture: identity is not security. Habits are.

ACADEMY NOTE This course will repeat uncomfortable sentences. Repetition is the point. A one-time warning is how people nod and then sign a permit. Crystal Stones Academy will never ask for a seed phrase, a private key, a 2FA code, or remote control of your screen. If a message claims otherwise, it is not us — even if it has our crystal.

What this lesson is for

You are not here to become a professional security engineer. You are here so that “who is the security team for this pile?” is a reflex, and so that finality stops being a slogan and starts being a reason to practise small.

Say this out loud

- Self-custody means I am the security team. The chain will not parent me.
- An exchange balance is an IOU. The company is a parent for that IOU, not for a withdrawal that already left.

- A threat model is a list of likely attacks, not a feeling that I am careful.
- Likely attacks are phishing, impersonation, P2P fraud, and approvals — not movie hackers.
- “I am careful” needs a checklist I can run when I am tired.

Next: what attackers actually want from you — seed, session, approval, OTP, and the panic that opens all of them.

Lesson 2: What attackers actually want (seed, session, approval, OTP, human panic) (27 min)

What attackers actually want (seed, session, approval, OTP, human panic)

They do not want to “hack the blockchain.” They want **authority you already have**. Cryptography is doing its job. The book will record whatever valid signature you (or malware on your phone) produce. The attacker’s craft is getting you to produce it.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to look at a message, a popup, or a phone call and name the loot: seed, session, approval, OTP, a mistaken send, a mule slot, or your audience. Naming the loot is how you pick the refuse-line before your hands shake.

Ranked loot, from worst to merely expensive

1. Seed phrase or private key. Total, durable control of that wallet, on every network that seed derives, including deposits you have not made yet. There is no “change password” on a seed. Rotation — a new wallet, a test send, a move, retirement of the old words — is the only honest response. Module 5 is that procedure. Today: treat a seed request as a robbery in progress, not a support ticket.

2. Exchange session. Password plus **OTP** (one-time password — the 2FA code), or a stolen cookie that keeps you “logged in.” This loot spends the IOU. It does not spend on-chain coins at an address you still control, unless they also withdraw to themselves and your whitelist is off. A **withdrawal whitelist** is a company setting: withdrawals may only go to addresses you already approved, often with a delay when you add a new one.

3. Unlimited token approval. They pull USDT (or Crystal Stones, or whatever you approved) later. You still have the seed. You have a mystery of “I didn’t send.” You did not. You loaded a gun last month. Module 4 is this door in slow motion.

4. One honest send to the wrong address. Paste attack, fake invoice, QR that does not match its caption, wrong network. The signature is yours. The destination is theirs. A test send is the cheap version of this lesson.

5. You as a mule. They want your KYC-facing account to move stolen funds. **KYC** is Know Your Customer: the identity file an exchange or bank holds. If you “receive USDT and forward it, keep a cut,” you may be washing someone else’s theft through your name.

6. Your audience. Hijack your Telegram, WhatsApp, or X. The next ten people trust your face. The loot is not your 20 USDT. It is theirs.

Different loot, different popups. If you know which loot a message is aiming at, you do not need a whitepaper to refuse.

What they say	Loot they want	Door they are opening
"Import seed to sync / migrate / restore support"	Keys	Device
"Send the 2FA code to verify this is you"	Exchange or email session	Account
"Approve to claim / verify / mint"	Allowance	Chain permission
"Sign to confirm you are human" (unread hex)	Often allowance in a costume	Chain permission
"Send 1 USDT to validate the wallet"	Direct transfer	Human, then a send
"Receive this USDT and forward it"	Mule slot	Human + your KYC
"Make me admin / drop the APK in the group"	Audience, then everyone else's keys	Human

Worked scenario. Chinedu sees "Official Crystal Stones airdrop — connect and sign to claim." He has memorised "never type 12 words." He feels safe. He connects. The wallet shows a signature, not a seed box. He signs.

719. Name the loot. This was not Door 1. This was an approval or a **permit** (a signature that grants a spender the same right as an on-chain approve, without the approve transaction). Loot type 3.

720. He still has his seed. That is not comfort. USDT can leave tonight or in August.

721. The refuse-line he needed was not "I don't type words." It was "I don't sign what I cannot read, on a site I did not bookmark."

722. He later opens a bookmarked explorer, finds the spender, and revokes from a tool he saved on a calm day — not from the airdrop site's "disconnect" button.

The student who only memorised seed-safety is the student this course is for.

Human panic is a loot type of its own

Attackers manufacture **cortisol**: the body chemistry of hurry. A timer on a banner. "Your funds will be lost in 10 minutes." "AML freeze, pay to unlock." "Last train for the snapshot." Panic is not a side effect. Panic is the product, because panic makes you skip the bookmark, skip the middle characters of an address, and skip the sentence "what loot is this?"

You cannot out-argue a timer with more speed. You out-argue it by treating every timer as a **prop**. Chains do not confiscate for ignoring a banner. Exchanges do not unsuspend accounts via a Telegram OTP. This academy does not run a 10-minute confiscation window.

A useful private sentence, said before you tap: **"If this were real, it would still be real in twenty minutes, and I would start from a bookmark."** If the offer dies in twenty minutes, it was never an offer.

DIAGRAM

Attacker

```
|
+--> seed / private key      (owns the wallet from now on)
+--> session + OTP           (owns the exchange IOU for a while)
+--> approval / permit      (owns a loaded gun against your tokens)
+--> one wrong send          (owns that payment)
+--> you as mule              (owns your KYC as a pipe)
+--> your group              (owns the next ten people)
+--> your panic              (opens every line above)
```

They do not need to "break BscScan."

OTP is not a conversation

An **OTP** is a one-time code. Authenticator apps generate them. SMS delivers them. Email sometimes delivers them. The code proves that the person at the keyboard can see a second device or inbox. It is not a greeting. It is not "verification" you send to a helper. Anyone who asks you to read an OTP aloud is asking for your session.

Same rule for **backup codes** — the paper codes an exchange gives you when you turn on 2FA. They are spare keys. They are not customer-care trivia.

ACADEMY NOTE Nobody needs to defeat cryptography if you will hand them the key, the session, the allowance, or the OTP. The chain, and the exchange database, will then honestly help them. That honesty is not a bug. It is why settlement works when you meant the payment too.

What this lesson is for

So that the next time a screen asks you for something, you name the loot in one word before you type. Seed. Session. Approval. OTP. Send. Mule. Audience. Panic. If you cannot name it, you reject.

Say this out loud

- Attackers want authority I already have. They do not need to break the chain.
- Seed is the worst leak. It is not the only leak.
- Approve-to-claim and "sign to verify" can be loot even when no 12 words appear.
- An OTP is a session key. I do not read it to a helper.
- Panic is manufactured. If it would still be real in twenty minutes, I start from a bookmark.

Next: the four doors as a map — device, account, chain permission, and human — so every later scam has a name.

Lesson 3: The four doors (device, account, chain permission, human) (27 min)

The four doors (device, account, chain permission, human)

Memorise four. Every scam in later modules is one of these, sometimes two stacked. Naming the door is not wordplay. It tells you the fix. People who only say “I was hacked” cannot pick a fix, so they pick a recovery wizard.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to point at a bad afternoon and say which door opened, which loot left, and which door is still shut.

Door 1 — Device (the keys live here)

The **device** is the phone, laptop, browser profile, or hardware box where signing happens. Attackers who win this door get the seed, the private key, or malware that can sign as you.

Typical openings:

- a cloned wallet app, or an APK (Android package file) from a chat
- a seed typed into a website “to sync”
- a screenshot of the words in a gallery or a cloud notes app
- overlay malware that draws a fake window on a real app
- a hardware device whose screen you ignored while the laptop lied

If they have the words, they have the wallet on every EVM chain that seed derives, including future deposits. **Rotation** (new seed on a clean device, test, move, retire old) is the only honest response. There is no “change password” on a seed. Module 5 will walk that procedure without asking you to send leftovers to a specialist.

Hardware wallets help **if you read the device screen**. They do not help if you tap confirm because the phone looked familiar. “I have a hardware wallet, so I can sign anything blindly” is a quiz answer this course will fail on purpose.

Door 2 — Account (the company still has a parent)

Account means exchange login, email, Apple or Google store account, academy login, the SIM that receives SMS. This door has a parent — the company — and also has phishing.

Typical openings:

- a fake login page from an ad
- a SIM-swap against SMS 2FA
- password reuse from a leaked site
- an OTP read to a “support agent”
- a session cookie on a shared or stolen laptop

The fix is the parent's security page: kill sessions, rotate password, rotate 2FA, check the withdrawal whitelist. The fix is never a Telegram handle that arrived after you tweeted "withdrawal stuck."

Academy login is Door 2 for **this site** (progress, not your BNB). Still: do not reuse the exchange password on the academy. Password reuse is how one leak becomes three doors.

Door 3 — Chain permission (the gun you loaded)

Chain permission is an on-chain or off-chain signature that lets someone else move tokens without holding your seed. The common names: **approval**, **allowance**, **permit**, **setApprovalForAll** for NFTs.

You still hold the seed. The spender is loaded. Days later, `transferFrom` can run while you sleep. Your wallet may not pop up. BscScan will show the spender. People say "I didn't click Send." Correct. They clicked Approve last month.

Revoke — a new transaction that sets that spender's allowance to zero — is the response when the seed is still yours. If the seed may also be leaked, revoke on the old wallet is theatre. Rotate. Module 4 is this door in detail.

Door 4 — Human (they change what you believe)

They change the **story**: who you are talking to, what the invoice is, whether the academy asked, whether the network is BEP-20, whether a lover is also your broker. P2P receipt fraud, romance, jobs, fake support, giveaways. No transaction is required until the last step. This is the door that opens the other three.

Typical openings:

- a display name that looks like a founder
- a "Crystal Mentor" DM
- a the checkout processor invoice pasted in WhatsApp
- a QR caption that does not match its bytes
- a timer that says you will miss the last train

The fix is not a better argument with the stranger. The fix is: stop talking, verify on a bookmark you already had, do not "finish the process."

Door	What they get	Typical fix if already open	What does not fix it
Device	Seed, signing malware	New wallet on a clean device; never reuse leaked words	"I changed the app PIN"
Account	Login, OTP, session	Official security page: sessions, password, 2FA, whitelist	A DM from a badge
Chain permission	Spender can pull tokens	Revoke on a known checker, then move if the device is dirty	The fake site's Disconnect button
Human	A story you believe	Stop; bookmark; do not finish	Winning the argument

Worked scenario. Fatima fails Door 4: she believes a fake admin in a Crystal Stones fan group. The admin drops a “verification dApp.” She opens Door 3: she approves unlimited USDT. She never typed a seed. Post-mortem in the group says “I was hacked.”

723. Precise version: social then allowance. Door 4 opened Door 3.

724. Door 1 may still be shut — unless she typed words, installed an APK, or the phone was already dirty.

725. Door 2 is untouched. The exchange IOU is still a separate pile.

726. The fix is: reject further popups, check approvals from a bookmarked tool, revoke, consider moving remaining funds to a fresh hot wallet if the phone is a playground. Not: pay a recovery specialist in the same group. That specialist watched the group for this moment.

Precision is how you prevent the next one. “Hacked” is a fog. Fog is how the second predator works.

DIAGRAM

```
Door 1  DEVICE ..... seed, APK, malware, ignored hardware screen
Door 2  ACCOUNT ..... login, email, SIM, OTP, session cookie
Door 3  CHAIN PERMISSION .. approve, permit, setApprovalForAll
Door 4  HUMAN ..... the story that opens 1, 2, and 3
```

Most “hacks” are Door 4, then one of the others.

ACADEMY NOTE Academy never-ask-seed is Door 1 policy. We also will not ask for 2FA codes (Door 2), unlimited approves (Door 3), remote control of your screen (Door 1 + 2), or off-platform “verification payments” including “send USDT to verify” (Door 4). If a human’s request needs any of those, they are not us — even with a similar avatar.

What this lesson is for

So that every later module has a map. Phishing is usually Door 4 opening 1, 2, or 3. People scams are Door 4 with patience. Drains are Door 3, sometimes Door 1. Incident response is: name the door, then pick the fix that matches.

Say this out loud

- Four doors: device, account, chain permission, human.
- Naming the door tells me the fix. “Hacked” does not.
- Human is the door that opens the other three.
- A hardware wallet is still Door 1 if I confirm blindly, and still Door 3 if I approve a drainer.
- Academy staff will not ask me to open any of the four doors.

Next: practice amounts and play-money rules — the architecture that makes a mistake survivable.

Lesson 4: Practice amounts and play-money rules (26 min)

Practice amounts and play-money rules

Skill is built with **money you can lose**. If the amount would change rent, food, school fees, or the invoice you are waiting on, it is not a practice amount. Pride is how people practise with a month of work.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to define a practice amount in your own life, split a hot play pocket from a colder savings pocket, and refuse the sentence “I’ll make it back tonight.”

A practice amount is a household number, not a Telegram number

A **practice amount** is a sum whose disappearance would sting your pride and not your calendar. For one student that is 3 USDT. For another, 15. For someone sending naira through P2P, it might be the smallest the counterparty will honour. The number is local. The rule is not: **if losing it would cancel a bill, it is not practice.**

This academy will keep saying **practice with amounts you can lose** until it is boring. Boring is the point. The first send on a new network, the first token add, the first dApp, the first P2P, the first withdrawal whitelist change — all of those are practice events. They use practice size.

“Everyone in the group uses 500 USDT” is not a definition. Groups contain people who can lose 500 USDT and people who are about to be wrecked. You are not a group. You are a rent cycle.

Five rules that sound childish and save careers

- 727. First week on a new wallet: only play money. Live with the app. Receive a tiny test. Send a tiny test. Confirm the explorer. Then, maybe, more.
- 728. First transaction on a new dApp: play money. A **dApp** is a website that asks your wallet to sign. New URL, new risk, even if the logo is familiar.
- 729. First time you add a custom token: verify the contract on a bookmarked explorer, still play money if you will swap. Crystal Stones, as the project publishes it, is ``0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00`` on BNB Smart Chain. That is a **reference to verify**, not a buy order, and not a reason to skip the test send.
- 730. Never “make it back” the same night you lost a practice amount on a clone. Revenge-sizing is how practice becomes a hole.
- 731. Hardware later, for amounts that would hurt — still with a test send. A hardware box does not make a 2,000 USDT first-try a good idea.

Two pockets is architecture, not a personality

A daily-driver software wallet should be a **spending** pocket. A second wallet (eventually hardware, at first just a second software seed you almost never connect) is the **savings** pocket. Approvals live on the spending pocket. If the spending pocket dies, the savings pocket did not sign the clone.

Moving between them is a normal on-chain send, with BNB for gas, with a test. **BNB** is the native coin on BNB Smart Chain; tokens need it for fees. Do not keep “just enough BNB to escape” only on the savings pocket if you have never practised the escape.

Two pockets means two backups. Do not invent a second seed and then screenshot both into the same Drive folder. That is one pocket wearing two hats. A cloud folder is Door 1 with extra steps.

Pocket	What it is for	What it may connect to	What a failure should cost
Play / hot	Learning, tiny swaps, first dApps	New sites, after a bookmark check	A practice amount
Savings / colder	Rare sends, longer holds	Almost nothing; known	Would hurt — so it does

		destinations	not visit sponsored links
Exchange IOU	On purpose, as a company balance	The bookmarked exchange app only	Whatever the company and your 2FA can still protect

Worked scenario. Chidi keeps everything in the same MetaMask (an **example of a wallet app**, not an endorsement) he uses to “test airdrops.” An airdrop site takes the USDT **and** the Crystal Stones **and** the BNB. There was no second pocket.

732. He named himself careful. He had one door, loaded, on every asset.

733. Architecture would have been: play pocket with 8 USDT and a little BNB; savings pocket that has never seen a sponsored link; exchange IOU separate.

734. The airdrop could still kill the play pocket. That is what play pockets are for.

735. The savings pocket would have been a boring send away, after a test, on a calm day — not during the incident.

The lesson is architecture, not luck. Luck is not a threat model.

DIAGRAM

```

Play pocket (hot)
| tiny tests, dApps you are learning
| approvals live here
v
--small sends--> Savings pocket (colder)
                  rare connects
                  known destinations
                  hardware later, still with a test

```

Exchange IOU sits to the side: company ledger, 2FA, whitelist.

Panic-sizing and “dust”

Dust is a leftover too small to care about — a few cents of a token, a fragment of BNB. After a scare, thieves and “recovery specialists” will ask you to send the dust “so they can trace” or “so they can unlock the rest.” Do not. Dust is not a tracing fee. Dust is bait. If you rotate a leaked seed, you may leave dust behind on purpose. That is cheaper than handing a stranger a last payment.

Also: do not sweep every mystery token along when you rotate. Mystery tokens are how Door 3 gets a second chance. Hide them. Move what you already understood. Module 4 and Module 5 will say this again.

ACADEMY NOTE Two pockets is not a command to buy a hardware wallet this week, and it is not a command to hold Crystal Stones. It is a command to stop storing experiments and savings behind the same signature. If you only have play money, you only need a play pocket — and you still practise small.

What this lesson is for

So that a mistake is tuition, not a hole in the month. Safety that only works when the number is tiny is still safety. Safety that you plan to “turn on later, when it matters” is how later arrives already empty.

Say this out loud

- A practice amount is defined by rent and food, not by a group chat.
- Hot pocket experiments. Colder pocket rarely connects.
- I do not chase a loss the same night, and I do not send leftover dust to a specialist.
- Two seeds in one cloud folder are one seed.
- Hardware does not make a large first-try safe. A test send still goes first.

Next: the academy never-ask-seed policy, written so you can quote it at a fake admin — including staff, “wallet support,” and a “token listing team.”

Lesson 5: Never-ask-seed, in writing (including academy staff, wallet support, token listing team) (26 min)

Never-ask-seed, in writing (including academy staff, wallet support, token listing team)

Quote this to anyone, including someone with a Crystal Stones logo, a Binance-coloured badge, a “Trust Wallet support” handle, or a business card that says token listing.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to recite what this academy will never ask for, what it may ask for, and which three costumes — staff, wallet support, listing team — use the same script.

The policy, as a paragraph you can paste

Crystal Stones Academy staff, mentors, and support will never ask for:

- a seed phrase (12, 18, or 24 words)
- a private key, a keystore file, or a “secret recovery phrase”
- a wallet PIN that is actually the seed, or a screenshot of either
- a 2FA code, SMS code, email code, authenticator QR, or backup codes
- remote desktop control of your phone or laptop (AnyDesk, TeamViewer, “just share the screen”)
- a payment to a personal wallet to “unlock” a course, a certificate, a listing, a recovery, or a migration
- “verify by sending USDT” (or BNB, or Crystal Stones) to an address in a DM

They may ask you to:

- log into the academy site **you bookmarked**
- pay Intermediate or Advanced tuition through the **published checkout** when that track is live — USDT on BEP-20 via the published academy checkout, not Crystal Stones token, not PaynovaX, not a wallet in a DM
- paste a **transaction hash** (a public explorer id) if you are stuck
- describe what a popup said, without photographing a seed

If a human’s request is not on the second list and is on the first, they are not us — even if they have a similar avatar, even if they say they are “Mentor Grok,” even if they say they are from the listing team.

A **transaction hash** is safe to share because it is already public. It cannot, by itself, authorise spending. A seed is the opposite object.

Costume 1 — academy staff and “Crystal Mentor”

The real Mentor, in this product, is a chat **inside** the academy app. It does not import wallets. It does not DM you first on WhatsApp. It does not need a seed to “sync Crystal Mentor AI.” A person who starts in Telegram with a crystal avatar is running Door 4.

Staff should be willing to say: “I will not finish this in WhatsApp. Open the bookmarked site.” If “staff” refuses to leave WhatsApp, they are not staff. That sentence is a test. Use it.

Certificates in Basic are **platform** certificates after quizzes, not a wallet signature. “Download certificate, sign in with wallet” is a drain costume.

Costume 2 — “wallet support” (Trust Wallet, MetaMask, hardware brands)

Wallet companies do not restore your funds with your seed. The seed **is** the restoration. Anyone who needs the words “to help” is asking you to hand them the vault. Trust Wallet and MetaMask are **examples of wallet apps**, not endorsements, and not people who will DM you after you tweet a screenshot.

There is no “BSC migration” that requires re-entering a seed into a website. There is no “new Trust Wallet APK” that must arrive as a WhatsApp file. Official updates come from the store listing you already used on a calm day, or from the hardware maker’s own site, bookmarked.

Costume 3 — “token listing team” and “the checkout processor billing”

Listing teams at real exchanges do not collect seeds. They do not ask retail students to “verify holdings” by sending tokens to a personal address. If you ever actually list anything, that is a company process with published forms — not a Telegram invoice.

the checkout processor is the checkout rail this academy has said it will use for paid tracks: USDT on BEP-20. A fake the checkout processor page is a phishing surface. Real checkout starts on the **bookmarked academy site**, not from a PDF in email, not from a WhatsApp invoice that “expires in 15 minutes.” If you did not click Checkout inside the official app, you do not owe that invoice.

The Crystal Stones contract to **verify only** is:

`0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00`

A listing-team costume that sends a **different** contract “because of a migration” is a clone. Verify on bookmarked BscScan. This paragraph is still not a buy order.

Request	Us?	Them?
“Paste 12 words to reset progress / sync Mentor”	No	Thief
“Send 0.1 BNB to verify the certificate”	No	Thief
“Open the official checkout URL	Yes, when you actually owe tuition	—

from the site you bookmarked”		
“What’s the tx hash on BscScan?”	Yes	Fine
“Share screen so I can fix nonce”	No	Thief
“New contract for the listing, last train”	No	Clone
“the checkout processor invoice, pay this 0x from WhatsApp”	No	Fake billing

Worked scenario. A WhatsApp account named “Mentor Grok” writes to Ada after she posted a quiz score in a fan group. It asks for a seed to “sync Crystal Mentor AI” and, if she hesitates, for 20 USDT “to a the checkout processor wallet so the certificate can mint.”

- 736. She quotes the policy. Seed is on the never-list. Personal USDT is on the never-list.
- 737. She does not argue about tone. Argument is how Door 4 stays open.
- 738. She opens the bookmarked academy app. Mentor is there. It does not know about WhatsApp.
- 739. She reports the number to people she already trusts **offline** if that is useful, and she does not paste her remaining address into the group as a bounty.

The refusal was the whole skill. Politeness is optional. The door staying shut is not.

DIAGRAM

Official paths

bookmarked academy site
in-app Mentor
published checkout (USDT BEP-20 / the checkout processor when live)
public tx hash

Unofficial paths

DMs, new wallets, seeds, 2FA codes
remote control, APKs in chat
WhatsApp the checkout processor invoices
"listing team" personal 0x

When in doubt, the unofficial path is a no.

ACADEMY NOTE This policy also protects staff. If someone claiming to be you asks a mentor to “hold these words,” staff must refuse too. A screenshot of a seed in a gallery is not “encrypted.” It is a photograph of the vault combination, sitting next to your selfies, often backed up to a company cloud. Treat it as a leak. Rotate. Do not debate file encryption with a thief.

What this lesson is for

So you have a paragraph, not a vibe. When a costume arrives, you do not need to research the person. You compare the ask to the two lists. First list: no. Second list: maybe, from a bookmark.

Say this out loud

- Crystal Stones Academy never asks for seeds, private keys, 2FA, remote desktop, or “verify by sending USDT.”
- Hashes are OK. Words are not.
- Checkout is published on the bookmarked site, not pasted in WhatsApp.
- Wallet support that needs the seed to help is not support. A listing team that needs a personal send is not a listing team.
- Logo plus urgency plus a door = thief. I can refuse without a debate.

Take the quiz. Module 2: fake surfaces — sites, apps, explorers, invoices, QR codes, and the pipes that deliver them.

Module quiz (answers included for editors)

Q1. Amaka holds USDT on an exchange, a little BNB in a software wallet, and salary in a bank. A Telegram account wants her seed “to unsuspend Crystal Stones.” Which security model applies to that ask?

- A. The bank model — she should call the number in the Telegram bio
- B. Self-custody — there is no parent, and a seed request is a robbery, not support
- C. The exchange model — she should send the seed to in-app chat so they can freeze the chain
- D. Validators will reverse the theft if she forwards the message

Correct answer: B

Q2. The most complete loot for an attacker is?

- A. A transaction hash she can paste into a group
- B. Her seed phrase or private key
- C. A BscScan bookmark
- D. A screenshot of a green candle

Correct answer: B

Q3. A site says “approve to claim the official airdrop.” Chinedu never types 12 words. What loot is this aiming at?

- A. Nothing — without a seed box, a signature is always harmless
- B. Chain permission — an approval or permit can load a spender without taking the seed
- C. Only his academy password
- D. His SIM card, automatically

Correct answer: B

Q4. The four doors taught in this module are?

- A. KYC, KYB, AML, and NFT
- B. Device, account, chain permission, and human

- C. Proof-of-work, proof-of-stake, RPC, and DEX
- D. Bid, ask, last, and spread

Correct answer: B

Q5. A practice amount is defined by?

- A. Whatever a Telegram VIP room uses for “entries”
- B. Whether losing it would not break rent, food, or fees
- C. The exchange’s maximum withdrawal
- D. Chain ID 56 as a lucky number

Correct answer: B

Q6. Ada’s “Crystal Mentor” WhatsApp asks her to paste 12 words “to sync progress.” What is true?

- A. Support needs the seed to help, so she should paste it once
- B. Academy staff, mentors, and support never ask for a seed — this is not us
- C. She should send a screenshot of the words instead, because images are encrypted in the gallery
- D. She should share screen first so they can type the words for her

Correct answer: B

Q7. Why is a transaction hash usually safe to share when a seed is not?

- A. The hash includes the seed, but only support can read it
- B. The hash is already public on the explorer and cannot by itself authorise spending
- C. The hash resets approvals automatically
- D. The hash is a 2FA code

Correct answer: B

Q8. Two seeds photographed into the same cloud folder are?

- A. A professional backup, because the cloud encrypts selfies
- B. Still one Door 1 — two hats on the same leak
- C. Required for BEP-20
- D. How hardware wallets store a PIN

Correct answer: B

Module 2: Phishing and fake surfaces

Fake sites, ads, lookalike domains, cloned apps and APKs, fake explorers, fake tickets, fake the checkout processor pages, QR and clipboard attacks, the panic-day procedure, and the chat pipes that deliver them.

Lesson 1: Fake sites, ads, and lookalike domains (27 min)

Fake sites, ads, and lookalike domains

Phishing is a surface that looks like a door you already trust. The transaction that empties you is honest. Your attention was not. The chain does not know that the logo was a costume. It only knows the signature was valid.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to say why HTTPS is not honesty, why a search ad is not navigation, and how a calm-day bookmark is the tool you will actually have on a panic day.

Where fakes sit, in 2026, for this academy's students

They sit where you already look when you are hurried:

- **Sponsored ads** on search for “Trust Wallet”, “BscScan”, “PancakeSwap”, “Crystal Stones”, “the checkout processor”
- **Lookalike domains**: an extra letter, a hyphen, `crystalstones-claim.org`, `bscscan-fix.com`, `app-crystalstones.net`
- **Homograph domains**: Unicode letters that look like Latin. The address bar is lying to your eyes, not to the computer
- A reply under a real post, with the real logo, pointing at a new host
- A “mirror” someone pasted because the real site was “down for ten minutes”

HTTPS — the padlock — means the connection is encrypted *to that host*. The host may still be a thief. Thieves buy certificates. The padlock is not a character reference.

You already used a bookmark ritual for exchanges. Expand it until it is boring.

The calm-day bookmark, used on the panic day

On a calm day, from a device you trust, type or navigate to:

- the academy site you actually use
- the official store page for the wallet app you actually use (Trust Wallet and MetaMask remain **examples**, not endorsements)
- BscScan, if that is your explorer for BNB Smart Chain
- the exchange you actually have an account on, if you have one
- the checkout processor only if you reached it from academy checkout, and only then save *that* checkout path
- PancakeSwap only if you actually use it — official domain saved, not a sponsored mirror

On panic day you do not search. You tap the bookmark. Search is an ad network with extra steps. Error messages are advertised against. “Crystal Stones official” as a query is a hunting ground.

If you do not have the bookmark yet, you are not “behind.” You are at the start of the ritual. Do it before Module 3. Do not do it from a link in this paragraph on a random mirror of the academy. You already know the site you enrolled on.

Clue	What it actually means	What you do
Urgency + official logo	Default hostile	Bookmark, or nothing
New domain, old logo	Hostile	Do not connect
HTTPS padlock	Encrypted to <i>that</i> host	Still check the name
You arrived from an ad	Hostile until a bookmark exists	Close the tab
Extra word: claim, fix, migrate, support	Costume	Close the tab
Real site, banner “connect to unfreeze”	Often a malvertising slot	Ignore the banner; use the core page

Worked scenario. A student googles “BscScan Crystal Stones” to add a token. They tap the first result. It is an ad. They connect a wallet and approve a spender named TokenFix. USDT leaves that night.

740. Real BscScan, opened later from a bookmark, even shows the approval. The book is not hiding.
741. The search ad was Door 4 opening Door 3. Nobody “broke cryptography.”
742. The contract they should have verified, if they were adding Crystal Stones at all, is
`0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00` — a **verify** step, not a buy order, and not something an ad should introduce.
743. The fix going forward is not “I will read ads more carefully.” It is “I will not use search as a navigation tool for money.”

DIAGRAM

Calm day

type known URL or use a source you already trust
confirm the host name with your eyes
save a bookmark

Panic day

tap the bookmark
do not search
do not tap an ad
do not “just this once”

Search ads are not a navigation tool.

If you already connected on a maybe-fake site

Assume Door 3 may be open even if you “only connected.” Connecting is not always an approval, but many clone sites queue a signature next, and people remember the connect, not the sign. Check approvals from a known tool later (Module 4). Do **not** go back to the fake site to “disconnect.” Disconnect on the fake site is theatre. It does not unload a spender on the chain.

If you typed a seed into that site, skip Module 4’s optimism. That is Door 1. Module 5: new wallet, clean device, test, move, retire. Do not ask the fake site to “release” you.

ACADEMY NOTE This academy will not tell you that a particular colour of padlock, a particular badge, or a particular “verified” tick in a search result is safety. The ritual is slower and ruder: bookmark on a calm day, refuse novelty on a panic day. If that feels unsocial, good. Thieves are very social.

Homographs deserve one extra look: copy the host and paste it into a notes app in a large font. Your eye will sometimes catch a character the address bar rounded off. If anything looks even slightly off, you do not connect. There is no swap so urgent that a second look is expensive. The second look is the whole defence.

What this lesson is for

So that “I googled it and the logo matched” stops being a sentence you say after a drain. Logos are cheap. Bookmarks are not glamorous. Bookmarks work.

Say this out loud

- HTTPS is encryption to a host, not proof the host is honest.
- Ads are not navigation. Search is not a wallet address book.
- Bookmarks are for panic days. I save them on calm days.
- A fake site’s disconnect button does not close Door 3.
- If I typed a seed into a lookalike, I rotate. I do not negotiate with the lookalike.

Next: fake apps and APKs — the clone that does not need a website because it **is** the box you type the seed into.

Lesson 2: Fake apps and APKs (sideloading Trust Wallet / MetaMask clones) (27 min)

Fake apps and APKs (sideloading Trust Wallet / MetaMask clones)

A cloned wallet app does not need to break cryptography. It **is** the box you type the seed into. Door 1, with an icon you already trusted.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to refuse a store clone, refuse a chat APK, and say why a hardware wallet still fails if you confirm on a lying phone screen.

Store clones

App stores are crowded. Similar name, similar icon, publisher you have never heard of, “Wallet Trust Pro”, “MetaMask Safe”, “Trust Wallet Official 2026.” Read the **publisher** name, not the title. Compare it, on a calm day, with the publisher you already used — or with the company site you bookmarked, not with a Telegram screenshot.

Install counts can be gamed. A 200-install “official” is a smell. A 10-million-install clone has also existed. Counts are a weak clue. Publisher identity plus a bookmark to the **store listing itself** is a stronger one. Save the listing, not the search query.

iOS has a cousin: enterprise profiles and “TestFlight from a helper.” A stranger’s profile on your phone is Door 1 wearing a lab coat. No.

APK from chat

An **APK** is an Android package — an installer file. A Telegram or WhatsApp file named `Trust\_Wallet\_update.apk` is, for our purposes, malware. **Sideload** means installing from that file instead of from the store. It skips even the already-weak store checks.

There is no BSC migration that arrives as a group file. There is no Crystal Stones academy update that arrives as an APK. There is no hardware-wallet companion that must be installed from a “tech admin.” Official updates: the store listing you already used, or the maker’s site you bookmarked.

If a phone is already a playground of random APKs — battery boosters, “WhatsApp plus,” movie loaders — **do not** generate a serious seed on it. The OS may already have overlay malware. An **overlay** draws a fake window on top of a real app when you copy an address or type a seed. You think you are in Trust Wallet. You are in a form.

Keep OS updates on. Delete junk. If you cannot, use a cleaner device for anything that is not play money.

Source	Verdict	Why
Official store, correct publisher, listing you saved on a calm day	Default for a play pocket	Still not a halo, but it is the ordinary path
Store, similar name, new publisher	No	Costume
APK in WhatsApp / Telegram / “drive link”	No	Treat as malware
“TestFlight / enterprise profile” from a stranger	No	They own a gate on the phone
“Update required to keep BEP-20” as a file	No	There is no such update channel

Worked scenario. A student updates Trust Wallet from a pinned group APK because the caption said “BSC migration, old app will not send.” The app opens and asks for the seed “to resync.”

744. There is no such migration. Wallet apps can add networks without eating the seed.

745. The APK was a form. Everything that wallet ever held, and will receive, is now shared with the publisher of the file.

746. “I will just use it as a burner” is not a plan. The thief waits for the next deposit.

747. Honest next step: new seed on a **different**, cleaner device, official store listing, paper backup, test, move what remains if anything remains, retire the old words. Module 5. Not: ask the group admin who posted the APK to “help recover.”

DIAGRAM

Real app update
 store listing you already used
 publisher name you already checked
 no seed prompt on ordinary open

Fake update
 file in chat
 new publisher

```
seed prompt on first open  
"migration" story
```

```
Hardware still fails if  
phone UI says 10 USDT to a friend  
device screen says a different 0x  
and you tap confirm anyway
```

Hardware does not bless a blind tap

A hardware wallet keeps the seed in a small computer that does not browse the web. Useful. Not magic. The laptop or phone still **proposes** the transaction. If the phone is compromised, it can propose a different destination than the one you think you see in the app.

You must read the **device screen** for destination and amount. If the phone shows 10 USDT to your friend and the device shows a different `0x`, you refuse. “Hardware wallet means I can sign anything blindly” is how expensive hardware becomes an expensive yes-machine.

Cheap clones of hardware devices exist. Buy from the maker, not a random marketplace listing with a seed card already filled in. A pre-filled seed is a wallet the seller already knows.

ACADEMY NOTE This course will not name a “safe APK site.” There isn’t one for your purposes. If a device cannot use the official store, it is not a device for a savings seed. Play money on a junk phone is still play money — treat it as already shared.

If a family member already sideloaded the clone, treat their seed as leaked even if they “didn’t type it yet.” Overlay malware can catch the next paste. Rotation on a cleaner device is cheaper than a debate about whether the APK “looked official.” Official is a store listing you saved, not a feeling about an icon.

What this lesson is for

So that “I updated from the group” stops sounding like IT hygiene. Groups are not app stores. Seed prompts on first open are not migrations. Hardware screens are the authority, not the colourful UI.

Say this out loud

- A cloned app harvests the seed at the door. It does not need to hack the chain.
- An APK in chat is a no. Sideloaded is not how Trust Wallet or MetaMask honestly update.
- Serious seeds are not born on junk phones full of random installers.
- If the hardware screen and the phone UI disagree, I refuse. The device screen wins.
- A pre-filled hardware seed card is the seller’s wallet.

Next: fake explorers, fake tickets, and fake the checkout processor pages — the costumes that sit on top of the “I always check BscScan” muscle.

Lesson 3: Fake explorers, fake tickets, fake the checkout processor pages (27 min)

Fake explorers, fake tickets, fake the checkout processor pages

You trained the muscle: “check BscScan.” Attackers trained too. They built **bscscan** with an extra letter. They built ticket portals that look like Binance (still **an example of a centralised exchange**). They built “Crystal Stones KYC” pages. They built the checkout processor invoices that expire in eleven minutes.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to use an explorer without connecting a wallet, refuse a ticket link that arrived as a reply, and refuse a payment page you did not open from academy checkout.

Fake explorers

A fake explorer can show a transaction that never existed. It can show a real transaction and swap the token icon. It can show “failed — rebroadcast to finish” with a Connect Wallet button. Real BscScan does not need your keys to show a **public hash**. A hash is an id. Public data is public. “Connect to decode” is the tell.

Ad banners **on** real explorers have historically been dangerous. Ignore connect-to-unfreeze banners even on the real domain. The core pages still work without them. Your job is the address, the token contract, the method, the spender — not the carnival at the edge of the page.

Bookmark the explorer on a calm day. Paste the hash. Do not connect. If you need token-approval pages later, you will open them from **that same bookmarked host**, not from an ad that says “revoke now.”

Fake tickets

You complain in public: “withdrawal stuck.” A link arrives: `secure-ticket.binance-support.help`. It wants login plus 2FA. That is Door 2, gift-wrapped as customer care.

Official support starts **inside** the bookmarked app or site. You open it. You create the ticket. You do not start from a reply-guy under your tweet, a WhatsApp number, or a “security desk” that DMed first. Display names are costumes. Blue ticks in one app are not a court in another.

Fake the checkout processor and fake academy billing

Paid tracks in this academy, when they are live, checkout as **USDT on BEP-20 via the published academy checkout**. Not Crystal Stones token. Not PaynovaX. Not a personal wallet. The path starts on the **bookmarked academy site**.

A PDF invoice in email, a WhatsApp message with a QR, a “your certificate is on hold, pay 40 USDT,” a page that looks like the checkout processor but whose host is `nowpayments.com` — those are phishing surfaces. If you did not click Checkout in the official app, you do not owe that invoice. There is no academy staff who will hurry you in a DM because a payment “will expire and your progress will reset.”

Fake Crystal Stones sites belong here too. A clone with a claim button, a “new contract,” or a mining dashboard that needs an approve to **view** is Door 3 in a crystal skin. The contract to verify remains

`0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00`. Verify on bookmarked BscScan. Do not verify on the clone's own explorer widget.

Real	Fake
Bookmarked BscScan, paste hash, no connect	Connect to view a public hash; “rebroadcast”; unfreeze banner
In-app exchange support you opened	Login portal from a reply-guy
Academy dashboard progress and platform certificates	Mint-your-cert dApp, WhatsApp the checkout processor invoice
Checkout you started in the bookmarked app	Invoice that arrived as a file, a QR, or a countdown

Worked scenario. Tunde pastes a real hash into a fake explorer from a Google ad because the page said the real BscScan was “congested.” The fake page says the transaction failed and a button will “re-broadcast if you sign.” He signs a permit. USDT leaves.

748. The real BscScan, opened from his bookmark, already showed success. He paid a tax on not using the bookmark.

749. “Re-broadcast” is not a thing you owe a stranger. If a transaction is genuinely stuck, that is a nonce / gas story on a real wallet, later, calmly — not a signature on an ad.

750. He writes the drain hash in a notebook. He does not send it to a wizard who appeared under the same ad.

751. He checks approvals from the bookmarked explorer's own tools, after he can breathe.

DIAGRAM

Need to check a hash

--> bookmark explorer, paste hash, no connect

Need support

--> you open the bookmarked app, you start the ticket

Need to pay this academy

--> you start checkout in the bookmarked academy site

--> USDT BEP-20 / the checkout processor when that is live

Never

--> ad, connect, rebroadcast, unfreeze

--> WhatsApp invoice, PDF, countdown

ACADEMY NOTE If a page needs your wallet to *show you* a public fact, it is not an explorer. If a page needs your seed to *show you* a ticket, it is not support. If a page needs a personal-wallet payment to *show you* a certificate, it is not this academy.

Fake the checkout processor pages often copy the logo and the countdown and change one letter in the host. If you did start checkout in the academy app, you still compare the host to what the app opened — not to a screenshot a “billing desk” sent after. A second invoice for the same course is a costume. One published checkout is enough.

What this lesson is for

So the muscles you built — “check the explorer,” “open a ticket,” “pay tuition” — do not get stolen by costumes of themselves. Same jobs. Official doors only.

Say this out loud

- Explorers do not need keys to show public data. Connect-to-view is a fake-explorer move.
- Ticket links in DMs are Door 2. I start support from a bookmark.
- Academy checkout is published, USDT BEP-20, not a WhatsApp the checkout processor QR.
- Banners that unfreeze or rebroadcast are drains, even on a real domain’s ad slot.
- A Crystal Stones clone with a new contract is a clone. I verify on bookmarked BscScan.

Next: QR codes, clipboard malware, and paste attacks — when your eyes read a sticker and your phone reads different bytes.

Lesson 4: QR codes, clipboard malware, and paste attacks (26 min)

QR codes, clipboard malware, and paste attacks

Your eyes read stickers, captions, and the first six characters of an ``0x``. Your phone reads bytes. Attackers use the gap. This is Door 4 dressing a Door 1-adjacent failure: you still signed. You signed the wrong destination.

By the end of this lesson you should check a decoded address in text, check middle characters after a paste, and refuse to copy a lookalike from dust in your history.

QR codes

A **QR code** is a picture of data. A poster, a “invoice,” a conference badge, a WhatsApp image, a the checkout processor lookalike. The caption can show the project’s known prefix. The QR can encode a different address.

Read the decoded ``0x`` in your wallet before sending. If the wallet cannot show the destination in text, do not send serious value. A test send is still allowed after you read the text — not instead of reading it.

Event QR is a favourite because you are standing up, someone is waiting, and pride does not want to be the person who decodes. Be that person. Merchants who are honest will wait for a test. Merchants who will not wait were not going to give you the goods anyway.

Clipboard malware

You copy an address. Something on the device swaps it for a **vanity twin** — an address whose first and last characters look like yours or like your contact’s. You paste, glance at the ends, and send.

Defence: check **middle** characters, not only the prefix and suffix. Check on a second line of the UI. If you use hardware, the device screen is the authority. A second device’s wallet receive screen is a useful cross-check for savings-size sends.

If the clipboard keeps changing `0x` strings by itself, stop using that OS user account for funds. Treat the device as dirty. If you typed a seed on it, treat Door 1 as maybe-open. Rotate on a clean device. Do not “scan for viruses” via an APK a group drops. That is the same lesson as Module 2’s last one, wearing a helper hat.

Address poisoning

Address poisoning is dust incoming from an address that looks like one you used before. Later you copy **that** lookalike from the transaction history, because history is easier than opening a contact. You send the real payment to the poisoner.

Defence: copy from contacts / bookmarked receive screens / a notebook you wrote on a calm day, not from a random incoming dust transaction. Hide junk tokens. Do not treat inbound dust as a convenient address book.

Paste attacks also include: a helper who pastes “their” address into your chat, then edits the message; a PDF invoice whose visible number does not match the copyable field; a group admin who posts an address, then a second account posts a “correction.” Copy once from a source you already trusted, then check middles, then test.

Trick	What you think you sent	Defence
QR caption does not match payload	The caption’s address	Read decoded destination in the wallet, then test
Clipboard swap to a vanity twin	Your contact (ends match)	Middle digits + hardware or second device
Poison dust in history	An address you “used before”	Never copy from mystery inners; use contacts
Edited chat message	The first paste	Re-check middles at send time

Worked scenario. Ngozi pays a merchant QR at a campus event. The poster shows a Crystal Stones community prefix she recognises. Her wallet decodes a different address.

752. She does not send the rest of the week’s stall money.
753. She sends a test of play size. The test lands in an unknown wallet on bookmarked BscScan.
754. She does not send the rest. She does not argue with the stall about “the chain.” She leaves.
755. The test fee was tuition. Pride would have sent the rest. Pride is not a threat model.

DIAGRAM



You read middles, not only ends

|

v

Test send --> bookmark explorer agrees --> then the rest, if ever

ACADEMY NOTE If clipboard malware is in the room, “I will paste more carefully” is not a full fix. A dirty OS plus a typed seed is a rotation event. Cleaning theatre (random APK scanners, “optimizer” apps) is how Door 1 gets a second form. New hot wallet on a clean device if the words may have been seen.

For savings-size sends, a second device showing the receive screen is not paranoia. It is how you notice a clipboard swap before the explorer does. Pride that refuses a test send at a stall is more expensive than the stall’s impatience. Honest merchants wait. Dishonest ones needed you hurried.

What this lesson is for

So that your eyes stop being the only parser. Captions lie. Ends of addresses are a costume. Middles, decoded text, test sends, and hardware screens are the actual tools. If a stall will not wait for a test, you did not lose a customer relationship. You avoided a gift you would have called a payment.

Say this out loud

- QR captions can lie. I read the decoded destination in the wallet.
- Clipboard malware is why middle characters matter, not only the first and last.
- Poison dust is bait for my copy-paste. I copy from contacts, not from mystery inners.
- If the clipboard rewrites addresses, I treat the device as dirty.
- A test send is cheaper than pride.

If a QR and a caption disagree, you already have the whole lesson. You do not need to diagnose malware. You need to not send the rest. The stall can wait. Your rent cannot come back from a wrong 0x.

Next: the panic-day procedure — a script you can run when a banner says you have ten minutes and your hands are already shaking.

Lesson 5: The panic-day procedure (stop, disconnect, official bookmarks only) (26 min)

The panic-day procedure (stop, disconnect, official bookmarks only)

When a screen says “your funds will be lost in 10 minutes,” that timer is a **prop**. Thieves need your cortisol. Chains do not confiscate for ignoring a banner. This academy does not run a confiscation clock. Exchanges do not unsuspend accounts because you typed an OTP into Telegram.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to run a short procedure from memory: stop, reject, bookmarks only, name the door, and not search the error into ads.

The procedure

756. **Put the phone down.** You have time. Stand up if you can. Twenty minutes of nothing is cheaper than twenty seconds of a permit.

757. If a popup is open in a wallet, **Reject**. Reject is a complete sentence. You do not need to finish reading a hex blob to reject it.
758. Close the suspicious tab. Disconnect the wallet from *your wallet app's* connected-sites list if you know how, on a bookmarked app — not on the fake site's Disconnect button.
759. Open only **bookmarks** you saved on a calm day: academy, exchange, explorer, wallet vendor store listing. If you have no bookmark for this job, the answer is wait, not search.
760. **Name the door:** device, account, chain permission, human. Naming picks the next module's fix. Guessing picks a helper DM.
761. If you already signed something, go to Module 5 (first hour) — not to a helper DM, not to a group with "I got hacked." Impersonators are faster than friends.
762. Do not search the error message in Google and tap ads. Error messages are advertised against. "Nonce too high," "execution reverted," "approval expired" are hunting queries.

If you already typed a seed in the last ten minutes, this procedure is not enough. Skip to Module 5 rotation. Reject and bookmarks will not unsay words a form already collected. The phone down still helps — so you do not type them a second time into a "confirm."

What you will feel, named so it does not surprise you

Shame. Hurry. The need to tell a group so someone competent can take the wheel. Groups in that minute attract impersonators. If you must talk, talk to a human you already know **offline**, and still do not read them the seed, the OTP, or the backup codes.

Anger at yourself is a Door 4 opening. People sign the second thing because they want the first mistake to have been "not that bad." It can wait. Remaining funds first. Story later.

Urge	Replacement
Google the error + tap an ad	Bookmark docs, or wait
DM the admin who just appeared	No. Offline human if needed, still no seed
Send again to "unstick"	Explorer first, from a bookmark
Type seed into a reset / migration	Never
Pay a small unlock fee	Never
Install the APK the group dropped	Never
Share screen with a helper	Never

Worked scenario. A banner: "Your USDT approval is expired. Renew in 8 minutes or lose the airdrop. Crystal Stones official." The logo is correct-looking. The domain is not in her bookmarks.

763. She rejects the popup. She puts the phone down. She walks to the kitchen.
764. Later she opens bookmarked BscScan. There is no such approval. There is no such airdrop on the contract she already verified, if she holds it at all: `0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00`.
765. The airdrop was fake. The timer was a prop. Cortisol was the product.
766. She does not go back to the banner site to "disconnect." She does not ask the fan group. She adds nothing to her bookmarks from that domain.

That is a successful panic day: nothing signed, nothing sent, nothing explained to strangers.

DIAGRAM



ACADEMY NOTE There is no on-chain airdrop that requires a seed typed into a website. There is no academy timer that confiscates a wallet. There is no honest “verify by sending USDT.” Those three sentences are enough for most banners. If a real system needs you, it will still need you after you have opened a bookmark.

Disconnect, said carefully

Disconnect means: stop talking to the hostile site. In the wallet app, remove the site from connected sites if the UI exists. On the chain, disconnect does **not** revoke an approval. People confuse the two because the words sound related. Module 4 is revoke. Today: do not return to the fake site to click its Disconnect as if that were a spell.

If you are not sure whether you signed, assume you might have. Check the explorer. Check approvals when you are calm. Do not check by reconnecting to the same host “to see.”

What this lesson is for

So that hurry has a script. Scripts beat slogans. You will not become a calmer person in ten minutes. You can become a person with seven steps. If you freeze and cannot remember seven, remember three: reject, phone down, bookmarks only. The rest of the list will still be here when your hands work.

Say this out loud

- Timers on banners are props. Chains do not confiscate for ignoring them.
- Reject, phone down, bookmarks only, name the door.
- I do not search errors into ads. I do not finish a process in a DM.
- Shame is not a reason to open Door 1.
- Fake-site Disconnect does not unload a spender. Revoke is a different job, later, from a bookmark.

If you remember only one panic-day picture, make it this: the timer is theatre, the bookmark is the door, the group is a hunting ground. Twenty minutes of nothing is a successful defence.

Next: email, SMS, WhatsApp, and Telegram — the pipes that deliver every fake surface in this module.

Lesson 6: Email, SMS, WhatsApp, and Telegram as delivery pipes (27 min)

Email, SMS, WhatsApp, and Telegram as delivery pipes

The fake site, the fake APK, the fake invoice, the panic banner — they have to **arrive**. They arrive through pipes you already live in: email, SMS, WhatsApp, Telegram, sometimes X. The pipe is not the thief. The pipe is how the costume gets a face.

By the end of this lesson you should treat unsolicited money-messages as hostile by default, know what each pipe is good at stealing, and refuse the sentence “but it came from the academy group.”

Email

Email is Door 2’s favourite hallway. Password resets, “Your Binance login from a new device,” “the checkout processor invoice attached,” “Crystal Stones certificate PDF.” The logo will match. The host in the button will not.

Rules that survive tired eyes:

- Open exchanges and the academy from bookmarks, not from buttons in mail.
- A reset you did not ask for is a signal to lock the account from a bookmark — not a reason to click the email’s button.
- Attachments that want macros, APKs, or “view invoice online” are Door 1 or Door 4. Delete.
- Password reuse is how a leaked shopping site becomes an exchange session. Unique passwords. A password manager is boring and adult.

SMS

SMS is weak 2FA and a strong panic channel. “Your USDT will be frozen, visit ...” is not a bank and not an exchange. **SIM-swap** is when someone moves your number to a SIM they hold, then intercepts OTPs.

Defence: do not use SMS as the only 2FA on an exchange if the product offers an authenticator app. Keep the mobile operator’s real shop number written on paper. If swap is in progress, you call **that** number, not a number a text just sent.

SMS that names Crystal Stones, BscScan, or the checkout processor is not from us. We do not collect your phone number in this course to text you invoices.

WhatsApp

WhatsApp is the Nigerian and many-country default for “someone I might know.” Display names are costumes. Forwarded status images are costumes. Voice notes can be cloned badly and still work on a hurried listener.

Typical payloads: fake jobs, fake mentors, P2P “I have paid, here is the receipt,” the checkout processor QRs, APKs, “your cousin’s new number,” a listing team. Official contact with this academy does not start as a cold WhatsApp. If a family member’s number asks for a seed, call them on a number you already had — voice, not the chat that just arrived.

P2P belongs here because it is a pipe problem as much as an exchange problem: a receipt is a picture. Pictures are not settlement. Settlement is the exchange's own paid-status, or the chain's own explorer, from a bookmark.

Telegram (and “the academy group”)

Telegram is where fan groups, fake admins, airdrop bots, and recovery specialists live in a pile. A **verified** mark inside Telegram is not a court. Anyone can be “Crystal Stones Admin” in a group you do not control.

This academy's classroom is the LMS you enrolled on. A public Telegram room — even a useful one — is not staff, not Mentor, not support, not a listing desk. Admins in fan groups cannot unsuspend a wallet. Bots that ask you to “verify” are Door 1 or Door 3. Mute, leave, bookmark the real site.

If you run a group, you are a target for hijack (loot type: audience). Guard admin rights. Never let a stranger “help moderate” with full rights. Never post a seed “as an example.”

Pipe	What it is good at	Adult default
Email	Fake resets, fake invoices, malware attachments	Bookmark, don't click; unique passwords
SMS	Panic links, OTP theft via SIM-swap	Authenticator over SMS; operator number on paper
WhatsApp	Costume of family, P2P receipts, APKs, mentor DMs	Call known numbers; receipts are not settlement
Telegram	Fake admins, bots, airdrops, recovery theatre	Fan groups are not staff; verify-bots are no

Worked scenario. Ife's phone gets three messages in an hour: an SMS “BNB Smart Chain freeze, click to appeal”; a WhatsApp “Crystal Mentor” with a the checkout processor QR; a Telegram bot in a fan group, “verify wallet to keep CST airdrop.”

767. She names them as pipes, not as institutions. None of the three is the chain, the academy, or an exchange.
768. She does not click. She opens bookmarked academy, bookmarked exchange, bookmarked explorer. Nothing is frozen. Nothing is owed.
769. The WhatsApp QR is a personal address. “Verify by sending USDT” is on the never-list.
770. She does not warn the Telegram group with her remaining wallet address in the post. She may warn with the **domain** and the **bot name**. Remaining funds are not a public trophy.

DIAGRAM

```

Pipes:  email, SMS, WhatsApp, Telegram, ads, X replies
  |
  v
Costume arrives (logo, timer, invoice, APK, bot)
  |
  v
You start from a bookmark, or you do nothing
  |
  X You start from the pipe

```

ACADEMY NOTE Being friendly on WhatsApp is allowed. Being available for seed-collection is not. You can reply “I will only continue inside the academy site I bookmarked” and then actually go there. If they cannot follow, they were never staff. Silence is also a complete answer.

X (Twitter) replies belong in the same family as Telegram: a logo under a pain post is a job. Mute, bookmark, official ticket. Do not argue the badge. Badges are cheaper than USDT. If you run a public account, say once in the bio that you will never DM a seed request or a recovery — then still assume clones will ignore the bio. The bio is for your actual audience, not for the costume.

What this lesson is for

So that the delivery channel stops borrowing trust from the rest of your life. Family-shaped WhatsApp, bank-shaped SMS, academy-shaped Telegram — same refuse-line. Bookmark or nothing.

Say this out loud

- Pipes deliver costumes. They do not become the academy, the exchange, or the chain.
- I do not click resets, invoices, or freeze appeals from mail or SMS. I open a bookmark.
- SMS 2FA can die in a SIM-swap. Authenticator plus paper backup codes is the adult pair.
- WhatsApp receipts are pictures. Fan-group admins are not staff. Verify-bots are a no.
- I can refuse in one sentence, or I can be silent. I do not need to win the chat.

Take the quiz. Module 3: people scams — giveaways, impersonation, jobs, romance, recovery specialists, and the last train.

Module quiz (answers included for editors)

Q1. Ada googles “BscScan Crystal Stones,” taps the first result, and the padlock is showing. What is true?

- A. HTTPS means the site is the real BscScan
- B. The connection is encrypted to that host — the host may still be a thief, and ads are not navigation
- C. The padlock means approvals she signs there cannot drain USDT
- D. She should type her seed because the padlock encrypts the words

Correct answer: B

Q2. A Telegram file named Trust_Wallet_update.apk is?

- A. The preferred official Trust Wallet channel for BSC migrations
- B. To be treated as malware — sideloading a chat APK is Door 1
- C. Required for BEP-20 tokens to keep sending
- D. How 2FA backup codes are installed

Correct answer: B

Q3. Real BscScan needs your wallet connected to show a public transaction hash?

- A. Always — that is how decoding works
- B. No — connect-to-view is a fake-explorer move

- C. Only on Sundays when validators rest
- D. Only for the Crystal Stones contract

Correct answer: B

Q4. A WhatsApp “invoice” with a the checkout processor lookalike QR arrives, but Ife did not click Checkout in the bookmarked academy app. She should?

- A. Pay quickly — academy invoices expire and reset progress
- B. Treat it as fake billing — real checkout starts on the bookmarked site, USDT BEP-20, not a DM
- C. Send a smaller USDT test to verify the QR, then the rest
- D. Paste her seed so the checkout processor can attach the course

Correct answer: B

Q5. Address poisoning relies on?

- A. Breaking hash functions on BNB Smart Chain
- B. You copying a lookalike address from dust in your history
- C. Chain ID 56 collapsing
- D. KYC files leaking from this academy

Correct answer: B

Q6. If a hardware device screen and the phone UI disagree on destination, Tunde should?

- A. Trust the phone, it is newer
- B. Refuse — the device screen is the authority
- C. Type the seed to resync the device
- D. Average the two addresses and send half to each

Correct answer: B

Q7. A banner countdown “10 minutes or funds lost” is?

- A. On-chain protocol law
- B. A cortisol prop — reject, use bookmarks, do not search the error into ads
- C. How nonce works on BSC
- D. BNB validator policy for Crystal Stones holders

Correct answer: B

Q8. After connecting on a maybe-fake site, the honest next step is?

- A. Use that site’s Disconnect button as sufficient
- B. Assume Door 3 may be open and check or revoke approvals later from a known bookmarked tool — do not re-enter a seed
- C. Re-enter the seed to clear the cache, as support needs the seed to help
- D. Disable 2FA so sessions cannot be stolen

Correct answer: B

Module 3: People scams

Giveaways and doubling, impersonation of founders and academy staff, jobs and romance long cons, recovery specialists and screen share, VIP last-train pressure, and pig-butcherer folklore named calmly.

Lesson 1: Giveaways, doubling, and “send 1 get 2” (26 min)

Giveaways, doubling, and “send 1 get 2”

If a stranger asks you to **send first** to receive more, you are the donor. The chain will record a gift. It will not record a contract you thought you had. There is no parent to call.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to name a send-first bonus as a donation, refuse a “whitelist snapshot” that wants a transfer, and not send a second time to “unlock” the first.

Why it still works

It copies a real pattern. Companies run promotions. Networks run **airdrops** — unsolicited token distributions — sometimes honestly, often as bait (Module 4). The honest versions, when they exist, do not need you to fund a “verification wallet.” They do not need a seed. They do not need you to pay gas to a helper.

The scam adds a payment. The payment is the scam. Screenshots of “last ten winners” are recycled. Telegram badges are self-awarded. A countdown is a prop. Live video of a “founder” can be a costume or a deepfake; you still do not send first.

People send because the amount looks small (“it’s only 1 USDT”) and because refusing feels like leaving money on the table. Practice-amount rules still apply: small is how they train the yes. After the yes, the number grows.

Crystal Stones flavour, said without a buy order

“Send CST to this address to whitelist for the snapshot.” “Double CST for 30 minutes, official.” “Gas fee to this helper so the airdrop can land.” Unless you independently verify a **slow, public** process on channels you already trusted *before* the message — bookmarked site, not a new contract in a DM — this is Door 4 plus Door 4’s invoice.

The contract to verify, if you are looking at Crystal Stones at all, remains:

```
`0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00`
```

A doubling address is not that contract. A “new CST” with a similar name is a clone. This academy will not tell you a snapshot is coming. Anyone who knows a snapshot “from inside the academy” and needs your send is not inside the academy.

What the explorer will show, and what it will not

BscScan (bookmarked) will show many incoming transfers to one ordinary address — an **EOA**, an externally owned account, a person-shaped wallet, not a published programme with rules you can read. It will not show outgoing doubles of any honest size. The book is public. The hope was not.

You cannot “report to the chain” to reverse this. You can warn others with the destination address and the domain. You must not chase with a second send to “unlock the first.” Unlock is the same script in a second costume. You must not send leftover dust to a recovery specialist who appeared in the same group. That is Module 5’s second predator.

Promise	Reality	Door
Send 1 BNB, get 2	You send 1, they send 0	Human, then a send
Pay gas to this helper	They take the gas	Human, then a send
Last 10 winners, screenshotted	Recycled images	Human
Verified badge in Telegram	Self-awarded costume	Human
“Whitelist for snapshot, send CST”	Donation unless a slow public process you already trusted	Human
“Send again, first tx is stuck”	Second donation	Human, panic

Worked scenario. An X account cloned the project, same avatar, extra underscore. “Double CST for 30 minutes.” Three students in a WhatsApp stall-owners group send 20 USDT each because “it’s a small test.”

- 771. Bookmarked BscScan shows many incoming transfers to one EOA, no outgoing doubles of 40.
- 772. The book agrees they donated. Agreement is not comfort. It is clarity.
- 773. One student wants to send a fourth payment “because maybe the minimum was 50.” That is the trained yes, growing. The others stop him with this lesson, not with a whitepaper.
- 774. They warn the stall group with the fake handle and the destination, not with their remaining addresses. They do not open a bounty in DMs.

DIAGRAM

```

Send-first giveaway
  |
  v
Their ordinary address (EOA)
  |
  v
They leave
  |
  v
Explorer agrees you donated
  
```

There is no second send that unlocks the first.
There is no chain ticket that reverses a valid gift.

ACADEMY NOTE Charity is allowed. You may give. Call it a gift so your head stays honest. What is not allowed in this academy’s classroom is mistaking a gift for a contract, a doubling, a whitelist, or a validator reward. BNB validators are not paying you 2-for-1 in a DM.

Live video does not change the rule. A founder-shaped face on a stream can still be a costume or a deepfake, and even a real person can be impersonated in the replies under the stream. You still do not send first. You still verify a contract on a bookmark. The stream is Door 4 with better lighting.

What this lesson is for

So that “small, official, hurry” stops looking like a promotion. Send-first is the whole tell. You do not need a forensic lab. You need the refusal. If a group calls you a tourist for refusing, they priced your USDT as an entry ticket. You can be a tourist who still has rent.

Say this out loud

- Send-first bonuses are donations. The explorer will agree I donated.
- Badges in chats are not courts. Recycled winner screenshots are not audits.
- I do not send a second time to unlock the first.
- Crystal Stones snapshots, if they ever existed in public, would not start as a DM that needs my USDT.
- I can warn others with a domain and a destination. I do not post my remaining address as a trophy.

If you already sent, do not send again to “complete the bonus.” The explorer will not sprout a refund because you were polite the second time. Warn with the destination. Keep the rest.

Next: impersonation — founders, this academy, exchange support, and a “Crystal Mentor” who DMed first.

Lesson 2: Impersonation: founders, academy, exchange support, “Crystal Mentor” (27 min)

Impersonation: founders, academy, exchange support, “Crystal Mentor”

The account looks like someone you already trust. That is the entire trick. They do not need a new story. They need a used face.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to say how official contact actually starts, why pain in public is bait, and which test real staff will pass: they will leave WhatsApp for the bookmarked app.

Where they sit

- replies under a real post (you think the founder replied)
- DMs after you comment “withdrawal stuck” or “seed help”
- WhatsApp using a similar display name and the academy crystal
- “Crystal Stones Academy Mentor” with a star they bought
- a cloned X or Telegram handle with an extra underscore, extra letter, or extra “official”
- a “Binance support” desk that arrived as a reply — Binance remaining **an example of a centralised exchange**, not the only desk that gets cloned

They will have the logo. They will have tone. They will have a case number. Case numbers are free.

How official contact actually starts

You messaged **them** first from a bookmark, or you already have an in-app thread that started **inside** the product. You never rely on a display name alone. You never rely on a “verified” mark inside Telegram. You never rely on a PDF ID. You never rely on “I can see your user id, prove you are you by sending 2FA.”

Academy: you logged into the bookmarked app. Mentor is in-app. Staff who cannot finish a security conversation there are not staff.

Exchange support: you opened a ticket in the bookmarked app. Real desks do not start in a DM after you tweeted pain. They may email from an address you can check **after** you open the bookmarked site, not before.

Project news: channels you saved before the drama, cross-checked against the bookmarked site. A new “founder” live-stream with a claim link is drama, not news.

What impersonators ask (all four doors)

Seeds and “sync phrases” (Door 1). 2FA, OTPs, “confirm this login” (Door 2). A new contract to add, a connect-and-sign (Door 3). A small verifying payment, a screen share, a the checkout processor QR, “the academy is late, use this checkout” (Door 4).

The refuse-line does not change with the costume. Compare the ask to the never-list from Module 1. First list: no. You do not need to authenticate the stranger. You need to refuse the ask.

A useful test you can say out loud: “I will continue inside the bookmarked app.” If they cannot follow, the conversation is over. If they get angry, that anger is data. Official desks do not need your cortisol. Costumes do.

Channel	How official contact starts	How the costume starts
Academy	You logged into the bookmarked app	A DM, a WhatsApp, a Mentor who wants a seed
Exchange support	You opened a ticket in the bookmarked app	A reply-guy after you posted pain
Project news	Channels you saved before the drama	A new handle during the drama
Wallet vendor	Store listing / maker site you bookmarked	“Support” that needs the words to help
the checkout processor / tuition	Checkout you started in the academy site	Invoice in a chat

Worked scenario. A student tweets at an exchange because a withdrawal is pending. A reply-guy with a helpdesk logo DMs a ticket URL. The student types email, password, and an OTP. The whitelist was off. The IOU left.

775. Real support never started in that DM. Pain in public is impersonator bait. The reply is not a coincidence. It is a job.

776. Door 2 opened. The fix is the parent’s security page from a bookmark: kill sessions, rotate password, rotate 2FA, check recent withdrawals. Not a second ticket from a second reply-guy.

777. If anything remains, whitelist goes on. The delay that annoyed them last month is the delay that would have saved the IOU.

778. They do not post “I got hacked, who can help?” next. That post is a dinner bell.

DIAGRAM

```

You posted pain
  |
  v
Many logos appear
  |
  v
Official path is still: you open the bookmark
  |
X  you open the DM
X  you send 2FA
X  you "verify by sending USDT"
```

ACADEMY NOTE Staff of this academy should be willing to say: “I will not finish this in WhatsApp. Open the site.” If “staff” refuses to leave WhatsApp, they are not staff. If “Crystal Mentor” needs a seed to sync, it is not Mentor. If “listing team” needs a personal send, it is not a listing team. Use the test. Do not use a debate.

Voice notes and “I am in a meeting, just send the OTP” are still Door 2. Familiar audio is cheaper than it used to be. Call a number you already had. If you cannot, you wait. An OTP expires. A stolen session lasts until you kill it.

What this lesson is for

So that familiarity stops being evidence. Faces are cheap. Official paths are narrow on purpose. Narrow is how you stay solvent. If a founder-shaped account DMs first, you do not owe them a reply that keeps Door 4 open. Bookmark or nothing is still the whole test.

Say this out loud

- Display names are costumes. Verified ticks in a chat app are not courts.
- Official contact starts from a bookmark I already had, or from a thread I started inside the product.
- Pain in public is impersonator bait. I do not finish support in the reply.
- Real staff will leave WhatsApp for the official app. If they will not, they are not staff.
- I do not send 2FA, seeds, or USDT to a desk that DMed first.

Speed after you posted pain is not customer care. It is a job. The official desk is still the bookmark you already had, even if twenty logos arrived first.

Next: jobs, tasks, romance, and long cons — the scams that take weeks and pay a small withdrawal first so you will fund the large one.

Lesson 3: Jobs, tasks, romance, and long cons (27 min)

Jobs, tasks, romance, and long cons

Not every scam is a 30-second phish. Some take weeks. They pay a small withdrawal so you will fund a large one. They use unemployment, loneliness, and the wish to be competent. Naming the script is not mockery. It is how you step off it.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to refuse a task mill, refuse a secret earnings partnership, and treat a lover who is also your broker as a script — not as a special exception because the voice notes felt real.

Task mills and “crypto jobs”

“We deposit, you trade, you keep a cut.” “Complete 20 tasks, withdraw at the end.” “HR hired you to test a Crystal Stones earnings dApp — don’t tell the academy, it is a secret partnership.”

Early withdrawals sometimes **work**. That is the bait. The large withdrawal is blocked until you pay a tax, a fee, an “AML unfreeze,” a “gas top-up,” a “tier upgrade.” You are funding them. The painted numbers on the private website are not BscScan.

There is also **mule** risk. If real stolen USDT moved through your KYC-facing account, your name is on a pipe. “I was only doing tasks” is not a shield you want to test. Refuse the job. Do not forward other people’s coins for a cut.

A real employer who needs you to hold keys, install an APK, or share a screen on day one is not a real employer. Real work can wait for a contract you can read, on a domain you can bookmark, without a seed.

Romance as a door, before the next lesson’s folklore

A new friend. Patient. Not asking for money at first. Then a “safe platform” they will teach you. Then a withdrawal that needs one more deposit. The patience is the product. It is Door 4 with a calendar.

You do not owe a stranger your broker slot because they listened. You do not owe a voice note a USDT transfer. If a romance is also your only trading desk, you do not have a romance. The next lesson names **pig butchering** as the wider folklore. Today: the job/task/lover cluster is one family. Small out, large in.

Secret partnerships with this academy

There are none that need your silence and your deposit. Intermediate and Advanced, when you choose them, are published tracks with published checkout. There is no underground Crystal Stones earnings dApp that staff will deny in public and confirm in WhatsApp. “Don’t tell the academy” is a complete tell. You can refuse without a whitepaper.

Pattern	Early feeling	The invoice	Adult move
Task mill	Small withdraw works; you feel hired	Tax / AML / tier to take the large amount	Stop depositing; do not pay the tax
Secret “test the dApp” job	Chosen, insider	Approve or send	Secrets + earnings + do-not-tell = no
Romance-broker	Patience, flattery	Private painted platform	Lover who is also broker is

			a script
Guaranteed club (preview)	Community	Recruit or deposit more	Guarantees are a tell; next lessons

Worked scenario. A “HR manager” on WhatsApp hires a student to “test a Crystal Stones earnings dApp.” Pay is in CST. The student must not tell the academy. After three small “withdrawals” that actually arrive, a 400 USDT cash-out is frozen until a 60 USDT AML fee.

779. Secrets + earnings + do-not-tell was enough on day one. The small withdrawals were bait, not proof of a job.
780. Paying 60 USDT is a second donation, not a tax to a regulator. Regulators do not collect AML fees to a personal BEP-20 address in a chat.
781. The student stops. They do not recruit a cousin to “help complete the tasks.” Recruiting is how task mills become community.
782. If any of their own funds remain on the painted site, those funds were never on a chain they control. Chasing them is how the rest follows. Module 5.

DIAGRAM

```

Kindness / job / crush
    |
    v
Private platform or task mill
    |
    v
Small withdrawal works    <-- bait
    |
    v
Large one needs a fee    <-- the point
    |
    v
Stop. Do not pay. Do not recruit.

```

ACADEMY NOTE We are not mocking loneliness or unemployment. We are naming the script. If you are already in it, stop depositing, do not pay unfreeze taxes, talk to someone offline you already knew. Module 5 is incident response, not shame. Police recovery is not promised. Leftover dust is not a tracing fee.

A painted withdrawal that “needs 24 hours” is still a switch. A job that needs your KYC-facing exchange to receive “client USDT” is mule work even if the HR voice is kind. Kindness is cheap. Your name on a stolen pipe is not. If a recruiter says the academy secretly runs the desk, open the bookmarked LMS. If it is not published there, it is not a partnership. It is this module using our crystal as a prop.

What this lesson is for

So that a small success stops being evidence. Scammers can afford a 20 USDT withdrawal. They cannot afford you walking away before the invoice. Walking away is the skill. If HR wants your silence, that silence is the product. A real job can survive a bookmark. A funnel cannot.

Say this out loud

- Early small withdrawals can be bait. They are not an audit of a job.
- A lover who is also my broker is a script. Patience is part of the product.
- “Don’t tell the academy” plus earnings is a no, without a whitepaper.
- AML unfreeze fees to a chat address are donations. I do not pay them.
- I will not forward other people’s coins for a cut. That can make my KYC a mule pipe.

If a small withdrawal already arrived, that is not proof you should pay a tax. That is proof they can afford bait. Stop. Offline human. No recruit.

Next: admins, recovery specialists, and screen share — the second predator who arrives after you are already hurt.

Lesson 4: Admins, recovery specialists, and screen share (26 min)

Admins, recovery specialists, and screen share

When you are already hurt, a second predator arrives selling **recovery**. They watched the group. They can be in your DMs ninety seconds after you type “I got hacked.” Speed is not competence. Speed is a hunting pattern.

By the end of this lesson you should refuse recovery-for-seed, refuse a verify-bot, refuse screen share on a funded device, and treat leftover dust as bait, not as a tracing fee.

Recovery specialists

“I work with the FBI / EFCC / Binance / BSC validators. Pay 2 BNB, I trace.” Tracing public transactions is something **you** can do on bookmarked BscScan. Paying them is a second donation.

Anyone who needs a seed to “trace” is the thief. Anyone who needs you to send leftover dust “so the trace can attach” is the thief. Anyone who needs remote control “to freeze the destination” is the thief.

Validators do not run a consumer helpdesk that unsends a valid transfer. This academy will never DM you a recovery agent.

Law enforcement, if you use them, is a local process with a real office — not a Telegram handle, not a WhatsApp voice note, not a person who already knows your loss because they live in the same group. We will not pretend every stolen 20 USDT will be recovered. We will pretend 0% of seed-sharing recoveries are honest.

Group admins and verify-bots

They mute you unless you “verify wallet.” They drop a bot. The bot wants a seed or a connect-and-approve. Real moderation does not need keys. Real moderation does not need unlimited USDT allowance to “prove you are human.”

If you are an admin, the pressure to “just add a verify bot” will come from a helper. That helper wants the room. Guard admin rights. Do not install mystery bots. Do not pin APKs.

If you were muted until you connected, leave the group. Muting is not a court. A community that cannot moderate without keys is not a community you owe a gun to. Take the bookmark you already had. Leave the bot.

Screen share

AnyDesk, TeamViewer, “Google Meet, share the phone,” “I will drive, you watch.” They will open the wallet while you look away, or they will watch 2FA, or they will paste a destination you will confirm because a competent voice is speaking. There is no academy procedure that requires remote control of a funded device. There is no nonce repair that requires it. There is no Crystal Stones listing that requires it.

If a device must be repaired, you repair it without a funded wallet on screen, or you move funds to a new wallet on a clean device first. Helpers who cannot work under that rule are not helpers.

Offer	Translation	Door
Trace for a fee + seed	Theft	Device
Trace for leftover dust	Second donation	Human + send
Admin verify-bot	Theft	Device or chain permission
Screen share to fix nonce / freeze / listing	Theft of session or keys	Device + account
“I will hold the funds and send back clean”	Theft or mule	Human
“FBI case ID, pay to open”	Costume	Human

Worked scenario. A student lost 80 USDT to a clone. A recovery admin appears in 90 seconds (they watch the group). Case ID. Photo of a badge. “Send 0.2 BNB and the remaining dust so we can attach a tracer. Also share screen, faster.”

- 783. The student pays nothing. Dust stays. Screen stays unshared. Seed stays on paper, untyped.
- 784. They open bookmarked BscScan and write the drain hash in a notebook. That is the whole “trace.”
- 785. They follow Module 5 for remaining funds if any remain. They do not follow the admin.
- 786. They are down 80 USDT. They are not down 80 USDT and 0.2 BNB and a leaked seed. The second line was optional. Optional is the lesson.

DIAGRAM

```

Loss
|
+--> official ticket / local police if it makes sense for the amount and the place
+--> bookmarked explorer, write hashes
+--> remaining funds, clean device, name the door
|
X paid recovery in chat
X seed
X dust as tracing fee
X screen share
X "hold funds and send back clean"

```

ACADEMY NOTE This academy is not a law firm and not a recovery desk. Local rules differ. We only insist you do not add a crime, a screen share, a seed paste, or a second drain to the story. Do not send leftover dust to specialists. Do not promise yourself a police reversal the chain cannot do.

If you run a group, pin this lesson instead of a verify-bot. Speed-to-help after a drain is a hunting pattern you now recognise. The pinned text can say: remaining funds, bookmarks, no seed, no screen share, no dust. That pin will not make you support staff. It will make the second predator work harder.

What this lesson is for

So that the minute after a loss is not a second loss. The first predator took a slice. The second predator takes the rest, plus the seed, plus the audience if they hijack your account while you share a screen. If you must help a friend in that minute, sit with them while they tap bookmarks. Do not drive. Driving is screen share with extra kindness.

Say this out loud

- Recovery-for-seed is theft. I can read a hash on BscScan myself.
- Leftover dust is not a tracing fee. I will not send it to a specialist.
- Screen share on a funded phone is a no. There is no academy procedure that requires it.
- Verify-bots and mute-until-you-connect are Door 1 or Door 3 in a moderator hat.
- Second predators hunt first losses. Speed in the group is a hunting pattern, not competence.

If you are the friend sitting next to the loss, you still do not drive the phone. Bookmarks, remaining funds, no seed. Kindness that takes the wheel is screen share in a softer voice.

Next: guarantees, VIP rooms, and “the last train” — pressure language that should make you walk without a debate.

Lesson 5: Guarantees, VIP rooms, and “the last train” (26 min)

Guarantees, VIP rooms, and “the last train”

Pressure language is Door 4 in a tuxedo. It does not need a fake domain if it can make you skip the domain check. It does not need a seed box if it can make you send.

By the end of this lesson you should treat “guaranteed,” “last train,” “VIP after you recruit,” and “secret official contract” as walk-away phrases — not as a research assignment you must finish in eleven minutes.

Words that fail the adult test

- guaranteed 10% a day, guaranteed listing, guaranteed recovery
- risk-free, insured by the chain, insured by the academy
- last train / closing in 11 minutes / snapshot in 8 minutes
- secret listing, send now, the academy is late, use this contract
- VIP room after you recruit three people
- “this is how the rich enter; Basic is for tourists”

Markets, if you ever meet them in Intermediate, do not talk like this. Criminal funnels do. A **guarantee** is a promise that physics and counterparties have been suspended for you. Adults hear a tell. Beginners hear a relief.

You do not need a whitepaper to refuse. Refusal is allowed to be short. “No” is a complete review.

If you want to go faster, finish Basic quizzes, use Mentor **in the app** with questions about concepts, not “what coin tonight.” Speed that skips Safety is how the last train leaves with your USDT. Ambition that requires a secret contract is not ambition. It is a funnel using your hurry as fuel.

VIP rooms and recruitment

A room that requires you to bring people is a shape you already know from other decades: a pyramid with extra dashboards. Even when a token is real, a social funnel that pays you to recruit is not “community.” It is a business model that needs new deposits more than it needs your understanding.

This academy is an LMS. Progress is quizzes. Certificates are platform records. There is no VIP rail that skips Safety if you pay a handler in USDT. Speed that skips this course is how the last train leaves with your balance.

Recruitment pressure also hijacks friendships. If a lesson costs you a cousin’s rent, it was not a lesson. It was a funnel using your face (loot type: audience).

“The academy is late, use this contract”

Clone plus cortisol. The public Crystal Stones contract, as the project publishes it, is ``0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00`` on BNB Smart Chain, chain id **56**. Verify on bookmarked BscScan. A VIP room’s “new official” born forty minutes ago, liquidity unlocked, name similar, is a clone. You do not owe it a swap. This paragraph is still not a buy order for the real one.

Phrase	Adult translation	Move
Guaranteed return	They need you to believe variance is optional	Walk
Last train / 11 minutes	Cortisol prop	Walk; bookmarks still work in 20 minutes
VIP after you recruit	Pyramid shape	Walk; do not donate your cousins
Secret official contract	Clone	Bookmarked explorer, or nothing
Academy is late	Impersonation	Bookmarked LMS, or nothing
Risk-free crypto	A sentence that has never been true here	Walk

Worked scenario. A VIP room shares a BSC token born 40 minutes ago, liquidity pool unlocked, name similar to Crystal Stones. “Last train. Academy people are sleeping.” A student who finished **this** lesson opens bookmarked BscScan instead of the swap.

787. They see the age of the contract. They see a name collision. They do not need a thread of 200 messages.

788. They go offline. They do not argue in the VIP room. Argument keeps Door 4 open.

789. They do not “just try 5 USDT to see.” Practice amounts are for learning rails, not for funding clones on purpose.

790. Sunday, they still have a play pocket. Intermediate is still optional. Solvency is the whole win.

DIAGRAM

Urgency + guarantee + secret + recruit
|
v
No

You do not need a whitepaper to refuse.
You do not need to defeat the room in argument.
You need to leave the room.

ACADEMY NOTE Refusing does not make you “not ambitious.” It makes you still solvent for Intermediate. This academy will not punish you for walking out of a funnel. It will also not congratulate a clone for being fast. Fast is easy when you are stealing.

If the room is also your only “market news,” you will feel uninformed when you leave. That feeling is the product. Bookmarked BscScan, the academy LMS, and a Sunday checklist are slower news and still news. Missing a forty-minute-old clone is not a career wound. Catching it with a swap is.

What this lesson is for

So that pressure is visible as pressure. You already have panic-day steps. This is the social version: no timer, no VIP, no secret contract, no recruitment homework. If leaving a room costs you a friend, that friendship was the funnel. You can still be kind. You cannot be their downline.

Say this out loud

- Guarantees are a tell. Markets do not talk like that; funnels do.
- Last-train timers are props. If it would still be real in twenty minutes, I start from a bookmark.
- Secret official contracts are clones. I verify `0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00` on bookmarked BscScan, or I verify nothing.
- VIP-after-recruit is a pyramid shape. I will not donate my cousins.
- I can refuse without a debate. “No” is a complete review.

You do not owe the room a thread. Leaving unread is allowed. A clone will not become honest because you explained Safety to it.

Next: pig butchering and investment-club folklore — the long con named calmly, so the story is harder to run on you or on someone you love.

Lesson 6: Pig butchering and investment-club folklore, named calmly (27 min)

Pig butchering and investment-club folklore, named calmly

Pig butchering is a documented crime pattern with a cruel name. We use the name because you will meet it in news and in group chats. The idea is calm: fatten trust, then slaughter the savings. It is not a joke about victims. It is a map.

By the end of this lesson you should recognise the long-con calendar, distinguish a painted platform from a bookmarked exchange, and refuse investment-club folklore that needs your silence, your friends, and a guaranteed number.

The calendar, not the movie

Week 1–2: a wrong-number text, a comment on a post, a friendly stranger who is not in a hurry. They talk about food, work, faith, gym, children. They do not talk about USDT.

Week 3–6: competence and warmth. They have a “mentor” or they **are** learning a “safe desk.” They screen-share profits. The numbers are pretty. They still do not need your money.

Week 6+: a private website, an app from a link, a “licensed” desk you cannot find on a bookmark you already had. Small deposit. Small withdrawal **works**. Larger deposit. Withdrawal stuck. Tax, AML, upgrade, insurance, last train. Then a recovery specialist. You have met every costume in this module, in order.

The patience is expensive for them. It is cheap compared to one person’s year of work. That is why it exists.

Painted platforms versus rails you already know

A **painted platform** is a website that shows numbers. It is not BscScan. It is not the bookmarked exchange you already have an account on. Withdrawals are a switch an operator flips. When they flip it off, no explorer will help you, because your USDT may already have left to them on the first deposit.

If someone will only trade with you on a site they sent, and they become angry when you suggest a bookmarked major exchange or — better — not trading with a lover at all, you have the tell. Anger at a bookmark is not passion. It is operational security for a funnel.

Investment-club folklore sits next door: “we are twenty families, we have a desk, 8% a week, keep it quiet, bring your auntie.” Community is real. Guaranteed yield is not. Clubs that require recruitment are often pyramids. Clubs that require a painted site plus silence are often pig butchering with extra uncles.

This academy is not an investment club. Basic is rails. Intermediate, if you continue, is still education — contracts, DeFi, tokenomics — and will still refuse guaranteed profit.

Folklore	What is actually happening	What you do
Wrong-number friend who becomes your broker	Long con calendar	Do not deposit; talk offline to someone you already knew
Private app with pretty profits	Painted switch, not a public book	Demand a bookmark you already had, or walk
Small withdraw then AML tax	Bait then invoice	Stop; do not pay

Family investment club, guaranteed, recruit	Pyramid or a painted desk	Walk; do not bring auntie
“Recovery team” after the slaughter	Second predator	Module 3 lesson 4, then Module 5

Worked scenario. An auntie in Lagos has a new friend from a “wrong SMS.” After a month the friend teaches her a private app. She withdraws 30,000 naira-equivalent once. She deposits much more. Stuck. The friend introduces a recovery officer. The officer wants a seed and the remaining dust.

- 791. A niece who finished this course sits with her, not above her. Shame is how the con continues. Calm naming is how it stops.
- 792. They do not pay the recovery officer. They do not type words. They do not install the officer’s APK.
- 793. They photograph nothing of a seed. They may write hashes if any on-chain sends exist, for a local report if the family chooses. No promise that police will reverse the chain.
- 794. They warn two other family groups with the *domain* and the *script*, not with the auntie’s remaining wallet as a bounty.

DIAGRAM

```

Warmth without money
  |
  v
Private painted desk
  |
  v
Small out (bait)
  |
  v
Large in
  |
  v
Stuck + tax + recovery costume
  |
  v
Stop deposits. No seed. No dust. Offline human.

```

ACADEMY NOTE If this lesson is arriving late — if the painted site already has a number you cannot stand to lose — Module 5 is next after this module’s quiz. Saving remaining funds is not “giving up on them.” Chasing a painted withdrawal is how remaining funds join the painting. You are not owed a Hollywood ending. You are owed a clear sentence: the switch is theirs.

Investment-club folklore will borrow this academy’s name. “Crystal Stones families, 8% a week, keep it quiet.” Quiet plus a number plus recruitment is the tell, not the crystal. Teach the calendar without cruelty. Sit with the person. Do not become their new broker. Do not become their recovery officer. Become the human who names the switch.

What this lesson is for

So that a slow kindness stops looking like proof. So that you can sit with someone you love and name a calendar without cruelty. So that investment-club folklore cannot borrow this academy's crystal as a guarantee.

Say this out loud

- Pig butchering is a long-con calendar: warmth, painted desk, small out, large in, tax, fake recovery.
- A private platform a lover sent is not BscScan and not a bookmarked exchange.
- Guaranteed club yield plus recruitment is folklore I will not bring auntie into.
- I will not pay an unfreeze tax or send leftover dust to finish a slaughter.
- Shame keeps the script running. A calm name and an offline human stop the next deposit.

Take the quiz. Module 4: on-chain drains — approvals, poison tokens, permits, revoke without a second drainer, and reading the loss on BscScan.

Module quiz (answers included for editors)

Q1. A cloned X account says “send 1 BNB, get 2 BNB, official Crystal Stones.” What is this?

- A. A standard validator reward on chain id 56
- B. A donation to the receiver — send-first bonuses are gifts the explorer will record as gifts
- C. How BEP-20 reflections must work
- D. Academy tuition through academy checkout

Correct answer: B

Q2. After Ada tweets “withdrawal stuck,” a helpdesk logo DMs a ticket link. She should treat it as?

- A. Official support by default, because she is in pain and they were fast
- B. Impersonation until she started from a bookmark — pain in public is bait
- C. A BNB validator acting as customer care
- D. A required KYC partner of this academy

Correct answer: B

Q3. A new WhatsApp friend becomes her only broker on a private website. Small withdrawal worked. This is closest to?

- A. True love plus DeFi, so she should deposit more
- B. A documented long-con pattern — stop depositing; a lover who is also a broker is a script
- C. How PancakeSwap onboards new users
- D. Required for chain id 56

Correct answer: B

Q4. Task jobs that let a small withdraw work then demand an AML tax to a chat address are?

- A. Normal HR for remote crypto work

- B. Bait then invoice — do not pay; do not recruit a cousin
- C. BscScan policy for large transfers
- D. How 2FA backup codes are sold

Correct answer: B

Q5. A recovery specialist who needs her seed (or leftover dust) to trace a public hash is?

- A. The FBI / EFCC desk for BNB Smart Chain
- B. A thief — she can read the hash on bookmarked BscScan herself
- C. A BNB validator with a consumer helpdesk
- D. Crystal Stones Academy staff performing Mentor sync

Correct answer: B

Q6. Screen sharing a funded phone with a helper is?

- A. Recommended nonce repair and the only way to freeze a thief
- B. How 2FA and popups get stolen — there is no academy procedure that requires it
- C. Required to add a custom token
- D. The same as sharing a transaction hash

Correct answer: B

Q7. “Secret official Crystal Stones contract, last train 11 minutes, VIP after you recruit” is?

- A. Normal token operations for listings
- B. Clone plus cortisol plus pyramid shape — refuse without a debate
- C. How decimals upgrade on BEP-20
- D. Chain-id rotation that students must pay to join

Correct answer: B

Q8. Real academy staff asked to finish a security check only on WhatsApp should?

- A. Agree — WhatsApp is the LMS
- B. Move you to the bookmarked official app — if they refuse, they are not staff
- C. Ask for the seed there instead of on Telegram
- D. Send a personal USDT address for “verify by sending”

Correct answer: B

Module 4: On-chain drains

Approvals as loaded guns, poison tokens and bait NFTs, permits and typed data, revoking without a second drain, and reading the loss on BscScan so you stop guessing.

Lesson 1: Approvals are loaded guns (27 min)

Approvals are loaded guns

You met this on the BNB Smart Chain course. Here we treat it as a crime scene, not as a glossary line.

An **approval** is an on-chain message to a token contract: spender S may take up to N of my tokens. A **spender** is usually another contract — a DEX router, a bridge, a “launchpad,” or a drainer. DEX routers need this to pull in what you swap. Drainers need this to pull **everything later**.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to say what unlimited means, why a later drain may have no Send popup, and why a dashboard that wants unlimited USDT to *view* Crystal Stones is hostile.

What you actually signed

Tokens like USDT on BEP-20, and Crystal Stones as a BEP-20 token, follow a common pattern: your wallet does not always “send” the token in one step when a site swaps it. The site’s contract **pulls**. The permission to pull is the approval.

Unlimited means N is enormous — often $2^{256}-1$, shown in the UI as “unlimited” or “infinite.” Convenient. If the spender is evil, or later gets hacked, or later sells its keys, they do not need you again.

Finite means you approve only a little more than this swap. Annoying. You will sign more often. You will survive a future drainer better. Annoyance is a fee. Unlimited is a loaded gun with no extra click.

Connect Wallet is not Approve. Viewing a token is not Approve. Adding a custom token is not Approve. If a “dashboard” insists on unlimited USDT to **view** Crystal Stones, leave. Viewing is a read. Reads do not need a gun.

A common costume: “allow once to prove you are not a bot.” Bots do not hold your USDT. You do. Another: “this is the same as Connect.” It is not. Read the popup’s verb. If the verb is Approve, Permit, Increase allowance, or Set approval for all, you are loading a gun, even if the site header says Welcome.

You will not see a “Send” when they collect

Days later, a function named `transferFrom` can run. Your wallet may not popup. You may be asleep. BscScan will show the spender as the actor, not a second signature from you that night. People say “I didn’t click Send.” Correct. They clicked **Approve** last month.

This is why “I would notice” is not a control. The noticing was supposed to happen at approve time: network, asset, spender, amount, site bookmark. After that, the gun is loaded until you **revoke** (next lessons) or until they fire.

If the seed is also leaked, they do not even need the gun. They can send directly. Approvals are Door 3. Seeds are Door 1. Do not mix the post-mortems.

UI text	Adult meaning	What later looks like
Allow USDT to spend / Approve	Loaded gun for that spender	transferFrom while you sleep
Unlimited / infinite	No extra click later	One fire can empty the pocket
Exact amount for this swap	Gun with one magazine	They cannot take more than you

		loaded, from this approve
Revoke / set allowance to 0	Unload	Costs a little BNB; worth it
Connect Wallet	Handshake with a site	Not permission to take tokens
Add token / view balance	A display	If they demand unlimited to view, leave

Worked scenario. In March a student approved unlimited USDT to a “launchpad” that looked like a listing for Crystal Stones. In August the launchpad key leaks — or was always evil. USDT leaves at 03:12. The seed is still in the student’s phone.

795. Door 3, not Door 1, until proven otherwise. They still rotate if the device might be dirty (Module 5), because phones that visit launchpads are not always clean.
796. They do not go to the launchpad site to Disconnect. That button does not unload the chain.
797. They revoke from a bookmarked checker, then move remaining funds if any remain.
798. They still did not have to click Send for the drain. That sentence is the one they teach a cousin.

DIAGRAM

```

Approve unlimited
  |
  v
Time passes (days, months)
  |
  v
transferFrom from the spender
  |
  v
Wallet may not popup
Explorer will still show the spender

Viewing a token never needed this gun.

```

ACADEMY NOTE This academy will not tell you to approve Crystal Stones, USDT, or anything else. Education only. If you ever approve on purpose, finite is the adult default, on a site you bookmarked, for a swap you meant. Unlimited for convenience is how August inherits March.

If a wallet UI hides the word unlimited behind “default,” tap the amount and read it. Defaults are how convenience loads guns. Changing a default to a finite number is a thirty-second adult habit. If the site refuses to work without unlimited, the site is not a swap you needed. Leave.

What this lesson is for

So that “I didn’t send” stops being a mystery. You loaded a spender. The book will say so. The book is how you stop guessing, and how you pick revoke versus rotate. Convenience is not a third option. Unlimited for “I will be back” is how you come back to an empty pocket.

Say this out loud

- An approval loads a spender. Unlimited means they may not need me later.

- A drain can happen via transferFrom without a new Send popup.
- Connect, add token, and view are not approve. A dashboard that needs unlimited USDT to view is hostile.
- Fake-site Disconnect does not unload the gun. Revoke is a later, bookmarked job.
- Door 3 is not Door 1. I still treat a dirty device as a reason to rotate.

If a site cannot swap without unlimited, you did not need that swap. Finite or leave. Convenience is how August inherits March.

Next: poison tokens, fake airdrops, and bait NFTs — junk that arrives uninvited with a URL in the name.

Lesson 2: Poison tokens, fake airdrops, and bait NFTs (26 min)

Poison tokens, fake airdrops, and bait NFTs

Anyone can send junk to your address. The send is a **notification** with a hook. It is not a salary. It is not proof you are early. It is not Crystal Stones arriving as a gift from the academy.

By the end of this lesson you should hide unsolicited tokens, refuse URLs in token names, and not approve a “convert / claim / clean blacklist” site you just met.

Zero-value tokens and fake millions

They appear in the wallet list with a huge fake USD price. The hook is often a website in the token name: “Visit claim-cst-drainer.tld.” You tap, connect, approve. Door 3, sometimes Door 1 if they also ask for a seed.

The USD figure is a costume. Wallet apps guess prices from thin or fictional markets. A day-old contract with no honest liquidity can still display eight million dollars. Display is not money. **Liquidity**, in the street sense you need today, means: there are actually other people willing to take the other side of a trade at a price that is not a cartoon. A bookmarked BscScan token page will show age, holders, and whether anyone real is there. You still do not need to visit the URL in the name. You still do not need to “sell it on the site it suggested.” Selling is a swap. Swaps need approvals. Approvals are the hook.

There is no penalty for hiding. Wallet apps (Trust Wallet and MetaMask remain **examples**) have a hide or spam control. Use it. The junk can sit on the chain forever. Your BNB does not leak merely because a stranger sent you a row. Signing is how you accept a job you were not offered.

Bait NFTs

Same family. “You are blacklisted, clean here.” “Security update, mint to keep your wallet.” “Crystal Stones founder pass.” Cleaning is the drain. **setApprovalForAll** — permission for an operator to take NFTs — is the usual gun. If you do not collect NFTs on purpose, you have no reason to sign that.

If you **do** collect NFTs on purpose, you still bookmark the market, still read the popup, still refuse operators you cannot name. A founder-pass that arrived uninvited is not a collection. It is bait with a picture.

Airdrop, two honest sentences

A real **airdrop**, when it exists, is usually tokens that simply appear, or a claim on a site you already bookmarked before the drama. It does not need a seed. It does not need unlimited USDT. It does not need you to pay a helper for gas. It does not expire in eight minutes on a banner.

Unsolicited inbound is, for your purposes, hostile until it is boring. Hide it. Your BNB and USDT are not automatically in danger **until you sign**. The junk can sit there forever. There is no penalty for ignoring a gift. There is a penalty for being polite to it.

People fail this lesson because the wallet UI is designed like a shop: new row, big number, bright icon. Shops want you to tap. Attackers rent that habit. A second failure is social: you ask a fan group “is this the official airdrop?” The group contains the helper with the claim link. You already had the rule before you asked. Asking was Door 4 inviting a costume.

A third failure is “I’ll just connect, I won’t approve.” Clone sites queue the signature after connect, and tired people remember the connect, not the sign. Hide is cheaper than a careful connect. A fourth is “I’ll sell it on PancakeSwap so it doesn’t clutter.” Selling a mystery token is how you visit a router you did not mean, on a pair with no honest liquidity, and load a gun besides.

Inbox junk	Safe response	Unsafe response
Fake million with a URL in the name	Hide / ignore	Visit the URL, connect, approve
NFT from nowhere	Hide	“Clean blacklist,” setApprovalForAll
“You are hacked, revoke here” as a token symbol	Bookmark a known revoke tool later, not this URL	Enter the symbol’s website
Lookalike Crystal Stones	Verify `0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00` on bookmarked BscScan, or ignore	Swap it on a site the token suggested
Poison dust of BNB or USDT from a lookalike address	Leave it; do not copy that from-address later	Use history as an address book

Worked scenario. A wallet shows +\$8,000,000 CrystalStonesAirdrop. A student feels rich and also “should claim before it expires.” That emotion is the payload.

799. Bookmarked BscScan token page: a day-old contract, no honest liquidity, name collision with Crystal Stones. Not `0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00`.

800. They hide the token in the wallet app (Trust Wallet and MetaMask are **examples of wallet apps**; the hide control lives in the app, not on a claim site).

801. Stack of real USDT and BNB unchanged. No approve. No visit.

802. They do not ask the fan group “is this real?” because the group will contain a helper with a claim link. They already have the rule.

DIAGRAM

```

Unsolicited inbound
|
+--> hide

```

```
|  
X visit URL in the name  
X approve to convert  
X setApprovalForAll to clean  
X ask a fan group while the timer runs
```

ACADEMY NOTE “Airdrop token in the wallet is free money” is a quiz answer this course will fail. Unsolicited tokens are notifications. Free money that needs a signature is priced at whatever the spender can pull. You already know the price can be the whole pocket.

What this lesson is for

So that inbound junk stops feeling like a decision. The decision was made by a stranger. Your job is hide. Signing is how you accept a job you were not offered.

Say this out loud

- Unsolicited tokens are notifications, not assets. A fake USD figure is a costume.
- URLs in token names are hostile. I do not visit them.
- Hide, do not hunt. I am not rude for ignoring a gift.
- “Clean blacklist” and “claim airdrop” sites I just met are Door 3.
- Real Crystal Stones, if I ever verify it, is a known contract on bookmarked BscScan — not a surprise million.

Next: “Sign to verify,” permits, and typed data — signatures that are not a Send and still move authority.

Lesson 3: Sign to verify, permits, and typed data (27 min)

Sign to verify, permits, and typed data

Not every signature is a gas-paying transaction. **Off-chain signatures** can still move authority. The wallet says “Sign.” People hear “login.” Drainers hear “yes.”

By the end of this lesson you should reject hex blobs, treat **permits** as approvals in a costume, and never sign to verify a Mentor, a listing, or a freeze appeal.

Login signatures

Many sites: “Sign to prove you own this address.” If the message is literally a human sentence on a **bookmarked** site — “Log in to example.com at 12:04” — risk is lower. They can still impersonate you **on that site**. They usually cannot, from that message alone, pull USDT. Still do not sign on a clone. Still do not sign if you did not bookmark the host.

Lower risk is not zero. It is “maybe.” Maybe is allowed to wait.

If the site is a clone of this academy, of BscScan, or of an exchange, the login signature is still a no — because you should not be proving ownership to a thief’s server at all. They can use that session to show you a second popup (the permit) while you think you are already “in.” Two signatures, one costume. Reject the first if the host is not a bookmark.

Permits (EIP-2612 style) and cousins

A **permit** is a signature that says the token may treat a spender as approved **without** a separate approve transaction. The next transaction from the attacker pulls funds. You saw “Sign,” not “Approve.” You still opened Door 3.

Wallet UIs vary. Some show the word Permit. Some show typed fields: token, spender, value, deadline. Some show a wall of hex. If value looks unlimited, it is unlimited. If you cannot see value, you do not sign.

Related costumes: `increaseAllowance`, `setApprovalForAll`, typed data that mentions a spender you did not intend, “Sign to claim” on a site you met today.

Hardware does not decode tiredness

A hardware wallet will happily sign a permit if you confirm. The device is a yes-machine for whatever you allow. Read the screen. If the screen is a blob you cannot parse, reject. “Hardware wallet means I can sign anything blindly” is a failed quiz on purpose. Tired is a reason to close the laptop, not a reason to tap.

How to refuse, as a habit

If the wallet’s message is a wall of hex, reject. If it says Permit, increaseAllowance, setApprovalForAll, transfer, or swap on a site you did not intend, reject. If a “Crystal Mentor verify” page wants a signature, reject — real Mentor in the academy app never needed that. If you cannot decode it, **reject**. There is no prize for signing under confusion.

Prompt	Default	Why
Sign in to a bookmarked site with a human-readable message	Maybe	Site-login risk, not usually a token gun
Permit unlimited USDT / CST	No	Door 3 in a costume
Hex blob you cannot read	No	You cannot name the loot
setApprovalForAll	No unless you fully intend that NFT market, bookmarked	Operator gun for NFTs
“Sign to verify / unfreeze / list / mint certificate”	No	Academy and honest explorers do not work this way

Worked scenario. A “Crystal Mentor verify” page (fake) asks for a signature. The wallet shows typed data mentioning USDT and a spender. A student almost signs because the academy crystal is in the tab icon.

803. They reject. Real Mentor, inside the bookmarked academy app, never needed a USDT permit.

804. They do not try to “finish verification” with a smaller signature. There is no smaller yes that satisfies a drainer.

805. They open the real app. Progress is still there. Certificates in Basic are platform records after quizzes, not a wallet event.

806. If they had signed, Module 5 plus a revoke from a bookmark — not a return to the verify page.

DIAGRAM

Sign popup
|

```
+--> readable login on a bookmark? maybe
+--> permit / hex / operator / unfreeze? reject
+--> tired / cannot decode? reject
|
Hardware
--> still reject if the device screen is a blob
```

ACADEMY NOTE Signing “to be polite” is how people empty a play pocket and then a savings pocket if those pockets share a seed. Politeness is for humans you know offline. Machines get reject. This academy will never ask you to sign typed data to prove you are a student.

If a site says “this signature does nothing, it just verifies,” read the fields anyway. “Does nothing” is a sentence in English. The wallet is showing mathematics. Mathematics wins. If your app cannot show typed fields and only shows hex, that app is the wrong tool for that site, or the site is the wrong site. Either way: reject, bookmark, later.

What this lesson is for

So that Sign stops being a synonym for harmless. You name the loot, or you reject. Confusion is not a maybe. Confusion is a no. A Mentor, listing, certificate, or freeze page that wants typed data is a costume even when the crystal looks right. Real Mentor stays in the bookmarked app and does not need USDT permission.

Say this out loud

- Sign is not harmless by default. Permits are approvals in a costume.
- Hex blobs get a no. If I cannot decode it, I reject.
- Crystal Mentor, certificates, and freeze appeals do not need a USDT signature.
- Hardware wallets still require me to read the device. Blind confirm is Door 3 with extra steel.
- Tired people should not sign. Closing the laptop is a complete procedure.

“Sign to verify” is not a greeting. If Crystal Mentor, a listing desk, or a freeze appeal wants typed data, it is a costume. Real Mentor stays in the app.

Next: revoking approvals without walking into a second drainer — including the revoke site that asks for a seed first.

Lesson 4: Revoking approvals without a second drain (27 min)

Revoking approvals without a second drain

Revoke means sending a new transaction that sets allowance for that spender to 0. It costs a little BNB. It is worth it. It is also a hunting ground: people google “revoke approval” while their hands shake, tap the first ad, and sign a second gun.

By the end of this lesson you should bookmark a checker on a calm day, revoke unknown unlimited spenders when the seed is still yours, and walk away from any revoke site that asks for a seed first.

Use a tool you bookmarked on a calm day

Common explorers have token-approval checkers (BscScan token approval pages and well-known revoke UIs). Bookmark from documentation you trust **before** you are on fire. This academy will not paste a random revoke URL in a lesson that will rot. Your calm-day job is to save **one** from BscScan's own docs or UI. If you cannot do that yet, wait for a knowledgeable human **offline** rather than an ad.

Googling “revoke approval” + the first ad is how the second drainer greets you. A revoke site that asks for a **seed** first is not a revoke site. Revoke is an on-chain transaction your wallet already on the device can sign. Seeds are for restoring a wallet, not for listing spenders. Seed-first is Door 1 wearing a hygiene costume.

Procedure, when Door 1 is probably still shut

807. Open the **bookmarked** checker. Confirm the host still matches the bookmark. Panic fingers lie.
808. Connect — this is a rare time connect is required. You are talking to a read tool so it can query your address. Still confirm the URL.
809. List spenders on USDT, other BEP-20 tokens you actually hold, Crystal Stones if you hold it.
810. Revoke unknown or unlimited you do not need. Finite leftover on a DEX you still use can wait for a calm reduction, or you can zero it and re-approve finite next swap.
811. Confirm each revoke transaction on bookmarked BscScan. The book should show allowance going toward zero.
812. Disconnect in the wallet app. You still do not return to a fake site to Disconnect.

What revoke does not fix

- they already `transferFrom`d — that money is gone
- they have the seed — they will approve again from another device; rotation is the job (Module 5)
- the device is malware-soaked — they may sign a new approve while you revoke; clean device, then rotate
- a malicious **owner** of a junk token you still “hold” — do not visit claim sites to bring junk along; hide it; move understood assets

If Door 1 might be open, revoke on a still-leaked seed is theatre. New wallet, test, move, retire. You may still revoke on the old address after, if you like a tidy book. Tidy is not safety if they still have the words.

State	Action	Not the action
Unknown unlimited spender, seed safe, device reasonably clean	Revoke from bookmarked checker	Ad; seed-first site
Spender already drained, seed safe	Revoke leftovers; move remaining if device is dirty	Pay a tracer
Seed maybe leaked	New wallet on clean device; test; move; retire old	Revoke as the only step
Revoke UI asks for 12 words	Close tab; treat as Door 1 attempt	“Just this once, it’s hygiene”

Worked scenario. A student used a real DEX months ago (legitimate router still approved unlimited).

Sunday checklist. They reduce to zero. Next swap they will approve a finite amount. Annoyance is the fee of Door 3 hygiene.

A second student googles “revoke BSC” the night of a scare. The ad asks them to import a seed “to scan allowances.” They almost do, because support-shaped language said “required to help.” They remember this paragraph. They close the tab. They wait until morning and use a bookmark.

DIAGRAM

```
Calm day: bookmark a real approval checker from explorer docs / UI
Fire day: use that bookmark, not an ad
Seed-first revoke site: close
If seed leaked: skip to rotation, do not perform theatre
```

ACADEMY NOTE Revoke costs BNB. Keep a little native coin on the play pocket for this reason. If you have no BNB and a loaded gun, that is a reason to get practice-size BNB through a path you already trust — not a reason to accept “we will pay gas if you share the seed.”

Do not revoke *from* the drainer’s own “security portal.” Their portal is how they collect the next permit while you think you are unloading the last one. Bookmark, host name, then connect. If your hands shake, wait. A gun that has not fired can wait an hour. A second gun cannot. Unlimited leftover on a router you “might use someday” is how someday arrives as a headline. Zero is allowed to be annoying.

What this lesson is for

So that hygiene does not become a second crime scene. Revoke is ordinary. Seed-first revoke is a robbery. Ads are Door 3 in a cape. If you finish a revoke and the checker still shows the spender, wait for the explorer confirmation, then refresh. Do not “try a different revoke site” from search. That is how the second gun loads while you chase a UI lag.

Say this out loud

- Revoke is an on-chain allowance-to-zero. It costs a little BNB. It does not need a seed.
- I bookmark the checker before I need it. I do not google revoke into ads on a fire day.
- A revoke site that asks for a seed first is a thief.
- Revoke does not fix a leaked seed. They will approve again. I rotate.
- Fake-site Disconnect is not revoke.

If the checker lags, wait on the bookmarked explorer. Do not hunt a second revoke UI from an ad. Lag is cheaper than a second gun.

Next: reading a drain on BscScan so you can name the door from the book, not from a group chat.

Lesson 5: Reading a drain on BscScan so you stop guessing (26 min)

Reading a drain on BscScan so you stop guessing

When USDT leaves, the book still talks. Guessing in a group chat hands the story to impersonators. The explorer, from a bookmark, is slower and ruder and true.

By the end of this lesson you should classify a loss as a wrong send, an approval-then-pull, a hostile swap bundle, or a leaked key — and write hashes in a notebook instead of a recovery DM.

Four patterns

A. Honest send to a wrong address. `to` is an EOA you do not own. Token transfer matches what you remember signing. Paste attack, fake invoice, QR mismatch, wrong network sometimes. Door 4 plus a send. Seed may still be yours.

B. Approval, later pull. An earlier transaction is `approve` (or a permit). A later transaction from the spender runs `transferFrom` while you slept. Door 3. Seed may still be yours. Revoke and consider a fresh hot wallet if the device is dirty.

C. Swap or router you did not mean. `to` is a contract. One bundle empties the pocket — hops, wrapping, a spender you did not read. Door 3 or Door 4 plus a signature. Still maybe Door 1 if malware signed it.

D. Seed leaked or malware signing. Many transactions you **did not** click, from your EOA, including after you uninstalled the app. Transfers you do not remember. New approves you do not remember. This is Door 1. Rotate. Do not “repair” the old words.

Exchange-side: a withdrawal you did not start, while your on-chain address is quiet, is Door 2. That post-mortem lives on the company’s history page, from a bookmark, not only on BscScan.

Clue	Likely door	First honest move
You remember the popup that night, destination wrong	Human + send	Remaining funds; do not send again to unlock
Approval then later pull while you slept	Chain permission	Revoke from bookmark if seed still yours
Txs you never signed, app uninstalled, still moving	Device (key leak or signing malware)	New seed on clean device; test; move; retire
CEX withdrawal you did not start, chain quiet	Account	Official security page: sessions, 2FA, whitelist

Worked scenario. At 03:11 an approval to a new spender. At 03:12 USDT `transferFrom`. The student was asleep.

813. They open bookmarked BscScan on the address. They do not connect. They read.

814. They search last week’s history. There it is: a “claim” approve from a site they barely remember. Door 3. Not a mystery hack of BNB validators.

815. Seed maybe still theirs. Device maybe dirty. They revoke from a bookmark, then move remaining to a fresh hot wallet from a cleaner device anyway. Two pockets would have made this cheaper.

816. They write both hashes in a private notebook. They do not paste the remaining address into Telegram with a bounty. They do not send leftover dust to a tracer.

DIAGRAM

```

Open your address on bookmarked BscScan (no connect)
|
v
Find the first unexpected approve or send
|
v

```

```
That event names the door
|
v
Respond to that door
|
X recovery DM
X second send to refund address
X "I can outrun it if I am fast"
```

You cannot outrun a drain by paying the thief

A destination that says “refund” in a token name, or a helper who says “send the rest here to reverse,” is not a refund rail. Sending more is a second gift. Speed does not unsay a valid signature. The chain will settle the second gift as calmly as the first.

Write hashes. Hashes help a real police report if you file one locally. They do not help a Telegram wizard. This academy will not promise that a report brings USDT home. It will promise that a notebook is cheaper than a wizard.

Do not “watch the thief’s address” as a hobby the same night. Watching is how people send a test to a refund-looking twin and call it research. If you must look, look from the bookmark, once, write the hash, close the tab. Remaining funds do not need a live stream of the gone slice.

ACADEMY NOTE If you cannot read BscScan yet, that is what the previous course was for. Re-open it. Do not hire a narrator in a DM. A cousin who finished Basic, sitting next to you, looking at a bookmark, is a narrator you can survive.

If the book is hard to read, slow down the labels: **from** (who started it), **to** (who received it), **method** (approve, transfer, transferFrom, swap), **token** (the contract, not the icon), **time**. Icons lie. Methods do not. Do not watch the thief’s address as a hobby the same night. Watching is how people send a test to a refund-looking twin and call it research.

What this lesson is for

So that the book, not a costume, names the door. Naming picks Module 5’s procedure. Guessing picks Module 3’s second predator. If you only remember one explorer habit: paste the hash on a bookmark, do not connect, write it down. That habit survives tiredness. A wizard does not.

Say this out loud

- The book shows whether it was a send, an approve-then-pull, a hostile bundle, or a leaked key.
- Sleep-time pulls often point at an earlier approve. Mystery signed txs point at Door 1 or malware.
- I cannot outrun a drain by sending to the thief’s refund address. That is a second gift.
- Hashes go in a notebook, not a recovery chat. Reports are optional and local. Reversal is not promised.
- I do not connect a wallet to an explorer to read a public hash.

Five labels are enough: from, to, method, token, time. Icons are costumes. A cousin on a bookmark beats a wizard in a DM.

Take the quiz. Module 5: if something already went wrong — the first hour, seed rotation, exchange sessions, reporting versus revenge, and what will not come back.

Module quiz (answers included for editors)

Q1. After unlimited approve, a later drain may?

- A. Require you to click Send again every time
- B. Happen via transferFrom without a new send popup
- C. Be reversed by validators for free if you tweet the hash
- D. Need your email password as a second factor

Correct answer: B

Q2. A dashboard that requires unlimited USDT approve to view a Crystal Stones balance is?

- A. Normal BscScan behaviour
- B. Hostile — viewing does not need that gun
- C. How decimals work on BEP-20
- D. Academy KYC for Basic certificates

Correct answer: B

Q3. An unsolicited airdrop token appears with a huge USD price and a claim URL in the name. Chidi should?

- A. Swap immediately — airdrop token in the wallet is free money
- B. Hide and ignore it — unsolicited tokens are notifications, not assets
- C. Approve unlimited so they convert before expiry
- D. Forward the token with his seed to an admin for safekeeping

Correct answer: B

Q4. A wallet prompt that is a hex blob he cannot read gets?

- A. Signed so it expires
- B. Rejected
- C. Posted in a group for crowd-sign
- D. Approved unlimited by hardware-wallet policy

Correct answer: B

Q5. A permit signature is closest to?

- A. A harmless login always
- B. Door 3 — allowance in a costume
- C. A bookmark
- D. A transaction hash

Correct answer: B

Q6. A “revoke approvals” ad asks Ada to import her seed first so it can scan. She should?

- A. Import — support needs the seed to help with hygiene
- B. Close the tab — revoke does not need a seed; seed-first is a second drain
- C. Import a screenshot from the gallery because those images are encrypted
- D. Share screen so the site can type the words for her

Correct answer: B

Q7. Revoke on a bookmarked checker is useless as the only step if?

- A. Gas costs a little BNB
- B. The seed is already leaked — they will approve again
- C. She uses BNB Smart Chain
- D. The token decimals are 18

Correct answer: B

Q8. USDT left while she slept, and BscScan shows approve yesterday plus transferFrom at 03:12. This pattern is?

- A. Door 4 only — she must send the rest to the thief’s refund address to outrun it
- B. Door 3 — an earlier approval loaded a spender; she should not chase with a second send
- C. A BscScan display bug that needs a seed to decode
- D. Proof that hashes are secret and must not be written down

Correct answer: B

Module 5: If something already went wrong

The first hour: stop and do not chase. Rotate a leaked seed. Handle exchange session theft and 2FA loss. Report without revenge. Name what will not come back, without cruelty.

Lesson 1: The first hour: stop, don’t chase (27 min)

The first hour: stop, don’t chase

You noticed a missing balance. The next hour decides whether the rest leaves too. Speed toward a helper is how the rest leaves. Speed toward remaining funds, on a clean device, is how something survives.

By the end of this lesson you should run an order of operations from memory, recognise chase in all its costumes, and treat “I can outrun it by sending to their refund address” as a second gift.

Order of operations

817. **Reject** any open popups. Close the suspicious tab. Do **not** smash the phone so hard you cannot use a **clean** device. Do not install an APK the group just dropped.

818. **Do not** message a group with “I got hacked, what do I do?” until you have moved what you still control. Impersonators are faster than friends. Pain in public is still bait, especially now.
819. From a **clean** device if possible, open bookmarked explorer. Name the door (previous lesson): device, account, chain permission, human-plus-send.
820. If Door 2 (exchange): bookmark login, kill sessions, change password, check whitelist and recent withdrawals, official ticket. Next lesson details this.
821. If Door 3: revoke from a bookmark if the seed still looks yours; move remaining funds to a fresh wallet if the device is dirty.
822. If Door 1: **new seed on a clean device**, test, move what is left, retire the old address forever. Next lesson. Never “repair” the old words on a recovery site.
823. Write hashes and timestamps in a private notebook. Only then tell a trusted human you already knew **offline**. Still no seed, no OTP, no screen share in that conversation.

If you cannot tell Door 1 from Door 3 in the first ten minutes, protect remaining funds as if Door 1 might be open: new wallet on a clean device, test, move. Extra caution is cheaper than a second drain. Revoke can wait until the rest is out of the fire.

Write one sentence in the notebook before you talk: “Door ___ opened; remaining moved to ___ (middles only); hashes ___.” That sentence is for you and for a real desk later. It is not a status for Telegram. Status is how impersonators find you while the rest is still on the dirty phone.

What chase looks like

- paying a recovery wizard, including with leftover dust
- sending more to “unlock,” “unstick,” or “refund”
- installing an APK the group dropped
- repeating the same dApp to “reverse”
- sharing a screen so a competent voice can drive
- googling the error and tapping ads
- posting a bounty with your remaining address

Impulse	First-hour replacement
Tell Telegram immediately	Move remaining first, then a quiet offline human
Pay unfreeze / tracer / dust fee	No
New APK / remote desktop	No
Second send to thief “refund”	No — you cannot outrun a valid signature
Re-enter seed to repair	No — new words, never repaired old ones

Worked scenario. 40 USDT gone via approve. 12 USDT and some BNB remain. The student still has the seed on a possibly dirty phone.

824. They reject leftover popups. They do not post in the fan group.
825. From a friend’s clean laptop they create a **new** wallet, official app, paper words, no photo.
826. They send a test of 1 USDT from the old wallet (imported once, onto the clean laptop if they must, not onto a new APK). Bookmarked explorer agrees.

827. Then the rest of the 11, then BNB dust minus gas. Then they may revoke on the old address. Then they tell a friend. Still no seed in the story.
828. The 12 USDT survives. The 40 does not come back. That is still a successful first hour.

DIAGRAM

Notice loss

- > reject popups
- > clean device if the old one may be dirty
- > name the door on bookmarked explorer
- > save remaining (test, then the rest)
- > notes
- > then talk, still no seed

X recovery payments

X refund address of the thief

X group announcement first

ACADEMY NOTE Saving remaining funds is not “giving up on the stolen slice.” The stolen slice is already a different address’s money. The chain will not parent you into a reversal. Chasing it is how the remaining slice follows. Dust left behind is allowed. Dust sent to a specialist is a donation.

If the dirty phone is also your only 2FA, you have two doors in one pocket. Do not factory-reset it until you have killed exchange sessions from a cleaner device and rotated what you can. A reset that you cannot log in after is how people then accept a skip-the-queue admin. Sequence: remaining on-chain funds if Door 1 might be open; Door 2 sessions from a bookmark on a clean device; then you may retire the dirty phone.

What this lesson is for

So that the worst hour of this course has a script. Scripts beat adrenaline. You do not need to feel brave. You need to move the rest, then write, then talk. Bravery that announces the loss first is how remaining funds get a spectator sport. Quiet is a security control.

Say this out loud

- Remaining funds first, story later. Clean device if the old one may be dirty.
- I cannot outrun a drain by sending to the thief’s refund address.
- No recovery payments, no dust-as-tracing-fee, no APK, no screen share.
- If I cannot name the door yet, I still move remaining funds as if Door 1 might be open.
- Naming the door picks the next fix. A group chat picks a second predator.

Quiet is a control. Announce after remaining funds have moved. The group that would have “helped” was already watching for the announcement.

Next: rotating a leaked seed — new wallet, never “repair” the old words, thieves watching empty addresses.

Lesson 2: Rotating a leaked seed (new wallet, never “repair” the old words) (27 min)

Rotating a leaked seed (new wallet, never “repair” the old words)

If the words may have been photographed, typed into a site, stored in cloud notes, spoken on a screen share, or entered on a fake app: **that wallet is no longer yours alone**. Shared ownership is the fact. Hope is not a detector.

By the end of this lesson you should run rotation as a procedure, refuse repair-sites, and treat an empty leaked address as a camera the thief still watches.

When to rotate

Rotate if: you typed the seed into a website; you imported into a chat APK; you stored it in Google Notes, a screenshot album, or email; a helper saw it; overlay malware may have seen it; you used the words on a dirty OS. “Nothing happened yet” is not a sensor. Thieves wait for deposits.

Do not rotate in a panic onto the same infected phone. Clean device first — a friend’s laptop is imperfect and still better than the APK that stole the last seed. Official store listing you already used. Paper backup. No photo. A screenshot of a seed in the gallery is not encrypted in any sense this academy will accept. It is a picture of the vault, often backed up to a cloud.

Procedure

829. On a **clean** device, official wallet app (Trust Wallet, MetaMask, or others remain **examples**, not orders), generate a **new** seed. Write on paper. Never photo. Never type it into chat “so a helper can check spelling.”
830. Note the new receive address on BNB Smart Chain. Check middles.
831. From the old wallet (clean device if you can import **once**), send a **test** of play USDT to the new address. Bookmarked explorer agrees. Middles match.
832. Move remaining tokens you understand, then remaining BNB (leave a drop for the last gas if you still need one revoke or one last send).
833. If NFTs or odd tokens, decide later — do not visit claim sites to “bring them along.” That is how Door 3 rides the rotation.
834. Never reuse the old seed. Do not “keep it as a burner.” Burners with leaked seeds are still shared with the thief.
835. Update an exchange withdrawal whitelist to the **new** address after a delay you can live with, from the bookmarked exchange.
836. If you used that seed on other chains, those balances need the same move, with each chain’s native gas. One seed is many doors.

What you do not do

- email the new seed to yourself
- generate the new seed on the same infected phone
- ask a helper to “create the new wallet for you”

- paste old words into a “wallet repair,” “migration,” or “BSC resync” site
- send leftover dust to a specialist so they can “close the case”
- announce the new address in the same group that saw the old one drain

Old wallet	New wallet
Compromised, watched, retired	Clean device, paper backup, almost no random connects
Whitelist later, after a test you control	After explorer agrees you hold it
Burner reuse of leaked words	No — it is still their camera
Repair the old twelve words	No — there is no honest repair

Worked scenario. A seed sat in Google Notes for a year. Nothing happened. A student still rotates, because absence of a drain is not proof of absence of a copy.

837. New words on a clean device, paper, no photo. Notes copy deleted — and they still assume cloud copies can persist. The rotation is the fix, not the delete.

838. Test 1 USDT, explorer agrees, then the rest, then BNB.

839. They do not sweep a mystery airdrop along. They hide it on the old address and walk away.

840. Empty old address stays empty. If 0.0003 BNB remains as dust, it remains. A tracer who wants it is Module 3.

DIAGRAM

Leaked seed

- > new seed on clean device (paper, no photo)
- > test send
- > move tokens you understand
- > move gas, leave dust if needed
- > retire old address forever
- > whitelist the new one later, from a bookmark

- X repair site for old words
- X same dirty phone
- X helper generates it
- X burner reuse

ACADEMY NOTE If you have nothing left to move, still generate a new wallet for the future. Do not “keep using” the leaked one because it is empty today. Thieves watch old addresses. A future salary sent there is a future gift. There is no parent who will intercept it because you already learned the lesson.

Other chains on the same seed are the same leak. Ethereum, Polygon, whatever else that seed derived — each needs its own gas and its own move. Forgetting a chain is how a later airdrop on that chain becomes the thief’s airdrop. Write a list of networks you ever added, then move or abandon on purpose.

What this lesson is for

So that leaked words stop being a superstition (“maybe they didn’t copy it”) and become a procedure. New, clean, paper, test, move, retire. Repair is a costume. If a helper offers to “check the new words are valid,” they are asking for the new vault. Validity is a receive test you already ran on the explorer.

Say this out loud

- A leaked seed means shared ownership. “Nothing happened yet” is not a detector.
- New seed, clean device, paper, no photo, test, move, retire. I never repair the old words.
- Empty leaked wallets are still cameras. I will not reuse them as burners.
- Helpers do not generate my new seed. Repair sites that want the old words are thieves.
- A screenshot in the gallery is a leak, not an encrypted backup.

Other chains on the same seed are the same leak. Move them or abandon them on purpose. An empty leaked address is still a camera.

Next: exchange session theft and 2FA loss — Door 2, where a parent still exists if you use the parent, not a Telegram skip-the-queue.

Lesson 3: Exchange session theft and 2FA loss (26 min)

Exchange session theft and 2FA loss

Door 2 has a parent. Use the parent, not a DM. An exchange IOU is still a company ledger. That is a cost (they can freeze you) and a feature (they can kill sessions). Binance and any other desk you actually use remain **examples of centralised exchanges**, not a ranking.

By the end of this lesson you should kill sessions from a bookmark, treat lost 2FA as official recovery plus paper codes, and assume SMS 2FA is dead during a SIM-swap.

You still have login

From a bookmark, not from an email button:

- kill sessions / devices you do not recognise
- rotate password to something unique (password reuse is how one shopping leak becomes this hour)
- rotate 2FA: new authenticator secret, new paper backup codes; destroy the old codes
- confirm withdrawal whitelist is on; inspect recent address additions
- confirm recent withdrawals; official ticket if you see one you did not start
- check the email account that owns the exchange — Door 2 often starts there

Do this even if the thief only “tried.” Tried is a session you might still be sharing.

You lost the 2FA device

Official account recovery. Slow. Identity checks. This is why 2FA backup codes on paper exist. Anyone offering to skip the queue in Telegram is stealing the account. Anyone who needs a seed to restore an exchange login is confused or lying: exchange logins are not seeds. Do not “help” them by pasting wallet words into an exchange-shaped clone.

If you still have backup codes, you are not lost. If you do not, you are in the company’s slow lane. Slow is infuriating and still better than a skip-the-queue admin.

SIM-swap in progress

Someone is moving your mobile number. SMS 2FA is now their 2FA. Call the mobile operator on a number **you already had** — the shop, the printed bill, the number on paper — not a number a text just sent. Ask to lock the SIM. Then rotate exchange and email passwords from a bookmark. Assume every SMS code is hostile until the operator confirms the line is yours.

Then leave SMS 2FA if the product allows an authenticator app. SMS was always the weak second factor. Today you have the demonstration. Academy login is a smaller Door 2, but it still gets a unique password. A phished academy session does not spend BNB. It can still be a costume: “we see you logged in, now verify the wallet.” That verify is not us.

Situation	Channel	Not the channel
Session theft, you still log in	Bookmarked security page: sessions, password, 2FA, whitelist	Email button; reply-guy
Lost authenticator	Official recovery + paper backup codes	Telegram skip-the-queue
SMS / SIM-swap	Operator on a number you already had, then rotate off SMS	Number in the SMS itself
Stranger “exchange security team”	No	Ever
Academy password same as exchange	Rotate both to unique	“It’s fine, academy has no coins”

Worked scenario. A student’s email was a reused password from a leaked shop. The exchange used that email and SMS 2FA. SIM-swap Friday. They notice Saturday.

841. They still have a session on the exchange app from last week. They open **that** bookmarked app, not a text link.
842. Whitelist saved them: 24-hour delay on a new withdrawal address. They cancel what they can, kill sessions, rotate password, move 2FA to an authenticator, paper codes, call the operator on a known number.
843. Without whitelist, this page would be a eulogy for the IOU. The delay that felt insulting was the parent doing one job.
844. They also rotate the academy password, which had been the same. Progress is not BNB, and reuse still couples doors.

DIAGRAM

Door 2

```
--> official security page from a bookmark
--> sessions, password, 2FA, whitelist
--> email account that owns it
--> operator, if SIM is in play
```

```
X Telegram skip-the-queue
X seed paste into an exchange clone
X SMS link
```

ACADEMY NOTE Academy login is Door 2 for **this site** (progress, not your BNB). Still: do not reuse the exchange password on the academy. Password reuse is how one leak becomes three doors. Staff will never ask for your 2FA to “verify a ticket.”

If you cannot get in at all — no session, no 2FA device, no backup codes — you are in the company’s slow lane with identity documents. Slow is the honest cost of Door 2. Anyone who can “fast-track” you in a chat already has a login page. Use the parent’s published recovery. Eat the delay. The IOU is still an IOU until they finish; a clone login would make it theirs.

What this lesson is for

So that Door 2 uses its parent. Parents are slow and annoying and occasionally on your side. Telegram is fast and never your exchange. Write the official recovery URL into your calm-day bookmarks the same way you bookmarked login. Fire-day you will not invent a desk. You will tap a desk you already had.

Say this out loud

- Door 2: official parent from a bookmark, not DMs, not email buttons.
- Whitelist is the delay that saves IOUs. I will live with it.
- Paper 2FA backup codes exist for lost phones. Skip-the-queue admins exist for stolen accounts.
- SIM-swap: call an operator number I already had, then rotate off SMS 2FA.
- Password reuse couples doors. Academy and exchange do not share a password.

Bookmark the official recovery URL on a calm day, next to login. Fire-day you will not invent a desk. Slow is the parent. Skip-the-queue is the thief.

Next: reporting versus revenge — hashes in a real process, not mixers, not bounties, not a second crime.

Lesson 4: Reporting versus revenge (26 min)

Reporting versus revenge

You may file a report. You may warn your group. You will not become a night-time detective sending bait funds into mixers “to catch them.” That is how people get a second loss and, in some places, a legal problem this academy will not help you shop for.

By the end of this lesson you should know what is useful (hashes, domains, official tickets), what is not (tracers, memos of threats, bounties in DMs), and that police recovery is not a promise we will make.

What a local report is, without Hollywood

A report is a statement at a real office, or a platform form the company publishes, with facts a stranger could check: timestamps, transaction hashes, destination addresses, the domain you typed, the handle that DMed you. It is not a seed. It is not remote control of your phone. It is not a USDT retainer to a man with a badge photo.

Whether it is worth a trip depends on amount, city, and how that desk actually treats crypto complaints. In some places a statement creates a paper trail that matters for a bank, an employer, or a later case. In some places it is a queue that never moves. Both outcomes are allowed. This academy will not pretend a Nigerian

(or any other) police desk can unsend a BEP-20 transfer because you are a student. We will also not mock you for filing if the number would have paid school fees.

If you file, bring the notebook, not the remaining wallet on a hot screen in a public corridor. Remaining funds first, always. A report is not a reason to delay rotation.

Useful

- BscScan hashes, timestamps, destination addresses, in a real-world police or platform report if the amount and local process justify it
- Warning friends with **facts** (“this domain drained me,” “this handle doubled CST”), not with a clone of the clone, not with your remaining address
- Telling the exchange, from a bookmark, if Door 2
- Telling a bank if P2P naira sat in a story they can actually act on — they still may not; you still do not chase on-chain
- Writing the contract you verified, if a clone used a name collision with Crystal Stones: the real verify-only address is `0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00`

Not useful, and not allowed as “homework”

- paying a mixer or a “tracer” in chat
- sending leftover dust to attach a trace
- threatening the destination address in a transaction memo
- deploying your own drainer (crime)
- doxxing random holders who later bought the stolen USDT on a DEX (they may be innocent liquidity)
- a public bounty that invites impersonators to play police

Warning well is a skill. Name the domain, the handle, the contract. Do not name your remaining address. Do not paste a screenshot that includes a receive QR. Do not offer to “help others recover” unless you are repeating this course’s refuse-lines — otherwise you become a costume someone else can wear.

Doxxing a random holder who bought USDT on a DEX after your drain is how innocent liquidity gets hurt and how you pick a fight that is not the thief. The book shows a path. Paths through public pools are not a confession of the pool.

This academy is not a law firm. Local rules differ. We only insist you do not add a crime or a second drain to the story. We do not promise that a report brings funds home. Sometimes it creates a paper trail that matters later. Sometimes it does nothing. Both outcomes are allowed. Revenge ops are not.

Act	Do?
Official report with hashes, if it makes sense locally	Optional, adult, no promises
Warn with the domain, handle, and drainer contract	Yes, without your remaining address
Pay Telegram police / mixer / dust tracer	No

Commit a crime to “get even”	No
Open a bounty in DMs	No — impersonators hunt bounties

Worked scenario. A student posts the **drainer contract** and domain in a community they already trust, plus a BscScan link. They do not post their remaining address. They do not offer a bounty in DMs. They file a local report because the number is large enough in their city that a desk will take a statement. They still plan as if the 40 USDT will not return.

845. Calm, factual, done.

846. A helper replies with “I am cybercrime, send dust.” They already had this module. They ignore.

847. They do not follow the stolen USDT into a mixer “to see.” Curiosity is not a tracing licence.

848. Sunday, remaining funds sit in a new play pocket. The report sits in a folder. Life continues without a Hollywood reverse.

DIAGRAM

Loss

```
--> save remaining
--> optional official report with hashes
--> factual warning (domain, contract, handle)
```

```
X revenge ops
X mixers as detective work
X bounties in open DMs
X dust to specialists
X threatening memos
```

ACADEMY NOTE We will not pretend every stolen 20 USDT deserves a task force, and we will not mock someone who files anyway. The skill is matching energy to reality: remaining funds, then paper, then quiet warnings. Not a second career as a bounty hunter the same night you were drained.

What this lesson is for

So that anger has a channel that does not open a door. Reports are adult. Revenge is how Door 4 gets a sequel.

Say this out loud

- Hashes help reports. Seeds never do. Dust never does.
- I warn with facts — domain, handle, contract — not with my remaining address.
- No mixer-detectives, no bounties in DMs, no crime to get even.
- Police recovery is not promised. I still may file if it makes sense locally.
- Impersonators hunt both pain posts and bounty posts. I do not feed them.

Next: what will not come back, said without cruelty — so hope does not become a third predator.

Lesson 5: What will not come back, said without cruelty (26 min)

What will not come back, said without cruelty

The chain settled a theft as calmly as a gift. That sentence is the spine of this course. This lesson says the quiet part without dressing it as a motivational poster and without dressing it as contempt.

By the end of this lesson you should be able to tell a friend, or yourself, which slices of a loss are gone, which habits still pay, and why leftover hope is a market that recovery specialists sell into.

What is gone

A completed on-chain send to an address you do not control. A `transferFrom` that already happened. An exchange withdrawal that already left the company to a chain address. Painted-platform balances that were never in a wallet you held. Giveaway donations. Dust you sent to a tracer.

Gone means: do not budget as if a parent will reverse it. Do not skip rent to “stay in the recovery process.” Do not recruit a cousin to complete the task mill so the large withdrawal can free both of you. The large withdrawal is not in a queue. It is in someone else’s pocket.

What may still be yours

Funds that never left. IOUs still inside an exchange if Door 2 was caught in the whitelist delay. Tokens still sitting behind an approval you can revoke before they fire. Other chains on a seed you are about to retire, if you move them first. Your KYC-facing name, if you refuse mule work now. Your audience, if you do not hand admin to a helper.

“May still be yours” is the first hour’s job. It is not a promise about the gone slice.

Grief is allowed. A number that would have paid fees is allowed to hurt. What is not allowed, in this classroom, is converting that hurt into a payment to a stranger who speaks the hurt’s language. Specialists listen well because listening is cheaper than returning USDT.

If you are sitting with someone else who lost money, do not rank their pain. Do not say “it was only practice size” unless they say it. Do not say “we will get it back.” Say: remaining funds, bookmarks, no seed, no dust, optional report, I will stay while you do the first hour.

What will not happen, named so nobody sells it to you

- BSC validators will not vote you a refund because you are a student of this academy
- Crystal Stones staff will not DM a recovery agent
- A screenshot of a chat will not freeze a destination
- A second send will not unlock the first
- A mixer will not “clean and return”
- A court, even a real one, is not a vending machine for USDT. It may be worth a statement. It is not a timer you can count on before Friday’s bills

Gone	Still a job	Not a job
Completed send / pull / CEX	Remaining funds, rotation, sessions,	Tracer payments

withdrawal that already hit-chain	revoke	
Painted-site number	Stop depositing	Unfreeze tax
Giveaway donation	Warn with facts	Double down for VIP
Shame	Offline human you already knew	Screen share with a new friend

Worked scenario. An auntie lost the number she cannot stand to say out loud. A niece sits with her. They do not say “at least it was a lesson” in the first ten minutes. They also do not say “we will get it back, I found a desk.”

849. They move what is left. They rotate if words were shared. They ignore recovery DMs together.

850. They write hashes. They decide, locally, whether a statement is worth a trip. No promise.

851. They tell two family chats the domain and the script. They do not tell them the remaining address.

852. Weeks later the money is still gone. The auntie still has a play pocket with practice size, a bookmark list, and a niece who will not let a wizard in the door. That is the un-cruel ending this academy can stand behind.

DIAGRAM

```

Stolen slice --> treat as gone
Remaining    --> first hour, then rotation / sessions / revoke
Hope product --> specialists, unfreeze taxes, last trains
                treat as Door 4

```

```

Sit with the person.
Do not sell them a reverse.
Do not mock them for wanting one.

```

ACADEMY NOTE If you are the person who lost the money, you are not “bad at crypto.” You met a funnel that is good at humans. Basic’s job was to make the next funnel more expensive to run on you. It was not to guarantee that the last one returns. Education only. No recovery theatre from us, ever.

What this lesson is for

So that hope stops being a door. You can grieve a number. You can file a paper. You cannot buy a reverse from a stranger without buying a second loss. The immune system is the rest of your life on these rails, not a refund. If a cousin asks “but what if this specialist is different?”, the answer is still the never-list: no seed, no dust, no screen share, no second send. Different costumes. Same doors.

Say this out loud

- A completed on-chain theft will not be parented back by validators, staff, or a second send.
- Remaining funds are the job. The gone slice is not a subscription I must feed.
- I will not skip rent for a recovery process. I will not send dust to close a case.
- Police reports are optional and local. They are not promised reversals.
- Shame is not a character flaw I must pay to remove. It is a feeling. Wizards sell to it.

If a cousin asks whether a specialist is different this time, the never-list is still the answer. Different badge. Same doors. No seed, no dust, no screen, no second send.

Take the quiz. Module 6: living the rules — weekly checklist, device hygiene, how to treat Crystal Stones after this course, Basic track close, and what Intermediate will still refuse.

Module quiz (answers included for editors)

Q1. In the first hour after a drain, the priority is?

- A. Announcing it in every group immediately so helpers can trace
- B. Protecting remaining funds on a clean device, then notes — not paying a Telegram recovery
- C. Paying a specialist with leftover dust so they can attach a tracer
- D. Sending an equal amount to the thief's refund address to outrun the drain

Correct answer: B

Q2. A seed that was in Google Notes, or typed into a “repair” site, should be?

- A. Kept, if nothing has happened yet
- B. Retired — new seed on a clean device, test, move, never reuse or “repair” the old words
- C. Posted so others can check the spelling of the words
- D. Used as the savings pocket forever because empty leaked wallets are safe

Correct answer: B

Q3. An empty leaked wallet is still dangerous because?

- A. Chain id changes when a wallet hits zero
- B. Thieves watch it for future deposits — it is still a camera
- C. BscScan deletes empty addresses and the seed with them
- D. Gas becomes infinite on retired addresses

Correct answer: B

Q4. Lost authenticator 2FA is recovered via?

- A. A Telegram skip-the-queue admin who needs the seed to help
- B. The exchange's official recovery plus your paper backup codes
- C. Pasting the wallet seed into a clone login
- D. A revoke dApp from a search ad

Correct answer: B

Q5. Password reuse across email, exchange, and academy is dangerous because?

- A. It improves 2FA
- B. One leak opens several Door 2s
- C. BEP-20 forbids unique passwords
- D. It lowers gas

Correct answer: B

Q6. Paying a mixer or “tracer” in chat after a theft is?

- A. Academy standard operating procedure
- B. A likely second loss (and possibly worse) — not a way to reverse the chain
- C. How BscScan refunds work if you include a memo
- D. Required before you may write down a hash

Correct answer: B

Q7. A screenshot of a seed in the phone gallery is?

- A. Encrypted by the gallery, therefore a professional backup
- B. A leak — treat as Door 1 and rotate; photos are not a vault
- C. The preferred hardware-wallet export format
- D. Safe to send to support because images cannot be typed

Correct answer: B

Q8. Which sentence is honest after a completed on-chain drain?

- A. Validators will reverse it if she is an academy student
- B. That slice is gone from her budget; remaining funds and better doors are the job — police recovery is not promised
- C. Sending leftover dust to a specialist is how the slice comes back
- D. A second send to the thief’s refund address unlocks the first

Correct answer: B

Module 6: Living the rules, and Basic track close

A weekly checklist, device hygiene that actually happens, how to treat Crystal Stones and any other token after this course, the Basic track close, and what Intermediate will add — and still refuse.

Lesson 1: A weekly safety checklist (26 min)

A weekly safety checklist

Safety is a habit, not a mood after a scare. Moods fade. Sunday does not have to.

By the end of this lesson you should have a ten-minute list you can actually run, a per-popup list, and a per-DM list — and you should know that a week you skip is not a moral failure, it is a week the guns stay loaded.

Every week (about ten minutes)

- 853. Open bookmarked exchange security: sessions look like you? Kill strangers.
- 854. Withdrawal whitelist still on? New addresses you did not add?
- 855. Bookmarked explorer approval checker: any new spenders you do not recognise? Revoke the unknowns. Finite-or-zero on DEX routers you are not using this month.

- 856. Phone and laptop: OS update pending? Random apps to delete? Overlay-junk, “boosters,” mystery APKs.
- 857. Seed paper still where you think it is — without photographing it, without unfolding it on a webcam, without typing it to “check.”
- 858. Practice pocket versus savings pocket still separate? Did a savings seed visit a sponsored link?
- 859. Any new official site you actually used? Add the bookmark **now**, not on a panic day.
- 860. Email inbox: a reset you did not ask for is a prompt to lock from a bookmark, not a button to tap.

If a week is too often at first, pick **Sunday and anytime you used a new dApp**. After a new dApp, check approvals the same day, not “later.” Later is how March becomes August.

Map the list to doors so it is not a blob: items 1–2 and 8 are Door 2 (account). Item 3 is Door 3 (chain permission). Items 4–6 are Door 1 (device and the keys that live there). Item 7 is Door 4 prevention (you will not search under stress). If you only have three minutes, do 1 and 3. If you only have one minute after a new dApp, do 3. Perfection is how people skip the week. A short pass still unloads a gun.

Keep a little BNB on the play pocket so revoke is possible. A loaded gun and a zero-gas wallet is how people accept “we will pay gas if you share the seed.” That sentence is still a no. Get practice-size BNB through a path you already trust, on a calm day, then revoke.

Every time you sign

- Network chip (BNB Smart Chain is chain id **56** if that is the book you meant)
- Asset (USDT is not BNB is not Crystal Stones)
- Destination middle characters
- Is this connect, sign, approve, permit, or send?
- If confuse → reject. Tired → close.

Hardware: the device screen is the authority. Phone UI can lie. Blind confirm is still a yes.

Every time a human messages about money, listing, support, or Mentor

- Did I start this from a bookmark?
- Are they asking for a door — seed, OTP, approve, remote control, “verify by sending USDT”?
- Academy never-ask-seed. Wallet support that needs the words is not support.
- Pain they are rushing is a prop.

Cadence	Items	Failure mode if skipped
Weekly	Sessions, whitelist, approvals, junk apps, paper exists, bookmarks	Loaded guns and surprise logins
Per popup	Network, asset, destination middles, popup type	One tired yes
Per DM	Bookmark origin, door test, never-list	Door 4 opens 1–3
After a new dApp	Approvals the same day	March’s unlimited, August’s pull

Worked scenario. Sunday, ten minutes. A student finds an unlimited USDT approve from a DEX they no longer use. Revoke, thirty seconds of gas. In December that spender is in the news. The Sunday habit was the whole defence. They did not need a whitepaper in December. They needed March's hygiene.

A second student skips six Sundays, then does a two-hour "security day" in a panic after a cousin is drained. Panic days are for remaining funds, not for discovering bookmarked checkers. They still do the list. They also admit the list is easier when it is boring.

DIAGRAM

Weekly hygiene	--> fewer loaded guns, fewer surprise sessions
Per-popup read	--> fewer bad signatures
Per-DM door test	--> fewer social openings
After new dApp	--> same-day revoke of surprises
Skip the week	--> the guns stay loaded
Do not "make up" on a panic day by googling ads	

ACADEMY NOTE If you only remember one weekly item, make it approvals plus sessions. Paper backup "exists" is the second. Everything else supports those two. This academy will not demand a screenshot of your checklist. We would not know what to do with it, and we would never ask for the words that sit under item 5.

Three minutes is still a week: kill strange sessions, open the bookmarked approval checker, revoke one surprise. Ten minutes is better. Two hours of panic-Googleing is worse. Put the list where you will see it on Sunday — a paper note, not a screenshot of a seed. If you miss a Sunday, run it when you notice. Guilt is not a control. The list is.

What this lesson is for

So that Safety does not end at the quiz. A list you can run tired is worth more than a personality called careful. Put it on a calendar if that is how your kitchen works. Skip-guilt is not a door. An unloaded gun on Monday is.

Say this out loud

- Weekly: sessions, whitelist, approvals, junk apps, confirming paper backup exists, adding bookmarks on calm days.
- Per popup: network, asset, middles, type — or reject.
- Per DM: did I start this from a bookmark, and are they asking for a door?
- After a new dApp, I check approvals the same day.
- Habits beat slogans. I will not google hygiene into ads on a fire day.

Three minutes still counts: sessions and one surprise spender. Guilt about a missed Sunday is not a control. An unloaded gun on Monday is.

Next: device hygiene that actually happens — updates, SIM-swap, a separate browser profile, and the junk you will actually delete.

Lesson 2: Device hygiene that actually happens (updates, SIM-swap, separate browser profile) (27 min)

Device hygiene that actually happens (updates, SIM-swap, separate browser profile)

A threat model that needs a cleanroom you will never build is a threat model you will ignore. This lesson is the subset that happens in real kitchens: updates, SIM-swap readiness, a separate browser profile for money, and deleting junk you already know is junk.

By the end of this lesson you should name three device habits you will actually keep, and refuse to generate a savings seed on a playground phone.

Updates, without a sermon

OS updates close overlay holes and cloned-app holes you will never see in a changelog you enjoy reading. Turn them on. Wallet apps update from the **store listing you bookmarked**, not from a WhatsApp APK. Browser updates similarly. “I’ll update after this airdrop” is how the airdrop writes to memory you did not mean to share.

You do not need to become a sysadmin. You need to stop postponing the green button because a timer on a site said not to reboot.

SIM-swap, as a boring drill

Write the mobile operator’s real shop number on the same paper-adjacent place you keep other adult numbers — not in a notes app titled “crypto.” If the line dies strangely, if OTPs stop, if a text says “your SIM is moving,” you call *that* number. You ask to lock the SIM. You then rotate exchange and email from bookmarks. You assume SMS 2FA is burned.

If the product offers an authenticator app, use it. Paper backup codes in the same house as the seed paper, not in the same photo album. Seeds and 2FA codes are different objects. They can share a drawer. They cannot share a screenshot.

Separate browser profile (and why a second phone is optional)

A **browser profile** is a separate hat inside Chrome, Brave, Firefox, or similar: its own cookies, its own extensions. Money profile: almost no extensions, no “Web3 helper” you met in an ad, bookmarks for academy, explorer, exchange. Everyday profile: the rest of the internet, the rest of the cookies, the rest of the junk.

This is cheaper than a second phone and actually happens. A second phone or a hardware wallet is for amounts that would hurt, still with a test send, still reading the device screen. It is not required to finish Basic. It is architecture you can grow into.

Do not install random extensions that “simulate contracts” or “speed up BSC.” Extensions sit in the browser with the same view as you. They are Door 1-adjacent.

Habit	Why it happens in a kitchen	What it is not
OS + store updates on	One green button	A reason to sideload an APK
Operator number on paper	One line of writing	A Telegram “telco desk”
Authenticator, not SMS only	One setup, paper codes	A seed paste into the exchange
Separate browser profile for money	Ten minutes, once	A cleanroom lab
Delete battery boosters and “WhatsApp plus”	You already know they are junk	An antivirus APK from a group
Savings seed not born on a playground phone	Wait for a cleaner device	Using the leaked one as a burner

Worked scenario. Emeka’s Android has four “cleaner” APKs, SMS 2FA on the exchange, and MetaMask (an **example of a wallet app**) in the same Chrome profile he uses for football streams and random extensions.

861. He deletes the cleaners. He updates the OS. He creates a money profile with no extra extensions. He bookmarks academy, BscScan, the exchange.
862. He moves 2FA to an authenticator, paper codes in a drawer. He writes the operator number on the same card as his sister’s clinic.
863. Play pocket stays on the phone for now, practice size. Savings, when he has any, will wait for a cleaner setup. He does not generate a second seed on the old playground “just to have it.”
864. A week later a stream site wants a wallet extension. That ask stays in the everyday profile, which has no wallet. The money profile never visited the stream.

DIAGRAM

Everyday device / profile
 sports, chat, curiosity
 no savings seed
 no extra “Web3” extensions on the money hat

Money profile / quieter device
 bookmarks: academy, explorer, exchange, wallet store listing
 few or no extensions
 authenticator, not SMS only

SIM
 operator number on paper
 lock the line, then rotate Door 2

ACADEMY NOTE Hardware still does not bless a playground. If the laptop that proposes transactions is a junkyard, read the device screen as if the laptop is hostile — because it might be. If you will not read the screen, the steel box is a very expensive yes.

A shared family phone is a shared Door 1. Children tap. Cousins install. If the savings seed lives there, it lives in a house with extra hands. Either the play pocket stays tiny, or the savings seed lives on a device those hands do not use. That sentence has ended more “I don’t know who signed it” stories than any antivirus.

What this lesson is for

So that hygiene is a few things you will do, not a lifestyle you will perform on Twitter. Playgrounds do not birth savings seeds. Money gets a quieter hat.

Say this out loud

- Updates come from the OS and the bookmarked store listing, not from a chat APK.
- I have the operator's real number on paper. SIM-swap: lock the line, then rotate Door 2. SMS is a weak second factor.
- A separate browser profile for money is hygiene I can actually finish in ten minutes.
- I will not generate a savings seed on a playground of random APKs and extensions.
- Hardware still requires me to read the device screen. Blind signing is not hygiene.

Next: how to treat Crystal Stones and any other token after this course — verify the contract, no hunt for clones, education only.

Lesson 3: How to treat Crystal Stones and any other token after this course (verify contract, no hunt for clones) (27 min)

How to treat Crystal Stones and any other token after this course (verify contract, no hunt for clones)

Crystal Stones is a **BEP-20** token on **BNB Smart Chain**. That is a technical sentence, not a buy order. This academy will not tell you to buy it, hold it, or hunt a clone of it. The immune system you just built is how you look at **any** ticker without becoming the ticker's prey.

By the end of this lesson you should verify a contract on a bookmarked explorer, refuse name-collision tokens, and treat academy surfaces (Mentor, checkout, certificates) as bookmarked product — not as dApps that need a gun.

The only number this course wants you to memorise as a verify step

``0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00``

Chain id **56**. Explorer: bookmarked BscScan. Native gas: **BNB**. Tokens do not pay their own fees.

Verify means: the contract you add, if you add one, matches that string in the middle characters, not only the first four. Verify does not mean: buy. Verify does not mean: the RWA or mineral-vault story is proven. That story is **their claim to verify** in later, slower work — not a slogan we will stamp for them, and not a reason to skip Safety.

A second contract with a similar name is a clone until your bookmark says otherwise. “Academy is late, use this one” is Module 3. “Last train” is Module 3. “Airdrop of 8 million CST” is Module 4. You already have the refusals.

How academy surfaces fit

- **LMS / Mentor:** inside the bookmarked app. No seed. No permit. No remote control.
- **Certificates:** platform records after quizzes. Not a mint, not a connect-wallet event in Basic.
- **Paid tracks, later:** published checkout, USDT on BEP-20 via official the checkout processor when live. Not CST. Not PaynovaX. Not a WhatsApp QR. Not a personal 0x.
- **Staff:** will leave WhatsApp for the site. Will never DM a recovery agent.

Fake Crystal Stones sites, fake mentors, fake invoices, fake BscScan, fake Trust Wallet APKs — you have named all of them. The token does not get a special exception because you like the crystal. Like is Door 4's favourite weather.

Any other token, same rails

Wrong network still vanishes value. Unlimited approve still loads a gun. Unsolicited inbound is still junk. A DEX you did not bookmark is still a site. Hardware still needs a read. Practice size still applies when curiosity itches.

You will meet thousands of names. Being “on a blockchain” is not a quality stamp. Intermediate, if you continue, will add tools for reading contracts and tokenomics. It will not add a licence to skip the four doors.

Action	Adult version	Costume
Add Crystal Stones to a wallet	Verify the contract on bookmarked BscScan, or don't add it	Ad, fan-group CA, “new official”
Pay this academy later	Bookmarked checkout, USDT BEP-20 / the checkout processor	WhatsApp invoice, CST to a mentor
Check a balance	Explorer or wallet read	Dashboard that wants unlimited USDT to view
Meet a new ticker	Practice size, bookmark, finite approve if you ever swap	Last train, VIP, guaranteed

Worked scenario. A cousin sends a contract in WhatsApp: “CST migrated, add this, academy slow.” Ada opens bookmarked BscScan. Middles do not match `0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00`. Token is forty minutes old.

865. She does not add it. She does not swap “a little to see.” She does not argue for twenty minutes. She sends this lesson's one-line refusal: verify or nothing.
866. She does not buy the real one as a consolation. This course did not become a buy order because a clone appeared.
867. She checks her play pocket approvals on Sunday like a person who has finished Basic, not like a person hunting listings.
868. Mentor in the app has nothing to say about the clone except what she already knows: never-ask-seed, four doors, bookmarks.

DIAGRAM

See a token name (CST or anything else)
|


```
v
Bookmarked explorer, middle characters
|
+--> matches a contract you already meant to verify? continue as education
/ your own choice
+--> new, similar, hurried, VIP, migrated? no

Academy product
--> bookmarked LMS, published checkout
X clone dApps, Mentor DMs, the checkout processor QRs in chat
```

ACADEMY NOTE Education only. Never a buy, sell, or price target. If you hold Crystal Stones already, you still revoke unknown spenders, still practise small, still refuse clones. Holding is not a halo. If you hold nothing, you still finished the immune system. Rails are the prize of Basic, not a position.

Name-collision tokens will keep arriving. Your job is not to catalogue them. Your job is to not hunt. Curiosity that needs a swap is still a swap. Curiosity that needs an unlimited approve is still a gun. The verify-only string is enough. Everything else can wait for Intermediate's slower tools, or it can wait forever.

What this lesson is for

So that the project this academy is named after does not get a free pass, and so that every other ticker inherits the same refuse-lines. Verify. Don't hunt clones. Don't let a crystal skip a door.

Say this out loud

- Crystal Stones, if I verify it, is `0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00` on BNB Smart Chain — a verify step, not a buy order.
- A similar name is a clone until a bookmark says otherwise. I do not hunt clones.
- Academy Mentor, certificates, and checkout do not need a seed, a permit, or a WhatsApp QR.
- Any other token uses the same four doors. Being on a chain is not a quality stamp.
- I can finish Basic holding nothing. Rails were the job.

Next: Basic track close — five courses, one job: rails, not a trading career.

Lesson 4: Basic track close: five courses, one job — rails, not a trading career (26 min)

Basic track close: five courses, one job — rails, not a trading career

You have finished the Basic map. The job was not to make you a trader. It was to make you **hard to steal from** and **hard to confuse**. If a friend asks what you studied, that sentence is enough, then the five titles.

By the end of this lesson you should name the five courses in order, name the four doors without looking, and refuse the idea that Basic was a starter pack for guaranteed profit.

The five courses, as one immune system

869. **Crypto Foundations** — money as ledgers, Bitcoin as history, keys as power of attorney, tokens as rows on a book. Crystal Stones as one project on one network, not the definition of crypto.
870. **Wallets, Keys & Self-Custody** — the key manager, seed, receive and send, practice amounts. Trust Wallet and MetaMask as **examples of wallet apps**, not endorsements.
871. **Exchanges & Your First Buy** — IOUs, KYC, 2FA, P2P receipts that are not settlement, BEP-20 withdraw, test send. Binance as **an example of a centralised exchange**.
872. **Blockchain & BNB Smart Chain** — chain id 56, BNB for gas, BscScan, contracts, the Crystal Stones address as a verify step.
873. **Crypto Safety & Common Scams** — four doors, phishing, people, drains, first hour, checklist. This course. The immune system.

If a friend only has time for one Safety slice, send them never-ask-seed, the four doors, and the panic-day procedure. Then send them into this course properly. A slice is not a personality. A course is a set of drills.

Each earlier course already trained a refuse-line this one reused. Foundations: the chain will not parent you. Wallets: a seed is not a password you reset. Exchanges: a receipt is not settlement, and a withdrawal is the moment self-custody starts. BSC: the contract string in the middle characters beats a logo. Safety: name the door, then pick the fix. If you cannot name which course a mistake belongs to, name the door anyway. Doors are the index.

You are allowed to replay. Quizzes are doors, not decorations. Re-opening Wallets because you never wrote the paper backup is more adult than collecting a Safety certificate over an empty vault.

What you will still refuse, as a list you can screenshot ***without*** a seed in the frame

- seeds, private keys, 2FA, remote control, in any chat
- ads as navigation
- send-first doubles and verify-by-sending-USDT
- surprise migrations and secret official contracts
- revoke tools from ads, especially seed-first
- recovery wizards, dust tracers, mixer-detectives
- painted platforms a lover sent
- last trains, VIP recruitment, guaranteed yield
- hardware as a licence to sign blindly
- this academy as a buy order

If you only remember four sentences	Why they earn the slot
I am the security team.	Finality has no parent
Match the network to the book.	Wrong book, gone value
Explorer beats screenshots.	The book names the door
Academy never asks for the words.	Costume test

Worked scenario. A stall-owner who finished all five is invited, the same week, to a VIP CST doubling, a fake the checkout processor certificate invoice, and a “job” testing a dApp. She does not need new theory.

874. Send-first is a donation. Invoice she did not start in the app is fake billing. Secret job is a task mill.

875. She runs panic-day in miniature: no, bookmark, name the door. Human, human, human.

876. Sunday she still checks approvals. Play pocket still play-sized.

877. She does not become a group detective. She warns two people with the domain. She goes back to the stall. Rails, not a career in other people’s adrenaline.

DIAGRAM

```
Basic
  Foundations --> Wallets --> Exchanges --> BSC --> Safety
    |
    v
Harder to steal from, harder to confuse
    |
    v
Intermediate later, if you choose it (paid track when live)
  contracts, DeFi, tokenomics, markets as study
  still no guaranteed profit
```

ACADEMY NOTE If you felt behind in any of the five, you are allowed to replay a lesson. Quizzes are doors, not decorations. This academy would rather you re-open Wallets than pretend Safety can parent a seed you never wrote down.

Each earlier course already trained a refuse-line this one reused. Foundations: the chain will not parent you. Wallets: a seed is not a password you reset. Exchanges: a receipt is not settlement, and a withdrawal is the moment self-custody starts. BSC: the contract string in the middle characters beats a logo. Safety: name the door, then pick the fix. If you cannot name which course a mistake belongs to, name the door anyway. Doors are the index.

What this lesson is for

So that the track has a close, not a cliff. You know what you were trained for: rails. You know what you were not trained for: a living as a trader, a recovery agent, or a recruiter. If someone congratulates you by sending a “graduate VIP contract,” that is Module 3 on graduation day. Refuse it with the same paragraph you already have.

Say this out loud

- Basic’s job was rails: hard to steal from, hard to confuse — not a trading career.
- Five courses: Foundations, Wallets, Exchanges, BNB Smart Chain, Safety.
- Four doors: device, account, chain permission, human. Explorer beats screenshots.
- Academy never asks for the words, the OTP, the screen, or a verifying send.
- I can warn a friend with never-ask-seed, four doors, and panic-day, then send them into the course.

Graduation week is a hunting season. A “graduate VIP contract” is Module 3 with a certificate costume. The refuse-list does not expire because a quiz went green.

Next: what Intermediate will add — contracts, DeFi, tokenomics — and what it will still refuse.

Lesson 5: What Intermediate will add (contracts, DeFi, tokenomics) and what it will still refuse (guaranteed profit) (27 min)

What Intermediate will add (contracts, DeFi, tokenomics) and what it will still refuse (guaranteed profit)

Basic ends here. Intermediate, when you choose it and when that paid track is live, is more rails — thicker rails — not a personality transplant into a trader who cannot be touched. Checkout, if you ever pay it, is the published USDT BEP-20 the checkout processor flow from the bookmarked site. Not a Mentor DM. Not Crystal Stones token as tuition.

By the end of this lesson you should know what the next track is for, what it will still refuse, and how to live between tracks without hunting clones to “stay sharp.”

What Intermediate is for (preview, not a syllabus you must buy tonight)

- **Contracts** — reading what a BEP-20 actually permits, what a router does, why allowance exists, how to look at a verified source without pretending you audited it professionally
- **DeFi** — using a DEX as a tool with finite approves, knowing pools can be empty or hostile, knowing “connect” is not a ritual of belonging
- **Tokenomics** — supply, unlocks, who can mint, what a claim is worth as a claim rather than as a guarantee
- **Markets as study** — how pairs and order books work, still without a signal group, still without “the last train”

None of that cancels Safety. Unlimited approve is still a gun. A new contract is still a stranger. A yield number is still not a law of physics.

What it will still refuse

Guaranteed profit. Risk-free return. Academy-as-broker. Staff as recovery agents. Seed collection. “Verify by sending.” Secret listings in VIP rooms. Hardware as a blind-sign licence. Police reversal as a product feature.

If a person selling Intermediate (or a clone of Intermediate) needs those costumes, they are not this academy. The never-list does not expire when you pay. Paid is a checkout event. It is not a halo.

How to live after Basic, even if Intermediate waits

Run the Sunday list. Keep practice amounts. Keep two pockets if you have two piles. Keep bookmarks. Keep the operator number on paper. Treat Crystal Stones as a contract to verify, not a hunt:

`0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00`. Hold nothing if you want. Hold play size if you want. This course will not grade your position. It will grade whether you can name a door.

Teach one person the never-ask-seed paragraph without making them your downline. Teaching is not recruitment. Recruitment that needs their deposit is Module 3.

Intermediate may add	Intermediate will still refuse	You already have
Reading contracts more slowly	Guaranteed profit, signal VIP	Four doors, panic-day, weekly list
Using DeFi tools as tools	Seed / OTP / remote / verifying send	Bookmarks, finite-approve instinct
Tokenomics as claims to check	Academy-as-broker, recovery DMs	Verify-only CST address
Markets as vocabulary	Last trains, painted desks	Practice amounts

Worked scenario. Two graduates. One waits six months, runs Sundays, holds nothing, uses an exchange IOU for ordinary payments. One continues to Intermediate when it is live, pays through bookmarked checkout, still rejects a “DeFi boost” APK in the same week as lesson one.

878. Both finished Basic honestly. Neither is behind. Rails do not expire.

879. The second still treats a hex blob as reject. A new module is not a new personality.

880. A third person buys a fake Intermediate from a WhatsApp invoice. That person needed this lesson, not a discount. Ada sends them the never-list and the bookmarked site. She does not send her remaining address.

881. The chain, this whole time, will still settle a theft as calmly as a gift. That is why Safety sat last in Basic, not first as a scare and not never.

DIAGRAM

After Basic

```

|
+--> live the checklist, practice size, bookmarks
+--> optional Intermediate (published checkout only)
|
still refuse
  guaranteed profit
  seeds in chat
  recovery theatre
  clone hunts
  last trains

```

ACADEMY NOTE If you never take Intermediate, you did not fail Crystal Stones Academy Basic. You finished the immune system. That was the assignment. Anyone who says Basic was incomplete unless you buy the next thing is selling. We will invite you. We will not kidnap you with a timer.

Between tracks, curiosity will itch. Feed it with the Sunday list and the BSC course’s explorer drills, not with a VIP room. If a friend is already in Intermediate, they still do not get your seed to “show you a pool.” Teaching is questions about concepts. It is not a screen share of a funded wallet. The never-list does not have a graduate exception.

What this lesson is for

So that the door out of Basic is a door, not a funnel. You know the next map exists. You know it will not parent you either. You know what you will still refuse on the days nobody is grading a quiz.

Say this out loud

- Intermediate, if I choose it, adds contracts, DeFi, and tokenomics as study — not guaranteed profit.
- Paid checkout is published USDT BEP-20 / the checkout processor from a bookmark, never a Mentor DM.
- The never-list does not expire when I pay, and it does not expire if I wait.
- I can live on the Sunday checklist holding nothing. Rails were the job of Basic.
- The chain will still settle a theft as calmly as a gift. I remain the security team.

Between tracks, feed curiosity with explorer drills and the Sunday list, not a VIP room. A graduate still does not share a seed so a friend can “show a pool.”

Take the quiz. Use the checklist on Sunday. If you teach one person, teach them this: Crystal Stones Academy will never ask for a seed phrase, and will never DM you a recovery agent.

Module quiz (answers included for editors)

Q1. The weekly checklist includes?

- A. Re-entering the seed into a website to “refresh” it
- B. Sessions, whitelist, new approvals, junk apps, confirming paper backup exists
- C. Disabling all 2FA so popups are simpler
- D. Approving unlimited USDT just in case a dashboard needs it

Correct answer: B

Q2. A separate browser profile for money is useful because?

- A. It encrypts the seed inside the gallery automatically
- B. Everyday cookies and random extensions do not sit in the same hat as exchange and explorer bookmarks
- C. BNB Smart Chain requires two profiles by law
- D. It lets her sign hex blobs blindly on hardware

Correct answer: B

Q3. After this course, Ada should treat a WhatsApp “new CST contract, academy slow” as?

- A. A listing she must catch — last train
- B. A clone hunt to refuse — verify `0xe252FCb1Aa2E0876E9B5f3eD1e15B9b4d11A0b00` on bookmarked BscScan, or add nothing
- C. A reason to sideload a Trust Wallet APK
- D. Official the checkout processor billing

Correct answer: B

Q4. The Basic track's primary job is?

- A. Guaranteed trading profit and a Crystal Stones purchase
- B. Make you hard to steal from and hard to confuse — rails, not a trading career
- C. Teach you to run a drainer so you understand crime from the inside
- D. Replace your bank next week

Correct answer: B

Q5. Hardware wallet means she can sign anything blindly?

- A. Yes — steel is a halo
- B. No — she must still read the device screen; hardware will happily sign a permit if she confirms
- C. Yes, but only on chain id 56
- D. Yes, if the phone UI looks like Crystal Stones

Correct answer: B

Q6. Intermediate, as previewed here, will still refuse?

- A. Reading contracts and using a DEX as a tool
- B. Guaranteed profit, seed collection, recovery DMs, and last-train VIP signals
- C. Tokenomics as claims to check
- D. Published USDT BEP-20 checkout from a bookmark

Correct answer: B

Q7. A SIM-swap drill that actually happens is?

- A. Paste the seed to telco support in Telegram
- B. Call the operator on a number she already had, lock the SIM, rotate Door 2 off SMS 2FA
- C. Install a battery-booster APK to hold the line
- D. Send leftover dust to a tracer so they can freeze the SIM

Correct answer: B

Q8. Tuition for a later paid track, when live, should be paid how?

- A. CST to a Mentor WhatsApp, or a PDF the checkout processor QR that arrived unsolicited
- B. Published checkout on the bookmarked academy site — USDT on BEP-20 via official the checkout processor, not a DM
- C. Verify-by-sending BNB to a listing team
- D. An APK invoice inside a fake Trust Wallet

Correct answer: B

